TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 3, 2026

The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

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Tour Name	J&L Price	Ex-Delhi
Singapore Thailand Malaysia (10D) Nov 15	160K-190K	207K-235K
Singapore Malaysia Bali (10D)	NA	230K-240K
Singapore Malaysia (7D)	141K-161K	182K-202K
Singapore Thailand (8D)	129K-150K	190K-210K
Singapore Bali (8D)	140K-170K	205K-245K
Best of Singapore (5D)	121K-131K	154K-164K
Best of Bali (7D)	106K-125K	151K-170K
Phuket Krabi (4D)	68K-82K	108K-125K
Thailand (4D/6D) Nov 22	40K-90K	75K-120K
Women's Special Thailand (6D)	39K-79K	79K-109K
Bangkok Pattaya Phuket Krabi (8D)	94K-101K	149K-165K
Chiang Mai Chiang Rai Phuket Krabi (9D)	NA	205K-210K
HKG Macao Shenzhen (7D) Nov 18	161K-191K	211K-242K
Best of Vietnam (8D)	NA	161K-190K
Highlights of Vietnam (5D) Nov 22	NA	130K-145K
Vietnam Da Nang Phu Quoc (11D) Nov 22	NA	237K-255K
Vietnam Cambodia (11D)	NA	237K-247K
Philippines Manila Cebu (8D)	NA	220000
Best of Laos (6D) Feb 12	105K-110K	160K-170K
Best of Japan with Nagoya (7D)	235K-255K	300K-320K
Japan China (13D)	378K-400K	453K-475K

America Africa Australia NZ

Tour Name	J&L Price	Ex-Delhi
Highlights of Australia (7D)	194K-200K	279K-289K
Best of Australia (9D)	247K-326K	379K-471K
All of Australia (15D)	434K-450K	539K-549K
Best of New Zealand (10D)	292K-303K	432K-453K
All of New Zealand (15D)	415K-500K	545K-555K
Australia New Zealand (11D/17D)	311K-484K	442K-641K
Australia New Zealand (21D)	618K-718K	778K-810K
Best of Kenya (8D)	250K-260K	305K-310K
South Africa with Pilanesberg National Park (9D)	199K-210K	275K-285K
South Africa with Kruger National Park (13D)	-	400K-410K
Best of Mauritius (6D)	103K-110K	180K-185K
USA East+West Coast with Chicago (13D)	425000	-
USA East Coast (7D)	195000	NA
USA West Coast (7D)	225000	NA
South America with Rio Carnival (21D)	1235000	1505000
Antarctica (13D) Jan 31	1120000	1399000

Europe - Western, Eastern, Northern, Mediterranean

Tour Name	J&L Price	Ex-Delhi
Swiss Paris Austria Germany (6D)	110K-120K	185K-195K
Swiss Paris Germany Amsterdam (6D)	104K-115K	179K-185K
Swiss Paris London (11D)	300K-325K	390K-410K
Swiss Paris Austria Italy (6D)	110K-115K	185K-195K
European Splendours (10D)	210K-225K	287K-300K
European Highlights (11D)	245K-255K	337K-345K
European Wonders (13D)	275K-290K	350K-360K
European Jewels with Versailles (15D)	370K-380K	450K-460K
London Paris Swiss Italy (9D)	205K-215K	295K-305K
Swiss Paris Italy (11D)	260K-270K	340K-350K
Swiss Paris (8D)	200K-215K	285K-300K
Vienna Prague Budapest Bratislava (8D)	175-185K	260K-270K
Croatia Slovenia Slovakia Hungary (12D)	290K-300K	375K-385K
Central and Eastern Europe (17D)	360K-370K	445K-455K

Tour Name	J&L Price	Ex-Delhi
Scandinavia Northern Lights with Icebreaker Cruise (10D)	390K-400K	505K-520K
Best of Iceland with Northern Lights (9D)	395K-410K	505K-520K
Iceland Scandinavia Northern Lights + Icebreaker Cruise (15D)	545K-560K	660K-685K
Russia Northern Lights (9D)	245K-305K	305K-315K
Spain Portugal (13D)	285K-290K	370K-385K
Spain Portugal Morocco (17D)	365K-380K	455K-470K
Egypt Greece Turkey (15D)	NA	485K-500K
Best of Turkey (10D)	170K-180K	250K-260K
Greece - Athens Santorini Rhodes (9D)	250K-290K	325K-365K
Tunisia Malta Sicily (10D)	310K-325K	385K-400K
Uzbekistan Kazakhstan Kyrgyzstan (9D)	160K-180K	245K-260K
Women's Special Iceland Northern Lights (9D) Mar 11	395000	505000
Georgia Armenia (8D)	160K-170K	220K-230K
Best of Egypt (10D)	200K-225K	260K-285K
Best of Almaty (5D)	80K-100K	125K-145K

India Nepal Bhutan Sri Lanka



Sri Lanka (5D/7D)
Dubai Abu Dhabi (5D)
Bhutan/Nepal (9D/8D)
Kashmir (6D)
Nainital Mussoorie Haridwar Corbett Park (9D)
Himachal (6D/8D)
Bhubaneswar Puri Konark Chilika (6D)
Rajasthan(4D to 17D)
Madhya Pradesh(5D/8D/13D/18D)
Gujarat (7D to 17D)
Karnataka (6D/8D)
Tamil Nadu (5D to 12D)
Keralam (6D/9D/11D)
Andaman (7D)

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THE INDIAN EXPRESS

The World

TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 3, 2026

RUSSIA USED OLESHKY CEASEFIRE TO BUILD UP ITS MILITARY POSITIONS, ALLEGES UKRAINE

18 killed as Russia struck village school acting as an aid centre, says Zelenskyy

'After the first strike, there was a repeat with 9 more bombs'

Reuters
Kyiv, November 2



A screen grab of a video shows Russian military personnel during a demining operation in Oleshky city. REUTERS

UKRAINIAN PRESIDENT Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Monday that Russian forces had bombed a village in southeastern Zaporihzhia region, killing 18 people and injuring five.

Zelenskiy, writing on Telegram, said Russian forces initially dropped aerial bombs on a school in the village of Komyshuvakha, used for distributing humanitarian assistance.

"After the first air strike, there was a repeat strike with nine more bombs, directly on the shelter where people were gathered," Zelenskyy wrote.

"The Russians could not have been unaware that every week residents who have remained in Komyshuvakha were receiving assistance aid right there. This is yet further proof that Russia does not want any kind of de-escalation, any real justice."

On Monday, Ukraine's General Staff said that Russian forces had used a humanitarian ceasefire last week in the Russian-held southern town of Oleshky to strengthen their military positions, which Moscow said it assumed Kyiv had also done.

The six—day ceasefire, brokered through US First Lady Melania Trump, was meant to allow aid deliveries and civilian evacuations from the frontline town. In total, nearly 800 people were evacuated, Melania Trump said on X.

However, Ukraine's General Staff said it recorded rotations of Russian units, fortification of positions, expansion of anti—drone measures along roads, and logistics activity including deliveries of ammunition.

"Under the ceasefire introduced for the humanitarian operation in Oleshky, units of the Defence Forces of Ukraine ensured that the ceasefire was observed, and acted exclusively within the framework of the agreements reached," the General Staff said on X. "The enemy, by contrast, used humanitarian pause to improve its positions."

In response, Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov said he had no specific information about Russian military operations, but assumed Ukrainian forces had also used ceasefire to regroup. "This is standard practice in such situations. But I'm not familiar with the specifics," he said.

In a video address on Facebook, Ukraine's 34th Separate Marine Brigade "Borysfen" urged residents of the Kherson region not to ignore air raid sirens, saying Russia had "used the ceasefire to prepare and strengthen its capabilities".

Hackers hit emergency apps, send fake nuclear, chemical attack alerts

Reuters
Kyiv, November 2

UKRAINE AND Russia said their emergency alert apps had been hacked overnight, sending false warnings to citizens about impending air raids and chemical and nuclear attacks.

Ukraine's public air raid app started to send false alerts just before 11 pm on Sunday for the capital Kyiv and other areas, warning of radiation and chemical attacks and also the risk of street combat in some areas.

Hours later, Russian state news agency *TASS* quoted the Emergencies Ministry in Moscow as saying that its own mobile app had also been hit by a cyberattack that resulted in fake public warnings being transmitted.

Reuters was unable to verify which groups were responsible. Experts have linked previous cyber security incidents during the almost five-year-old war to activist hackers as well as intelligence agencies on both sides.

In Ukraine, one of the alarms said Russia had launched a hypersonic Oreshnik missile, capable of carrying a nuclear warhead, and that a nuclear alert had been declared.

Ukraine's air force said shortly after on Telegram hat the alert system appeared to have been hacked by Russia, noting the alerts were broadcast in Russian. "The air alert app appears to have been subjected to enemy influence," the air force said.

Atesh, a pro-Ukrainian hacking group, posted a screenshot of the alert message seen in Russia on its Telegram channel on Monday, with a message saying: "The Ministry of Emergency Situations app has been hacked!"

However, the Moscow ministry played down the impact, saying the app was not one of its main public warning system channels.

A fake message posted by the hackers did not attempt to mimic an official communication and was laced with colloquialisms, profanities and derogatory language about Russia, calling its regions "swamps".

The message told Russians that nuclear warheads had been launched and advised people to stock up on three weeks of food and shelter in their cellars.

MIDTERM POLLS: MICHIGAN ENDORSEMENT ROILS SENATE RACE

Parties make a final push as US gets set to vote

Reuters
Detroit, Michigan, November 2



Michigan Republican Senate candidate Mike Rogers (right) with Haley Stevens at a church service in Detroit on Sunday. AP

DEMOCRATS SOUGHT on Monday to contain a rift in Michigan's US Senate race after one of their own crossed party lines to endorse the Republican, as both parties made their final push before midterm elections that will determine control of Congress for the next two years.

US Representative Haley Stevens, who lost the Michigan Democratic Senate primary to Abdul El-Sayed in a bitter contest, publicly backed Republican Mike Rogers and appeared with him at a Detroit church.

Trump, who has been holding daily rallies around the country for Republican candidates, was due to deliver remarks at 1900 GMT at the belated reopening of Washington's Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool.

In Michigan, Stevens' decision to endorse Republican Rogers surprised party leaders, with some, such as Representative Debbie Dingell, saying it created a "distraction" for Democrats. Stevens said in a video posted to social media: "I don't belong in Abdul's campaign."

Nonpartisan analysts generally favor Democrats'chances of winning a majority in the House of Representatives. Winning control of the Senate will be trickier, with those analysts now seeing races in Republican-leaning states including Texas, Kansas and Iowa as competitive for the opposition, giving it more options for a path to pmajority.

Control of either chamber would constrain Trump's ability to pass legislation and empower Democrats to probe his administration, while a Senate majority would also allow them to block his appointees to federal courts including Supreme Court.

According to the University of Florida Election Lab, 55 million votes have been cast in person and by mail already.

Michigan Rift

Stevens called on El-Sayed to condemn an outside group's ad that she said blames Israel for high grocery prices. "That ad was very painful," Stevens told *CNN* on Sunday night. "There are so many Democrats who want to vote for our Democratic nominee, and they're just being told, 'Hey, this is a party you don't belong in, or this is a campaign you don't belong in.'"

El-Sayed's campaign recently asked Stevens to skip his events through Election Day so as "not to distract from the central issues of the campaign," a person familiar with the matter said.

Republicans sought to capitalize on Stevens' move. "When you see a party, and at least a sliver of the party, veering off into the virulent hate that they have been spewing toward a group of people, it gets dangerous," Rogers said.

Revised peace proposal on table, contacts continue: Iran

Tehran shortens its proposals for faster implementation

Reuters
Dubai, November 2

CONTACTS BETWEEN Iran and the United States to end their eight-month war are continuing, Tehran's foreign ministry said on Monday, after days of Iranian talks with Qatari mediators ended with altered proposals but no breakthrough.

"I can tell you that the dialogues are continuing. However, the issue is complex," said Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmaeil Baghaei, adding that the two sides were exchanging messages through mediators.

Amid fears the conflict could reignite after Tuesday's midterm elections in the United States, China and Russia both spoke out on Monday against the possibility of renewed military action in a war that has hit the global economy.

Baghaei said the plan Iran had submitted in September to end the war remained the focus of discussions, but he confirmed comments attributed to Foreign Minister Abbas Araqchi on Saturday that the proposal could be shortened.



Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmaeil Baghaei

"The basis of dialogue and talks between Iran and the US via mediators is still Iran's seven-steps proposal, which is now condensed, making it possible to implement it within two days," he said.

US President Donald Trump rejected the seven-step proposal in September.

The plan would call for the US to end its blockade on Iranian ports, Iran to reopen the Strait of Hormuz waterway, a US waiver on Iranian oil sales, the cancellation of new sanctions on Iran and then talks on other issues.

Baghaei reiterated condensing the plan would not change Iran's underlying stance that a return to talks on the country's nuclear programme could only happen after it verified that all its conditions were met.

Asked whether the possibility of transferring Iran's highly enriched uranium stockpile to another country was raised in the talks, and whether Iran might agree to that, he said no.

An official briefed on the talks said Iran's negotiators had left on Sunday but not because of any problems in the talks, and added that a draft proposal was being circulated without elaborating.

Meanwhile, China's Foreign Minister Wang Yi said Monday all parties to the conflict should focus on political solutions rather than resorting to arms again after a meeting with senior Iranian security official Ali Bagheri Kani in Beijing.

Trump's team takes Democratic bastion California ballot fight to SC

Reuters
November 2

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump's administration asked the US Supreme Court on Monday to temporarily block California from counting mail-in ballots from more than 20,000 registered voters who federal officials allege are likely non-US citizens.

Escalating a legal fight that could affect thousands of voters in the November 3 midterm elections, the Justice Department filed the emergency request as it seeks to prevent counting the disputed ballots until each voter's citizenship status can be verified.

A federal appeals court had refused the request on Friday. Trump's fellow Republicans are fighting to retain control of Congress in the midterms. California is the most populous US state and a Democratic stronghold.

The administration has intensified its focus on alleged non-citizen voting in the run-up to the midterms.

The US Constitution assigns the responsibility of administering elections to states, though the federal government has some oversight. The lawsuit marked a rare federal intervention in the voting process and signaled a willingness by the administration to contest the election results in court.

The administration already sought to restrict voting by mail — a mode of casting ballots used more often by Democratic-leaning voters — but the Supreme Court in September rebuffed that effort.

The list of 20,000 registered voters was amassed by the US Department of Homeland Security and sent to California officials and to Los Angeles County officials.

Binance sees $4.7 billion in withdrawals after heist raises security concerns

Reuters
Singapore, Paris, November 2

BINANCE'S CUSTOMERS have withdrawn a net $4.72 billion from the world's biggest cryptocurrency exchange since it reopened, after hackers stole around $6.3 billion of crypto from the platform in what could be the largest financial heist in history.

The exchange froze withdrawals for about 48 hours after the hack, which which the FBI said was carried out by North Korea, then started allowing customers to withdraw again on Sunday .

The theft has underlined the vulnerability of digital assets to attacks and raised questions about the impact on Binance, which has vowed to repay customers in full, and on the wider market. Binance said the net outflows amounted to around 3% of assets on the platform, a relatively modest figure that analysts said suggested customer confidence had largely held up. The majority of the withdrawals from the platform were in form of Tether's USDT stablecoin, Binance added.

The outflow compares with about $7 billion withdrawn from Circle's USDC stablecoin over a week after the collapse of Silicon Valley Bank in 2023. Binance itself processed net outflows of about $6 billion over 72 hours in 2022 after the collapse of FTX .

The attack marks a step-up in North Korea's crypto thefts. Blockchain analytics firm TRM Labs said North Korea-linked hackers have stolen $7.4 billion so far in 2026.

Nepal investigating alleged conspiracy against Balen govt

Yubaraj Ghimire
Kathmandu, November 2

THE INVESTIGATION into the arrest of a former chief justice Cholendra Shumsher Rana in Nepal has widened, bringing politicians, judges, senior police officers, bureaucrats and businessmen under scrutiny over their alleged roles in business deals and policy decisions. Rana was arrested shortly after midnight on September 26. Following nationwide protests, the government released him, saying he had been taken into "protective custody" at his own request because he was receiving "threats" from certain quarters.

PM Balendra Shah has said that no guilty person will be spared. Investigating agencies have indicated that there was a plot to topple Shah government.

Bangladesh's garment factories shut again as wage protests turn violent

Reuters
Dhaka, November 2

BANGLADESH'S GARMENT factories briefly resumed operations on Monday after a widespread shutdown a day earlier, but fresh clashes between workers and police forced hundreds of plants to suspend production again.

The unrest has raised concerns over shipment delays and buyer confidence in Bangladesh, a key supplier to brands including H&M, Zara, Walmart and Primark.

Workers demanding a minimum monthly wage of 30,000 taka ($243), up from 12,500 taka, blocked roads, vandalised factories and clashed with police prompting 679 factories to halt production.

In a bid to defuse the crisis, the government on Sunday formed a six-member wage board to review workers' demands, which have gained momentum amid persistent inflation and rising living costs.

Police said they used tear gas to disperse garment workers attempting to block roads in Dhaka after protesters hurled bricks and stones at officers. Unrest was also reported in Ashulia and Gazipur, two manufacturing hubs on the outskirts of the capital.

Police and industry officials said protesters set fire to a police vehicle and vandalised a number of factories. The clashes follow Sunday's protests and factory closures, with workers continuing to demand higher wages and resolution of employment grievances.



Fireball after Florida jet crash, 9 killed

A fireball rises into the sky as thick black smoke billows from the crash site after a Bahamas-bound Learjet 60 plunged into the ground at high speed and crashed in a residential area near a busy roadway in Palm Beach County, Florida, on Monday. All nine people aboard were killed, officials said. AP

2 dead, 20 hurt in stampede at Pak social media influencer's wedding

Lahore: Two people were killed and over twenty others sustained injuries in a stampede in Pakistan's Punjab province after a large crowd rushed to enter a wedding venue to collect cash and other prizes announced by a social media influencer, an official said on Monday.

The incident occurred on Saturday evening at Faraz Sports Stadium in Sialkot, about 100 kilometres from capital Lahore.

According to police, TikToker Anser Mahmood, also known as Mr Patlo, leveraged his social media platform to invite the public to his mehndi ceremony, offering prizes as an incentive.

Police officer Dost Muhammad confirmed that six suspects have been arrested after a case was registered against nine named individuals, including TikToker Mahmood, and 45 unidentified people.

Two people, identified as Rehan and Adeel, were killed in the stampede and more than two dozen others suffered injuries, he said. The FIR cites multiple offences, including death by negligence, violation of official directives, property damage, and unlawful assembly.

TikToker Mahmood used social media to invite the public to his mehndi ceremony, promising massive giveaways including 20 million Pakistani rupees in cash, a car, 50 motorcycles, mobile phones, and other luxury gifts, according to police officer Dost Muhammad. PTI

• HACKERS SEIZE CONTROL OF FRIDGES AT HUNDREDS OF SUPERMARKETS, RAISING TEMPERATURES AS HIGH AS 50 DEGREES CELSIUS, CAUSING FIRES & FOOD LOSSES

Hackers turn up the heat on Europe's supermarket chillers — again

Reuters
Stockholm, Brussels, November 2

A HACKING attack on European supermarkets spread across the continent on Monday, hitting fridges and freezers from Sweden to Belgium and forcing stores to throw away food in an incident that echoed a similar attack in France last month.

The attack, which raised temperatures in refrigerator and freezer units at dozens of stores, hit supermarket groups Ahold Delhaize and Colruyt in Belgium and Luxembourg, as well as Swedish grocers ICA and Coop. Furniture-to-meatballs retailer IKEA also saw at least one store affected.

"Everything is destroyed," Engla Ingwall, sales manager at an ICA franchise store in Stockholm, told *Reuters* during a visit to the store on Monday, adding the attack occurred at 2 am but was only noticed hours later.

"There has been a cyberattack and all our freezers reached 50 degrees (Celsius)."

A spokesperson for privately held ICA said the company was aware that a "limited number of stores were affected by an incident overnight, which impacted their refrigeration and freezer systems".

The latest incidents follow an attack in France last month when police said hackers seized control of cooling units at hundreds of supermarkets, causing fires and food losses.



A sign reads 'all of our freezers are broken due to a cyberattack' at a supermarket in Stockholm, Sweden, on Monday. REUTERS

While no one has claimed responsibility for either attack, the incidents have heightened concerns among European authorities about hybrid threats to infrastructure amid growing security tensions since Russia's 2022 invasion of Ukraine.

Moscow has repeatedly denied involvement in sabotage or hybrid warfare operations. Reuters could not establish who was behind Monday's attacks or whether they were linked to the incidents in France.

"It is not known who is behind this attack, and it may never be determined," said Katrien Eggers, spokesperson for Belgium's Centre for Cybersecurity, adding she was concerned about the growing number of incidents, in part due to AI.

"All IT systems are potentially vulnerable, and AI can now be used to successfully exploit these weaknesses — especially by sophisticated actors," she said.

From refrigerators and heating systems to security cameras and alarms, an expanding range of devices once largely mechanical can now be monitored and controlled remotely, creating new opportunities for cybercriminals.

At least some of the refrigerator units affected on Monday used temperature control technology from Danish firm Danfoss that was also targeted in the French attack. The firm said it had been working with customers to implement fixes.

The European Commission said the latest incidents highlighted how digital threats are becoming increasingly disruptive.

"They are a deliberate attempt to disrupt our food supply chain and undermine consumers' confidence in it – a warning that we must take seriously," said EU commissioner for agriculture Christophe Hansen.

In Ireland, wholesaler Musgrave said the incident affected systems in 13 of its SuperValu stores, forcing it to remove some chilled and frozen products from sale. "Our monitoring systems alerted and we took immediate actionOur investigation is ongoing," it said.

The Ideas Page: The anti-SIR and anti-CEC agitation is now set to become a pro-democracy movement 11

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Happening today

- **PM NARENDRA** Modi will inaugurate Pune Metro's Line 3 and lay the foundation stone of four new metro corridors under Phase-II, involving investment of around Rs 21,800 crore.
- **AMERICANS WILL VOTE** in the midterm elections to decide which party will control the Congress, and shape the country's laws, for the rest of President Donald Trump's tenure.

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Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



AT INAUGURAL FINANCIAL EXPRESS LEADERSHIP AWARDS

FM open to investor concerns, weighs case for foreign capital

Says Tata Group a 'critical component of economy', conflict a 'delicate matter', expect it not to spill in public domain

Prasanta Sahu
Mumbai, November 2

UNION FINANCE Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday acknowledged growing anxiety among retail investors and equity market participants over stretched Indian stock valuations and the capital gains tax regime, and said their concerns would be considered. She, however, cautioned against viewing tax concessions as the principal driver of capital market performance.

Her remarks come amid renewed calls for a review of long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax on equities against the backdrop of sustained foreign portfolio investor (FPI) outflows and concerns over the relative attractiveness of Indian stocks.

Sitharaman, who was the chief guest at the inaugural Financial Express Leadership Awards in Mumbai, made the remarks at a 'fireside chat' with *Financial Express* Editor Shyamal Majumdar.

Ahead of her 10th consecutive Union Budget, likely to be presented on February 1, Sitharaman said the government would hear stakeholders before deciding on any possible action, indicating that their representations would be taken into account.

"I realise the sensitivity and anxiety prevailing among retail investors, especially equity participants, while not being biased either way," she said.

Pointing out that India witnessed strong FPI inflows with the same capital gains tax structure in 2023-24, she said capital markets thrive on strong fundamentals, not necessarily on tax sops. She, however, acknowledged that circumstances had since changed and challenges had grown, and referred to the net FPI outflows over the past few quarters, even as flows may have turned around only recently.

"The stakeholders are voicing their concerns louder. I will consider all this," she said.



Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman at the Financial Express Leadership Awards in Mumbai, Monday. AMIT CHAKRAVARTY

Sustaining economic growth at 7% or above remained paramount, Sitharaman said, underlining that "for that, we need capital". While policy attention in recent years had focused on deepening India's underdeveloped corporate bond market, she acknowledged the need to address concerns in the equity market as well. "Equity market also needs support, I recognise that voice," she reiterated.

Asked whether foreign capital needed a red carpet to attract inflows, Sitharaman cautioned against a policy approach that could be seen as favouring one class of investors over another. "If you pitch for dollar (investors), what about rupee (domestic) investors?" she asked. "Hear all the stakeholders, what the government can really do, and we'll do that. First, hear them, and then see what we can act on," she said.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPRESS special

Pay and play: SAI pulled fund support while Sindhu, Sen won badminton titles

Shocked... not faced this before: Sindhu



PV Sindhu in action at the Hylo Open in Germany. BWF

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, November 2

P V SINDHU and Lakshya Sen gave Indian badminton two reasons to celebrate on Sunday, winning the singles titles at the Hylo Open in Saarbrucken, Germany. But weeks earlier, the country's shuttlers had been left to finance their European campaign themselves after funding support was withdrawn at the last minute over an administrative tussle.

The Indian Express has learnt that the Sports Authority of India (SAI) declined to fund the Indian contingent's European swing, comprising four consecutive tournaments in Finland, Denmark, France and Germany. Sources said the players were informed of the decision just days before the Arctic Open began on October 6 in Vantaa, Finland.

"When I got to know, I was a bit shocked and wondered how the funding hadn't gone through. I hadn't faced something like that before," Sindhu told *The Indian Express* from Saarbrucken.

"But at that point, I couldn't really decide that if there was no funding, I wouldn't play. For me, the priority was to participate and focus on what I needed to do, how I needed to play my matches and keep on improving. Obviously, it was surprising that we couldn't get the funding, whatever the reason may have been. I managed the funding on my own a bit and OGQ (Olympic Gold Quest, her backers) also helped me in this," Sindhu said.

Three officials involved in managing the sport in different

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

SHOW BIG HEART: COURT TO FRRO

OCIs don't have right to protest, says HC; Imran Khan says sorry



Actor Imran Khan

Omkar Gokhale
Mumbai, November 2

SAYING THAT Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) cardholders don't have "any right to criticise the country" and such actions "cannot be tolerated", the Bombay High Court on Monday asked actor Imran Khan, a US citizen, to submit an "unconditional apology" and "categorical undertaking" that he would not participate in future protests. The court said it could then ask the authorities to adopt a "lenient approach".

Khan, represented by Senior Advocate Venkatesh Dhond, submitted the undertaking and unconditional apology. "I am volunteering to give the present undertaking that there will be no participation by me in any protests in the future," he said, adding that he would "not join or indirectly influence others to protest in future". The undertaking, filed through advocates Zulfiquar Memon, Parvez Memon and Chirag Naik of MZM Legal, noted that he has lived in India for the past 42 years, has "utmost love" for the country, and his "life, profession and affiliation are all confined to this great nation".

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

NCP explores merger option with Sharad Pawar party, meets Amit Shah in Delhi



Union Home Minister Amit Shah with NCP leaders (from left) Sameer Bhujbal, Dilip Walse-Patil, Dhananjay Munde, Hasan Mushrif, Chhagan Bhujbal, Praful Patel and Sunil Tatkare in Delhi, Monday. ANI

Convene meeting of legislators on Tuesday: NCP top body to Sunetra

Liz Mathew & Alok Deshpande
New Delhi, Mumbai, November 2

A GROUP of senior Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) leaders met Union Home Minister Amit Shah in Delhi late Sunday night to discuss the possibility of a merger with the rival NCP led by Sharad Pawar.

The NCP old guard that met Shah in Delhi is in favour of the merger and wants the possibility to be explored even if Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Sunetra Pawar and her son, Parth Pawar, a Rajya Sabha MP, are not on board, *The Indian Express* has learnt. At a meeting of the NCP core committee in Mumbai on Monday,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPLAINED

BJP cautious

The BJP is guarded and treading cautiously on the NCP issue as it does not want to upset its own cadre and old-timers in Maharashtra. In the past, the BJP leadership has received complaints about the party's 'organic leaders' being sidelined because of the power-sharing agreement in place in the state.



GRAP-II in Delhi-NCR

A hazy Monday in New Delhi. The Commission for Air Quality Management imposed Stage-II measures in Delhi-NCR under the Graded Response Action Plan as the air quality slipped into the 'very poor' category. The CAQM said the Air Quality Index had exhibited a sharp rise to 324. PRAVEEN KHANNA PAGE 5

Two brothers behind cheetah shooting, held, weapon recovered: STF

Accused had gone hunting, no link to illegal wildlife trade network: Probe

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, November 2

THE 19-MONTH-OLD male cheetah that died last week was shot by two brothers who had gone hunting in a forest in Sheopur district of Madhya Pradesh, the Special Task Force (STF) investigating the matter said on Monday.

The two men, identified as Bhagwan Singh and Pritam Singh, have since been arrested and a traditional *bharmar*, a double-barrel muzzle-loading firearm, has been recovered, the STF said in a press note. It said the investigation so far does not indicate the involvement of any illegal wildlife

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

MAHARASHTRA GOVT SAYS WORKING TO RESOLVE ISSUE

Suicides 'linked' to unpaid bills of contractors, association seeks action

Chandan Haygunde
Jarud (Amravati), November 2

SUNIL WAGADRE (52) in Amravati district on October 8, 2026; Gajanan Devkatte (36) in Navi Mumbai on August 25, 2026; P V Verma (63) in Nagpur on September 1, 2025; Harshal Patil (35) in Sangli on July 23, 2025.

All four died by suicide, and their families say the common thread was severe financial stress over pending bills for work done for the Maharashtra government: Rs 2.5 crore for Wagadre, Rs 40 crore for Verma, Rs 60 lakh for Patil and Rs 2.5 crore for Devkatte.

The four families are left with one question: will they get justice?

On Monday, a group of agitated civil contractors in Maharashtra performed a symbolic "*Tervi*" — the 13th-day ritual after death — of the state government outside the Public Works Department (PWD) office in Amravati to register their distress over unpaid dues.

The Maharashtra State

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Varsha Wagadre with husband Sunil's photo at their home in Amravati district. CHANDAN HAYGUNDE

INSIDE

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3 CRORE VOTERS DROPPED IN S.I.R INFILTRATORS, SAYS SHAH

8 LABOURERS ELECTROCUTED IN RAJASTHAN

ENDURANCE RACE INVOLVES 1.9-KM SWIM, 90-KM CYCLING RIDE, AND A 21.1-KM RUN

At 57, Kerala HC judge completes Ironman: 'Cut down on my sleep, not work'

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, November 2

"IF YOU want to attain your goal, you will have to overcome and embrace the pain, and not fight it."

As he crossed the finishing line of the Ironman 70.3 held in Goa on Sunday, Kerala High Court judge Justice Bechu Kurian Thomas remembered these words vividly.

PAGE 1 anchor

Justice Thomas, 57, competed in the Males 55-59 age category, completing the race in eight hours, 46 minutes and 44 seconds.

The Ironman 70.3 Goa is a triathlon endurance race that involves a 1.9-km swim, a 90-km cycling ride, and a 21.1-km run.

Justice Thomas first heard of the race two years ago, when his son competed in it in Goa. "I saw him train. I can say he was my inspiration to do Ironman," he told *The Indian Express*.

"I have always been interested in sports. But after becoming a judge, I lost out on the health front. Sitting 16-18 hours a day was actually taking a toll on my health," he said. "Occasionally, we have a cricket tournament for judges. We had a shuttle tournament recently, where I was the champion in the singles and doubles category. That probably gave me a feeling that I can compete (in Ironman). And so, I thought it's time to get back in shape," he said.

For the judge, time management was a primary concern. "I was handling one of the heaviest jurisdictions in the court – Writ Petition Miscellaneous. Finding time for the training was difficult. I cut down on my sleep... to gain time for training," he said. "I do not have any single backlog. Not a single case."

"I always say it's all in the mind. We are all busy. And it's an excuse that we can always come up with — to say we don't have the time. But life begins when fear ends."

Justice Thomas started training for the endurance race on April 21, a few days after his son got married. "Three days after my son's wedding, I went for my first swim. The court was on vacation, so I thought, 'Why not give it a try?'"



Kerala High Court judge Justice Bechu Kurian Thomas during the Ironman 70.3 in Goa on Sunday

On the first day, he barely managed to swim 50 metres. But he continued to train for 3-4 weeks, swimming every alternate day.

"After the court resumed, it was tough to find the time to train. But, either late in the day or early in the morning, I would train," he said.

He refused invitations to social engagements to accommodate his training schedule. "I cut down on all social functions, did not attend any speeches or inaugurations... and focused solely on training. On the weekends, I devoted extra hours to running, swimming and cycling. I got one cycle for training inside the house," he said.

Justice Thomas said the path has not been easy, given his history of injuries. "I had surgery on my knee for a meniscus tear a decade ago; I have a varicose vein. I had two meniscus tears last year, and I have not done anything about it. I have got an Achilles tendon rupture. One is wary about injuries, and one has doubts," he said.

During training, Justice Thomas suffered a muscle tear on his calf, and doctors asked him to stop training and to rest. "I consulted another doctor, who advised knee surgery, saying it could worsen. But I always felt that the body would adapt."

Three weeks later, Justice Thomas went on a small run and did not feel any pain. "Slowly, I learnt to manage the pain. I embraced the pain and kept telling myself that unless I overcome the pain, I will succumb to it. If you want to attain your goals, you need to overcome pain and embrace it. Don't fight it," he said.

After a three-week break to recover, Justice Thomas started training again. "I went for my first swim and felt a slight niggle. The next day, I swam for the first time in the ocean for 1.8 km in 49 minutes.

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FM open to investor concerns

Analysts attribute the FPI pullout partly to stretched valuations of Indian stocks and weaker earnings growth, while some also flag LTCG taxation as a factor affecting investor sentiment. Alternative investment avenues have remained attractive to foreign capital, with the yield on the US 10-year Treasury, for instance, hovering around 5% in recent weeks.

On the ongoing differences within the Tata Group, Sitharaman described it as a "delicate matter", expressing the hope that the dispute would be resolved amicably without government intervention at this stage.

Praising the Parsi community's role in building the Tata Group into a global brand, she highlighted the conglomerate's wide-ranging business interests and the scale of its investments. Describing the group as a "critical component" of the Indian economy, she said she expected normalcy to be restored at the earliest, without allowing the conflict to spill into the public domain. She also expressed the expectation that commercial wisdom and business acumen would prevail in resolving the differences.

"I wouldn't readily say (anything at this point)," the minister said.

Her remarks come in the backdrop of differences between Tata Sons and its controlling shareholder, Tata Trusts, over the reappointment of N Chandrasekaran as chairman and whether the holding company should go public. The board's decision on September 17 to grant Chandrasekaran another five-year term, despite objections from Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata, has triggered a governance dispute. While conciliatory efforts are reportedly under way, the next Tata Sons board meeting, scheduled for November 26, could emerge as a key flashpoint.

Separately, Sitharaman criticised the Opposition over its protests and allegations against the government on Sunday, accusing it of undermining parliamentary processes and creating an impression of instability. She said the Opposition should hold the government accountable through debates in Parliament rather than resorting to street protests and mock Parliaments.

"To be in the Opposition and put the government on the mat to answer questions is absolutely right. I'm not against that. I would want more of that to happen in Parliament rather than in mock Parliaments," she said. "You (Congress party) are the Opposition, with 100 MPs elected by the people of India to function in Parliament, and you resort to mock Parliament."

Turning to the forthcoming Budget, Sitharaman said the responsibility of delivering a Budget that makes a difference to people's lives remained paramount. Bridging the skills gap among young job seekers, accelerating private investment and strengthening the contribution of micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) would remain important priorities as India works towards Viksit Bharat, she said.

As she prepares to present her 10th consecutive Budget, Sitharaman said the milestone brought with it an overwhelming sense of responsibility rather than personal achievement. "It's always an overwhelming feeling of the responsibility to deliver a proper Budget, which means a lot to the people, helps growth and faces the challenges," she said.

She credited the policy direction of successive Budgets and the stability provided by Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership for helping the economy navigate challenges. Every Budget, she said, had benefited from the experience gained through implementation, public feedback and consultations at different levels of government. "The responsibility to deliver something that will make a difference to people's lives is what is at the top of my mind," she said.

On employment, Sitharaman said the government would continue to focus on skilling to bridge the gap between employers' expectations and the capabilities of young job seekers. "Training youth and giving them the skill sets so that they are job-ready is what we want to spend time on," she said, adding that the government had already begun to address the issue through its previous two Budgets.

On private investment, the minister said she was beginning to see industry come forward with fresh investments, marking a shift from her earlier assessment that companies were holding back despite strong balance sheets. She attributed the improvement partly to the next-generation GST reforms, which, she said, had strengthened consumption and made demand more visible to businesses. "Industry today has the confidence that it can see demand in the market. It can invest and produce, and therefore reach the level it wants to reach," she said.

Citing the October GST collection, which she described as the highest, Sitharaman said domestic consumption was holding up the economy and giving companies greater confidence to expand capacity. "Consumption having really come up has given that clear visibility, and therefore, I'm seeing investments happening from the private sector," she said.

Responding to concerns that India's economy was increasingly dominated by a handful of large business groups, Sitharaman pointed to the growth of MSMEs and startups as evidence that expansion was taking place across different layers of industry.

She also urged industry to maintain regular engagement with the government rather than limiting its interaction to annual pre-Budget consultations. "They are welcome to ask the government for anything they want," she said. "But after that, I would also want them to keep engaging with us to say whether they're moving forward or not. Are there more troubles? Are there more challenges? That interaction should be active and live," she said.

On regulatory reforms, Sitharaman said the government was taking the Economic Survey's observations seriously and working with states to address industry concerns. Procurement rules, tender conditions and project execution requirements were being reviewed to improve transparency and ease of doing business, she said.

Reiterating the government's policymaking approach, she said trust in businesses, industry and taxpayers would remain central. "Whichever policy we make, trust the business, trust the industry, trust the taxpayer. That will be our charter," she said.

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NCP explores merger

Sunetra Pawar was urged to convene a meeting of the party's legislators Tuesday to discuss the matter.

NCP insiders said the lack of "collective leadership" in the party was one of the issues discussed with Shah in the meeting at his official residence. The Home Minister is learnt to have told the NCP leaders that their party's organisational weakening was adversely affecting the Mahayuti alliance government in Maharashtra. The NCP delegation included senior leaders Sunil Tatkare, Praful Patel, Dhananjay Munde, Hasan Mushrif, Chhagan Bhujbal, Sameer Bhujbal, and Dilip Walse-Patil.

"While the issue of lack of collective leadership within the party was discussed, they (the delegation) were told that NCP leaders need to ensure smooth functioning of the party. These leaders were told that the problems within the NCP were not harming only them. Being in Mahayuti, it is affecting the ruling alliance as a whole. If these issues are not resolved, then the alliance will face problems," said a source in the NCP privy to the discussions.

The NCP core committee, which met at Sunetra Pawar's residence in Mumbai in the evening, urged the Deputy CM to convene a meeting of the party's MLAs Tuesday to "understand their sentiments" and decide the next course of action.

While the NCP denied a rift and said the merger issue was "over", the NCP (SP) said it had not been approached.

"We only discussed how to work collectively under the leadership of Sunetra Pawar. The issue of merger is already over. This stance was earlier put forth by Sharad Pawar's party as well, and we have also clarified our position," said Tatkare, the NCP's Maharashtra president.

"It is highly unfortunate that unnecessary political colour is being given to today's meeting in Delhi between Union Home Minister Amit Shah and senior leaders of the NCP, attempting to fabricate a narrative of internal differences," said NCP national spokesperson Umesh Patil. The meeting had been fixed during Sunetra Pawar's meeting with the Home Minister in October, he claimed.

The NCP (Sharadchandra Pawar) said it does not know about a merger. "Nobody has approached us, nobody has talked of a merger," said a senior party leader.

BJP insiders said the party was keen on the NCP reuniting and joining the NDA as it would help the alliance consolidate non-Brahmin and Maratha votes in Maharashtra. The party is learnt to have offered two Union Cabinet berths to balance the power equations between the two NCPs.

However, the "ambitions" of certain leaders were proving to be a hurdle, said BJP sources. They said Parth wants his mother to get the Maharashtra Finance portfolio, a post that his father, the late Ajit Pawar, held in the Devendra Fadnavis government. He is also learnt to have expressed the desire to be the NCP national president. However, Tatkare, NCP's working president Praful Patel, and Chhagan Bhujbal want the power-sharing to be more inclusive.

The NCP joined the Mahayuti after Ajit Pawar broke ranks with Sharad Pawar, his uncle, in July 2023. However, the party leadership has been at odds since Ajit Pawar died in a plane crash this January. The old guard is unhappy with the party's functioning under Sunetra Pawar and Parth. Recently, both Patel and Tatkare publicly called for introspection following the party's defeat in the Legislative Council elections. Chhagan Bhujbal is learnt to be miffed about not being consulted on the appointment of MLC Zeeshan Siddique as Mumbai NCP chief, while Walse-Patil and Munde have not been accommodated in the state Cabinet despite vacancies. In the MLC elections, Mushrif was asked to give up his claim on the Pune graduates seat and the ticket went to the BJP instead of his trusted aide Bhaiyya Mane.

Pay and play

capacities told *The Indian Express* that they believed the funding withdrawal was linked to India's performance at the Asian Games. The Indian shuttlers had a below-par campaign in Aichi-Nagoya, returning without an individual medal for the first time since 2014.

"This is the first time such a thing has happened. There was no official communication explaining why this step was taken. It is suspected that the decision is linked to performance because, in terms of budget, it is not the case that the badminton federation has exceeded the limit," sources said.

However, a senior SAI official categorically denied that the funding cut was linked to performance, attributing the non-release of funds to the failure of Badminton Association of India (BAI) to submit its proposal within the stipulated timeline.

"Earlier, the rules required federations to submit proposals 90 days in advance without names and 60 days in advance with the names. This was primarily because you could plan your trip well in advance. But the federation said it could not do it that early, so we revised the deadline to 30 days. Even then, we did not receive the proposal. These new guidelines apply to everybody. If we don't have the proposal with the names 30 days before a tournament, we will not process it," the official said.

The official said funding for upcoming tournaments will be restored but the shuttlers will not be reimbursed for expenses incurred over the past four weeks.

BAI general secretary Sanjay Mishra did not respond to calls or messages seeking comment. It is learnt that the BAI informed the players about the funding cut through a WhatsApp message. The federation said it would provide accommodation for the first tournament in Finland, but that players would have to bear the costs of travel, food, accommodation and other expenses for the rest.

The financial constraints also meant that some players had to compete without their coaches. During the French Open, for instance, Ashmita Chaliha had fellow player Isharani Baruah in her corner while beating Akane Yamaguchi, effectively doubling up as her coach. Tanvi Sharma, who reached the quarterfinals in Denmark, also had no coach to guide her during a match.

"The situation arose because of the funding cut. Who would bear the coach's costs? The players couldn't afford to pay for their coaches when they had to take care of their own expenses," the sources said.

While a 26-member Indian contingent competed at the Arctic Open in Finland without any withdrawals, six players pulled out of the Denmark Open in Odense, seven from the French Open in Paris the following week and nine from the Hylo Open last week.

Despite the financial uncertainty, Indian shuttlers produced notable performances on the European circuit. Sindhu made the final of the S750 French Open losing only to An Se-young, while Ashmita stunned World No. 3 Yamaguchi at the French Open. Anmol Kharb, meanwhile, made the semifinals of the Hylo Open. Sen ended his year-long title drought by winning the men's singles crown, while Sindhu claimed her second title of the year. It was the first time since 2017 that she had won two BWF Super 500 or higher titles in a calendar year.

The Hylo Open triumph also boosted Sindhu's prospects of qualifying for the season-ending BWF World Tour Finals, while taking her back to No.6 in the world rankings. "For me, the focus was on how I could improve my performance. That was the most important thing at the end of the day. See, these things keep happening, but they shouldn't stop us," Sindhu said.

Imran

The HC was hearing Khan's plea against the Leave India Notice issued by the Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO) on October 14, days after he was detained at a protest against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar in Mumbai on October 10.

While the FRRO notice asked Khan to leave India by October 28, the court, last week, kept it in abeyance until November 2. On Monday, the court put the notice in abeyance until the next hearing on December 7.

"In the meantime, we expect that he would reside in India as a law-abiding person, not associating/ indulging in any activities/ protest, rights which are available to the citizen/s of this country under the Constitution," the HC noted in its order.

During the hearing on Monday, the bench of Chief Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi and Justice Advait M Sethna also questioned the FRRO and orally remarked that Khan should have been given "at least an opportunity" to present his side before being issued the Leave India Notice.

Addressing Khan, Chief Justice Tripathi said in oral remarks: "You have to give a categorical undertaking that you will not participate in any such agitation because it is not available to the OCI card(holders). You cannot behave like an Indian citizen... because you are not even remotely affected to that cause. Therefore, you had no right at all to participate in this."

"You had no role at all in the agitation of SIR (Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls). You are not even remotely concerned with that...You cannot be put at par with Indian citizens. (An) unconditional apology has to be there if you have made certain statement inadvertently. That's all and it would suffice, and we accordingly can direct the State to have some lenient approach," he said.

"Prima facie, there can be no quarrel with the proposition that the rights of an OCI cardholder and an Indian citizen operate in distinct and different spheres," the bench noted in its order, adding that the OCI document issued to Khan in December 2025 mentioned his occupation as "searching for job".

"The State, in exercise of its sovereign functions, would have the right to deport a person out of India in a given case," the bench noted. It sought the Centre's affidavit "further clarifying this aspect" and making clear its stand.

The bench also said that "mere tendering of an unconditional apology... is not a green signal for you (Khan) to venture (into) all these things". "This activity is permissible in USA, where you can go and cast your vote too, but so far in India, you have to abide with the law and order. Because it's a very serious matter. Would an Indian doing this in another country be permissible?," it said.

"Since your childhood, you are here in India, (you) work here, why don't you accept Indian citizenship? You are a celebrity... See the magnanimity of the country that, despite you being a US citizen, all recognition and employment is from India, in Maharashtra...," Chief Justice Tripathi said.

Additional Solicitor General (ASG) Anil Singh, who represented the FRRO, argued that an undertaking would set a wrong precedent and the Centre had "unfettered rights to deport the petitioner". However, the bench said that Khan should have been given an opportunity to present his side before being issued the Leave India Notice.

"OCI cardholders cannot be put at parity with Indian citizens. They are at the mercy of the sovereign, and they have no right at all to stay here and criticise the country. This cannot be tolerated... Even though you (FRRO) have complete power, but you acted in a certain situation, and once it (the situation) goes, your decision would be different. So, for a person who is here for last so many years... we have to be Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam (world is one family). You have to show a big heart," Chief Justice Tripathi told Singh.

Cheetah shooting

trade or organised wildlife crime network.

The cheetah, KNG-22, was found injured outside Kuno National Park on October 25. It died during surgery two days later. Five pellets, identified as being consistent with those used in muzzle-loading firearms, were recovered from its body.

The Madhya Pradesh government had set up a four-member STF, comprising forest and police personnel, to probe the incident. The STF said it relied on an informer network, and also carried out a search operation in the forests with the help of a dog squad.

Based on information obtained during the investigation, ground verification and analysis, Bhagwan Singh, a resident of Navalpura-Behrara village in Morena district, was arrested on October 31. According to the STF, Bhagwan Singh revealed during questioning that he and his brother, Pritam Singh, had gone hunting in the forest near Nitanwas village, in Sheopur district, when they saw a cheetah moving in the area.

"He fired at the wild cat with their licensed Topidar Bharmar rifle and then fled the scene," the STF said. Based on Bhagwan Singh's statement, his brother Pritam Singh was also taken into custody. Investigators later took the accused to the site and recovered the weapon from a forest area in Morena district, the STF said.

A case has been registered against the accused under the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, relating to sections prohibiting hunting of Schedule I species which are accorded the highest protection, and penalties for violating those provisions.

State forest department officials said that the shooting seemed to be a case of "opportunistic hunting". Madhya Pradesh Chief Wildlife Warden Sameeta Rajora could not be reached for comment.

During the probe into the cheetah's death, investigators had questioned around 20 people and searched houses in the Morena-Sheopur region. They also examined data from KNG-22's radio collar to reconstruct its movements.

The Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change has also constituted a three-member team, comprising officials from the National Tiger Conservation Authority and the Wildlife Crime Control Bureau, to examine the circumstances of the incident and security arrangements for cheetahs moving outside protected areas.

Suicides 'linked' to unpaid bills

Contractors Association (MSCA) claims nine contractors have died in the last year-and-a-half because of pending government dues, which it puts at Rs 90,000 crore, mainly for projects sanctioned during 2022-23 and 2023-24. The state government says it is working to resolve the issue but pegs the pending amount at Rs 17,000 crore, of which Rs 6,200 crore has been "cleared".

According to Ujjwal Pande, Amravati district president of the State Engineers Association, a year before the November 2024 state elections, the Maharashtra government released work orders amounting to four times the available funds. He alleged that every contractor gets a work order only after paying about 10 per cent of its amount as "commission".

The contractors also question the government's spending on the flagship Ladki Bahin scheme, launched ahead of the polls, while ignoring their dues. Opposition leaders, such as MLA Rohit Pawar of NCP-SP, have also claimed the government is clearing the bills of contractors from Gujarat and Andhra Pradesh while the dues of local Marathi contractors remain unpaid.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Maharashtra PWD Minister Shivendraraje Bhosale said, "The government makes the payment to principal contractors. Sub-contractors are not registered with us. Bills of Rs 17,000 crore were pending with PWD. Of these, we have cleared Rs 6,200 crore so far, ensuring that all small contractors having pending bills of less than Rs 1 crore got their dues."

However, the contractors say much more needs to be done. During statewide protests on October 19, they arranged a mock funeral of the state government in Amravati, calling Maharashtra a financially "dead" state. The "Tervi" ritual followed on Monday.

At Jarud village in Warud taluka of Amravati district, Varsha Wagadre sat beside her husband's garlanded photograph with a vacant look in her eyes. Her husband Sunil, a licensed contractor, took his life in his agricultural field in the village on the evening of October 8, when Varsha had gone out with their son, 13, and daughter, 19. Varsha says he was under huge stress because, even after completing government projects in 2023-24, his bills of approximately Rs 2.5 crore were unpaid.

"He demanded his money several times, but did not get it. A man with immense self-respect, he finally took the extreme step. Now I just want the government to return my husband," Varsha told *The Indian Express*.

Wagadre left a suicide note asking his nephew and colleague Ghanshyam to shoulder the family's responsibilities and sell some of the property to clear a bank loan, a gold loan and other debts. Ghanshyam said Sunil "desperately wanted the government to clear his bills". Sunil had also participated in the "Bheek Maango Andolan" organised by contractors in Nagpur in August 2025.

According to Wagadre's family, he was a licensed contractor who also took up a subcontract from a construction firm, which was the main contractor for road and bridge construction related to a work order dated October 7, 2024.

P V Verma, also known as "Munna" Verma, died by suicide at his residence in Raj Nagar, Nagpur. His family and the contractors claimed that his dues of Rs 40 crore for completing various government projects were pending.

Following the death, Nagpur police arrested three persons: NCP-SP politician Sharad Maind of Pusad Urban Co-operative Bank, an alleged illegal money lender Manjeet Singh Wade, and another contractor, Radheshyam Biyani. Police alleged that they were part of a nexus that provided high-interest loans to people like Verma and then exerted pressure for repayments.

Harshal Patil died by suicide at his farm land at Tandulwadi village in the Walwa taluka of Sangli district. His family member Prakash Sankpal said he was not a licensed contractor but worked with a few other contractors, and was owed about Rs 60 lakh for work, such as laying a pipeline and constructing a water tank.

Sankpal said Harshal had taken loans to complete the work and could not repay them. He is survived by his wife and a daughter. About Rs 3.8 lakh were cleared after his death, but the remaining bills are pending, Sankpal said.

Gajanan Devkatte left no suicide note when he died at his house in Ulwe. His family says he took the final step after failing to recover dues of Rs 2.5 crore for government work completed over the last three years. He is survived by his wife Sheetal, two children and an ailing mother.

Sheetal has filed a complaint at the Ulwe police station, blaming a few government officials for allegedly taking a bribe from her husband to clear his bill, and then avoiding him. Police Inspector Arjun Rajane said, "The probe revealed that Gajanan Devkatte was not a licensed contractor. He was working through a subcontractor. We have received a complaint from his wife with allegations of bribery, but so far there is no evidence to prove it. The inquiry is ongoing."

Sheetal cited a letter titled "*Amhi Jagave Kase*... (How should we live?)", which her husband submitted to authorities in the Mumbai City division on July 4, 2025. In it, he wrote about unpaid bills of small contractors and said, "We visit every sub-division to seek work, but get nothing. Nobody sees anything beyond money..."

Dipesh Kolurwar, a member of MSCA in Nagpur, said Verma mortgaged some of his properties and took loans from financial institutions and illegal money lenders to complete the work in time. "Had the government paid his bills, he would have survived," he said.

MSCA president Milind Bhosale said that of the Rs 90,000 crore owed, about Rs 38,000 crore are pending dues for Jal Jeevan Mission work and Rs 27,000 crore are unpaid bills at the PWD.

"There are many contractors who have taken loans, borrowed money to manage expenses, pay labourers, buy materials, to complete the government works in time. Their bills have not been cleared since 2022. Now they are unable to handle the mounting financial pressure," said Bhosale.

ED tightens noose, four Patnitop hotels attached

Arun Sharma
Jammu, November 2

THE ENFORCEMENT Directorate (ED) said Monday it had provisionally attached four hotels at the hill resort of Patnitop in J&K's Udhampur district under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA).

Valued at nearly Rs 10.66 crore, the properties include hotel buildings and the land on which they stand, an ED spokesperson said. Earlier, the ED had issued two provisional attachment orders in 2025, attaching properties worth approximately Rs 30.72 crore in the same case.

The ED initiated its investigation based on an FIR registered by the CBI's Anti-Corruption Bureau (ACB), Jammu, against owners and directors of hotels, guest houses, resorts, cottages and residential properties in the Patnitop area, as well as officials of the Patnitop Development Authority (PDA).

The allegations relate to the commercial use of residential buildings, construction beyond approved limits and operation of commercial establishments in prohibited areas, including dense forest, agricultural and residential zones. The investigation also revealed alleged lapses by PDA officials in ensuring compliance with prescribed rules and regulations, the spokesperson said.

In 2023, the CBI had filed six chargesheets against eight hotel owners associated with six hotels and several PDA officials under various provisions of the Jammu and Kashmir Prevention of Corruption Act, Ranbir Penal Code, Registration of Tourist Trade Act, and Jammu and Kashmir Forest Act.

At 57, HC judge completes Ironman: 'Cut down on my sleep, not work'

So, I realised that I am on target and swimming was perhaps my strength," he said.

However, that evening, he developed pain in his shoulder, which doctors said was a muscle tear. He was advised to rest and recover. "This was a month before the race. Slowly, I started cycling again and went for short runs. I would feel pain, but I took a rest and recovered."

Just a week before the race, he considered withdrawing from the event. "Last week, I tried swimming for 300 metres and felt pain. I thought I would withdraw and did not know whether I would be able to compete... but then again, I kept telling myself that it is better to try it and not be able to finish, rather than not trying at all," he said.

"I told my family if the pain comes back, I will stop swimming wherever I am, and will just float and come back. Fortunately, I did not feel the pain that day, and everything went off well," Justice Thomas said.

Justice Thomas said his aim was to finish the race in eight hours, 29 minutes and 59 seconds. "I overshot that by over 16 minutes. I want to do it again and better my timing. I lost time during the transitions, from swimming to cycling and cycling to running. I should have been a little wary about transitions," he said.

"But as a first-time participant, I just wanted to complete it. I was not looking for any podium finish. I wanted to just complete it for my own satisfaction," he said.

On how he changed his diet in preparation for the race, Justice Thomas said, "For the past year, I have been consuming only four eggs in the morning. From 97 kg, I came down to 86 kg. For lunch, I had two chapatis and chicken. I started having an early dinner, which had only protein. That has been my diet for the last six months, except for the occasional cheat day."

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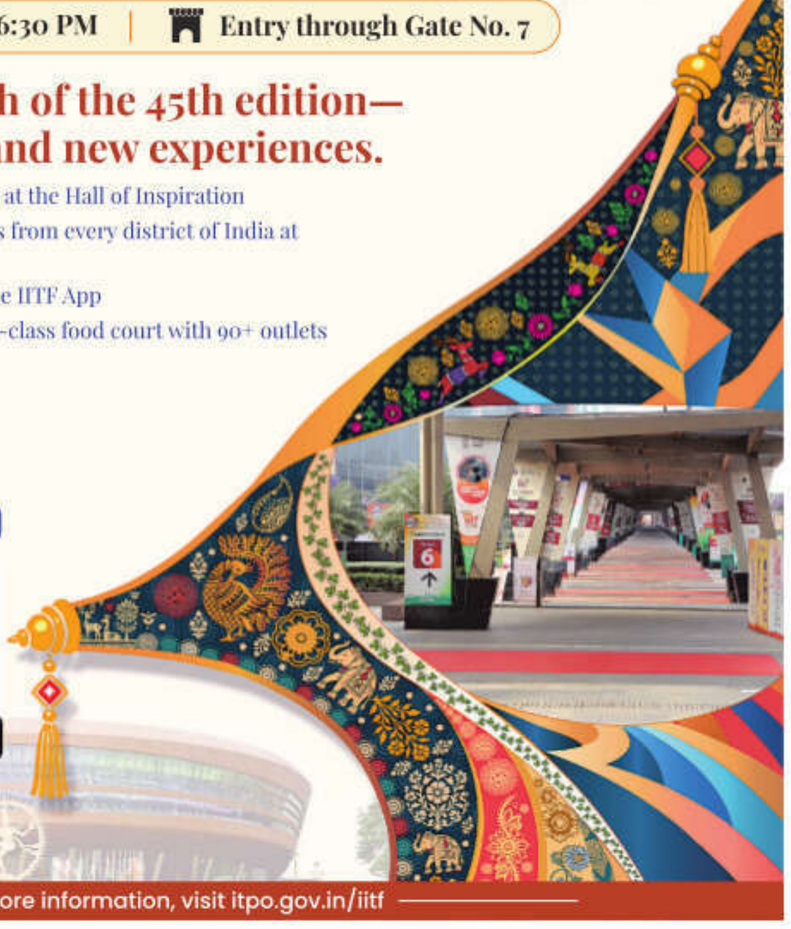
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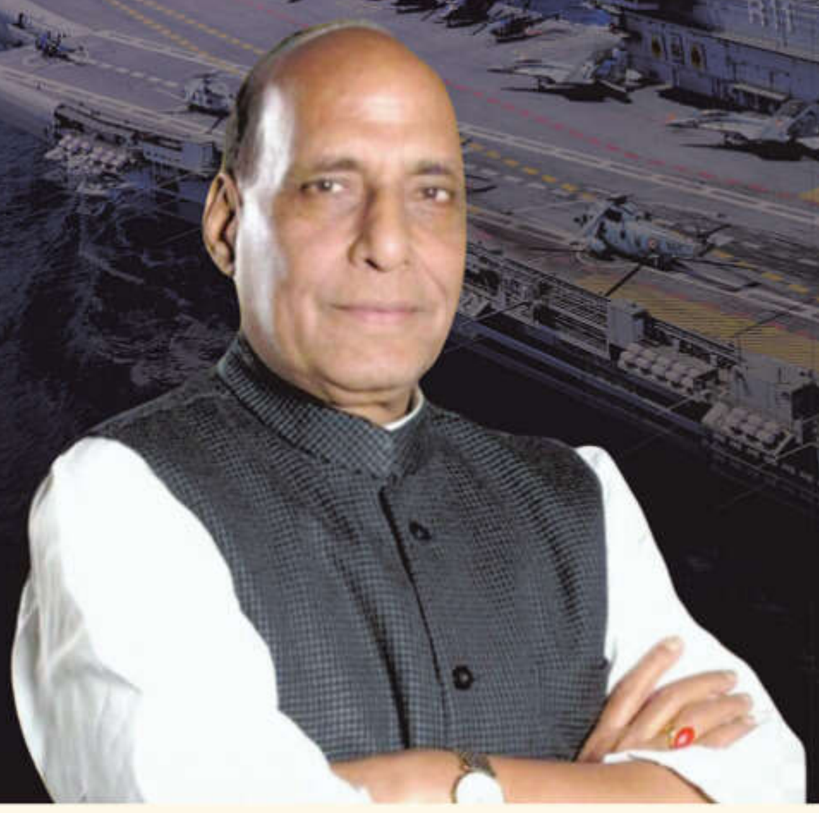
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STIR AGAINST TRANSFER OF TWO POLICE OFFICERS FOLLOWING A SCUFFLE WITH LAWYERS LAST MONTH

'Don't behave like protesters': Delhi Police sees protest within own ranks

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, November 2



ABHINAV SAHA

Police personnel protest outside the headquarters on Monday.

UNPRECEDENTED SCENES were witnessed outside the Delhi Police Headquarters (PHQ) on Monday as around 100 personnel protested the transfer of two police officers following a scuffle with lawyers on October 24 as seniors tried to persuade them to call it off.

The protest began outside Gate No.1 at 8.30 am. Soon after, DCP (New Delhi) Sachin Sharma reached the spot and spoke to Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Manasvi Vashistha — one of the officers who was transferred — urging him not to stage a protest. He also urged personnel to maintain discipline and not behave like protesters.

Negotiations and demands

The personnel initially refused to go inside the PHQ and meet senior officers, before agreeing to wait until noon, saying more personnel were on their way. Around 11.45 am, the protesters were taken to the Adarsh Auditorium where Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar and other senior officers, including Special Commissioners of Police, interacted with them.

At the meeting, Commissioner Kumar sought to reassure the 500-strong gathering, saying Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the Home Ministry stood with them, as per sources. However, sources added, Vashistha insisted that he would not withdraw the case filed against lawyers after the last month's confrontation, it is learnt.

At the time of the incident, the ACP held the charge of Shahdara and the Gandhi Nagar subdivision. Hence, the case was filed at Shahdara police station.

The ACP, who was posted in the Gandhi Nagar subdivision, and Inspector Arun Kumar, the SHO of Shahdara police station, were transferred following the incident in which an advocate allegedly sustained a serious head injury. This triggered a strike by district court lawyers, who demanded action against the officers concerned. The lawyers called off their strike on October 28 after the transfer orders were issued.

Vashistha, at the meeting, also raised concerns over the treatment of police personnel in courts, seeking an increase in security presence, formation of a redressal committee, and no action against those part of the Monday's protest.

With regard to the allegations against him by lawyers of brandishing his weapon, he said, "The lawyers barged inside my office when I was counting my rounds. There was no other intention which is why it was immediately handed over the armoury incharge." The ACP has laid out the demands including a SOP in order to deal with "such people".

Monday's protest brought to the fore a wider resentment within the force. "It hurts our self-esteem. We join the uniformed service to protect people. Every time there is a confrontation between the police and lawyers, it is the police who are suppressed and action is taken against us," a sub-inspector who was present at the meeting told *The Indian Express*.

Women personnel recalled the 2019 Tis Hazari court violence, during which a senior woman IPS officer was allegedly manhandled, and questioned the action taken against police personnel in the aftermath.

ASI Jyoti, who participated in the protest said women personnel also face harassment when they go for court proceedings, claiming lawyers use derogatory remarks against them.

The meeting ended around 3 pm, after which the personnel came out and sat outside Gate No. 1. They later moved to the footpath opposite the headquarters, next to the YMCA bus stand, saying they did not want to disrupt traffic. They said they would wait to see whether their demands were met.

Round 2 of talks

Around 5 pm, Vashistha and five other personnel went inside again to speak to senior officers. Around 6:40 when Vashistha came out, he said he met Joint CP Nupur Prasad. "With regard to my transfer order to be reversed, the top brass will look into that. Our main agenda was never to protest but to hold a Sampark Sabha and share our issues with the CP and senior officials and since that happened, it's a success. I have been assured no action would be taken against those who protested today," the ACP told *The Indian Express*. He added their grievances will be resolved in due course of time.

The ACP asked those who continued to protest should wear black bands and continue their work. Before the crowd dispersed around 7:40 pm, policemen gathered around the ACP and clicked selfies .

The protest, negotiations, and reassurances come ahead of an interaction programme scheduled by LG Taranjit Singh Sandhu with Delhi Police personnel on Tuesday.

How parking dispute snowballed into stir after ACP's transfer

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, November 2



Video grab of the incident.

IT WAS an alleged parking dispute between a group of lawyers and a salon owner in North East Delhi's Rohtash Nagar area last month, which ended in the transfer of Manasvi Vashishta, ACP of the Gandhi Nagar subdivision, and the SHO of Gandhi Nagar police station. The action then triggered an unprecedented protest on Monday by around 100 personnel outside their own police headquarters.

A confrontation allegedly took place on October 23 when a parked motorcycle blocked the access to a salon in Rohtash Nagar. The salon owner, Sheetal Thakur, and her husband, Rahul Thakur, said they asked the person who had parked the bike to move it.

According to Sheetal's sister, Shweta Bharti, the exchange escalated into an argument. "They said, 'This is not your father's road,'" Shweta claimed. This happened around 11 am. Around 4:30 pm, Shweta alleged, a group of lawyers returned to the salon, vandalised it and assaulted Sheetal, who is eight-month pregnant.

The family dialled up the police helpline number and went to Shahdara police station to file a complaint. However, Shweta said, their complaint was not turned into an FIR. The family was asked to submit a written complaint.

According to Shweta, around the same time, two lawyers entered the police station and began assaulting her husband and brother-in-law Rahul. She claimed that police personnel tried to intervene but the duo kept hitting them.

The family alleges that a case was registered on the lawyer's complaint, while no FIR was registered on their complaint. Shweta said her husband and brother-in-law were subsequently called to the police station by the investigating officer. They went there the following day but found a large gathering of lawyers. It was the same group, according to her, which later misbehaved with the ACP and SHO.

The two left the premises and have not returned home since, according to the sisters, who said the family has been unable to contact her husband.

The sisters have since approached senior police officers, including the DCP and the SHO, seeking action and access to the CCTV footage. DCP Shahdara RP Meena did not respond to queries by *The Indian Express*.

On Monday, Sheetal and Shweta reached the police headquarters after learning about the protest. They said they had come to support the ACP and the SHO, alleging that the two officers had intervened to protect their family.

Sheetal said the CCTV footage from the police station should be seized and examined. "The entire truth will come out once the footage is seen," Sheetal said.

EXPRESS special

'Incompatible with secular character': Centre says Krishi Bhawan mosque to be removed

Court seeks to know if there are rules that bar religious structures inside govt complexes

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, November 2



Krishi Bhawan is set to be razed under the Central Vista plan. FILE

THE CENTRE has told the Delhi High Court that it plans to "remove" a century-old mosque on the premises of Krishi Bhawan and that retaining the structure within the office complex is "impermissible and incompatible with the secular character of Government property".

The submission marks the first clear acknowledgement by the Government that the mosque is set to be removed from the site as Krishi Bhawan and adjoining Shastri Bhawan are slated to be demolished to make way for new buildings under the Central Vista redevelopment plan.

Earlier, in December 2021, in a plea by Delhi Waqf Board before the High Court seeking protection of six mosques likely to be affected by the project, including the Qadeemi Masjid situated in the open court in Krishi Bhawan, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta had told the court: "Nothing is happening to these properties ... It (the project) is a very long plan and we have not reached anywhere near it."

On Monday, the High Court sought to know whether there are rules that bar religious structures within the premises of Government complexes.

Justice Anish Dayal said: "What we need to understand is, what are the rules for providing an alternate space? Are you saying no (alternate) spaces are to be provided for (any) faith?..There has to be some rules to say that 'in no government space can be a space for prayer to provide for any community'. This is just an observation... You can communicate to the ASG....We are curious to understand the stance you have taken..."

Addressing the Centre's counsel Nishant Gautam, Justice Dayal said: "Once we understand what is really the conspectus (implication) of that statement (of religious structure being impermissible in a central government complex) and the impact it has, we can understand the legal position."

The court granted time to the Masjid's committee to respond to the Government's submission by the next date of hearing on November 23.

The caretaking committee of Waqf-notified Qadeemi Masjid had moved the court in September, apprehending demolition. The apprehension arose after a tender was floated by the Central Public Works Department (CPWD), under the Union Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA), on January 19 for construction of Common Central Secretariat (CCS) buildings 4 and 5, at the site of Krishi Bhawan and Shastri Bhawan.

The Indian Express reported in February that while the mosque did not figure in the list of structures to be removed, it also did not appear at its site on the map of the proposed new building in drawings attached to the tender for redevelopment.

Stating that the construction of the two CCS buildings is "a public project of paramount national importance", the Land and Development Office under MoHUA said in a status report on October 27, "The mosque in question presently stands on the project site and is required to be removed".

"Krishi Bhawan and the Central Secretariat complex are secular public premises, dedicated exclusively to governmental, administrative and public service functions. The establishment or retention of a permanent religious structure, or a demand for one, within the confines of a central government office complex is impermissible and incompatible with the secular character of Government property. That the public land situated within a central administrative zone cannot be encumbered by any permanent religious reservation," the Government stated.

The Government said "reserving any portion of the project site for a religious structure would be inconsistent with the Master Plan" for Central Vista Redevelopment project. In an agreement in 1940, the administration had granted permissive possession of the mosque to the managing committee of Jama Masjid "for the limited purpose of its use as a mosque."

While the mosque's committee is seeking that CPWD and NDMC be restrained from demolishing or removing the mosque, it is also seeking that, in case retention of the Qadeemi Masjid is "unavoidable or incompatible with the approved redevelopment", a "reasonable, proximate and adequate alternative prayer facility" be provided. The Centre said that being the owner of the land, it "cannot be compelled to allot or set apart any separate space for the said mosque within the Krishi Bhawan compound or the Central Secretariat complex."

As per the masjid's committee, Qadeemi Masjid has been used for offering prayers by employees working in Krishi Bhawan and the neighbouring government offices, and has thus "become an established prayer facility for persons required to remain within or around their workplaces during working hours." The Centre contended that Shahi Masjid Zabta Ganj is within a 2-km radius from the Krishi Bhawan vicinity.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ashish Sharma, S/o. Vinod Kumar, R/o.: WZ-143 B, Second Floor, Plot No.D-12, Sant Garh Extension, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **Cr. Case No.167/2020 U/S 138 NI Act** registered at **P.S. Tilak Nagar, West District, New Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Ashish Sharma** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Ashish Sharma** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ashish Sharma**, accused of **Cr. Case No. 167/2020 U/S 138 NI Act, P.S Tilak Nagar, West District, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.12.2026.**
By Order, Sh. Anshul Singhal
DP/15811/WD/2026 Judicial Magistrate (West)-04,
(Court Matter) Court No. 268, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Harender Gor @ Dharmender S/o Shiv Shankar R/o B-50, Adayapak Nagar, Nagloi, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 1332/2021 U/S 323/341 IPC, PS Nihal Vihar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Harender Gor @ Dharmender**can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Harender Gor @ Dharmender** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Harender Gor @ Dharmender** of **FIR No. 1332/2021 U/S 323/341 IPC, PS Nihal Vihar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **04.12.2026.**
By Order,
Ms. Shruti Saraswat
Judicial Magistrate First Class - 03
West District, Room No. 292
DP/15521/OD/2026(Court Matter) **Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Rajesh S/o Om Prakash R/o H. No. 78/2 Ambedkar Nagar Haiderpur Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 339/17 PS: U/s 498A/406/506/34 IPC Shalimar Bagh Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rajesh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rajesh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rajesh** accused of **FIR No. 339/17 PS: U/s 498A/406/506/34 IPC Shalimar Bagh Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before**10.12.2026.**
By Order
Ms. Divya Singh
DP/15639/NW/2026 **JMFC Mehila Court-01, Room No. 106**
(Court Matter) **Rohini Court, Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C.)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Kamal @ Tarun S/o Harish Dhingra R/o 72/73 Silver Park, Near Gyandeep Public School, Shivpuri, Krishna Nagar, East Delhi - 110051** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 29918/2020, U/s 379/411 IPC, PS Krishna Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Kamal @ Tarun** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Kamal @ Tarun** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Kamal @ Tarun** of case **FIR No. 29918/2020, U/s 379/411 IPC, PS Krishna Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **19.01.2027.**
By Order
Sh. P. Bhargav Rao
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
DP/14442/SHD/2026 2nd Floor, Room No. 03
(Court Matter) Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ranjeet, S/o: Bhikam Nath, R/o: Nagli Sakrawat, Uttam Nagar, Delhi, Also at: Village Owa Shergarh, Oba Bangar, Distt. Mathura, UP** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 43/2026, U/s: 4(C) DPTMAT Act, Police Station Domestic Airport, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ranjeet** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ranjeet** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ranjeet** of **Police Station Domestic Airport, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.12.2026.**
By Order
Sh. Pankaj Rai
JMFC-09, South-West, Room No. 314,
DP/15805/IGIA/2026 **Dwarka Courts, New Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPc
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rinku S/o Jaipal R/o Plot No. 10, Sunday Bazar Road, Begum Pur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 310/2022 U/S 356/379/411 IPC, PS Begum Pur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Rinku** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rinku** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rinku** of **FIR No. 310/2022 U/S 356/379/411 IPC, PS Begum Pur, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **04.12.2026.**
By Order,
Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North-West
DP/15537/RD/2026(Court Matter) **Rohini Court, Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pardhan @ Neeraj, S/o Jagdish R/o D-170 T -Huts GP Block, Pitampura, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.32/2020 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pardhan @ Neeraj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pardhan @ Neeraj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Pardhan @ Neeraj** of **FIR No.32/2020 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.12.2026.**
By Order,
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, North-West
DP/15730/NW/2026 **Court No.101, 1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Prem Wati Bhalla W/o Lt. Dilip Kumar Bhalla R/o H. No. 104, Gali No. 04, New Lahore Park, Shastri Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 00139/2022, U/s 411/34 IPC, PS Subzi Mandi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Prem Wati Bhalla** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Prem Wati Bhalla** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Prem Wati Bhalla** of case **FIR No. 00139/2022, U/s 411/34 IPC, PS Subzi Mandi, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **07.12.2026.**
By Order
Ms. Preeti Rajoria
DP/14953/N/2026 JMFC-07, Room No. 32,
(Court Matter) Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS
Whereas complaint have been made before me that the accused person Namely **(1) Poonam W/o Suresh Singh (2) Suresh Singh S/o Sh. Ashok Singh R/o Village Mujahidpur PS: Mujahidpur, Distt. Sahib Ganj, Bihar, Also at: Jhuggi at Gole Kuan, Tehkhand, New Delhi (3) Naresh Kumar S/o Nek Mandal R/o Village. Khiordpur, Distt. Munger, Bihar. (4) Leela Devi W/o Late Vishvanath R/o Village Alipur, PS & Distt. Bhagalpur, Bihar** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 85/1996 U/s 364A/368/34 IPC PS: Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi,** and it have been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Above accused cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Above accused have absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **(1) Poonam (2) Suresh Singh (3) Naresh Kumar (4) Leela Devi** accused of **FIR No. 85/1996 U/s 364A/368/34 IPC PS: Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi,** is required to Criminal Appeal No. 301/2001, currently pending before the Hon'ble High Court of Delhi in connection with the aforementioned case.before **11.12.2026.**
By Order
Sh. Sandeep Gupta
DP/15607/SE/2026 **Joint Registrar (Judicial)**
(Court Matter) **Hon'ble High Court New Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **M/s Rajni, W/D/C/O Phool Chand, R/o: A-45-E Block, Peera Garhi Camp, Peera Garhi, Near Police Chowki, Shakur Basti Depo, North West, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **Reg No.: 2250/2024, U/s: 25 PASA Act, P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Rajni** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rajni** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rajni** of **P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.12.2026.**
By Order
Sh. Sanyam Jain
JMFC-04, North West, Room No. 112,
DP/15821/NW/2026 **Rohini Courts, Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **1. Dinesh @ Shinu S/o Babu Lal R/o Risal Garden, Nangloi, Delhi 2. Mantu S/o Shankar R/o L-224, L-Block, JJ Colony, Wazirpur, Delhi 3. Mohd. Irshad S/o Mohd. Subbam R/o N-17A/122, L-Block, JJ Colony, Wazirpur, Delhi** have Committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 499/2020 U/s 3/4/5/9/55 Gambling Act, P.S. Bharat Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **1. Dinesh @ Shinu 2. Mantu 3. Mohd. Irshad** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **1. Dinesh @ Shinu 2. Mantu 3. Mohd. Irshad** have absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **1. Dinesh @ Shinu 2. Mantu 3. Mohd. Irshad** of case **FIR No. 499/2020 U/s 3/4/5/9/55 Gambling Act, P.S. Bharat Nagar, Delhi** are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.12.2026.**
By Order
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North-West, Court No. 101, 1st Floor
DP/15722/NW/2026 (Court Matter) **Rohini Courts, Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sally Unnikrishnan, R/o H.No. J-37, LG-4, Dilshad Colony, Delhi, Nr. Park, Delhi-110095** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No. 3393/16, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Rajender Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sally Unnikrishnan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sally Unnikrishnan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sally Unnikrishnan** accused of **CC No. 3393/16, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Rajender Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.03.2027.**
By Order - Sh. Arvind Tomar
Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI Act)-07
DP/15679/CD/2026 **Room No. 507, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi**

AIR QUALITY LIKELY TO REMAIN 'VERY POOR' IN COMING DAYS

Delhi AQI worsens: Unfavourable weather, farm fires across border to blame; GRAP-II invoked

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, November 2

AS THE air quality in the Capital deteriorated sharply to enter the 'Very Poor' category on Monday, the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) invoked Stage II of the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) across Delhi-NCR.

Citing a sharp rise in the air quality index (AQI) from 117 on October 31, in the 'Moderate' category, to 261 ('Poor') on Sunday, followed by a further jump to 324 ('Very Poor') on Monday, the watchdog attributed the deterioration to unfavourable meteorological conditions and ordered intensified pollution-control measures.

Farm fires across the border, in Pakistan's Punjab, are also adding to the pollution load in the Capital, data analysed by *The Indian Express* shows. The Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM) has forecast that Delhi's air quality will remain in the 'Very Poor' category till November 5, with the outlook for the subsequent six days ranging from 'Very Poor' to 'Poor'.

Stricter measures

With GRAP Stage II in force, authorities have rolled out a range of anti-pollution measures across Delhi-NCR, alongside restrictions on the entry of non-BS-VI vehicles into the Capital. These include daily mechanical road sweeping, intensified water sprinkling with dust suppressants, and stricter inspections of construction sites to enforce dust-control norms.

To encourage public transport use, parking fees have been hiked, traffic personnel have been deployed at congestion hotspots, and public transport services have been augmented.

The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation has announced 20 additional train trips on weekdays.

The measures also ban the use of coal and firewood in hotels, restaurants and open eateries, while restricting diesel generator sets to emergency and essential services. Resident Welfare Associations and commercial establishments have been directed to provide electric heaters to security guards and other outdoor staff to curb the open burning of wood and biomass. Separately, the DMRC said it has intensified dust-control measures at its construction sites and adjoining roads. It has also installed over 250 anti-smog guns and misting systems across construction sites, Metro stations and office buildings, officials said.



Farm fires add to load

The deterioration comes amid a combination of unfavourable weather conditions and smoke from agricultural residue burning in neighbouring regions, including across the international border in Pakistan's Punjab province.

Even as the number of farm fires recorded in India remains relatively low compared with previous years, 219 residue-burning events were recorded on Monday, taking the seasonal total since September 15 to 3,535, according to the data from the Indian Agricultural Research Institute (ICAR-IARI). The institute monitors satellite-detected fires by filtering them against specific agricultural land boundaries.

So far this season, Punjab has accounted for 1,612 fires, followed by Rajasthan (738), Madhya Pradesh (614), Uttar Pradesh (349), Uttarakhand (176), Haryana (44) and Delhi (2). This is an all-time low for the three major states: Punjab, Haryana and UP. However, farm fires in Madhya Pradesh have picked up and are higher compared to 486 recorded in the corresponding period last year.

Meanwhile, cross-border pollution continues to impact the broader airshed. A week-long analysis by *The Indian Express* of NASA's Fire Information for Resource Management System (FIRMS) satellite imagery, up to November 2, showed a dense band of active fires immediately west of the international border in Pakistan's Punjab province.

This comes amid a weekend spike in fires on the Indian side. Punjab recorded 292 fires on Saturday, its highest single-day count of the season, followed by 175 on Sunday and 98 on Monday.

According to the IITM's Decision Support System (DSS), stubble burning accounted for 8.5% of Delhi's PM2.5 pollution on Monday. Its contribution is forecast to rise to 22% by Thursday.

Other factors

Among Delhi's internal sources, transport accounted for 20.07% of the pollution load.

Meteorological conditions have also been unfavourable for the dispersion of pollutants. North-westerly winds prevailed over Delhi, with speeds reaching 10-15 kmph through the day on Monday, according to the India Meteorological Department.

The IMD had also reported shallow fog at a few places in the morning. Safdarjung, the Capital's base station, recorded visibility of 800 metres between 6.30 am and 7.30 am on Monday.

IN A NUTSHELL

- Stubble burning accounts for **8.5%** of **PM2.5** pollution in Capital on Monday, set to rise to **22%** on Thursday
- Transport accounted for **20.07%** of pollution load on Monday
- But farm fires at all-time low for 3 major states: Punjab, Haryana, UP


Haze-engulfed Akshardham Temple Monday. ANI

MEASURES UNDER GRAP-II

- Daily mechanical road sweeping, intensified water sprinkling with dust suppressants, and stricter inspections of construction sites to enforce dust-control norms.

DMRC announces **20 additional** train trips on weekdays



6-7 am, 8-10 pm: SC fixes timings for green crackers in Delhi-NCR on Diwali

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 2

THE SUPREME Court on Monday allowed the sale of certified green crackers at designated locations in Delhi-NCR ahead of Diwali, permitting people to burst them only between 6 am and 7 am and 8 pm and 10 pm on November 7 and 8. The court clarified that the temporary relaxation would end on November 8, with the complete ban on firecrackers set to be restored from November 9.

A bench of Justices MM Sundresh and PB Varale directed that "(the) authorities shall ensure that bursting of firecrackers is allowed only between 6 am and 7 am, and 8 pm and 10 pm on November 7 and 8."

The October 29 order — made public on Monday — also allowed the manufacture of such crackers in the region for a limited time.

The ruling added that "there shall not be any bursting of fireworks within a 300-metre radius of hospitals, nursing homes, primary and district health centres, old-age homes and any notified silence zones". These areas will be declared as 'No-Cracker Zones', and shall be marked on the ground and published. Similar restrictions shall also be applicable to educational institutions.

Certification must

The order read, "The firecracker and fireworks manufacturers, who possess valid certification for the green crackers, as certified by the CSIR – National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (NEERI), as well as Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation (PESO), are permitted to manufacture only those green crackers that have been uploaded on the website of CSIR-NEERI from November 2 to November 6."

The bench ordered that "the licences of traders that have been cancelled, shall be restored for a temporary period commencing from November 4 to November 6 to facilitate the sale of approved green crackers purchased from CSIR-NEERI certified manufacturers. Such licences shall be immediately cancelled, if they are found flouting the aforesaid directions, and they shall be prohibited from selling the firecrackers during the remaining period."

The order added, "All necessary efforts will have to be made to ensure due compliance as endeavours should be made not to cause any inconvenience to those who are suffering from ailments."

It further said that "boxes containing the green crackers must be completely sealed to ensure that they are not mixed with any of the unauthorised or conventional firecrackers" and "there shall be no manufacture or sale of firecrackers joined in series ('ladis') and garlands" or firecrackers that use Barium. "Each of such boxes shall contain the QR code, and there shall be sale of only those firecrackers that carry product-specific QR codes," it stated.

The Supreme Court had on October 23, 2018, in the case Arjun Gopal & Ors. v. Union of India & Ors., while striking a balance between competing interests of concerns about air pollution and the religious significance of Diwali, permitted manufacture and sale of crackers with reduced emission - improved crackers, and green crackers.

Later, in 2024, pursuant to the directions issued by the court in M.C. Mehta v. Union of India & Ors, the Government of the National Capital Territory of Delhi (GNCTD) on December 19, 2024, imposed a complete perpetual ban on manufacturing, storage, selling and bursting all kinds of firecrackers throughout the year, with immediate effect from January 1, 2025.

However on October 15, 2025, the SC in the M.C. Mehta case relaxed the total ban and allowed sale and use of green crackers as a temporary measure.

Skywatch

Forecast: November 3, 2026
Mainly clear sky, mist in the morning hours
MAX: 28-30
0.5°C below normal
MIN: 15-17
1.7°C above normal
- *Sunrise: 6:35 AM (November 4)*
- *Sunset: 5:35 PM (November 3)*
- *Moonrise: 1:44 AM (November 4)*
- *Moonset: 2:03 PM (November 3)*

AQI Tracker

JNU: Very Poor, AQI:362	Bawana: Very Poor, AQI: 393
Anand Vihar: Poor, AQI: 278	ITO: Very Poor, AQI: 366

- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)

HC: No stay now on ban on entry of non BS-VI vehicles

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, November 2

THE DELHI High Court on Monday refused to interfere with the government's decision on banning the entry of non-BS-VI vehicles, registered outside the Capital, till January 31 to tackle winter air pollution. The ban, which kicked off on Sunday, is one of the several anti air pollution measures being taken.

A division bench of Acting Chief Justice Nitin Sambre and Justice Sanjay Sharma, hearing a plea filed by Advocate Gurmukh Dass Kohli Ahas, has also sought a response from the government.Kohli, a resident of Haryana's Faridabad, in his plea, has challenged the government's ban, noting that "differential treatment" has been meted out to non-Delhi-registered vehicles when no such restriction applies for Delhi-registered vehicles.

Apart from seeking an interim suspension of the government's notification, the plea also called for the quashing of the directive. The bench, while refusing to stay or suspend the operation of the notification as an interim measure, also recorded that the issue is already subjudice before the Supreme Court.

The High Court instead issued notice to the Delhi government, seeking its response to the contentions being raised in the petition by November 27 when it will hear the matter next.Kohli, in his plea, has highlighted that as per the notification, while a Delhi registered BS-IV vehicle is allowed to ply, a Haryana-registered BS-IV vehicle is not even allowed to enter the Capital even though the National Capital Region (NCR) "functions as a single integrated urban region".

Kohli has flagged that the restriction impacts not only him, who has to travel to various courts and tribunals in Delhi while possessing a BS-IV Haryana-registered vehicle, but also lakhs of other commuters.

"The recurrence of this prohibition each winter, together with the imminent threat of enforcement, constitutes a direct and continuing interference with (Kohli's) ordinary professional travel arrangements," the plea flags.

The plea highlighting that "pollution is a function of emission standard and fuel, not of the registering authority", noted that "congestion at choke points, poorly maintained roads and the absence of effective traffic management multiply emissions far more" than the state where a vehicle is registered.


Checks underway at Ghazipur border in Delhi on Monday
PRAVEEN KHANNA

GROUND report

'We're sitting on road, family worried': On Day 2 of BS-VI checks, commuters stranded, scramble for costly rides

Drishti Jain & Abhimanyu Hazarika
New Delhi, November 2

NEWLYWED NAHIDA (23) boarded a Delhi-bound AC sleeper bus from her hometown, Benipur in Bihar, around 11:30 am on Sunday.

She was travelling to her in-laws' house in Delhi's Udyog Vihar. The bus had reached a stretch near the Delhi-Uttar Pradesh border — only a few kilometres away from her marital home — when it was stopped, and the passengers stranded. She said she booked the bus tickets for herself, her sister and aunt for Rs 3,500.

The non-BS-VI compliant vehicle was challaned at Chilla Border. The Delhi government has imposed a ban on the entry of vehicles below the BS-VI emission standard as pollution has started tightening its grip.

Monday marked Day 2 of the ban, with officers stationed along Delhi's border with states like UP and Haryana. Only BS-VI-compliant, CNG and electric vehicles were allowed to enter the Capital.

Unaware, many commuters, like Nahida, were left stranded. They were caught off-guard while police personnel grappled with "unclear instructions"."

The bus Nahida took was ferrying around 40 passengers. It pulled over under the shade of a tree, forcing some of them to toggle multiple online taxi service apps on their phones, while others hunched over clutching their bags in a row.

"My family was very excited to see me, but we're here sitting on the road. They're worried now. They (the bus operator) are not even giving us money to go back," said Nahida.

She was not alone.

Varun (43), who drives an auto rickshaw in Sonipat, was travelling with his wife, children and a relative.

"We boarded near Muzaffarpur and paid Rs 6,000 for five people to be dropped near GT Karnal," he said as the relative waved at an autorickshaw, asking it to stop.

"I don't have much money left. A cab will charge Rs 1,600. We have been here since the last two hours," he fumed as an app on his son's phone showed their cab was "31 minutes away".

Umesh Singh, the bus driver, was equally confused. "There was a chatter that few vehicles would not be allowed (to enter Delhi), but nothing was confirmed. Some said that the rules will be fixed by November 5," he said with the challan in his hand.

They would have to pay Rs 66,000, he claimed.

A few hours earlier, another vehicle bearing an UP number plate, was turned back from Chilla Border, leaving its occupants — including a couple in their late 50s — visibly distressed.

A police officer, meanwhile, was heard telling occupants of a non-BS-VI car travelling from Noida to Delhi: "Sir, you will not be allowed to proceed."

The owner, Bhupendra, who was driving the vehicle, frowned. "I don't know anything about these rules. We live in Paschim Vihar and came to meet someone in Noida."

His wife said, "I can show you our Aadhaar cards... How can you stop us? How will we go home now?"

"I will turn 60 in November. This is so troubling for people of our age," Bhupendra added.

The police officer suggested alternative routes, telling the couple, "We are following the Supreme Court order. You should too."

He then stopped the traffic, moved barricades aside as the couple made a U-turn and drove towards Noida again.

A Delhi Police officer said that a total of 8,263 vehicles were checked in the Capital and along its borders till 8 pm.

A total of 37 were challaned, 1,228 were sent back and two impounded and sent to scrap yards.

While space constraints led to traffic disruptions in Ghazipur, at checkpoints in Kalindi Kunj and Chilla Border, the traffic flow was heavy, as usual.

At the DND Flyover, 28 vehicles were checked until 10:20 am, and at least three sent back.

At the Delhi-Gurugram Aya Nagar border, ASI Deepak Kumar said all 10 vehicles stopped by his team were BS-VI-compliant.

"There's nothing to worry about. People have become aware of the rules now," he told his seniors over the phone.

Enforcement in numbers on Day-1

- **14,930** vehicles checked
- **1,539** vehicles turned back at borders
- **127** vehicles challaned for violating the BS-VI entry ban
- **566** PUCC challans issued for pollution certificate violations
- **300** construction sites inspected
- **33** construction sites found violating dust-control norms
- **₹68.40 lakh** in total penalties imposed


Traffic snarls at Ghazipur border. PRAVEEN KHANNA

- On Day 2, a Delhi Police official said a total of 8,263 vehicles were checked, 37 vehicles were challaned, 1,228 were returned from the borders, 2 were impounded.

'Society impacted as a whole': Court denies bail to accused in medical procurement case

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, November 2

A DELHI court Saturday denied bail to former deputy controller of accounts at Delhi government's Central Procurement Agency (CPA), Neeraj Chopra, a key accused in an alleged Rs 842-crore medical procurement scam.

"There is no gainsaying that the applicant/accused was holding responsible position, and his alleged acts constitute economic offences, which has not only caused severe damage to the health system of Govt. of NCT, Delhi, but has also adversely affected the society as a whole," said Special Judge Vidya Prakash of Rouse Avenue Court."...if the applicant/accused is enlarged on regular bail at this stage, there is a reasonable apprehension that, having regard to his former senior official position..., he may influence.. the material witnesses, ... hamper ongoing probe," the court added.

As per the government's Anti-Corruption Branch, Chopra was a member of the CPA's procurement committees and bid files for purchases were placed before him for approval.

The ACB alleged he signed notings without objecting that the winning bidder did not meet the tender's eligibility conditions.In one instance, a bill from M/s F-Med Devices, a firm allegedly owned by the "mastermind" in the case, Rajiv Rangila, reached Chopra after processing. He marked it to the cashier for re-verification, after which it went to the then Directorate General of Health Services for approval.

"The material available on record, would prima facie show that the officials who had raised objections to the questioned files, were subjected to pressure, and that one such officer was allegedly taken to the residence of co-accused Rajiv Kumar on the directions of co-accused Dr. Vinod Kumar Ranga. The apprehension of interference is, therefore, not theoretical," the judge said in the order. The case centres on the CPA, the nodal agency responsible for supplying medicines, vaccines and medical equipment to Delhi government hospitals and healthcare facilities. The chargesheet filed in the case in September alleged that tenders were manipulated to favour two companies owned by pharmaceutical trader Rajiv Rangila.

The ACB described Rangila, who has been arrested, as one of the alleged masterminds.The chargesheet names Dr Ranga, Head of Office of the CPA; Directorate General of Health Services chief Dr Vatsala Aggarwal; and Chopra. The ACB also alleged that 10 important procurement files could not be traced.

HC stays JNU's order to dismiss Cong MP Akoijam amid sexual harassment case probe

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, November 2

THE DELHI High Court on Monday stayed the Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) administration's decision to terminate the services of professor Angomcha Bimol Akoijam over allegations of sexual harassment. Justice Anup J Bhambhani issued notice to the university on Akoijam's petition challenging the dismissal order and listed the case for hearing in January.

Akoijam, the Congress MP from the Inner Manipur Lok Sabha seat, was a professor at the JNU's School of Social Sciences.


Angomcha Bimol Akoijam

According to reports, at least 11 female students filed sexual harassment complaints against the professor in May. The complainants alleged that Akoijam invited students to his campus residence under the pretext of meetings or gatherings and attempted to sexually harass them.

Some students have also alleged that he made obscene and inappropriate remarks during classes. On October 9, JNU dismissed Akoijam over the sexual harassment complaints.

The termination order, signed by Vice Chancellor Santishree D Pandit, said the university's internal complaints committee had conducted an inquiry and recommended disciplinary action based on its findings.

"Upon following the due process and considering all available facts and as per the report of the Internal Committee, the punishment of dismissal from the services of the university is hereby imposed," the order stated.

The dismissal order cited the relevant service rules and Rule 11(ix) of the Central Civil Services (Classification, Control and Appeal) Rules while imposing the punishment.

The Congress MP has denied all allegations and termed his dismissal a "witch hunt". Days after his dismissal, the Delhi Police registered an FIR against Akoijam on charges of sexual harassment and insulting a woman's modesty. The FIR was registered on a complaint lodged by the university's chief security officer on October 11. The FIR was registered at the Vasant Kunj North police station on Sunday.

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL



Crown Prince?

WHEN BSP national convener Akash Anand reached Saharanpur on Monday to announce the name of party leader Naresh Kumar Saini as the BSP candidate from Nakur Assembly seat for the 2027 Assembly elections, Saini welcomed the senior leader with a gold crown. A senior BSP leader said the gold crown was offered on behalf of the Saini community. Notably, when BSP supremo and Anand's aunt Mayawati was the Uttar Pradesh chief minister in the late 2000s, she had drawn criticism from Opposition parties for accepting gold crowns as gifts from party workers.

Crowd Contest

THE RAMLILA Maidan rally of the INDIA bloc on Sunday seems to have set off some "healthy competition" among frontal organisations of the Congress. Sources said senior leaders of the Seva Dal have been claiming within the party circles that the Indian Youth Congress (IYC) could mobilise only around 3,000 workers for the rally. The IYC, on the other hand, has asserted that it managed to bring more than 10,000 workers from across the country to the Capital. This competition will soon be addressed by the senior leadership of the party, said the sources.

Punjab: 3 MLAs who quit AAP join BJP

Speaker accepts resignations of two, issues notice to Jouramajra

Kanchan Vasdev & Raakhi Jagga
Chandigarh, November 2



(From left) Harmeet Singh Pathanmajra, Kunwar Vijay Pratap Singh and Chetan Singh Jouramajra with BJP's Punjab chief Kewal Singh Dhillon, national media convener Ashish Agarwal, former Delhi unit president Virendra Sachdeva and other leaders at the party headquarters in New Delhi on Monday. PTI

THREE MLAS of the ruling Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) in Punjab jumped ship to the BJP on Monday, months ahead of Assembly polls. Sanaur MLA Harmeet Singh Pathanmajra, Samana legislator Chetan Singh Jouramajra and Amritsar North MLA Kunwar Vijay Pratap Singh joined the BJP at the party's Delhi headquarters. Sources said the BJP has promised to field the three leaders in the constituencies they represented.

BJP's Punjab unit chief, Kewal Singh Dhillon, and the state in-charge, Satish Poonia welcomed the trio into the partyfold. Poonia said the leaders' "political, social and administrative background" will strengthen the BJP's "victory mission" in Punjab. "There is an undercurrent in favour of the BJP and anti-incumbency against the AAP," he said.

Dhillon described the AAP as a "sinking ship" and said more resignations are expected. "AAP leaders are saying BJP is getting leftovers from other parties. They need to remember that Surjit Singh Rakhra in their party came from the Shiromani Akali Dal, Dimpy Dhillon and Harmeet Singh Sandhu, too. And Dr Raj Kumar Chabbewal from Congress. Leaders keep going to different parties. It is a question mark on the party as to why MLAs are leaving despite the government in power with over 90 MLAs," he said, adding that the three leaders will "get due respect" in the BJP.

AAP's Punjab unit chief Aman Arora, however, said the BJP has failed to build its own political base in Punjab. "The BJP has neither been able to develop its own leadership nor present a clear agenda for Punjab. Instead, it is inducting leaders from other parties who have faced serious allegations and disciplinary action, suspended by other parties," Arora said. "If the BJP believes that it can form a government in Punjab through such inductions, it is mistaken. The people of the state will judge every party on its record, its policies and its commitment to Punjab."

While Jouramajra and Pathanmajra quit AAP on Sunday, Kunwar Vijay Pratap announced his resignation from the Assembly on Monday. The developments in quick succession came soon after the AAP released the first list of 40 candidates for the Assembly polls on October 31.

Jouramajra and Pathanmajra had earlier said they were in touch with the BJP. Sandeep Pathak, Rajya Sabha MP and senior AAP leader who joined the BJP in April, is learnt to have played a key role in the three MLAs switching to the BJP. Pathanmajra was earlier with the Shiromani Akali Dal. He then switched to AAP before moving to the Congress. He returned to AAP ahead of the 2022 election and won the Sanaur seat. Jouramajra won the Samana seat in his electoral debut in the 2022 polls.

The AAP, meanwhile, has submitted a petition to Assembly Speaker Kultar Singh Sandhwan, seeking the disqualification of Jouramajra and Pathanmajra under the anti-defection law. AAP's chief whip Baljinder Kaur told *The Indian Express*, "I have filed the petition against both with the Speaker, seeking their disqualification from the Vidhan Sabha under the anti-defection law. Both joined the BJP without resigning from the Vidhan Sabha."

Sandhwan told *The Indian Express* that he had accepted Kunwar Vijay Pratap's and Pathanmajra's resignation. "I am issuing a notice to Jouramajra. If he doesn't respond with resignation, he will be disqualified," he said.

With the acceptance of the two resignations, the Amritsar North and Sanaur Assembly constituencies have become vacant. With this, the strength of AAP will now come down to 92 in the 117-member Assembly. The Congress has 16 MLAs, the SAD has three MLAs, BJP two, the Bahujan Samaj Party one, while one seat is held by an Independent.

The development spotlights an earlier political switch in Punjab. Ahead of the 2024 Lok Sabha elections, the AAP brought Akali MLA Dr Sukhwinder Kumar Sukhi into its fold. However, no disqualification proceedings were initiated against him, and he continues as an MLA.

SP's Azam Khan moves top court over ED arrest after jail release

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 2

SAMAJWADI PARTY (SP) leader Azam Khan Monday moved the Supreme Court challenging his arrest and judicial remand by the ED on money laundering charges. He was arrested shortly after his release on bail in a separate case involving dual PAN cards.

Appearing for Khan, advocate Nizam Pasha mentioned the matter before a bench led by CJI Surya Kant and requested an urgent hearing. The CJI-led bench said it would list the petition for hearing this week.

The Allahabad High Court granted bail to Khan and his son Abdullah Azam Khan on October 29 in the dual PAN card case, while dismissing their prayer for a stay on their conviction. After stepping out of Rampur jail on October 31, the agency immediately took Khan into custody over alleged financial irregularities in the construction of Mohammad Ali Jauhar University in Rampur. His son was released, and he returned home.

On November 27, 2025, a Rampur trial court sentenced both to a maximum of seven years of RI under charges of criminal conspiracy, cheating, and forgery. An appellate court then enhanced Azam Khan's sentence to 10 years of RI. The FIR alleged a conspiracy between the father and son to forge papers to overcome age-eligibility constraints for the election.

After Mamata-mukt Bengal, it's time for Rahul-mukt Delhi: BJP chief in Kolkata

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, November 2



BJP chief Nitin Nabin and West Bengal CM Suvendu Adhikari in Kolkata on Monday. PTI

LEADING A march in Kolkata to counter INDIA bloc's campaign against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the SIR process, BJP national president Nitin Nabin on Monday targeted Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi, accusing him of "working with foreign forces seeking to destabilise the country".

Nabin asserted that the BJP would defeat the Samajwadi Party in Uttar Pradesh next after having defeated the RJD in Bihar and TMC in West Bengal. He called for making Delhi "Rahul-mukt" (Rahul-free).

Addressing a rally at Dharamtala after concluding the 'Save Democracy, End Anarchy' padyatra along with Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari and state BJP president Samik Bhattacharya, Nabin alleged, "Rahul Gandhi is a toolkit of those forces which engineered the unrest in Nepal and other neighbouring countries. He is leading those forces who are behind the anarchy across the country."

"Just as Bengal has become Mamata-mukt, we will make Delhi Rahul-mukt. We defeated Congress and Rahul Gandhi in 2014, 2019 and 2024. We will do so again in 2029." His sharp attack on Opposition leaders came a day after the INDIA bloc parties held a huge rally at Delhi's Ramlila Maidan against CEC Kumar, claiming vote theft.

Nabin claimed that had the Congress and Rahul "learnt lessons" from their electoral failures, they would not have raised "baseless allegations" against the ECI. "Rahul Gandhi has no vision; he will be responsible for the Congress' complete wipeout," he said.

Nabin also asserted that Modi will once again hoist the national flag from the Red Fort in 2029 as the country's PM. Nabin also claimed the BJP will win in all five states where Assembly elections are due, including Punjab.

He also took a dig at former West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee, who had also attended the INDIA bloc rally in Delhi on Sunday. "West Bengal has already become completely free of Mamata (Banerjee). Unable to cope with the setback of defeat in her own state, the former CM now goes to Delhi and cries there."

Meanwhile, Mamata AITC leader Derek O'Brien took a swipe at the BJP over its nationwide street mobilisation against the Opposition over the "vote theft" issue, saying its top leadership was playing catch-up. He wrote on X, "...Imitation is the best form of flattery."

'Became PM with foreign help': Rahul slams Modi over 'obstructionist side' comment

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 2

LOK SABHA Leader of Opposition (LoP) Rahul Gandhi on Monday said that Narendra Modi became the country's Prime Minister with "foreign help" and challenged him to an open debate.

Gandhi was reacting to PM Modi's comment that the Opposition had turned into an "obstructionist side (*avrodh paksh*)". Attaching a news report of PM Modi's remarks, Gandhi said, "Mr Modi, stop lying to this nation. You became PM because of foreign help. You remain PM because of foreign help."

"Your financial system is fully controlled and supported by foreigners. Foreign social media fully backs you," Gandhi wrote in a post on X.

He "challenged" PM Modi to an open debate, saying, "Any stage, any time. Come if you have the guts."

"You won't dare, because you are terrified of what I know about you," said the LoP.

Speaking at the Rashtriya Ekta Diwas celebrations on Saturday, to mark the birth anniversary of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel at the Statue of Unity in Gujarat's Ekta Nagar, PM Modi had said, "In a democracy, the responsibility of the Opposition is to oppose government policies, but it is our misfortune that the Opposition (*virodh paksh*) has become an obstructionist side (*avrodh paksh*)... Driven by frustration and disappointment, these people are creating obstacles in the path of the country's development. This is not Opposition, this is obstruction... They are engaged in undermining the dignity and sanctity of the Constitution."



Union Home Minister Amit Shah leads the 'Save Democracy, Remove Anarchy' march in Hyderabad. PTI

'Never existed': Shah says 3 crore votes dropped in SIR 'infiltrators'

Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, November 2

UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah said in Hyderabad that the INDIA bloc rally held in Delhi on Sunday was not to save votes but to save infiltrators who form the vote bank of "Congress and company".

Speaking at Hyderabad's Mozamjahi Market Monday, Shah said the SIR had identified 3 crore people as non-voters or infiltrators. "Now, I'm coming to what is causing a stomach ache for [Congress leader] Rahul Gandhi. Three crore votes were those which never existed. These votes were those of Bangladeshi infiltrators. Three crore people are such that they aren't there. They aren't around. Tell me whether these votes should be cut or not?"

"Who are these three crore people? They are infiltrators. Should we not remove them from the rolls? But Rahul ji says we shouldn't remove them (from the rolls)," Shah said, adding that the BJP would remove "every infiltrator from the electoral rolls". He later said the government was ready to hold a special session of Parliament on SIR, infiltrators and EVMs. "I challenge you from Hyderabad's soil... If you have the courage, come for this discussion," he said, adding Gandhi wouldn't come for the debate. "Because he knows that only anarchy keeps Congress in the news."

"Rahul Gandhi says that 13 crore people have lost their vote in the country. He is lying." Of the 13 crore, 6.15 crore were people who had shifted to a different place. "Should they get votes in two different parts of the country?" he asked the crowd. "As many as 2.8 crore to 3 crore people are the ones who have died. Should their vote not be removed? Rahul Gandhi, who will cast the votes of those who have died? The Congress party. The Congress party wants to come to power by casting bogus votes."

He claimed that 1 crore of those removed were "duplicate voters". "Shouldn't one of the votes of the duplicate voters be removed or not?" he asked.

Responding to the Congress' charge that the BJP was coming to power because of SIR, Shah said, "In 2014, there was no SIR. Modiji won that year. In 2019, Modiji won again, but no SIR was held. In 2024, Modiji won again, and no SIR was held. Modiji has come to power on the votes of Indian voters." He listed the states that the BJP and its alliance partners had won after the 2024 general elections. "After 2024, Maharashtra, Haryana, Delhi, Bihar, Bengal and Assam were won. Now we are going to win Telangana too."

Referring to the recent Opposition mock impeachment session of CEC Gyanesh Kumar, Shah said, "It would have been good had Rahul Gandhi played the role of the PM in the mock parliament session because he would never be PM in the real parliament." To win in India, he said, "you have to be one with the country" and the people, and sweat it out. He then called for a door-to-door campaign to "end the confusion around SIR that the Congress has created".

SC tells Rajasthan election body to reconsider voter campaign plea

ENS & PTI
Jaipur, November 2

THE SUPREME Court on Monday set aside a communication by the Rajasthan State Election Commission (SEC) rejecting an application for a voter awareness campaign.

Social activist Aruna Roy and others had filed a plea on October 6, seeking the SEC's permission to conduct voter awareness campaigns in Rajasthan. However, the SEC rejected it.

On Monday, a Bench led by CJI Surya Kant, which also included Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, directed SEC "to reconsider the petitioners' request for permitting them to conduct the voter awareness campaign during phase 3 of the Panchayati Raj poll", asking it to pass an order within two days.

Advocate Prashant Bhushan, appearing for the activists, had challenged the SEC's refusal to allow the petitioners to undertake voter awareness activities in the run-up to the local body polls. Opposing the plea, the SEC said it had examined the representation and apprehended that the proposed campaign could be undertaken at the behest of another person.

Justice Bagchi rejected the Commission's reasoning, observing its awareness initiatives could not be a ground to prevent other organisations from undertaking similar efforts.

Rajasthan puts investment package of firm linked to IAS officer on hold

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, November 2

VIRTUALLY BREAKING his silence on the corruption allegations against senior IAS officer Shikhar Agrawal, Rajasthan Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma, through his office, said on Monday that "the state is committed to a zero-tolerance policy towards corruption."

He also put on hold the customised package for the firm that, along with Agrawal, had been at the centre of the allegations. "Under the leadership of CM Bhajan Lal Sharma, the state government is committed to a zero-tolerance policy towards corruption. The government is taking necessary steps to ensure transparency, accountability, and financial discipline in matters related to government schemes and investment promotion," the CMO said.

It said that after the matter came to the attention of the CM, the state-level scrutiny committee for Industry and Commerce has placed a hold on the customised package approved for Messrs Goyal Fashions Private Limited. "This exemption was granted to the company under the Rajasthan Investment Promotion Scheme. After being put on hold, the company will not be granted the benefits and disbursements of the approved benefits until the ACB completes its preliminary investigation."

As per the ACB's assessment, there was "prima facie evidence" of collusion between Agrawal and the firm, with the IAS officer allegedly "abusing his position and influence, thereby conferring undue benefits upon himself and the related firm, and causing substantial financial loss to the state government."

ACB said that Agrawal facilitated benefits for the company, including relaxations in resort construction conditions, approvals without verification of requisite certificates, and special concessional financial packages.

Why Bihar BJP landed in a soup over 'defection' of Independent MLCs

Santosh Singh
Patna, November 2



X/@JANSURAAJONLINE

Jan Suraaj Party leaders meet Bihar Legislative Council Chairman Ram Bachan Rai on Monday, to demand disqualification of newly elected Independent MLCs Bansidhar Brajwasi and Rahul Raj

THE ANNOUNCEMENT by Bihar's newly elected Independent Members of Legislative Council (MLCs), Bansidhar Brajwasi and Rahul Raj, about joining the ruling BJP has triggered a political controversy in the state, with the Opposition parties demanding their disqualification under the provisions of the anti-defection law.

On Monday, a Jan Suraaj Party (JSP) delegation met the Bihar Legislative Council's Chairman Ram Bachan Rai to demand the immediate disqualification of Brajwasi and Raj, who recently won, respectively, from the Tirhut Graduates seat and the Saran Teachers' constituency.

Besides the two Independents, in the October 23 MLC polls for eight seats in the state, the BJP and the principal Opposition RJD bagged two seats each, with the NDA ally JD(U) and the JSP winning one seat each.

The row erupted after the Bihar BJP issued a press release on Saturday evening, declaring that Brajwasi and Raj had joined the party in the presence of state party president Sanjay Saraogi. The two Independent MLCs also echoed this before the media. Their pictures, showing them wearing the BJP's saffron scarves while holding party membership slips, flooded digital and social media, even as the BJP later withdrew its press release.

The Opposition, including the RJD, Congress, and JSP, seized upon the issue to demand the disqualification of Brajwasi and Raj as MLCs under the anti-defection law.

RJD working president and Leader of Opposition in the Assembly, Tejashwi Prasad Yadav, demanded that both the Independent MLCs be disqualified for allegedly violating the anti-defection law. He also accused the BJP of "making a mockery of the Constitution".

RJD MP and national spokesperson Manoj Kumar Jha said, "The Tenth Schedule of the Constitution, known as the anti-defection law, clearly states that if an Independent candidate joins any political party after their election, they face immediate disqualification from the House."

JSP spokesperson Kumar Saurav cited the numbers on the BJP membership slips purportedly given to Brajwasi and Raj when they joined the party. "It is a blatant violation of constitutional provisions. If needed, we will also move court to demand their disqualification," he said.

Senior JSP leader and former MLA Kishore Kumar Munna, who led a delegation to meet Council Chairman Rai, said, "We have informed the Chairman how the two Independent MLCs joined the BJP within 72 hours of winning their elections. We also produced all relevant evidence to support our claim. The two MLCs had openly admitted to joining the BJP. We were assured of appropriate action by the Upper House."

State Congress spokesman Asit Nath Tiwari underlined that "the Opposition is united over the issue".

On their part, the two Independent MLCs have now recalibrated their position, claiming that they have not joined the BJP but "merely offered support" to the party.

Brajwasi said, "I have decided to support the BJP as the state government has agreed to address the grievances of teachers... I have also decided to support the BJP as I am highly impressed with the development vision of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary, and former Chief Minister Nitish Kumar."

Echoing them, state BJP chief Saraogi, who had presided over the induction event for the two Independents, said: "The two leaders are impressed with the NDA's functioning and have decided to support us." He avoided answering media queries whether the two Independent MLCs risked disqualification for their moves.

Paragraph 2(2) of the Tenth Schedule dealing with anti-defection provisions says that if an Independent legislator joins any political party at any time after being elected, the member incurs disqualification from the membership of the House. It is unlike provisions in the case of nominated members who do not face disqualification if they switch their political allegiance within six months of becoming members of the House. The final decision on whether a member should be disqualified rests with the Chairman or Speaker, whose decision remains subject to judicial review by the courts.

Misri to visit Nepal tomorrow, set stage for Balen's likely trip to India this month

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, November 2

FOREIGN SECRETARY Vikram Misri will travel to Nepal on November 4 and 5 as part of the preparations for the likely visit by Nepal Prime Minister Balen Shah to India later this month.

According to the Ministry of External Affairs, Misri will undertake an official visit to Nepal to "discuss bilateral, regional and global matters of mutual interest."

"India and Nepal share strong and friendly ties which have seen substantial progress across diverse areas of cooperation. Foreign Secretary's upcoming visit continues the tradition of regular high-level exchanges between the two countries and will help further enhance comprehensive bilateral partnership," the MEA said.

On September 19, *The Indian Express* had reported that six months into the new Nepal government led by Prime Minister Shah, Delhi and Kathmandu are working towards scheduling a bilateral visit by him in the latter half of November. The two sides are looking at dates between November 22 and 24.

In September, Nepal's Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle had met Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and had discussed the possibility of the visit.

According to sources, Misri's visit is aimed at preparing the ground for Balen Shah's India visit — taking forward the conversation that started during Wagle's visit.

During the visit, India and Nepal will prioritise cross-border connectivity, including roads, railways, air routes and transmission infrastructure, sources said. Clean-energy cooperation is central, with Nepal targeting 35,000 megawatts (MW) over the next nine years through run-of-river and storage projects.

Nepal seeks expanded Indian investment, digitalization, high-value agriculture, green manufacturing, tourism and production-sharing opportunities, sources said. They will also discuss updating the trade treaty to cover services, investment protection, profit repatriation, and movement of parts and components, according to sources. Since this is the first bilateral visit after the devastating August 26 flash flood, this will also be an opportunity to exchange notes on the rescue and relief efforts. At least 270 Indians are still missing.

India sent humanitarian aid and extended emergency power support. It had delivered aid material and disaster relief supplies, apart from Bailey bridges.

Wagle's visit was part of Kathmandu's efforts to make up for its earlier actions -- when Nepal PM Shah refused to meet the Indian Ambassador to Nepal, Naveen Srivastava, and his subsequent reluctance to meet Foreign Secretary Misri in May, which resulted in the latter's visit being cancelled.

In early September, the Nepal PM thanked India for its timely assistance in response to the flood.

The course correction, they say, began well before the flash flood. In June, Nepal's top leader Rabi Lamichhane of the ruling Rashtriya Swatantra Party (RSP) visited New Delhi and met Prime Minister Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah.

RAJASTHAN: CONSTRUCTION MACHINE COMES IN CONTACT WITH POWER LINE

8 labourers working on road project electrocuted

Parul Kulshrestha
Jaipur, November 2

EIGHT LABOURERS were electrocuted and five others sustained injuries after a road construction machine came in contact with an overhead high-tension power line in Chapoli village of Rajasthan's Jhunjhunu district on Monday morning.

According to police, the incident occurred around 10 am when the labourers were shifting a cement mixer machine to another location. The hydraulic jack of the machine came in contact with an overhead live power line.

Jhunjhunu Collector Arun Garg said the villagers had started constructing a road connecting the village to Kadam Kund temple. However, since the road passed through a forest area and the forest guards were on panchayat election duties, they had not received the required permission to carry out the work.

"However, the villagers arranged some financial assistance at their own level and started the road construction work themselves. During the work, the cement mixer came in contact with a live wire. The labourers who were pushing the machine got electrocuted," Garg said.



Rajasthan Minister Jhabar Singh Kharra meets the injured who is undergoing treatment at a hospital in Jhunjhunu on Monday. ANI

The deceased have been identified as Hariram Gurjar (30), Mangalchand Gurjar (22), Kaluram Gurjar (29) and Pawan Gurjar (23), all residents of Haleda Mandawara village and Vishnu Saini (38), Surendra alias Suresh Saini (30), Mukesh Saini (27) and Fatehchand Saini (32), all residents of Chapoli. Vishnu was also the contractor.

One of the injured labourers, Gidaram Saini, told the media, "We were working in Chapoli. We were in the process of pushing the machine to another location when it came in contact with the power line."

Following the incident, villagers staged a protest and demanded compensation for the families of the dead. Former minister Rajendra Gudha said the victims belonged to economically weaker families and demanded compensation of Rs 20-25 lakh for each family.

Urban Development and Housing Minister Jhabar Singh Kharra also reached the spot and later visited the hospital to take stock of the situation.

Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma expressed grief over the incident and ordered a high-level inquiry.

"Saddened by the loss of lives due to a mishap in Jhunjhunu, Rajasthan. My condolences to the bereaved families. May the injured recover at the earliest. An ex-gratia of Rs 2 lakh from PMNRF would be given to the next of kin of each of those who lost their lives," PM Narendra Modi tweeted.

Former Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot expressed grief over the deaths and demanded a probe to determine who was responsible.

As per the state government's policy, a compensation of Rs 5 lakh is provided in cases of death due to electrocution. Additionally, Rs 2 lakh has been announced from the Prime Minister's Office, while Rs 5 lakh will be provided under the PM Ayushman Arogya Yojana, taking the announced assistance to Rs 12 lakh per deceased victim, subject to applicable eligibility and scheme provisions.



NTA recently shifted its headquarters from South East Delhi's Okhla area to the Government of India Press building on Minto Road

NTA overhaul: 5,000 experts empanelled for setting, vetting question papers

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, November 2

ABOUT 5,000 academicians, scientists, researchers, professionals, educators, translators and moderators have been empanelled with the National Testing Agency's (NTA) panel of subject matter experts for question paper setting, translation, vetting, moderation, answer key verification, curriculum mapping, research, psychometric validation and other confidential assignments, said sources.

After the NEET-UG paper leak in May this year, which led to massive protests and the resignation of former Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, the NTA sacked about 600 subject matter experts. It also shifted its headquarters from South East Delhi's Okhla area to the Government of India Press building on Minto Road.

As part of its ongoing overhaul, the NTA has invited Expressions of Interest (EOI) from academicians, scientists, educators and others to join its three-year panel of subject matter experts.

"More than 5,000 experts, including subject matter experts, moderators and translators, have been added to NTA's panel... We are not hiring them; they are being empanelled following multi-layered scrutiny and verification. The NTA is building its own large question bank for conducting examinations — a common pool of questions to prevent paper leaks. Therefore, the NTA has not set any deadline for empanelling translators and subject matter experts. The EOI remains open, and experts are being added to the panel throughout the year," sources said.

NTA had invited EOI to empanel subject matter experts and translators to review AI translated materials last month.

The plan is to ensure that subject matter experts and translators set question papers, vet them and verify them without having the knowledge of which question will be asked and even which examination the questions are meant for. The question bank will be so large that there will be no scope for question paper setters or translators to memorise and reproduce the questions, the sources said.

Explaining the process, officials said subject matter experts are empanelled after a strict four-layer verification process. "In the first stage, the applicant's details, eligibility, educational qualifications, experience, etc are checked and verified. Following the documentary verification, the NTA has constituted a subject matter committee which reviews and evaluates an applicant's academic standing, research record, experience in setting question papers, etc," an official said.

Only those who clear these stages are shortlisted, officials said, adding that the agency also conducts background checks to ensure that the applicants are not associated with any coaching institute or have prepared question bank material for students.

"The agency has also specified restrictions on how the confidential work is to be carried out. Empanelled experts are required to sign a comprehensive Non-Disclosure Agreement at the time of empanelment and reaffirm it at the start of every assignment," the official said.

A senior government official said the NTA had already started working on the question bank so that questions could be selected and a question paper could be finalised a few minutes before an examination to prevent paper leaks.

"The NTA has already started implementing this for some of the entrance examinations it conducts...," the official said.

The NTA conducts some of the major entrance examinations, including JEE (Main), CUET (UG and PG), UGC-NET, CSIR-NET and NEET. Except for NEET, all the other examinations are conducted in the Computer-Based Test (CBT) mode.

SC closes plea for CBI probe in temple donation 'theft' case

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 2

THE SUPREME Court on Monday disposed of a plea for a CBI probe into the donation theft at the Ayodhya Ram temple, stating that the Special Investigation Team (SIT) that had probed the case had filed a chargesheet.

A three-judge bench presided over by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said, "State of Uttar Pradesh has filed a status report, according to which, the chargesheet has now been filed in the matter. Keeping this in view, we dispose of this writ petition and other connected matters with a direction to the learned Judicial Magistrate to proceed in the matter in accordance with law."

The bench added that "since there is an element of public interest involved, liberty is granted to the writ petitioners to assist the learned Magistrate on the same premise as the law enables a victim of crime to assist the court."

The bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, clarified that it "has not expressed any opinion on merits" to "ensure that no prejudice is caused".

Appearing for the state, Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta said the theft mostly took place during counting.

"Individuals who were counting have taken the money," he said.

Mehta said an audit was also conducted and that "all artefacts or all *chadava* are found to be intact". He added that measures have been taken to ensure such incidents do not happen again.



Catching Up

Congress parliamentary party chairperson Sonia Gandhi with RJD chief Lalu Prasad, his son Tejashwi Yadav and other family members in Delhi on Monday. The meeting was held at Lalu's daughter and MP Misa Bharti's residence. Lalu posted on X: "Respected Madam Smt. Sonia Gandhi ji visited the residence and obtained health-related information. During this time, memories of the old days were refreshed." PTI

Manipur: Kuki group extends shutdown in Kangpokpi district by 48 hours

Jimmy Leivon
Imphal, November 2

ACCUSING THE government of failing to deliver justice for the abduction and murder of two Kuki-Zo civilians, the Committee on Tribal Unity (CoTU) on Monday prolonged its total shutdown in Manipur's Kangpokpi district by another 48 hours.

Essential services, including schools, healthcare, media, and airport-bound transit, have been exempted from the shutdown.

On October 29, the Kuki-Zo civil society and tribal organisation had called a 48-hour shutdown in the district, which was later extended for another 24 hours last Saturday.

The CoTU accused authorities of failing to act decisively despite the gravity of the crime, leaving the victims' families and the Kuki-Zo community waiting for justice. "The patience of a grieving community must never be mistaken for weakness, nor its demand for justice be treated with contempt," its statement read. The Committee stated that the Kuki-Zo community would no longer accept administrative delays or empty assurances, demanding immediate, time-bound justice against the perpetrators of the heinous crime.

It warned that failure on the part of the government to ensure decisive action and timely justice within the extended 48-hour period would compel it to take its own course of action with the help of its community.

"... will hold the government responsible for the consequences of its continued failure to respond to the community's demand for justice," the statement added.

BJP corporator booked for slapping man who questioned UP Dy CM

Express News Service
Lucknow, November 2

A MAN was allegedly slapped by a BJP corporator after he posed a question on the issue of UGC reservation to Uttar Pradesh Deputy Chief Minister Keshav Prasad Maurya at an event in Prayagraj on Sunday, triggering sharp reactions.

Local BJP MLA Harsh Vardhan Bajpai condemned the assault on the man, writing, in a post on X, that "raising questions over the UGC (reservation) is a right of every Brahmin". By late Monday evening, Rohit Tiwari, the man who was allegedly assaulted, got an FIR registered against BJP corporator Vinay Mishra on charges of assault and criminal intimidation.

The controversy erupted at 'Prabudhha Mahakumbh' organised by Rashtriya Parashuram Sena in the Daraganj area of Prayagraj on Sunday when two men questioned the Deputy CM over the University Grants Commission regulations aimed at addressing caste-based discrimination on college campuses.

While Maurya was addressing the event, the two men shouted, "Will you speak about us? Will you speak something on UGC?" Apparently upset by the interruption, Maurya replied, "Keep quiet. Go from here. I will speak over everything."

Soon, policemen deployed at the event caught hold of the two men and started to escort them out of the venue. In the meantime, local BJP corporator Vinay Mishra walked towards them and slapped one of the two men. The policemen took the two men to Daraganj police station and released them later.

On Monday, BJP MLA from Allahabad North, Harsh Vardhan Bajpai, reacted on social media. In a post on X, he wrote, "Opposing UGC is a right of every Brahmin/upper caste. Those who resorted to violence against people of their own community only to curry favour should remember that no one names their child Vibhishan."

'Selective agenda': BJP objects to Dia Mirza anti-firecracker video, BMC takes it down

Pratip Acharya
Mumbai, November 2

THE BRIHANMUMBAI Municipal Corporation (BMC) on Monday deleted a video featuring actor Dia Mirza from its pollution-free Diwali campaign after BJP members objected to it, sparking a controversy. The civic body had on Sunday posted the video of the actor, urging Mumbaikars not to burst firecrackers during Diwali festivities amid concerns over the city's deteriorating air quality.

Within hours after the video went live on social media, BJP members, including the party's Mumbai chief Ameet Satam, criticised the civic authorities, following which the video was taken down.

"The festivities are here and while indulging in the celebrations, we shouldn't forget about our health and well being. Firecrackers emit noise and air pollution, which is harmful to all of us. Therefore, it is my request to celebrate Diwali by spreading happiness and not noise," Mirza said in her video.



Dia Mirza

Mumbai Mayor Ritu Tawde called a press conference and said she was not consulted by the civic authorities before roping in Mirza for the campaign.

"Our problem is not with the message that was shared, but with the celebrity that was appointed for the campaign... the elected representatives should have been consulted by the administration," she said.

Labelling Mirza's appeal as "selective agenda", Tawde said, "If we look at Dia Mirza's profile, we see that she has opposed the Narmada project and the Uniform Civil Code (UCC)... She has even opposed statements made by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. Consistently, her opposition appears to be directed against Hindutva."

After the video in which Dia Mirza appealed to the citizens to refrain from bursting crackers during Diwali started gaining traction, Mumbai BJP chief and Andheri West MLA Ameet Satam posted on X: "@mybmc We don't need lessons on how to celebrate #Diwali from @deespeak Our traditions are deeply rooted in our culture."

Following Satam's tweet, several other users also criticised the civic body for roping in Dia Mirza for the anti-cracker campaign. Within hours after Satam's tweet, the civic administration deleted the post from all its social media handles.

"Following the public outcry against the earlier posts, the administration decided to remove them. However, the civic body's stand on cracker bursting continues to be the same as we are just following the Bombay High Court's (HC) order," a civic official told *the Indian Express*.

Mahayuti ally Shiv Sena, meanwhile, maintained that there was nothing wrong with the message that was shared by Mirza. Speaking with reporters on Monday, Mumbai deputy mayor and senior Shiv Sena corporator Sanjay Ghadi said, "Our problem is not with the person giving the message, but the way the person was chosen. The administration should have consulted the Mayor, deputy mayor and leader of the house or at least should have presented the proposal in the civic house," he said.

"I don't think Dia Mirza has said anything inappropriate. It was unnecessary for the administration to take down the video or for BJP chief Ameet Satam to oppose it," he added.

IN REMEMBRANCE

Corps of Signals salutes its Signallers who left us for their heavenly abode during the month of October 2026.

1.	15712406Y	Nk	M Mahendiran
2.	15748698X	Sigmn	Mohit Kumar
3.	15748735A	Sigmn	Mallesh
4.	15755093Y	Sigmn	Damor Sagarbhai Chandrasinh

Deeply mourned by Lt Gen Vivek Dogra, SM, SO-in-C, Col Comdt and all ranks of Corps of Signals.

ARUNACHAL JANTA PARTY

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that **ARUNACHAL JANTA PARTY**, formed on **16th October 2026** with its head office at **015, Dokum Colony, Akash Deep, Itanagar District Papum Pare, Arunachal Pradesh – 791111** has propose to apply for registration with the Election Commission of India under Section 29A of the Representation of People Act, 1951.

Any person having any objection to the proposed registration may submit the objection in writing to the **Election Commission of India, Nirvachan Sadan, Ashoka Road, New Delhi – 110001**, by **3rd December 2026.**

Khyoda Sanjoy
President

केन्द्रीय पेट्रोरसायन अभियांत्रिकी एवं प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान (सिपेट), रायपुर
CENTRAL INSTITUTE OF PETROCHEMICALS ENGINEERING & TECHNOLOGY (CIPET:IPT), RAIPUR
(Department of Chemicals & Petrochemicals, Ministry of Chemicals & Fertilizers, Govt. of India)
Plot No. 48, Industrial Area Bhanpuri, Bhanpuri, Raipur-493221(C.G.)
Phone. No. 07771-6673001-30, E-mail:- raipur@cipet.gov.in, Website:- www.cipet.gov.in

Advt No. CIPET/RPR/ADMN/ADVT_PROJ_ASSO./2026/05 Date: 02.11.2026

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Principal Director & Head

भारतीय कंटेनर निगम लिमिटेड
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
एक नवरत्न कम्पनी (भारत सरकार का उपक्रम)
A Navratna Company (A Govt. of India Undertaking)
Regd. Office & Investors Relation Centre: CONCOR Bhawan, C-3, Mathura Road, Opp. Apollo Hospital, New Delhi-110076 | CIN : L60011DL1988GOI030915 | website : http://www.concorindia.co.in

NOTICE OF RECORD DATE FOR 2nd INTERIM DIVIDEND FOR FY 2026-27

Notice is hereby given that 11th November, 2026 (Wednesday) has been fixed as the Record Date for the purpose of determining the entitlement of members to 2nd Interim Dividend @38% (Rs.1.90 per share on equity share of Rs.5/- each), declared by the Board in its meeting held on 02.11.2026 for the financial year 2026-27. Further, 2nd Interim dividend will be paid:

(i) to those Members whose names will appear in the Register of Members of the Company, after giving effect to all valid Share Transfers in physical form lodged with the Company and its Registrar on or before 11th November, 2026; or

(ii) in respect of Shares held in electronic form, to those "deemed members" whose names appear on the Statements of beneficial ownership furnished by National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) and Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL), at the end of business hours on 11th November, 2026.

In order to avail the facility of payment of dividend through Electronic Clearing Service (ECS), members of the Company, holding their shares in Demat mode are requested to submit the duly filled in ECS mandate form to their Depository Participant and those holding physical shares to Company's Share Transfer Agent and Registrar: M/s Beetal Financial & Computer Services (P) Ltd., BEETAL HOUSE, 3rd Floor, 99, Madangir, Behind Local Shopping Centre, Near Dada Harsukhdas Mandir, New Delhi – 110062. ECS instructions once furnished by the member will supersede all his/ her previous bank mandates/details. ECS mandate form is available on Company's website: www.concorindia.co.in.

Shareholders holding shares in dematerialized mode are requested to update their records such as tax residential status, and permanent account number (PAN), mobile numbers and other details with the relevant depositories through their depository participants. Shareholders holding shares in physical mode are requested to furnish details to the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent, M/s Beetal Financial & Computer Services (P) Ltd at concor@beetalfinancial.com.

Shareholders are also requested to register/ update their E-mail ID with company at investorrelations@concorindia.com/ their Depository participants/ Company's Registrar & Share Transfer Agent at concor@beetalfinancial.com which will be used for sending official documents through e-mail in future.

Shareholders are requested to claim their unpaid/ unclaimed dividend, if any by writing to company at its Registered office or email or to its R&TA. Dividends if remained unpaid or unclaimed for a period of seven years shall be transferred by the company to the Investor Education and Protection Fund. Further, all shares in respect of which dividend has not been paid or claimed for seven consecutive years or more shall be transferred by the company in the name of Investor Education and Protection Fund.

For Container Corporation of India Ltd.
sd/-
(Harish Chandra)
PED (Finance) & Company Secretary

Place: New Delhi
Date : 02.11.2026

Jalaun bar panel head killed after being lured into car, four arrested

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, November 2

THE PRESIDENT of the Kalpi Bar Association in Uttar Pradesh's Jalaun district was killed over a long-standing land dispute, hours after he was allegedly abducted on the pretext of discussing a court case, police said. The body of Gayadeen Ahirwar, 68, was recovered on Sunday afternoon from a drain in Kanpur, nearly 80 kilometres from Kalpi.

Four men, including the prime accused, Indrajeet Singh Yadav, a Kanpur-based contractor, have been arrested. Yadav has been embroiled in a legal dispute with Ahirwar over a piece of land in Jalaun's Kadaura area since 2015.

Officials claimed that two of the accused, Sarvesh Shukla alias Sabbu and Ashish Vishwakarma, both aged 27, were shot in the leg in an encounter when they allegedly tried to flee from a forest area where they along with their accomplice Keshav Katiyar, 26, were taken on Sunday evening to recover the car allegedly used in the crime.

Another accused, Monu Yadav, 24, who was allegedly hired by Indrajeet, is absconding, they added.

"We have recovered the body and the car used in the crime...," said Jalaun Circle officer Rajesh Kamal. Police said a search was launched after they were informed by Gayadeen Ahirwar's son, Harsh, on Saturday that some men had abducted his father in a car.

During the preliminary inquiry, Harsh told police that his father had gone to the court on Saturday. Around 3.30 pm, his father asked him to drop him at a crossing, saying a client was waiting there, he added.

Harsh took him there, where he said three men were waiting in a car.

He added that one of the men stepped out of the car, touched Ahirwar's feet and took him away under the pretext of discussing a case, police said.

When Ahirwar did not return home by late evening, his family tried calling him, but his phone was switched off. They then approached the police, who registered a kidnapping case.

Navy to add eight next-gen corvettes from two PSUs

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, November 2

This is the first project in which the ships will be indigenously designed by the Indian Navy and constructed by defence PSUs

DAYS AFTER the Cabinet Committee on Security greenlighted the project, the Ministry of Defence on Monday signed contracts worth Rs 53,866.50 crore with Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers Limited (GRSE) and Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) to acquire eight next-generation corvettes for the Indian Navy.

This is the first project in which the ships will be indigenously designed by the Indian Navy and constructed by defence public sector undertakings (PSUs) selected through a competitive process, marking a major milestone in India's indigenous warship design and construction capabilities, the ministry said in a statement.

While GRSE will build five corvettes, GSL will build the remaining three.

According to the ministry, the corvettes will be equipped with state-of-the-art capabilities, including advanced missiles, weapons and sensor suites, enabling them to undertake missions across the air, surface and sub-surface domains.

Welcoming the deal, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh wrote on X, "The construction of these ships will generate approximately 72 lakh person-days of employment in the shipyards and 460 lakh person-days in ancillary industries and micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) over the next ten years."

"The induction of these ships will significantly enhance the Indian Navy's operational capabilities in safeguarding maritime trade routes, conducting anti-surface and anti-submarine warfare operations, strengthening coastal defence, undertaking littoral combat operations, and carrying out maritime presence and surveillance missions," the ministry stated.

The project will also give an impetus to India's indigenous shipbuilding ecosystem by strengthening collaboration among defence public sector undertakings, private shipyards, and Indian industrial partners, including micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs).

The project is intended to create a versatile combat platform that can perform a variety of roles, including anti-submarine warfare, maritime surveillance and reconnaissance, search-and-attack missions, and coastal and littoral defence, among other deterrence and maritime security operations.

The Defence Acquisition Council granted acceptance of necessity for the project at an approximate cost of Rs 36,000 crore in June 2022.

The ministry inked the contracts in the presence of Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh in New Delhi.



PM Narendra Modi during the Bharat Renewable Energy Summit and Expo 2026 at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi on Monday. ANI

PM: India to add 500 GW non-fossil fuel capacity in the next 10-11 years

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, November 2

INDIA WILL add 500 gigawatts (GW) of new non-fossil fuel capacity over the next 10-11 years, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Monday.

"This target is somewhat difficult, but I have faith in the capabilities of our country. And that is why I say, 'We will do it!'," PM Modi said while speaking at the inaugural session of the Bharat Renewable Energy Summit & Expo 2026.

"Under the Paris pledge, India had also set a target of meeting half of its installed power capacity from non-fossil sources, and achieved this in 2025 itself. That means we achieved it five years ahead of schedule. Today, more than 50% of our installed power capacity is based on non-fossil sources," he added.

He said India is also working resolutely towards achieving the target of 500 GW non-fossil fuel capacity by 2030 and has achieved nearly 300 GW.

"Today, India is among the top three countries in the world in solar and renewable energy," he added.

Currently, India has 308 GW of installed non-fossil capacity, about 55.1% of the total power generation capacity of 558.89 GW, according to data from the Central Electricity Authority.

Modi said that investments in the renewable energy space in India helped the country avert an energy crisis amid the West Asia war.

"If India had not invested in clean energy and created new systems for it over the past decade, our crisis could have been much more serious than that faced by the rest of the world," he added.

"And we all know that the future of energy security lies in clean energy. If we continue to depend heavily on fossil fuels, the global economy will keep facing disruptions...," he added.

Modi said more than $164 billion has been invested in the renewable energy sector over the past decade.

In just two years since the RE-INVEST Summit in 2024, he said investments of around $63 billion have come into the sector.

"It is estimated that by the end of this decade, investment opportunities worth more than Rs 20 lakh crore, or around $220 billion, will emerge in this sector. Therefore, a new horizon of opportunities is going to open up for all of you in India's clean energy sector," he added.

Woman kills dad with a cooker lid after he broke her phone over gaming addiction

Kamal Saiyed
Surat, November 2

AN ARGUMENT between a Surat man and his daughter over her habit of playing games on her phone ended in tragedy when she allegedly hit him on the head with a pressure cooker's lid before stabbing him to death.

Kajal, 22, was arrested on Sunday night for allegedly murdering her father, Ramesh Chauhan (55), after he broke her phone during an argument over her habit of playing games on her phone. According to his wife Manju, the argument began when Chauhan asked Kajal to stop playing games and help with household chores.

According to the police complaint, the family lives in Surat's Kosad area. On Sunday, when Chauhan returned home from work, Manju complained that Kajal was busy playing games on her phone and was not helping with chores. Chauhan then asked Kajal to keep her phone aside and help with the chores. When Kajal did not comply, Chauhan snatched the phone and slammed it to the ground, breaking it.

Police said this angered Kajal, and she allegedly took the pressure cooker's lid from the kitchen top and hit Chauhan hard on the head. She then stabbed him with a knife.

Hearing his screams, Manju ran to the kitchen and found him on the floor, blood coming out of his head and stomach.

Chauhan was rushed to a nearby private hospital, where he was declared dead. After Manju filed a complaint, police filed a case and arrested Kajal.

Police Inspector J B Vanar said, "We arrested the accused, Kajal, late on Sunday night. A quarrel broke out between the father and the daughter over a petty issue of her playing games on the phone, and it led to the murder. Kajal's father died a few years ago in Saurashtra, and her mother moved to Surat and married Ramesh Chauhan."

CHANDIGARH POWER DISTRIBUTION LIMITED (CPDL)
SCO 204 & 205, Sector 34-A, Chandigarh - 160022, India
CIN: U31200UP1992PLC014506

TENDER NOTICE Date: 03.11.2026

Bids are invited from the eligible bidders for the following tenders:

Tender Enquiry No.	Tender Description	EMD (in Lakhs)	Due Date & Time of Bid Submission
CPDL/FY26-27/ VMI/046	RATE CONTRACT FOR SUPPLY OF VARIOUS ITEMS IN VENDOR MANAGED INVENTORY MODE	5.00	30.11.2026

Tender fee of individual Tender Document **Rs.1180/-** (Incl. GST)
For tender details and further amendment/corrigendum, please visit our website **www.chandigarhpower.com -> Tenders**
Head (CMM)

NPCL NOIDA POWER COMPANY LIMITED
CIN: U31200UP1992PLC014506

Notice Inviting Bids for Setting-up of 4x20 MW/320 MWh Standalone Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) in Greater Noida

Bids are invited by **"Noida Power Company Limited having its registered office at Electric Sub-station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida – 201310 (U.P.)"** for procurement of power on a long-term basis for a period of 12 (twelve) years from BESS of 4 × 20 MW / 320 MWh to be set-up in Greater Noida in accordance with the Guidelines for Procurement and Utilization of Battery Energy Storage Systems as part of Generation, Transmission and Distribution assets along with Ancillary Services issued by MoP, GoI dated 10.03.2022 and its subsequent amendments thereof. Bid Document is available on www.bharat-electronictender.com.
The Company reserves the right to reject all or any of the Bids or cancel the bidding process at any stage without assigning any reasons whatsoever and without any liability.
For any clarification, contact at e-mail id Powertradingnpcl@rpsg.in or mobile no. 9718804966.
Head (Power Management Services)

Government of Karnataka
(Rural Development and Panchayat Raj Department)
KARNATAKA RURAL ROAD DEVELOPMENT AGENCY
III Floor, Grameenabhivruddhi Bhavana, Ananda Rao Circle, Bengaluru - 560009.
Phone No.: 080-29710021/ 22 / 23 / 24 Fax: 080-29710025
E-mail: coo.krrda.karbng@gmail.com Website: http://www.krrda.in
No.:KRRDA/TECH/208/TND/NOT-9/2026-27/ 2991 Date: 29.10.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDERS (NIT)

Karnataka Rural Road Development Agency (KRRDA), on behalf of Government of KARNATAKA, invites **item rate tenders** in electronic tendering system for Indent Number: **KRRDA/2025-26/RD/WORK_INDENT 482 Call-2, 473 Call-2, 474 Call-2, 523 Call-2, 343 Call-2, 398 Call-2, 380 Call-2,** under **Karnataka Rural Road Improvement Project (KRRIP) Pragathi Patha - ADB Financed** in the Karnataka state for (04 Prior + 03 Post) number of packages including routine maintenance for five years. **KRRDA/2025-26/RD/WORK INDENT No: 256 Call-6, 559 Call-3 under Financial Incentive Fund Scheme** in the Karnataka state for 02 number of packages. From the eligible contractors registered with Public Works Department, Govt. of KARNATAKA, or non-registered contractors for the above works may participate in the tendering process, subject to fulfilling the eligibility and qualification criteria specified in the respective tender documents. Availability of Bid Documents and mode of submission: The bid documents are available online on KPP Portal **(https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in)** and should be submitted online. The bidder shall be required to register on this portal. For submission of the bids, the bidder is required to have a valid Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) from one of the authorized Certifying Authorities. Last Date/Time for receipt of bids through KPP Portal: **5:00PM, 18/11/2026** For further details please log on to KPP Portal **(https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in)**
Any further corrigendum and addendum relating to the said tender notification will be published only in the KPP Portal.
Sd/- Tendering Officer & Executive Engineer,
DIPR/CP/3417/Advertn/2026-27 KRRDA, Bengaluru.

विज्ञप्ति

शिक्षुता अधिनियम 1961 के अंतर्गत इस कार्यालय में ओधोगिक शिक्षुओ का एक वर्ष के लिए चयन किया जाना है। चयनित शिक्षुओ को प्रशिक्षण एवम भत्ता अधिनियम 1961 के अंतर्गत देय होगा। कर्मशाला, झज्जर में दिनांक 10-11-2026 को नीचे दर्शाए गए निम्नलिखित ट्रेड्स के प्रशिक्षुओं का चयन किया जाना है। जिन प्रशिक्षुओ ने ऑनलाइन पोर्टल पर अपना नाम रजिस्ट्रेशन करवाया है। वह प्रशिक्षु अपने मूल दस्तावेज जैसे - रजिस्ट्रेशन फॉर्म, मेट्रिक सर्टिफिकेट, आई टी आई मार्कशीट, आधार कार्ड आदि लेकर दिनांक 10-11-2026 को कर्मशाला, झज्जर में प्रातः 10.00 बजे पहुचे।

क्रमांक	ट्रेड्स	रिक्त पद
1	पेंटर	2
2	फिटर	7
3	विधुतकार	8
4	मोटर मैकेनिक	6
5	डीजल मैकेनिक	6
6	कोपा	2
7	वेल्डर	7
8	कारपेंटर	7
	कुल	45

नोट :- शिक्षुता अधिनियम 1961 के अनुसार किसी भी संस्थान से पूर्व में प्रशिक्षण पूरा कर चुके उम्मीदवार दूसरी बार प्रशिक्षण लेने के पात्र नही है।
2. इच्छुक उम्मीदवार ऑनलाइन पोर्टल **https://www.apprenticeshipindia.gov.in** पर अपना रजिस्ट्रेशन करके ऑनलाइन आवेदन दिनांक 10.11.2026 तक कर सकते है।
3. महाप्रबंधक हरियाणा राज्य परिवहन झज्जर के पास अपरेंटिस विज्ञप्ति में वर्णित रिक्तियो को घटाने और बढाने का अधिकार है।
4. चयनित उम्मीदवार को सहायक शिक्षुता सलाहकार झज्जर द्वारा कॉन्ट्रैक्ट को स्वीकार करने के बाद प्रशिक्षण पर लिया जाएगा

हस्ता/-
महाप्रबंधक
हरियाणा राज्य परिवहन
झज्जर
No. 50712/hry

PFC CONSULTING LIMITED
(A wholly owned subsidiary of PFC Limited)
Regd. Office: First Floor, "Urjanidhi", 1, Barakhamba Lane, Connaught Place, New Delhi – 110001, (India) Fax: 011-23443990
Website : www.pfcclindia.com

GLOBAL INVITATION (THROUGH E-BIDDING ONLY)

FOR SELECTION OF TRANSMISSION SERVICE PROVIDER ON BUILD, OWN, OPERATE AND TRANSFER (BOOT) BASIS FOR INTRA-STATE TRANSMISSION PROJECTS IN MADHYA PRADESH

PFC Consulting Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Power Finance Corporation Limited (A Government of India Undertaking), invites proposals for setting up of transmission projects on Build, Own, Operate and Transfer (BOOT) basis following single stage two envelope process of "Request for Proposal" (RFP).
Interested bidders may refer to the RFP notification and RFP documents available on the website **https://www.mstcecommerce.com** and **https://www.pfcclindia.com.**
The Bidders may obtain the RFP documents on all working days between 10:30 hrs (IST) and 16:00 hrs (IST) **from 03.11.2026 to one working day prior to bid submission for the projects mentioned below** on payment of a non-refundable fee of Rs. 5,00,000/- or USD 7,000 plus applicable GST @18% from 9th Floor, Wing – A, Statesman House, Connaught Place, New Delhi - 110001, Tel.: 91-11-23443996; Fax: 91-11-23443990; e-mail: **pfccl.itp@pfcindia.com**. The RFP documents can also be downloaded from **https://www.mstcecommerce.com** and **https://www.pfcclindia.com**, however, in such case, interested party can submit Response to RFP only on submission of non-refundable fee of Rs. 5,00,000/- or USD 7,000 plus applicable GST @18% separately. The survey report and clarification to RFP documents shall be issued to those bidders, who have obtained/ purchased RFP documents by paying requisite fee at least one working day prior to bid submission date. Bidders should regularly visit website to keep themselves updated regarding clarifications/ amendments/ time extensions etc., if any. The important timelines in this regard are as follows:

S. No.	Name of Transmission Scheme	Last Date for seeking clarifications (dd/mm/yyyy)	Last Date for submission of response to RFP (dd/mm/yyyy)	Date of opening of Response to RFP(dd/mm/yyyy)
1.	**Establishment of Intra-State transmission System for Evacuation of 4000 MW power through STU network from proposed Thermal Power Plants coming up in Madhya Pradesh**	23.11.2026	05.01.2027 up to 15:00 hrs (IST)	05.01.2027 at 15:30 hrs (IST)

Note: PFC Consulting Limited reserves the right to cancel or modify the process without assigning any reason and without any liability. This is not an offer.

Bid Process Coordinator: PFC CONSULTING LTD. (A wholly owned subsidiary of PFC Ltd.) (A Govt. of India Undertaking)
An Initiative of: Government of Madhya Pradesh
Initiative Partner: Madhya Pradesh Power Transmission Company Limited

MINERAL RESOURCES DEPARTMENT DIRECTORATE OF GEOLOGY AND MINING, MADHYA PRADESH
29- A Khanij Bhawan, Arera Hills Bhopal
Phone and fax 0755-2551795 | Email: geology.dgm@mp.gov.in

No- /Auction-21/Geology/F. No.- 21/2026-27 **October 30, 2026**

Notice Inviting Tender

"Invitation of bids for grant of Mining Lease for Limestone, Basemetal (Zn), and Basemetal and associated minerals (Zn, Pb, Cu, Ag) minerals and for grant of Composite Licence for Basemetal (Zn), Manganese & Dolomite, Copper, and Basemetal associated minerals (Cu, Ag, & Au)"
In exercise of the powers conferred by Section 10B and Section 11 of the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957 and in accordance with the Mineral (Auction) Rules, 2015 notified thereunder, as amended from time to time, the Government of Madhya Pradesh has identified:
a) 8 mineral blocks (6 blocks of Limestone, 1 block of Basemetal (Zn), and 1 block of Basemetal (Zn, Pb, Cu, Ag)) for Electronic Auction and hereby invites tenders for the purposes of grant of Mining Lease.
b) 4 mineral blocks (1 block of Basemetal (Zn), 1 block of Copper, 1 block of Manganese & Dolomite, and 1 block of Basemetal (Cu, Ag, & Au)) for Electronic Auction and hereby invites tenders for the purposes of grant of Composite Licence.
Accordingly, financial bids are invited in digital format only and technical bids are invited both in digital and physical format from eligible bidders.
Eligibility conditions, date and time, terms, and conditions etc. for participating in the electronic auction are provided in the Tender Document. Detailed Tender Documents along with timelines, notifications, updates and other details for the e-auction process for the mineral blocks are available in electronic form only and can be downloaded from the e-auction portal of MSTC Limited [https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mlcln/index.jsp].
Interested and eligible bidders can register themselves on the above e-auction portal. On successful registration, eligible bidders will obtain login ID and password necessary for participation in the e-auction process. Interested and eligible bidders can participate in the bidding only after online purchase of the Tender Document on payment of the Tender fee from the above e-auction portal. The Tender Fee shall be waived, for those mineral blocks only which have been put up for auction under "second attempt" as per Mineral Auction Rule vide this Notice Inviting Tender, for such bidders only who have previously purchased the Tender Document in prior auction attempts of the said mineral block. Any revision, clarifications, addendum, corrigendum, time extensions, etc. to the tender document will be hosted on the above e-auction portal only and no separate notifications shall be issued in the press.
Model Tender Document and Mineral Block Summaries are available free of cost on the e-auction portal of MSTC Limited website [https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mlcln/index.jsp]

List of Mineral Blocks for Auction

S No	Name of the Block	District	Mineral	ML/ CL	Price of Tender Document without GST* (in Rs.)
	First Attempt Blocks				
1.	Muhrai-Hatta Limestone Block	Damoh	Limestone	ML	5,00,000
2.	Kesharpura-Nayagaon-Ghasundi-Chainpura Limestone Block	Neemuch	Limestone	ML	5,00,000
3.	Shitalpani Copper Block	Balaghat	Copper	CL	2,00,000
4.	Bhilapar Manganese & Dolomite Block#	Pandurna	Manganese & Dolomite	CL	25,000
	Pre-Embedded Blocks				
5.	Gudha Limestone and Dolomite Block#	Damoh	Limestone	ML	25,000
6.	Muariya Basemetal (Zn, Pb, Cu, Ag) Block	Betul	Basemetal (Zn, Pb, Cu, Ag)	ML	5,00,000
	Second Attempt Blocks				
7.	Ramsthan Limestone Block	Satna	Limestone	ML	1,00,000
8.	Kuiyan Barwah Limestone Block	Rewa	Limestone	ML	2,00,000
9.	Birwa Bhitwan Limestone Block	Rewa	Limestone	ML	2,00,000
10.	Biskhan Extended Basemetal (Zn) Block	Betul	Basemetal (Zn)	ML	5,00,000
11.	Salaiya Phatak Basemetal (Cu, Ag, & Au) Block	Katni	Basemetal (Cu, Ag, & Au)	CL	5,00,000
12.	Kehalpur (East) Basemetal (Zn) Block	Betul	Basemetal (Zn)	CL	2,00,000

*Note: * GST shall be payable by reverse charge mechanism*
Mineral Blocks being put up for auction in accordance with section 10A2D of the Act

Notwithstanding anything to the contrary in the Tender Document for the blocks being auctioned in accordance with Section 10A(2)(d) of the Act, the State Government makes no representation whatsoever, express, implicit or otherwise, regarding the accuracy and/or completeness of the information provided in the said geological report and the Bidder confirms that it shall have no claim whatsoever against the State Government in this regard. The Bidder acknowledges and hereby accepts the risk of inadequacy, mistake or error in or relating to said geological report and hereby acknowledges and agrees that the State Government shall not be liable for the same in any manner whatsoever to the Bidder and their associates or any person claiming through or under any of them. The Bidders agree and acknowledge that any mistake or error in or relating to the said geological report shall not vitiate the tender process, Mining Lease and/or MDPA, or render the same voidable.
The block specific Tender documents are available for purchase on the e-auction portal of MSTC Limited (https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mlcln/index.jsp) from Monday, 2 November, 2026. Last date for purchase of Tender Document, on the e-auction platform is Friday, 20 November, 2026 The payment is to be remitted and received before 17:00 hours (IST) and the last date for submission of the bid is **Wednesday, 25 November, 2026, on or before 17:00 hours (IST).**
Bidders may note that for composite licences, the Mineral (Auction) Amendment Rules, 2022 have dispensed with the requirement of indicating the division of the land into forest land, land owned by the State Government, and land not owned by the State Government and the requirement of demarcating the area using total station and differential global positioning system and has provided the flexibility of demarcating the concession area using global positioning system. However, the requisite demarcation in respect of certain blocks is nevertheless being provided [as and where available] as part of the information memorandum. Thus, the terms and conditions for auction of the said block remain unchanged.

Head of Office Superintending Geologist
Directorate of Geology and Mining Madhya Pradesh
G-20902/26

Tent, bags spotted but no trace of missing trekkers in Uttarakhand

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, November 2

FOUR DAYS after seven trekkers and a local guide went missing in Uttarakhand's Kedartal region, rescue teams found a tent and a few bags along with other belongings near the Kedarkadak area during a search operation Monday.

However, the rescue personnel could not locate any of the missing persons, Uttarakhand SDRF Commandant Arpan Yaduvanshi told *The Indian Express*.

"There was a search today. We found tents and their belongings there, but we did not find anyone," Yaduvanshi said. He said that an aerial reconnaissance was also conducted on Monday, but yielded no further leads.

The search operation is being jointly conducted by the State Disaster Response Force (SDRF) and the Nehru Institute of Mountaineering (NIM), with teams continuing efforts in the high-altitude region despite difficult weather and avalanche-hit terrain.

The eight missing persons are among a 12-member trekking party that set out for the Kedartal trek from Gangotri on October 27. The group comprised seven trekkers, a guide, a cook and three porters. The trekkers were granted permission for a three-day expedition on October 26 and were expected to return by October 29.

Hours after the group set out, authorities received a weather alert around 10.30-11 am on October 27, warning of adverse conditions expected on October 29. However, the team had already entered the trekking route, and officials were unable to contact them to convey the warning, Mayank Garg, Deputy Director of Gangotri National Park, had told *The Indian Express*.

On October 30, a day after the group was expected to return, authorities received information that its members had been trapped by heavy snowfall and avalanches in the Kedartal region.

Four members of the party — three porters and a cook — were rescued on October 31 near Kachchi Dhang, a stretch below the avalanche-affected area. The remaining eight, including five trekkers from West Bengal, two women from Uttar Pradesh and a 25-year-old local guide from Uttarkashi, remain missing.

Rescue operations have been hampered by multiple avalanches along the route. Garg had said that the avalanche-affected stretch near Sukhi Dhang was approximately 11-12 km on foot from the entry point, while its direct aerial distance was around 5.5-6 km.

Information available with the department indicated that avalanches had occurred at around 10-12 locations along the route.

Earlier attempts to reach the missing trekkers on foot had to be aborted after the rescue teams encountered avalanche-hit stretches. Aerial reconnaissance operations conducted over the past few days had also failed to locate the missing persons or their belongings.

The Kedartal route sees relatively fewer trekkers compared to the Gomukh route, which accounts for around 95% of visitors undertaking treks in the area. Monitoring on the Kedartal route is, consequently, less frequent.

AMARAVATI GROWTH AND INFRASTRUCTURE CORPORATION LIMITED
Rayapudi Village Thulluru Mandal, Guntur District-522237.
E PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
NIT NO: 27/MAU81- AGICOWORK(EPRO)/1/2026-ENGG-PROJ, Dt: 02.11.2026
Name of Work: RFP for Providing PMC & Consultancy Services for MEP in Twin Office Towers (T1 & T2) at Amaravathi Quantum Valley, Amaravati-Andhra Pradesh. The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from **03.11.2026 to 24.11.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs. Pre-Bid Meeting Date 11.11.2026, Due date for submission of Bid 24.11.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs, Technical bid opening 24.11.2026 @16.00Hrs.** For further details please refer to **www.apeprocurement.gov.in** and **www.crda.ap.gov.in**
Sd/- Managing Director, AGICL, Amaravati.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sheela W/o Ram Sharan R/o H No-d-72 Gokulpuri Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CT NI No. 189/2020 U/s 138 NI Act at PS: Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sheela** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sheela** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sheela of CT NI No. 189/2020 U/s 138 NI Act of PS: Bhajanpura, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 02.12.2026.**
By order
Kirandeep Kaur
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
Court Room No.05,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/15835/NE/2026

EAST COAST RAILWAY
Tender No. eT-M-EnHM-BBS-STN-14-26
NAME OF WORK : MECHANIZED CLEANING AND HOUSEKEEPING OF BHUBANESWAR (BBS) RAILWAY STATION INCLUDING PLATFORMS, YARDS, TRACKS, OFFICE BUILDINGS, RESERVATION OFFICE, CONCOURSE AREA, WAITING HALLS, YARD FROM HOME SIGNAL TO HOME SIGNAL ETC. FOR A PERIOD OF ONE (01) YEAR.
Advertised Value : ₹14,57,82,545.59, **EMD :** ₹8,78,900/-, **Tender Document Cost :** ₹ 11,800/-, **Period of Completion :** 12 Months.
Bidding Start Date : 06.11.2026
Tender Closing Date and Time : At 1530 Hrs. of 20.11.2026.
Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored.
Complete information including e-Tender documents and corrigendum is available in website **www.ireps.gov.in**
Sr. Divl. Mechanical Engineer/ Khurda Road
PR-530/R/26-27

Andhra braces for landfall, rescue teams mobilised in Odisha as Murasu approaches

Sreenivas Janyala & Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, Hyderabad, November 2

EVACUATIONS, DEPLOYMENT of government officials and closure of educational institutions. Less than a week after Cyclone Arnab hit India's eastern coast, Tamil Nadu, Odisha and Andhra Pradesh have begun preparing for another cyclonic storm, Murasu.

According to the IMD, the severe cyclonic storm is moving at 14 kmph. Currently centred 110 km from Nellore, it is likely to cross the coast near Ongole early Tuesday morning.

"The severe cyclonic storm Murasu is very likely to move northwestwards and cross the south Andhra Pradesh coast as a severe cyclonic storm with a wind speed of 100 to 110 kmph (and) gusting up to 120 kmph between Nellore and Narasapur to the south of Ongole during midnight (11.30 pm) of today to early hours (4 am) of tomorrow, November 3," the Met department said in an official release.

Under its influence, light to moderate rain is expected at most places across Coastal Andhra Pradesh, Yanam and Rayalaseema on Monday. Extremely heavy rainfall is likely at one or two places in Bapatla, Prakasam, Nellore, Chittoor and Tirupati districts. In Odisha, the IMD has forecast heavy rainfall in parts of Gajapati and Ganjam districts on Monday, along with thunderstorms and gusty winds of 40-50 kmph.

Rayagada, Koraput, Malkangiri, Puri and Khurda districts are also likely to receive rainfall. Several parts of Odisha have already begun experiencing light rain, with its intensity expected to increase, officials said.

For the governments of Andhra Pradesh and Odisha, this means a second round of evacuations in less than a week. Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister Chandrababu Naidu held a review meeting with senior officials at the secretariat on Monday and directed the administration to remain alert.

Naidu asked officials to make effective use of the rainfall to fill tanks and reservoirs through efficient water management.

Officials told the Chief Minister that Palnadu district was expected to receive the highest rainfall, at around 30 cm, followed by Prakasam with 24 cm and Markapuram with 19 cm. Krishna and Guntur districts may receive up to 9 cm, while Eluru and Nellore are also likely to receive around 9 cm each. Naidu directed officials to complete post-cyclone restoration work within 48 hours.

In Odisha, the government has prioritised evacuations from vulnerable areas and strengthened emergency response mechanisms, officials said. Disaster Management Minister Suresh Pujari said although the storm is likely to make landfall along the Andhra Pradesh coast, it would affect several parts of Odisha, particularly the southern districts of Ganjam, Gajapati, Rayagada, Koraput and Malkangiri. He said all district collectors had been put on alert, with the southern districts placed on high alert.

In Tamil Nadu, the state government has deployed 500 electricity department personnel in 25 teams to assist Andhra Pradesh in restoring power supply disrupted by Cyclone Murasu, following a request from CM Naidu, state Electricity Minister R Nirmal Kumar said.

Chamoli helicopter crash: Probe finds no Mayday call

Initial report blamed bad weather but probe looking beyond

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, November 2



Wreckage of the private helicopter, operated by Trans Bharat Aviation, that crashed into a hillside near Chai village in the Joshimath area of Chamoli district in Uttarakhand, Friday. FILE

NO MAYDAY or distress call from the pilot of the Trans Bharat Aviation helicopter was recorded before it crashed near Sthan Marwari in Uttarakhand on Friday, investigators probing the incident have told *The Indian Express*. The crash killed the pilot and five passengers.

The absence of any distress communication, along with eyewitness accounts and videos showing the helicopter's descent, raises the possibility that something happened suddenly, leaving the pilot with little time to alert other aircraft, an official familiar with the ongoing investigation told *The Indian Express* on condition of anonymity.

"Some aviation experts suggest there might have been a mid-air collision — a bird or a drone — though we are still figuring it out," he said.

The official added that the manner in which the helicopter fell did not appear consistent with an engine failure.

The Chamoli district administration's initial Action Taken Report had attributed the incident to adverse weather conditions in the Hathi Parvat area, where the helicopter reportedly crashed while descending towards a lower altitude. The IMD had issued an orange alert for Chamoli on October 30, warning of thunderstorms, lightning, hail and gusty winds of 40-50 kmph in isolated areas.

However, the official said, "There was no communication about poor visibility or any issue that this particular pilot faced. Otherwise, some issue would have been raised over the RT (radio telephony)."

As *The Indian Express* had earlier reported, another helicopter took off from Badrinath just eight minutes after the Trans Bharat aircraft. It landed safely at its destination. Yet another helicopter departed nearly an hour later, while two flights that had flown before the crashed aircraft also completed their journeys safely.

The timing and sequence of these flights are among the aspects being examined as part of the investigation.

The official said pilots of other helicopters operating in the area have shared their versions with authorities. None reported receiving a distress call or hearing any communication about poor visibility or other operational difficulties over radio telephony (RT).

The Trans Bharat Aviation helicopter had departed from Dehradun at 12.20 pm on Friday and landed at Badrinath at 1.11 pm. After picking up five passengers, it crashed while returning to Dehradun.

Flight operations in the Badrinath Valley were suspended between 9 am and noon on Friday due to inclement weather, but resumed after conditions improved. The official said there was no black box in the single-engine helicopter. Investigators are instead trying to recover a camera usually installed behind the pilot's seat, which could offer clues about the final moments.

"The team is active on the ground trying to find the camera. It's difficult terrain. It's getting difficult to find the camera. But yes, our priority is to find it anyhow," he said.

The investigation team is also questioning eyewitnesses who saw the helicopter descending before it crashed and consulting aviation experts. The Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) is probing the accident. "Everything is under investigation. Maybe if we get some more clues, more evidence, we'll be in a better position to conclude something," the official said.

Meanwhile, charter helicopter services for the Char Dham Yatra have been suspended for the remainder of this season following a meeting between helicopter operators and the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) on Monday.

The meeting came after 11 helicopter operators wrote to the authorities opposing the DGCA's decision to make two pilots mandatory for charter helicopter operations for the remainder of the ongoing pilgrimage season.

The operators raised concerns that the requirement would make it financially unviable for them to continue operations, particularly with only a week left in this year's yatra.

"They raised a few concerns that this might not be financially viable for them to continue the chopper services. And considering that only one week is left in the Char Dham Yatra for this year, they requested DGCA to relook at this decision," CEO of UCADA Prateek Jain told *The Indian Express*.

He added that deliberations would continue and a final decision on the twin-pilot requirement would be taken before the commencement of next year's yatra. "For now, we've agreed to call off the charter services for Char Dham Yatra for this season," he said.

BRIEFLY



NSA Ajit Doval and Vietnam's Deputy Prime Minister and National Defence General Phan Van Giang in Hanoi on Monday. PTI

VIETNAM

NSA Doval, Vietnamese ministers hold bilateral talks to boost security

NATIONAL SECURITY Adviser Ajit Doval on Monday held separate high-level talks with Vietnam's ministers of public security and foreign affairs on strengthening bilateral cooperation in security and other areas and agreed to enhance "multifaceted" ties. Doval held talks with Minister of Public Security General Luong Tam Quang on ongoing cooperation in the security domain. Doval also met Vietnam's Foreign Affairs Minister Le Hoai Trung. Earlier, he met Vietnam's Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of National Defence General Phan Van Giang. "Both sides reviewed the status of ongoing bilateral defence cooperation and agreed to continue further strengthening activities in this field," said the Indian Embassy in Hanoi on X. PTI

Fire breaks out at HPCL facility in Vizag

A FIRE broke out at the HPCL facility in Vizag on Monday night, police said. However, there were no casualties, said an official. Vizag police commissioner Shankabrata Baghci said, "A fire broke out in Vizag HPCL facility and there were no casualties." The official added that the exact cause of the blaze is yet to be confirmed by the oil marketing company. Visuals of towering column of fire accompanied by thick smoke, illuminating the night sky over the port city went viral. PTI

One dies in blast triggered by gas leak in Bihar

ONE PERSON died and at least six were injured after an explosion triggered by a leaked gas pipeline on Monday. The blast sent shockwaves, which damaged a four-storey building and shattered windowpanes that came in a 100-metre radius, officials said. Eyewitnesses said the explosion happened when a JCB machine touched an underground PNG pipeline in the Gobarsahi-Dumri area. The blast also led to a blaze that was doused by rescue teams. PTI

Homebuyers pen letter to PM: After 10 yrs, objectives of RERA 'far from being achieved'

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 2

A HOMEBUYERS' forum has written to PM Narendra Modi raising concerns about the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, claiming even 10 years after the law was enacted it has failed to address malpractices, including the misuse of homebuyers' money, one-sided nature of buyer-seller agreements and project delays.

In its letter on October 26, the Forum for People's Collective Efforts (FPCE), which was one of the campaigners behind the RERA, acknowledged the law led to the registration of an increasing number of projects, but its objectives were "far from being achieved".

The primary cause, according to the forum, was that the Real Estate Regulatory Authority—set up in 2016 under the Act—had been entrusted with the conflicting responsibilities of both promoting the sector and protecting homebuyers.

The forum suggested a mandate overhaul, allowing the Housing Ministry to continue looking after the promotion of the sector, while entrusting the Department of Consumer Affairs with the sole responsibility of protecting homebuyers' interests. "We fully recognise that RERA has brought a large number of projects within a registration framework and introduced important disclosure requirements. But registration and disclosure alone cannot be the measure of success when violations continue and homebuyers struggle to obtain effective remedies," FPCE president Abhay Upadhyay wrote.

"A family that has invested its lifetime savings needs a completed home and enforceable rights - not merely a project registration number."

The letter noted that during CAC meetings with ministry officials, the forum repeatedly raised concerns that projects were being registered without proper document scrutiny, promoter declarations, or agreements to sale.

Bhilai stall to Dubai villa: Mahadev promoter's journey to extradition

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, November 2



Saurabh Chandrakar at the Rouse Avenue courts in New Delhi on Monday. ANI

THE ENFORCEMENT Directorate's (ED) investigation into the money laundering case against Saurabh Chandrakar, the prime accused in the Mahadev Online Book betting case, traces his journey from working at a juice shop in Madhya Pradesh's Bhilai to living in a villa in Dubai, and a Rs 200-crore wedding that led to the unravelling of an alleged Rs 6,000-crore scam.

Indian agencies have extradited Chandrakar from Oman. A CBI team brought him to India on Sunday evening. He is wanted in two CBI cases in which chargesheets have been filed, and in an ED case under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) in which a prosecution complaint has been lodged. Indian authorities had been trying to trace Chandrakar since 2023. They recently tracked him down to Oman and coordinated with the authorities there for his extradition.

"Chandrakar, along with co-accused Ravi Uppal, is the principal promoter, controller and beneficiary of Mahadev Online Book. He ran the head office from Dubai and did not return to India after he left on February 16, 2022," a source familiar with the investigation said.

Investigators describe Mahadev Online Book, along with its allied platforms Reddy Anna, Fairplay, Skyexchange and Lotus365, as an organised transnational betting syndicate run as a franchise of panels controlled from a Dubai head office. The head office issued master credentials to operators and settled weekly profit-and-loss statements. The agency estimates more than 3,200 such panels operated across India and the UAE.

According to the investigators, the proceeds of crime in the case are between Rs 88,000 crore and Rs 94,000 crore. Of this, Mahadev Online Book accounts for Rs 75,000-80,000 crore, Skyexchange for Rs 11,000-12,000 crore and Lotus365 for Rs 2,400 crore. "Of this, Rs 4,000-5,000 crore is estimated to have been remitted out of India to promoters in the UAE. Six prosecution complaints — one main and five supplementary — have been filed against 116 accused, and 14 persons have been arrested," the source said.

Chandrakar is from Chhattisgarh's Bhilai. His father worked as a clerk with the Bhilai Municipal Corporation and took voluntary retirement. His mother is a homemaker. "Before setting up the betting business, the family ran a juice shop in Bhilai named Juice Factory under M/s Orbique Foods Pvt. Ltd. His elder brother, Gitesh, held 51 per cent of the company, and Chandrakar worked at the shop. He drew around Rs 15,000 a month from it," a source said.

The probe revealed that Chandrakar's co-accused Uppal was a frequent visitor to the juice stall. The investigation found that Chandrakar took money from the shop to set up his own business and operated on a small scale till December 2020. But within two years, the family moved to an ultra-rich lifestyle.

Chandrakar left India in 2022. "Family members and friends from Bhilai settled with him in the UAE, and a Dubai investment company, M/s Perfect Plan Investment LLC, declared in its KYC papers that its villa was given to him to live in and to use as his address," the source added.

On May 6, 2022, while holding an Indian passport, he obtained a Vanuatu passport issued at Port Vila. His Indian passport has since been revoked. Besides Chandrakar, co-promoter Uppal and associates Vikash Chhaparia, Shubham Soni and Anil Kumar Agarwal alias Atul Agarwal are named as accused.

Gujarat: 61 'foreigners' detained

Brendan Dabhi
Ahmedabad, November 2

POLICE IN Ahmedabad have claimed to have detained 61 alleged illegal immigrants, most of whom belong to Bangladesh.

The Detection of Crime Branch (DCB) of the Ahmedabad City Police said on Monday (November 2) that the alleged foreign nationals had been rounded up from across Ahmedabad in a pre-Diwali crackdown targeting illegal migrants.

"In a major proactive step to bolster public safety ahead of the upcoming Diwali festivities, the Ahmedabad Crime Branch launched a comprehensive, city-wide crackdown targeting illegal foreign nationals residing in the metropolis, resulting in the detention of 61 illegal immigrants, predominantly hailing from Bangladesh," the Crime Branch said.

The Crime Branch said it had carried out raids across multiple zones in Ahmedabad city starting Sunday night. DCP (Crime) Ajit Rajian told *The Indian Express* that the alleged illegal immigrants had been picked up from Danilimda, Pirana, Jamalpur, Naroda, and Nikol.

The Gujarat Police usually carries out crackdowns and raids across the state during the Navratri-Diwali period, but the drive that began on Sunday night was conducted in Ahmedabad city alone.

The detainees, which include women and children, were taken to the headquarters of the Crime Branch, and will be sent to the Joint Interrogation Centre (JIC) in the city, where around 40 others are already lodged, police said.

EXPRESS special

'We are suffering': In Goa village, a railway line cuts off homes

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, November 2



Residents of Velsao say that an average of seven goods trains carrying coal pass daily, covering their houses with dust. EXPRESS

SANDRA RODRIGUES says her family is "land-locked". A 51-year-old resident of Velsao in South Goa's Mormugao taluka, Rodrigues lives in a 400-year-old heritage house facing a railway track.

Her ancestral home was built long before the railways arrived in the area in the late 19th Century. But now, with the ongoing double-tracking project, mud, soil and other construction material have been dumped near her house by the South Western Railway (SWR) contractor, blocking the traditional motorable access road (Level Crossing 26) and the family's right of way, she says. As a result, she has to "trespass" on a neighbour's property to leave her house. The debris has also cut off vehicular access for ambulances and fire tenders in an emergency.

For years, residents of Velsao have been protesting against the 363-km Hospet-Tinaighat-Vasco da Gama double-tracking project, being executed by state-owned Rail Vikas Nigam Limited (RVNL) to increase the line's capacity to handle passenger and freight traffic.

The proposed doubling of the 91-km Tinaighat-Vasco stretch, including the section passing through the Western Ghats between Castle Rock and Kulem, has been particularly contentious. Environmentalists and residents argue that the project will facilitate coal transportation from Mormugao Port in Goa to Karnataka and threaten the ecologically sensitive Western Ghats.

In Velsao, residents say the project is being carried out without regard for their property rights, access to their homes and health. Rodrigues's neighbour, Oscar Goes, says cracks have developed in some walls of his house because of vibrations when trains pass. Residents say an average of seven goods trains carrying coal pass daily, covering their houses with dust.

Orville Dourado Rodrigues, founder of NGO Goencho Ekvott, which has been at the forefront of protests against the double-tracking project, says: "We are already suffering because of a single (railway) track. If and when this double-tracking project is complete, the coal dust will severely impact our health."

The opposition extends beyond Velsao, particularly over the project's potential impact on the Western Ghats. The Supreme Court in 2022 set aside the clearance granted by the standing committee of the National Board for Wildlife for doubling the railway line from Castle Rock in Karnataka to Kulem in Goa.

The apex court accepted the recommendations of the SC-appointed Central Empowered Committee (CEC), which said in its report that it did not find any justification for the track as it "will destroy the fragile ecosystem of the Western Ghats which is an internationally recognised biodiversity hotspot and also one of the most important wildlife corridors of the country".

What is the double-tracking project?

Sanctioned in the 2010-11 Railway Budget, the Hospet-Tinaighat-Vasco da Gama double-tracking project has been implemented in phases. While 312 km of the 363-km route had been commissioned by September 2025, sections in Goa – including the Castle Rock–Kulem stretch – remained pending amid environmental clearance issues.

The existing single railway line between Hospet and Vasco, laid in 1900, connects iron ore mining and industrial areas in Hospet in Karnataka to Mormugao Port in Vasco. The project seeks to add a second line to increase the route's capacity to carry freight and passenger trains. The 26-km stretch between Castle Rock and Kulem, which has faced strong opposition, passes through natural forests of the Western Ghats.

The Railways has argued that industrial growth and an increase in tourism have saturated the capacity of the existing single line, which needs to be doubled to meet rising demand and accommodate more goods and passenger trains. Environmentalists and residents dispute this argument.

The protests

In September 2025, the Goa government said that no expansion of coal transportation capacity would be permitted in the state, adding that reports suggesting additional land was being acquired for coal handling in connection with the Hospet-Vasco double-tracking project were "incorrect".

In Velsao, residents allege that the "temporary" second railway track has been laid haphazardly and soil dumped despite the SWR not having title documents for the land. The issue of land ownership near the Velsao railway line is being contested in a civil suit before the District Judge, South Goa, at Margao, and the Court of the Inspector of Survey and Land Records, Salcete.

In the suit, the SWR has denied any trespass, encroachment or illegal interference with private property, arguing that RVNL and SWR are carrying out the double-tracking work strictly on land in the Railways' possession and occupation. The SWR has also submitted that the Government of Goa, through an official gazette notification issued in May 2023 under the Goa Land Revenue Code, 1968, recorded that certain lands in the SWR's possession and occupation had not been assigned survey numbers and had no records of rights in Forms 1 and 14.

It has further argued that railway land along the Castle Rock-Vasco da Gama section has been in the exclusive possession of the Railways for railway purposes "from time immemorial" and that the area residents refer to as a "pathway" or access has never formed part of privately owned land.

When contacted, Sashibhusan Sahoo, general manager of the Rail Vikas Nigam Limited (RVNL), declined to comment. The Public Relations Officer of the South Western Railway could not be reached.

Max Rodrigues, whose house faces the railway tracks, worked as an architect in Mumbai for several years before returning to his ancestral home in Velsao in 2013 to pursue farming.

"If the double-tracking project goes through, we will have sleepless nights. Every hour, a goods train will pass from here. The coal transportation would exacerbate air pollution from coal dust and pose a severe risk of respiratory ailments," he says.

WEB EXCLUSIVE
A sexual violence survivor's ordeal shows where Zero FIR falls short — *Audrey Dmello*
Log on to www.indianexpress.com

WORDLY WISE
If liberty means anything at all, it means the right to tell people what they do not want to hear.
— *George Orwell*

The Indian EXPRESS
~ FOUNDED BY ~
RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932

BECAUSE THE TRUTH
INVOLVES US ALL

Opposition climbs stage but needs sharper script

THE CONGRESS-LED Opposition's rally at Ramlila Maidan on Sunday was a significant moment in the protests against the Chief Election Commissioner's conduct of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. For parties pushed to the wall by the BJP's serial electoral victories that it has regularly leveraged to squeeze spaces for opponents and to short-circuit debate, the crowds and the line-up of INDIA bloc heavyweights was a reclaiming of public space that was, arguably, cathartic. A day earlier, a similarly united Opposition, along with civil-society groups that joined hands with it on both days, had staged a "mock impeachment" of CEC Gyanesh Kumar. But the day after Ramlila Maidan, and ahead of crucial polls early next year in UP and other states, the Opposition may need to pause and take stock. Is symbolism overtaking the substance of its politics, and even undermining it? By refusing to make vital distinctions, by spreading the net too wide — from CEC-SIR, to lack of jobs, shrinking farmers' incomes, price rise and capture of institutions in general — is it losing the issue while sounding nihilistic? Most of all, by folding into this unwieldy campaign their own electoral defeats, by using high-pitched rhetoric in place of evidence to connect dots, parties of the Opposition risk looking like defeated players in search of a fall guy.

At their joint rally, speaker after speaker sought to make a hold-all accusation of illegitimacy against the BJP-led ruling establishment their starting point. In a way, this also reflects the genuine problem that the Opposition confronts in framing the CEC-SIR issue for a larger audience. It is challenging to communicate institutional integrity in terms that touch the hearts and minds of voters. But the Opposition does itself no favours by not stepping up to that challenge. The greater danger is that it also does disservice to an issue that fundamentally affects the health of democracy. The Election Commission of India underwrites the constitutional guarantee of equal voting rights for all citizens, which is essential for democracy to renew itself through free and fair elections. As this paper's investigation showed, there has been, under this CEC's direct watch, a disquieting erosion of checks and balances within the ECI, which needs to be addressed urgently.

Opposition parties' invocation of generally apocalyptic spectres is unpersuasive and self-defeating also because it has not found resonance on the ground. And because it is vulnerable to the charge that it is a thin cover for the absence of an affirmative politics — the inability of these parties to showcase alternative governance models in states where they are in power, Karnataka to Jharkhand, Himachal to Punjab. These parties will have to reconsider whether mechanically adding the name of CEC Gyanesh Kumar to their already existing villains' gallery is enough. For the losing side in a democracy, to keep knocking the electoral process is, after a point, dispiriting for the voters they are addressing and appealing to. The energy comes from the harder labour of politics. That, for those who took the Ramlila stage on Sunday, is still work not done.

The challenge is more productive employment

INDIA HAS made remarkable progress in lifting millions out of abject poverty. Extreme poverty, as measured by a $3 per day poverty line, has fallen to 2.6 per cent in 2023, according to the World Bank's latest estimate. At a higher threshold — the lower-middle income country line of $4.2 per day — the decline from 57.7 per cent in 2011 to 16.1 per cent in 2023 is equally impressive. This improvement in living standards can be observed across the rural-urban divide, in most states. Yet, the lack of more productive and better paying non-farm employment opportunities remains an obstacle in the path to mass prosperity.

India's labour force participation rate has increased to around 59 per cent in 2025 (15 years and above), according to the periodic labour force surveys. Much of this is because more women are joining the labour force. But a significant number are either engaged in agriculture or self-employed. The less productive farm sector now employs around 43 per cent of the workforce. In comparison, in China, 21.68 per cent are engaged in agriculture, in Vietnam the figure is 25 per cent, according to the World Bank. In the non-farm sector in India, roughly three-fourths of workers are employed in informal enterprises — another segment characterised by low levels of productivity. Unlike in other Asian countries that have moved up the income ladder, manufacturing in India hasn't been able to absorb the millions of low and unskilled workers. Employment has steadily expanded, instead, in the less productive, low-end services.

Poverty in India is now concentrated in north India — 57 per cent of the poor are found in the "belt stretching from Uttar Pradesh to West Bengal", according to the World Bank. This region, where per capita incomes tend to be lower than the national average, offers fewer job opportunities, leaving migration to high-income regions as a channel for greater access to non-farm employment. For India to move up the income ladder — to the ranks of the upper-middle-income group and then to the high-income category — it needs to shift its workforce from low to high productivity jobs. That is one of the biggest development challenges.

What's in a meme? A player and a league

EVERYONE IS fair game for a meme, but memes can have consequences. Kylian Mbappé, captain of the French football team, is learning this the hard way. Asked about his favourite online joke, he picked one that superimposed his face on "some guy", saying "I think he's a Chinese dictator." That "guy" was Mao Zedong. China's response has turned a football meme into a diplomatic and commercial headache.

The Mbappé-as-dictator meme was born in a kebab shop in Marseille, after its owner was served a legal notice over a sandwich he called "as round as Mbappé's skull". The owner retorted that Mbappé "had turned his name into a dictatorship". The internet ran with the joke, with phrases like "Dictator Mbappé" doing the rounds. The meme also drew upon a narrative of him wielding outsized influence in his previous club, Paris Saint-Germain.

Only the internet could have brought together two figures so disparate. But the controversy has now ballooned, it threatens La Liga's ambitions in the Chinese market. Sponsors have walked away, and despite apologies from Mbappé, Real Madrid and the League, the League went dark in China. A meme about one man's hold over a football club has been displaced by a different kind of power: It decides what may be said, and what it can cost to say it. Mbappé has been portrayed online as running his club like a politburo. It seems he has now met his match.

The Communist Party with Xi Jinping characteristics



JABIN T JACOB



DEVENDRA KUMAR

SINCE THE 18th National Congress of the Communist Party of China (CPC) in 2012, when Xi Jinping took over as general secretary, discipline inspection and supervisory organs across the country have filed 8.105 million cases and punished 7.922 million officials. Contrast this with the situation in India, where even if it were the claim that the problem does not exist at the scale it exists in China, it should still be concerning that consolidated figures are not issued by the government and that available figures are scattered across multiple sources.

However, the real significance of China's long-running anti-corruption campaign is in the sustained targeting of the "tigers", or Party officials in senior ranks. Of the millions punished, 963 are "officials registered at and supervised by the CPC Central Committee", which is to say very senior officials including Central Committee (CC) members.

Each Party Congress elects a CC of approximately 200 full members and 170-odd alternate members. The full members choose the politburo of about 25 members from within their ranks and it is from the politburo that the Standing Committee, including the general secretary, are chosen. In other words, the full CC members are the 200 most powerful people in China, comprising party secretaries (equivalent to Indian chief ministers) and governors of provinces, central government ministers, military leaders at the theatre command level and heads of Central Military Commission (CMC) departments, heads of the party organisations that report directly to the CC — such as, for example, the Communist Youth League — and heads of national-level organisations such as the All China Women's Federation, All China Federation of Trade Unions and state-owned enterprises. The alternates, meanwhile, occupy junior ranks and constitute leaders-in-waiting.

By the end of the fifth plenum of the 20th CC, a total of 51 members — full and alternate — had been expelled, an unprecedented number in the post-Mao period. At the end of the 18th and 19th CCs, the numbers were respectively 49 and 12. In other words, approximately an eighth of the 20th CC membership were removed before the full term concluded. It is against this backdrop that the fifth plenum issued its communiqué, 'Resolution on Certain Major Issues concerning Persevering with Full and Rigorous Party Self-Governance'.

What are the implications for China and the rest of the world of this stringent CPC approach to "self-governance"?

To start with, the communiqué declares that the Party "has secured progress" in, among other things, "balancing domestic and international imperatives; ensuring both development and security; delivering tangible results in high-quality economic development... safeguarding national security and social stability... modernising national defence and the armed forces; carrying out work related to Hong Kong, Macao, and Taiwan; and pursuing major-country diplomacy with Chinese characteristics".

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In other words, the domestic and the external are closely tied. In this respect, one of the first things that impacts the rest of the world is China's economic policymaking. Like other aspects of policymaking, this too, is increasingly top-down and centralised. Xi seeks to shape local economic policies and their implementation through the appointment of officials who are not just competent economic administrators — a large number of new appointees to the positions of governor and vice-governor in provinces have backgrounds in economics and finance — but also hew to his political agenda of firm Party control over the economy.

However, just like the Party cannot will Chinese families to produce more children, it is unlikely that it can will them into parting with their savings to boost domestic consumption — the lack of which is a fundamental weakness of the Chinese economy. In external economic policy, meanwhile, Party control does not necessarily translate into good Chinese economic behaviour. The Party has noted that "safeguarding... [China's] development interests" has become "even more arduous". This is a recipe for greater pressure both on Chinese enterprises engaged abroad and on foreign enterprises doing business in or with China.

The other important aspect of China's external policy affected is its security policies. The CMC was reduced to just two members in January this year and the sole vice-chairman, General Zhang Shengmin, has now been promoted to the politburo. Zhang is a political commissar with a focus on anti-corruption work, not a battlefield commander. While this does indicate greater politicisation of the PLA, it does not simultaneously mean that war-fighting is not a priority. If anything, it suggests the opposite — that Chinese military modernisation and expansion is so far advanced that it requires greater political oversight over decision-making within the PLA so that political goals and the military means to achieve them are better aligned. China's neighbours will have much to worry about.

A decade-long anti-corruption campaign that continues with ever-increasing intensity raises several questions, especially when even those considered close to Xi have also fallen. However, the fifth plenum communiqué declares, "deep-seated problems that had plagued the Party for years have been remedied, and serious dangers hidden within the Party, the state, and the military have been removed". Xi is clearly making a case for his continuance in power for a fourth term at the 21st Party Congress at the end of next year. His political strategy is of shaping the next generation of the Party's leadership while pre-empting any potential opposition to his political agenda.

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Manufactured distrust and a politics of shortcuts



VINAY SAHASRABUDDHE

ALL OVER the world, people are talking about Gen Z uprisings. Opposition groups in several countries are pinning their hopes on young people taking to the streets to achieve what they themselves could not. Others are riding piggyback on Gen Z and trying to settle scores with their respective establishments. In some countries, Gen Z agitators have struck a popular chord but failed miserably to bring anything substantial to the table. An overview of recent uprisings in countries as diverse as Albania, Bangladesh, Morocco, France and Madagascar suggests that one size simply does not fit all. Besides, creatively talented but thoroughly inexperienced organisers appear largely confused. Understandably, the initial hype surrounding Gen Z is waning everywhere, and India is no exception.

About a year ago, an essay by a researcher-blogger at the London School of Economics identified reasons for failed youth uprisings in several countries. Two observations were particularly realistic and remarkable. First, such movements succeed only when governments are weak, divided or vulnerable. Second, Gen Z energy does catalyse momentum, but lasting victories require workers, unions, professionals and older generations to join in. Their absence has proved a major weakness in most cases.

India has a long history of semi-organised uprisings that people eventually rejected. The Naxalite movement, for instance, illustrates this. Through violence, Naxalites held some sway over vulnerable sections in certain regions for a limited period. However, their influence remained confined to the margins in a handful of states. Openly Naxalite political parties, too, have failed to secure popular mandates.

Those seeking to present themselves as alternatives to established political parties have more often than not failed. Two decades ago, Medha Patkar tried to bring together leaders linked with so-called "mass movements" and form a political platform to contest elections, but failed miserably. Regional outfits invoked language or provincial identity to mobilise people, yet their political impact remained short-lived and geographically limited.

Indian society is averse to instability. True, the present youth movement lacks the maturity of serious, cause-driven movements of the past. Even so, some lessons emerge. Even during the Independence struggle, people were less comfortable with street activism, and manufactured cynicism found few takers. It was not without reason that freedom fighters, too, reposed confidence in the judiciary of their time. Almost all streams of the freedom movement conducted mass awareness campaigns as part of their groundwork. In the post-Independence era, leaders spearheading movements combined popular education with on-ground activism.

> It was not without reason that freedom fighters reposed confidence in the judiciary of their time. Almost all streams of the freedom movement conducted mass awareness campaigns as part of their groundwork

Manufactured distrust in democratic institutions rarely influences the popular mind in India. People trusted the ECI even when the Prime Minister had sole discretion over the CEC's appointment. Even during the draconian Emergency, people continued to believe in the judiciary, media and even a truncated Parliament. The Morarji Desai government could easily have reversed Parliament's decision to add "socialist" and "secular" as adjectives describing the Republic. But it showed remarkable restraint, safeguarding public trust in democratic institutions. The Modi government could have issued an ordinance to take control of land near the Bangladesh border for border check-posts, overcoming Mamata Banerjee's recalcitrance in the interest of national security. But it did not overstep, again respecting the constitutional framework. Since the Emergency, voters have grown more confident in the power of their ballot. They know they can change governments through elections when they make up their minds.

We are witnessing a generational divide, not only in society but within families. It is a conflict between the impracticable "here-and-now" approach of the impatient and the "right decision at the right time" approach of those wiser through experience.

The moral, then, is clear. Changing governments requires years of hard work and sustained mobilisation of public opinion. India has always rejected frivolous attempts masquerading as popular imagination. There is no place for shortcuts here.

The writer is in-charge of Delhi BJP

Patrick Stewart's greatest role: Power that paused



BIJETRI PATHAK

PATRICK STEWART, who has died at 86, spent a career playing power that does not strike. The man behind the role knew what the other kind looked like. The obituaries will recite the credits: Captain Jean-Luc Picard in *Star Trek: The Next Generation* from 1987 to 1994, Professor Charles Xavier in the *X-Men* franchise; Emmy nominations for *Frasier* and *Extras*. They will note that he was a Royal Shakespeare Company actor before he was a household name, and that he is survived by his wife, the singer-songwriter Sunny Ozell, and two children. The credits cannot show the argument his career made, or where it may have come from.

Stewart was born in 1940 in Mirfield, West Yorkshire, and left school at 15. His childhood was marked by poverty and domestic violence. He later described his father as a very powerful man who got what he wanted, and he spent his later years campaigning for survivors of domestic abuse, alongside refugees and LGBTQ+ equality. It is tempting, and perhaps not unfair, to read Picard as a long, patient answer to that home: An authority figure whose power was real and whose first instinct was never the fist.

Consider how often Picard's finest hours involve not firing. In "The Measure of a Man", the question of whether the android Data is property or person is decided not by force but by a hearing, in which Picard asks what a civilisation reveals about itself through the beings it finds convenient to own. In "Darmok", an alien people who speak only in allusion are understood through patience. The Prime Directive, forbidding interference in other societies, is usually treated as a plot device. It is better read as a theory of power: Those who can intervene owe the world a discipline of restraint. Picard breaks the rule often, but the show never lets him do so comfortably. This was Stewart's real contribution. Television's captains had been men of action. He, trained in Shakespeare, made thinking itself dramatic. You could watch Picard weigh a decision, and the pause became the point of the scene. At a time when politics everywhere rewards the leader who is fastest and loudest, he made deliberation look like authority, which is a harder acting problem than it sounds.

Then there are the Borg, the franchise's scariest alien. Read them instead as a warning about ourselves. They are efficiency without dissent; "resistance is futile" is the motto of any system that mistakes agreement for harmony. Picard, captured and made their spokesman, returned knowing how persuasive uniformity can be. India's Constitution is a long bet against that logic: Unity without uniformity. Its test is not whether we tolerate a colourful festival or a regional dish, but whether we tolerate the dissenting editorial, the inconvenient question and the minority that declines to assimilate. Nor was the show naive. The Federation's faith in dialogue often looked thin against aggression and exploitation, and Picard knew it. His claim was that a civilisation is judged by whether it keeps talking when it holds all the weapons.

We have built replicators of our own: Instant information, outrage, an expectation of instant verdicts. What we lack is the half-second in which a person, party or government asks, "Is this who we want to be?" Stewart lived in that interval. Our age celebrates the leader who strikes first. A boy from Mirfield who knew the cost of that kind of strength spent a lifetime imagining the other kind, and made it look like the future.

> We have built replicators of our own: instant information, outrage, an expectation of instant verdicts. What we lack is the half-second in which a person, party or government asks, 'Is this who we want to be?'

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40 YEARS AGO
November 3, 1986


INDIAN EXPRESS
Farooq will head J-K coalition govt
Installation by week-end
Priests: Ignore Sarbat Khalsa resolutions
13 killed in fresh Karachi clashes

Farooq to lead coalition

THE NATIONAL Conference leader, Farooq Abdullah, will form a coalition government in Jammu and Kashmir sometime this week: It will have nine or 10 members. The seal of approval to the Congress(I)-NC(F) coalition was given at a meeting of the Central Parliamentary Board presided over by the Prime Minister, Rajiv Gandhi. A resolution adopted by the CPB (I) hoped that the coalition would "consolidate the secular and democratic forces in the border state". Hoping that the coalition would fight "anti-national and fundamentalist forces", the resolution recalled how the National Conference had been an active part of the national and freedom movement in the state.

Sikh head priests' appeal

THE FIVE Sikh head priests appealed to the Sikh masses not to give credence to the resolutions at the so-called "Sarbat Khalsa" held at the Golden Temple. The priests discussed the situation after Saturday's Sarbat Khalsa meeting called by Gurbachan Singh Manochahal, the acting chief of the Akal Takht. The Sarbat Khalsa had excommunicated Surjit Singh Barnala, the Chief Minister, and the Finance Minister, Balwant Singh, from the Sikh *panth* for their "anti-*panthic*" activities.

13 killed in Karachi riot

IN ONE of the worst ethnic riots in Karachi, 13 persons were killed when groups of Pathans and Muhajirs (Urdu-speaking migrants) exchanged fire and clashed with the curfew-enforcing army and security agencies.

Violence in Madras

MILITANTS BELONGING to the Sri Lankan Eelam People's Revolutionary Liberation Front (EPRLF) opened fire with machine guns at Choolaimedu in the city, killing one man and injuring two others, one of them seriously. The Diwali afternoon clash between 10 militants and a 600-strong mob at Thiruvalluvarpuram First Street killed Thirunavakkarasu, aged 24, and injured Ravi and Gurumoorthy, both in their 20s.

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

This time, Republican efforts to undermine the results began well in advance.
— *The Guardian*

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The anti-SIR and anti-CEC agitation is now set to become a pro-democracy movement



DESHKAAL

BY YOGENDRA YADAV

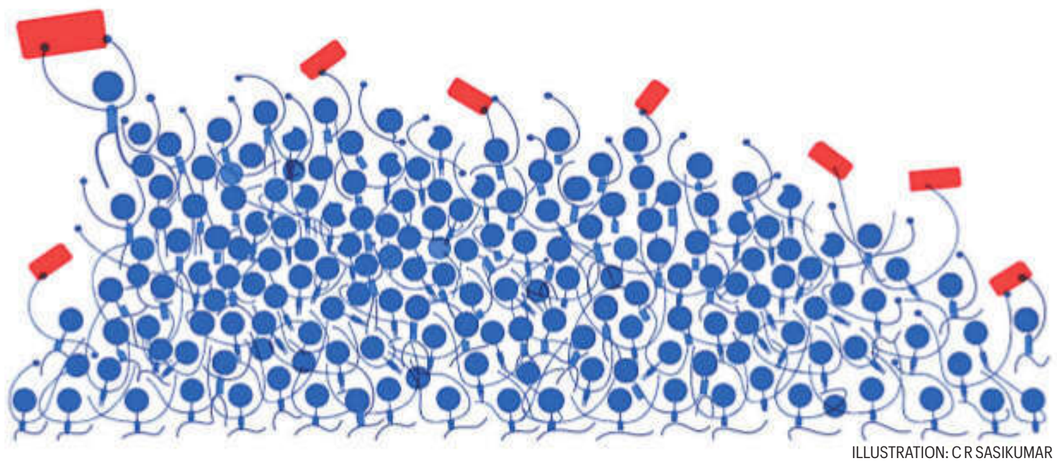


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

NO ONE expected Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar to resign after the massive INDIA bloc rally this Sunday. Yet, despite the churlish debate over how many attended the rally, the protest has achieved more than anyone expected. At the same time, this success places greater responsibility on everyone involved in this month-long struggle.

The run-up to the rally had already seen the entire Opposition, not just the INDIA bloc, come together to question the role of the Election Commission of India (ECI). Although AAP and DMK stayed away from the rally, they are very much with the cause. Non-INDIA bloc opposition parties like the BJD, BRS and YSRCP, which have often supported the government, have also come out against the SIR and the ECI. Such a full-spectrum vote of no-confidence by the entire parliamentary Opposition against the election management body would be unprecedented in any democracy. This is like all the non-host teams demanding replacement of the tournament referee.

The "Vote Bachao Desh Bachao" rally and the "public impeachment" of Gyanesh Kumar, the day before the rally, expanded the definition of opposition beyond the political parties. A large number of "civil society" organisations and movements that have led the current campaign against the SIR were present both in the "mock parliament" on Saturday and at the podium of the Sunday rally. These included many farmer organisations and all the youth organisations active in the October protests. In an unusual and significant move, the CJP issued a call to support the Opposition rally. Influencers like Dhruv Rathee and farmer leaders like Rakesh Tikait also endorsed the rally. Though the rally participants were overwhelmingly workers and supporters of INDIA bloc parties, mainly Congress, they exuded confidence that they stood for the people at large. While we should not expect all future protests to be under a single umbrella, this weekend has brought in much-needed cohesion in this medley of protests that we witnessed in October. It has also established Rahul Gandhi, the first leader to bring the "vote *chori*" issue to a disbelieving public, as the moral leader of the wider oppositional space.

The rally was a significant landmark in the popular acceptance of the "vote *chori*" narrative. The *Indian Express* exposé has opened the floodgates of media reporting on the multiple scandals of the SIR, besides the unconstitutional functioning of the ECI. The public now knows about the questions that surround Form 6, misuse of bulk Form 7 objections, the contentious use of Form 8 to change the final voter list, the weird pattern of voter deletion and bulk filing of anonymous appeals in West Bengal and much more. The ECI is on the back foot. The Supreme Court, too, faces questions. True, many of these grave infringements are too technical for the public to grasp. Yet the cumulative impact of the last six weeks has been a shift in the collective common sense towards "*daal mein kuchh kaala hai*" — something is rotten out there. The gravitas of the "public impeachment" pushed this popular narrative further.

> As of now, a call for free and fair elections encompasses the most widely shared sentiment of the people. This would also entail reclaiming democratic freedoms like freedom of expression, dissent and protest

This imposes a historic responsibility on all those who have contributed to the success of these protests so far. Going forward, the movement is not just about removing Gyanesh Kumar and rolling back the SIR but about reclaiming the democratic space that has been lost over the past 12 years. The anti-SIR and anti-CEC agitation is now set to become a pro-democracy movement.

At this critical juncture, the call for "regime change" is a distraction best avoided. To be sure, there is nothing wrong or unconstitutional about demanding regime change through the normal democratic route of elections. And the onus of keeping that normal route truly open is on the ruling establishment and independent institutions like the ECI and the Supreme Court. Yet at this stage, this is the demand of the Opposition, not necessarily the demand of all the people on the streets. The success of a mass movement depends on floating with the sentiment of the organic protesters, on keeping to the lowest common denominator that ensures the widest possible support.

As of now, a call for free and fair elections encompasses the most widely shared sentiment of the people. Such a call goes beyond the current demands for the removal of the CEC, the repeal of the 2023 Act and the rollback of the SIR. This would also entail reclaiming democratic freedoms like freedom of expression, dissent and protest — all the more relevant in the context of the repressive and intimidatory tactics adopted by the state, like the insistence on a "peace bond". A demand for neutral functioning of autonomous institutions like the ECI, the judiciary, investigating agencies and the media would also be a part of the democracy movement. Yet, all this does not amount to a demand for regime change — and certainly not on the streets — until all peaceful, democratic and constitutional means are truly and fully exhausted. And are perceived to be so by the people.

In that context, the coming elections in Uttar Pradesh could be the litmus test. For someone like me who has observed Indian elections closely for the last four decades, the assembly election in UP will be an *agnipariksha* that will determine whether we can expect anything like fair elections in the minimal sense of the term under the present dispensation. More than a test of Narendra Modi's or Yogi Adityanath's popularity, it will be a test of the electoral system's credibility. That must be the focal point of the pro-democracy movement.

As this stir enters its second phase, it may not look like a mountain river with its mad and unpredictable gush of water. As it descends to the plains, the movement will be slower and more widespread. This is not to be regretted, as the example of the farmers' stir showed us. The river slowing down allows water to percolate. As the rush of energy unleashed by the spontaneously synchronised protests gives way to a loosely coordinated movement spread across the country, the "vote *chori*" message is likely to seep deeper into popular consciousness. The regime's decision to brazen it out and block Gyanesh Kumar's resignation could well be a blessing in disguise, not just for the protestors, but for Indian democracy.

The writer is member, Swaraj India and national convenor, Bharat Jodo Abhiyaan. Views are personal

On the ballot in US midterms: 'Epstein class', affordability crisis



RAMESH VENKATARAMAN

"GRIFT", ONCE a folksy term for carnival swindlers and petty con games, has become the defining issue of the US midterm elections. Front-page headlines in *The Wall Street Journal* and *The New York Times* reported that voter anxiety over corruption now outranks almost every other concern. A *Financial Times* survey found that 69 per cent of registered voters — and nearly half of those who backed Donald Trump in 2024 — worry about "corruption, self-dealing, or conflicts of interest" in his administration. Even *Fox News* polling showed 88 per cent of voters "extremely" or "very" concerned about government corruption.

Americans are hardly naive about public corruption. But American political corruption was traditionally clandestine. What is truly remarkable about corruption in the Trump administration is how blatant and in-your-face it has been. Trump has made no effort to hide the fact that he and his family have made an estimated $4 billion while in office. Between presidential pardons treated as currency, venture capital windfalls for his sons, crypto regulations bent toward family allies, insider stock plays, and private jets gifted by foreign regimes, Trump has turned the government into a personal enrichment machine.

The only reasonable explanation for this brazenness is that Trump must not think his self-enrichment is wrong. And, until now, neither did his base.

To understand why, one must look beyond politics to the grotesque evolution of the American Dream. The competitive ethos of American society has long manifested itself in the notion that, as a famous American football coach put it, "Winning isn't everything; it's the only thing." Combine this with the self-image of a nation that was conceived in rebellion against the old European world of pedigreed privilege and you get the wholehearted adulation of self-made winners. In the American imagination, those who climb to the top by talent, hustle, or sheer market savvy earn moral legitimacy — luck and contingency notwithstanding. It is a short step from this to believing that society's winners are inherently superior and unbound by the pedestrian constraints governing ordinary citizens.

Trump weaponised this sentiment. By glossing over the fact that he came from privilege and presenting a myth of self-made triumph, he cast himself as the ultimate "winner". It is no surprise that his go-to insult is to call someone a "loser". Trump never claimed to be a traditional public servant. Instead, he placed himself as an insider of the winning super elite whose exempt status was proof of his dominance.

A hollowed-out middle class that backed Trump out of cultural and economic despair is finding it impossible to reconcile his White House grift with their daily reality. Treading water under the weight of tariffs, rising inflation, and steep petrol prices, voters are watching a billionaire cash in while their own lives get tougher.

Yet Trump is merely the most visible symptom of a deeper structural rot. Over three decades of economic distortion, America has birthed a class of unaccountable ultra-winners: The "Epstein class". Comprising less than 0.1 per cent of the population, this circle spans tech founders, private equity barons, hedge fund titans, and media moguls. Because many come from modest backgrounds, they claim the bulletproof moral armour of meritocracy.

The Epstein class inhabits a separate stratosphere — a world of private islands, gated enclaves, superyachts, corporate jets, plush VIP boxes, and red-carpet extravaganzas. But their real privilege is structural. They enjoy carried-interest tax loopholes, multi-million-dollar compensation payouts from their buddies on company boards and golden parachutes after catastrophic failure, private profits backstopped by Federal Reserve liquidity and public bailouts, and immunity from punishment for obvious criminality. They commercialise billions in taxpayer-funded university research, rely on state subsidies for renewables, and massive government contracts in healthcare, defence, and space.

This is not the capitalism described in textbooks. The "free market" that is practically a religion for Americans is in reality a heavily rigged oligarchy wrapped up in the garb of merit. Armies of well-funded lobbyists, lawyers, and tax advisers, and the opaque web of non-disclosure agreements ensure that it stays this way.

Bernie Sanders and others on the left have been railing about this for years. But they have struggled to make it into a politically sellable issue. As working Americans face an acute affordability crisis, the central question for American democracy is whether voters finally realise the game isn't just broken at the White House — it is rigged across the entire board.

The writer is an investor

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Dignity for workers

WHILE THE article rightly highlights the need for regulatory reforms to promote formal employment and higher wages, it overestimates the role of deregulation in addressing employment crisis ('Challenge is wages, not jobs. Expanding Jan Vishwas interventions can help', *IE*, November 2). Simplifying compliance and digitising laws are necessary, but cannot independently resolve structural challenges such as inadequate skill development, weak labour protections, and the limited creation of quality jobs. By placing considerable faith in the Jan Vishwas framework, the author risks reducing a complex socio-economic problem to an administrative one. Reform must ensure that growth translates into secure employment, fair wages, and dignity for workers.

Imran Hasan, New Delhi

Protecting protest

THE RIGHT to demonstrate matters only when citizens can exercise it without intimidation, while others remain protected from violence. Governments may regulate routes and hours for safety, but restrictions must be proportionate and reviewable ('In France, protest is also about the right to protest', *IE*, November 2). Treating dissent itself as disorder creates a dangerous precedent.

A Senthil Kumar, Kaniyur

US midterms

POWER IN a democracy is rarely lost in a single election, but it can be quietly borrowed from the people who vote, and the bill often arrives years later ('A larger reckoning lies behind US midterm', *IE*, November 2). Voters judge leaders on groceries, rent and jobs, yet those worries can redraw the map of distant wars. If the next Congress checks the White House on tariffs and military adventures, partners get a clearer picture of what Washington can sustain. A practical step for every democracy would be publishing plain-language reports on the costs of foreign actions, so citizens can weigh them as they weigh household budgets.

K Chidanand Kumar, Bengaluru



Amid noisy blockbusters, missing the quiet film

POOJA PILLAI

IN THE decade since *Baahubali 2: The Conclusion* became the first Indian film to earn over Rs 1,000 crore globally, that number has come to be a paradox: Concrete as the threshold that every ambitious filmmaker hopes they will cross, but large enough that it is still an abstraction. What, after all, does Rs 1,000 crore even mean in an industry that spins a tale long enough that most people stop expecting any actual figures? Success is as success is narrated.

Not that the recent blockbuster history of India is all myth. Films like *Baahubali*, *KGF* and *Pushpa* have made money hand over fist, cementing a new appreciation of an old saw: The bigger the better. The formula is essentially reduced to huge budgets, scale and a multistar, multilingual cast. This year, *Dhurandhar 2: The Revenge* was that juggernaut, netting just over Rs 1,800 crore worldwide. As 2026 draws to a close, two films will hope to top its earnings. *Ramayana: Part 1*, opening on November 5, is reportedly the most expensive Indian film ever made, with the cost of both parts coming to about Rs 4,000 crore. Then on Christmas Eve, Shah Rukh Khan returns in *King*, its budget reportedly surpassing the sums spent on *Pathaan* (Rs 350 crore) and *Jawan* (Rs 400 crore).

But numbers — whether fact or fiction — are only part of the story. Consider two films that opened in the same week of August. *Toxic* is among the most expensive Indian films ever made, with a budget estimated at anywhere from Rs 500 crore to Rs 1,000 crore. It opened with the year's biggest advance bookings, then faltered within a week. On the other hand, *Bethlehem Kudumba Unit*, a Malayalam romantic comedy made for around Rs 25-30 crore opened modestly. Excellent word-of-mouth ensured that on its second Friday, the film earned nearly twice what it did on the first day.

Toxic was not the only big-budget disappointment of the year, which began with the floundering of *The Raja Saab*, starring Prabhas. Tamil Nadu Chief Minister Vijay's farewell project, *Jana Nayagan*, broke opening-day records and then just about broke even. Even Ram Charan's *Peddi*, which did well in the Telugu market, failed to make the larger intended splash. The films that did work belong to popular franchises: *Dhurandhar 2: The Revenge*, *Jailer 2*, *Drishyam: The Conclusion*. *Dhurandhar* alone appears to have accounted for nearly a fifth of India's box office in the first half of the year.

> The success of a film like 'Bethlehem Kudumba Unit' speaks to a real gap: The sensible budget film that finds an audience simply by being good. In Hindi cinema, the space for that kind of film has largely collapsed

But the success of a film like *Bethlehem Kudumba Unit* speaks to a real gap: The sensible budget film that finds an audience simply by being good. In Hindi cinema, the space for that kind of film — middle of the road with no big star but a great plot and strong writing — has largely collapsed. It exists elsewhere, but is shrinking under pressure from the changing economics of filmmaking. This year, for the first time, three Malayalam films, including *Vaazha II* — a coming-of-age comedy with no superstar lead — have each crossed Rs 200 crore worldwide. In Marathi, *Deool Band 2*, a devotional comedy made for around Rs 10 crore, reportedly earned a 550 per cent profit.

Hollywood's 2026 shows what a healthy range can look like. Its biggest film, *Spider-Man: Brand New Day*, is a franchise giant at nearly $2.5 billion. But the year was carried by films of every size, from *Obsession*, a horror film made for under $1 million that became a runaway global hit earning $500 million, to *Backrooms*, which was made for $10 million and made over $400 million worldwide.

The stakes are higher because audiences are returning. According to Ormax Media's India Box Office Report, the January to June earnings were Rs 6,398 crore — a rise of 10 per cent on last year. More importantly, footfalls rose 5 per cent. Those viewers were drawn to all kinds of films. To respond largely with spectacle cinema would be to bet against the mood. *Ramayana* and *King* may well break records. But the lessons of 2026 would still stand, encapsulated in the box office journeys of the most unexpected hits, and flops, of the year.

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Smaller cities can lead the way on climate resilience

VAISHNAVI T G SHANKAR AND SANJAY SRIDHAR

EVERY SEASON brings a familiar climate stress to Indian cities. Yet, heat and flooding are often addressed separately even though they are shaped by the same decisions about land, buildings, and infrastructure. The challenge is not simply to respond to each challenge, but to rethink how cities grow.

The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change offers a useful framework: Climate-resilient development, which brings together adaptation, emissions reduction, and sustainable development. India's Long-Term Low Emissions Development Strategy submitted to the UNFCCC and the National Mission on Sustainable Habitat provide a framework to integrate climate considerations into urban development. More recently, the Urban Flood Risk Management Programme covering 18 cities and the recognition of heat as a notified disaster, enabling the use of disaster funds for heat resilience, reflect growing attention to climate risks. The next step is to embed these priorities in routine planning and investment. And the opportunity lies in smaller cities.

More than half of India's urban population lives in cities with fewer than one million residents, and estimates indicate that more than 50 per cent of the housing needed by 2070 is yet to be built. Unlike large cities, where retrofitting infrastructure or changing development patterns can be costly and complex, smaller cities have an opportunity to shape how they expand. Decisions made today on roads, drainage, buildings, and public spaces can lock cities into high energy use and climate vulnerability or create more resilient and resource-efficient neighbourhoods.

Rising temperatures increase cooling needs, air-conditioning use, and electricity demand. Yet cooling demand is shaped not only by rising temperatures but also by how cities grow. A study across 88 Indian cities highlights that land use patterns, building density, urban expansion, and green cover influence cooling demand. India's Cooling Action Plan estimates that building design, energy efficiency, and thermal comfort practices could reduce cooling demand by 20 per cent by 2037-38. So, urban planning and building regulations are important for reducing heat exposure while limiting energy demand.

> Understanding how people walk, commute, and use public spaces can help smaller cities build on existing practices to shape low-carbon and resilient growth

Realising these benefits requires a shift in how cities plan. Development authorities prepare master plans, public works departments design roads, utilities provide services, and municipalities regulate buildings. These decisions are often made across separate departments and addressing them requires two shifts. Climate considerations must become part of routine planning, project appraisal, and investment, and stronger coordination between departments can help align investments and maximise collective benefits.

Climate-resilient development does not always require a separate funding stream; it can begin with how existing municipal revenues, government transfers and scheme-based grants are allocated and designed. Corporate social responsibility funding, impact investment, and development finance can complement public resources by supporting pilots, generating evidence that can be scaled.

Spatial data, local risk and vulnerability assessments, and scenario modelling can help identify where risks are concentrated and need focus. But these tools are most effective when combined with local knowledge and people's lived experience. Understanding how people walk, commute, and use public spaces can help smaller cities build on existing practices to shape low-carbon and resilient growth, rather than replicating infrastructure models from larger cities.

Shankar is senior advisor, Climate Resilience and Sustainable Cities at Vasudha Foundation. Sridhar serves on the Advisory Board of SaveLIFE Foundation, and is a core member of the World Economic Forum's global task force on sustainability and the built environment

MP cop run over by truck carrying smuggled liquor

Incident comes amid a state-wide crackdown on illicit liquor

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, November 2

A POLICE station in-charge died after allegedly being run over by a truck suspected of transporting illicit liquor during an interception operation in Madhya Pradesh's Dewas district Sunday night, police said. The incident comes amid an intensified crackdown on the illicit liquor trade following a series of suspected hooch deaths in the state.

Khategaon police station in-charge Dilip Puri was killed after a truck ran over him on the Harda-Nemawar highway. Police said the driver tried to flee when Puri and his team attempted to intercept the vehicle. A 2007-batch sub-inspector, Puri was leading the team tracking the truck following intelligence inputs that it was transporting illicit liquor from Harda to Gujarat via Indore.

Police said the driver had been arrested and the truck seized. The vehicle was allegedly found carrying liquor. A probe is underway to establish the source of the consignment and whether others were involved in the alleged smuggling operation.

Dewas Superintendent of Police Aditya Mishra said multiple teams, led by the station in-charges of Khategaon, Kannod and Nemawar, were deployed to intercept the truck following intelligence that it was carrying illicit liquor from Harda to Gujarat via Indore. The teams were pursuing the vehicle when the incident occurred.





Family members and police personnel grieve beside the mortal remains of Khategaon SHO Inspector Dilip Puri (left) at his residence in Indore. PTI

"The driver ran the vehicle over the police station in-charge, who was leading one of the teams, leaving him seriously injured. He was rushed to hospital but could not be saved," Mishra said. Police seized the truck and recovered more than 800 litres of alcohol, he added.

Congress leader and Madhya Pradesh Leader of Opposition Umang Singhar condemned the death of Khategaon police station in-charge Dilip Puri, alleging that the incident reflected the growing audacity of criminal networks in the state.

"Has the fear of the government and administration completely disappeared from the minds of the mafia in the state?" he asked, calling the incident a "slap in the face of the system."

Local BJP MLA Ashish Sharma said the administration was taking action against the illicit liquor trade and that the police were conducting a large-scale crackdown on the network.

"The police are carrying out action on a large scale. This incident occurred after police received information and attempted to apprehend the vehicle. The administration will take action against everyone involved in illegal trade," he said.

The incident comes amid a wider crackdown on illicit liquor in MP following the deaths of 13 people in Dewas district in September and October after allegedly consuming spurious liquor.

The Ujjain divisional commissioner ordered a high-level inquiry, while police launched a probe into the liquor network. The government subsequently transferred Dewas Collector Ritu Raj and SP Puneet Gahlot and suspended three excise officials, including district excise officer, over alleged negligence.

Minor survivor points to Veeramani in ID parade

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, November 2

A MINOR survivor of alleged sexual abuse identified granite businessman R Veeramani during an identification parade at Tamil Nadu's Puzhal Central Prison last week, marking a significant development in an investigation into eight cases registered under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act involving him and several associates.

The identification took place as the Greater Chennai Police widened their investigation, conducting searches at properties linked to the accused, pursuing a businessman who had fled abroad, and arresting a security guard who allegedly knew that children were being brought to Veeramani's residence but failed to alert the authorities.

The latest arrest, made on Sunday, brought the number of people taken into custody to nine.

Police said Seenu alias Srinivasan, a security guard employed at Veeramani's residence, was arrested in connection with two cases. Investigators alleged that he was aware of children visiting the property but did not report the matter to the authorities.

His arrest followed the detention of eight people, including Veeramani, in connection with allegations of sexual offences against minor girls. The others arrested were Shanthi, Mahendra Simhan, Lazar, Ganesan, Babu, Parthiban and Sakthivel.



Granite baron R Veeramani

All eight were remanded to Puzhal Central Prison.

The identification parade was conducted inside the prison as part of the investigation into one of the registered cases. Police said a survivor identified Veeramani during the procedure. They did not disclose further details of the identification or the circumstances surrounding the alleged offence.

Veeramani was formally arrested in three additional cases, while Shanthi, her husband Mahendra Simhan, and Lazar were arrested in another case on October 28.

Investigators also searched Ganesan's residence in Kolathur and a dance school operated by Shanthi in Neelankarai over the weekend. Police said materials relevant to the investigation were seized from the premises, without specifying their nature.

In a parallel development, police have initiated action against businessman K Prakash, son of Southern Railway union leader N Kanniah, who allegedly helped Veeramani conceal his offences.

Prakash has allegedly fled abroad, according to investigators. Police said action had been taken to revoke his passport and that efforts were underway to secure his return to India. Look Out Circulars have also been issued to prevent accused persons from leaving the country.

The investigation is being pursued by a Special Investigation Team, with the Greater Chennai Police's Anti-Human Trafficking Unit having made the earlier arrests.

Police said they were expediting the investigation and preparing to file final reports before the court in the registered cases this week.

EXPRESS special

Farmers watch yrs of work dry up as drought hits Maharashtra's fruit belts

Ankita Deshkar & Sadaf Modak
Jalna, Nagpur, Beed, November 2

IN JALNA'S Ambad taluka, sweet lime trees bear wrinkled green fruit barely the size of lemons. Some have turned brown, sun-scorched skeletons, while ripe fruit are scattered on the ground. In Vidarbha's Linga village in Amravati district, orange growers are plucking immature fruit in the hope of saving their trees.

Maharashtra's worsening drought situation is beginning to take a visible toll on its fruit-growing belts. After the state recorded an 18% rainfall deficit between June 1 and September 26, drought or drought-like conditions were declared in 304 of its 358 talukas. In Marathwada and Vidarbha, where rain has been deficient and unevenly distributed, the impact is showing up in shrinking fruit, premature crop loss and trees drying up.

In Linga, orange grower Shivhari Hadke is removing oranges barely the size of an Indian Gooseberry (*amla*) from his nearly 2-acre orchard of 18-year-old trees. With fruit-bearing trees requiring frequent irrigation, he hopes that removing the immature crop will reduce their water needs and help the remaining trees survive.

Of the nearly 250 trees in his orchard, 10 have already dried up. His younger brother has lost 70 trees. Some of Hadke's trees had withered last year, too. The family has also been dealing with damage caused by animals scratching the bark, further weakening the trees.

In Marathwada, successive droughts and pest attacks have steadily reduced sweet lime production in parts of Jalna. Rohilagad, Ambad and Ghansawangi in Jalna, along with Georai in Beed and Paithan in Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, were once known for their sweet lime orchards. Repeated crop losses have since driven many farmers out of fruit cultivation.



A dried orange tree at Shivhari Hadke's farm in Linga village. EXPRESS

Shivaji Takle, a 35-year-old farmer from Rohilagad, says he has lost nearly Rs 2.5 lakh this year after his pomegranate crop failed. "I had spent nearly Rs 2.5 lakh on my 2.5-acre farm, which has 500-600 pomegranate trees. There was no rain and irrigation is not viable for the entire crop. Over 400 trees just dried up and the remaining had small fruit but not fit for sale. We will be cutting down those trees. I am not sure how much insurance and compensation I will get but the losses are difficult to come to terms with," he says.

Takle's father began planting sweet lime on their land in 1998 and harvested over 2,500 fruits every year. With no local market at the time, he would sell the produce in Nagpur. But droughts in 2012 and 2014, followed by pest attacks, dealt a severe blow to orchards in the region. Sweet lime is available in limited quantities in local markets at Rs 35 per kg. The state may have to depend on supplies from other states, including Andhra Pradesh, this year.

Jagdish Deshmukh, a farmer from Ambad who earned lakhs from pomegranate cultivation in 2023, says the lack of rain has turned this year into a season of losses.

Scientists at ICAR Central Citrus Research Institute (ICAR-CCRI), Nagpur, warn that adverse weather could cause substantial losses in both the Ambia and Mrig flowering cycles of citrus cultivation.

A Thirugnanavel, principal scientist at the institute, said rain in major citrus-growing belts like Vidarbha was deficient by around 30-40% this year. Fewer rainy days and uneven distribution had left farmers struggling to irrigate their orchards. "Both the amount of rain and its duration are important. This year, the duration and amount of rain were inadequate, and farmers were unable to irrigate their crops. High temperatures, low water availability and increased evaporation together contributed to drought conditions."

The impact is visible in fruit size and tree survival. "When water is scarce, the plant uses the available moisture primarily for survival rather than transferring it to the fruits. As a result, fruit size has reduced. Plant mortality has also been reported," he said.

Under normal conditions, citrus yields average around 13 tonnes per hectare, with fruits weighing 140-180 grams. In affected orchards, yields could fall to seven or eight tonnes per hectare, pointing to substantial production losses.

Institute director N G Patil said state departments were assessing the full extent of damage. "People often look at the total rain and assume the situation is not bad. But rain distribution matters. Rain at the wrong stage of the crop cycle may not benefit farmers. Agricultural drought and hydrological drought are also different."

Poor colour development can further depress market prices, while prolonged moisture stress weakens trees and leaves them vulnerable to pests and diseases. Trees that have dried beyond the stage of permanent wilting may not recover. Farmers may have to uproot and replant them, and a new orchard takes around four years to yield its first harvest.

For growers in both regions, the damage is not limited to one failed harvest. It means losing years of investment and facing the cost and wait involved in rebuilding an orchard. As Deshmukh puts it, "This year, the lack of rain has meant only losses for farmers."

'Don't travel by air': SC declines urgent hearing on 'inflated airfares'

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 2

THE SUPREME Court Monday declined to grant an urgent hearing to an application seeking its intervention to cap the "inflated" airline fares on domestic sectors ahead of festival season.

Filed in a pending PIL challenging the fare hike, the application pointed out the petition is next listed for hearing on November 16 – by which time the festive travel for Diwali, Bhai Dooj, and Chhath Puja will already be over. It therefore urged the court to hear it at the earliest.

Justice Vikram Nath, presiding over a three-judge bench, however, did not agree and told the applicant's counsel, "don't travel by air", before moving on to the next matter.

S Laxminarayanan, a social activist, had moved SC last year highlighting "arbitrary and opaque" pricing by airlines, during festival seasons and questioning state's inaction on it.

Hearing it in January this year, Justice Nath called it "exploitation". "We will definitely interfere. Just see the exploitation during the Kumbh and other festivals. Just see the fares from Delhi to Prayagraj and Jodhpur – three times the normal," Justice Nath had said then.

And while hearing it again on May 15, a bench of Justices Nath and Mehta told the government that "there has to be some rationalisation".

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Centre and Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA), then said that the government was in the process of framing rules under the new Bharatiya Vayuyan Adhiniyam, 2024.

Popular Keralam preacher raped teen girl citing purification ritual, say police

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, November 2

POLICE IN Keralam have arrested a popular Islamic preacher on charges of sexually abusing a minor girl repeatedly over a period of two months last year. Muhammed Niyas Jouhari, 34, was arrested on Sunday and sent to judicial custody.

A native of Kollam, he has been active on social media platforms for a while now, with his YouTube channel alone having over 2.25 lakh subscribers.

Police said the preacher allegedly sexually exploited the girl as part of a ritual-cleansing intended to "free her grandmother from the influence of an evil spirit".

Said an officer in Kollam's Ochira Police, "Jouhari has been popular as a preacher on social media. The victim's family has been following his social media pages. The 16-year-old girl and her grandmother went to meet Jouhari at his educational institution, which is meant for nurturing Islamic faith, last year."

The officer said, "The preacher allegedly convinced the woman that she is under the influence of an evil spirit and requires a purification ritual. He allegedly lured the woman and the girl to his rented premises, where he repeatedly raped the latter for several months starting from last October."

The officer said, "Recently, the girl, who has been living under the trauma of the abuse, shared the alleged incident with her friends, leading to a case against the preacher. Medical reports and mobile phone chats were considered before making the arrest."

He has been arrested under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act and Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) sections pertaining to rape and criminal intimidation.

Police said Jouhari's digital gadgets will be examined.

Jouhari, who runs the Habibiyyah Islamic Academy, recently courted controversy after he commented on the clothing of a prominent Muslim actor. The preacher had dubbed the attire un-Islamic.

COURTROOM RUCKUS

Allahabad High Court recommends criminal contempt proceedings, FIR against lawyers

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, November 2

STATING THAT the Bar's obligation to speak truth to power does not grant a "license to incite violence", the Allahabad High Court has recommended criminal contempt proceedings against lawyers who allegedly assaulted staff and vandalised a courtroom on October 28.

The bench of Justice Ajay Bhanot and Justice Divesh Chandra Samant also asked the Registrar General to consider getting FIRs filed against those involved in vandalism, as well as those who allegedly circulated "false information" about the incident on social media.

"Anarchy is not a species of dissent. Freedom of speech at the Bar is not the freedom to slander the Bench," the court said, observing that the legal process had no space for intimidation and violence.

Referred the matter to the Chief Justice to launch criminal contempt proceedings against lawyers linked to the courtroom violence, the bench said, "The actions of the said lawyers... scandalised and lowered the authority of the court... (it) also interfered with the due course of judicial proceedings and obstructed the administration of justice. The aforesaid actions of the said lawyers prima facie constitute criminal contempt of this court," the bench said.

The suo motu contempt case stems from an October 28 incident in Court No. 49, where a group of lawyers allegedly shouted slogans and disrupted proceedings in protest against alleged misconduct by Justice Ajay Bhanot.

A day earlier, the Allahabad High Court Bar Association had sent a letter to the Chief Justice on the same issue. It had objected to reserved seating for police and assisting officials in the court and alleged that Justice Bhanot humiliated an advocate, forced him to apologise, and even threatened him with jail time.

Calling it "total falsehood," the bench dismissed the allegations. It said that the seating arrangement was intended to help officials follow proceedings and assist the court. It also clarified that "no order was dictated nor exists on the record" where the court is ordering imprisonment of an advocate.

Additionally, the bench said that a report submitted by the Registrar General stated that several state advocates, court staff, and a peon were assaulted in the ruckus. Videos, it said, citing the report, clearly captured the alleged assault by lawyers.

The court also criticised the circulation of what it described as false narratives about the incident on social media. "A frenzy of social media falsehoods caused the carnage of truth. In fact, truth has ceased to be relevant," it said.

Siang project row: Arunachal CM writes to protesters, promises dialogue, transparency, public consultation

Shinjini Ghosh
New Delhi, November 2

ARUNACHAL PRADESH Chief Minister Pema Khandu on Monday reached out to locals protesting against the 11,200-MW Siang Upper Multipurpose Project (SUMP), saying their concerns will be addressed through open dialogue, transparency and meaningful public consultation.

In an open letter, Khandu assured the indigenous communities that "no decision has been made" regarding the construction of the proposed dam. He reiterated that currently the government is only talking about the Pre-Feasibility Report (PFR), as that is "the first step towards establishing facts".

The CM's assurance comes in the wake of the ongoing protests against the proposed project. The Siang Indigenous Farmers' Forum (SIFF) on Monday alleged that the Arunachal government had not consulted the landowners who would be affected by the project.

It also alleged that a lack of transparency and awareness among the local communities regarding the project has led to a loss of trust in the state government. SIFF spokesperson Tagori Mize said the state government did not discuss the merits and demerits of the proposed project with the affected communities.

"The government never went to either the private landowners or the community landowners. There was a lack of transparency and community members were not taken into confidence. That is why the common people are raising their voices," Mize said.



Arunachal CM Pema Khandu

Khandu in his letter said decisions will come later, and only through open discussion with people. "Fear of uncertainty is understandable, but our promise is clarity, with a clear roadmap and continued support. We will never abandon our people midway," Khandu said.

The Chief Minister also said "some people and some groups are spreading false information" about the proposed project. "They claim that a decision regarding the dam has already been taken, that families will be forced from their homes and that land will be taken without consent. None of this is true," Khandu said in the letter posted on X.

"Dialogue requires trust and mutual understanding, and we remain committed to dialogue, consent and finding a constructive way forward," Khandu said.

The 11,200-MW Multipurpose Project is touted to be India's biggest hydropower project. Both the central and state governments have maintained that the project is a national security issue and essential to counter China's mega dam project.

Indigenous communities along the banks of the Siang River have argued that the project is a threat to not only their sources of livelihood but also their cultural heritage.

Referring to an MoU signed between the state government and sections of the Siang Valley, Mize claimed there were inconsistencies in the same. "To gain a majority, some like-minded people were made to sign the MoU. In some instances, multiple people from the same family signed the MoU and they were counted as different households. That's how a majority was reached," Mize alleged.

BJP MLA Ojing Tasing, who represents Pangin constituency in Siang district, denied the allegations. Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Tasing, who is also a state Cabinet minister, said, "In the recent past there have been frequent leadership changes in SIFF. How will the current post holders know what happened when the MoU was signed?"

'Your Krishna, our Ram': Baba Bageshwar remarks trigger controversy

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, November 2

A VIDEO of Bageshwar Dham head priest Dhirendra Shastri making remarks about Lord Krishna's appearance, posture and flute-playing has sparked controversy, prompting him to apologise.

Shastri made the remarks during a Ram Katha in Karera, Shivpuri district, while comparing the physical appearance and mannerisms of Lord Krishna and Lord Ram. He also contrasted their respective abodes, Ayodhya and Vrindavan, and questioned the significance of Krishna's flute-playing.

"Your Thakurji seems to be looking around in every photo. Even when he stands, he is crooked in three places. His feet are crossed, his waist is bent somewhere, and then, with his neck bent, he plays the flute," Shastri says in a now-viral video.

He then contrasts Krishna's posture with that of Lord Ram, saying, "Ours stands absolutely straight. His name is straight, he looks straight and walks straight. Yours is crooked, he looks crooked and walks crooked."

Referring to a flautist on stage, he says, "Playing the flute is a sport, but using the bow is no sport. The flute played by your Thakurji is no big deal. There's a man on stage playing the flute as well."

After the video went viral, Shastri faced flak from a host of religious leaders based in Mathura, who said that comparing Lord Ram and Lord Krishna in this manner was inappropriate and could hurt the sentiments of devotees.



Dhirendra Shastri made the remarks during a Ram Katha in Karera, Shivpuri district.

They argued that both deities were manifestations of the same divine being and that such comments risked creating divisions among devotees. Some also questioned the language used to describe Lord Krishna's posture and flute-playing, warning that "religious figures should exercise caution while making public statements about revered deities".

Shastri said his remarks were part of an explanation of a devotional verse and had been taken out of context. He apologised if his words had hurt the sentiments of devotees.

"Some people have interpreted our words differently and drawn incorrect meanings from them. We humbly want to clarify that we did not intend to create any distinction between Lord Ram and Lord Krishna," Shastri said.

He cited examples of the gopis speaking playfully to Lord Krishna and saints using similar expressions in their devotional compositions. He said his remarks were made in the same spirit.

"I am not opposed to Lord Krishna. He is our Thakurji. We ourselves have repeatedly raised our voice for Krishna Janmabhoomi. His name is part of my own name. It is because of him that our lives have meaning," he said.

Shastri also said he considered himself a devotee of Lord Krishna and a part of the Braj tradition. "We did not try to divide society or create a distinction between the gods. Why would we divide God?" he said.

No plan for fuel hedging, but evaluating it as long-haul ops expand: IndiGo

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, November 2

AMID SURGING jet fuel prices, India's largest airline IndiGo has no immediate plans for fuel hedging, but has started internal discussions on whether it should do so in future as its long-haul operations develop over the coming years, CEO Willie Walsh said on Monday.

He also said the airline is in talks with the government on potential measures to mitigate high jet fuel prices, adding that it is open to participating in future government schemes on the issue if they are economically viable. No airline participated in the government's jet fuel price stabili-sation fund scheme when it was launched in June.

As per the sources in the know, the government could consider the scheme's revival to provide stable fuel pricing to airlines amid extreme price volatility in overseas market.

Recent rise in jet fuel prices has led airlines to hike fuel surcharge on flight tickets. However, the hikes are not enough to offset impact of high prices. In September quarter, IndiGo logged a loss of nearly Rs 1,880 crore. Jet fuel accounts for over 40% of IndiGo's total operating cost base, like other Indian airlines. This leaves Indian airlines exposed to global fuel price volatility.

Unlike European carriers that hedge between 70% and 80% of fuel needs, or Asian airlines that hedge around 40%, domestic airlines operate completely unhedged.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Centre steps in to protect bulk Scotch duty benefits

Mukesh Jagota
New Delhi, November 2

THE GOVERNMENT is taking necessary steps to address issues relating to the HSN Code classification of bulk Scotch whisky imports to ensure that the duty concessions negotiated under the India-UK comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) are not impaired, senior commerce ministry officials assured industry representatives on Monday.

At a high-level stakeholder consultation with domestic distillers, multinational liquor companies and industry associations, the officials said the government's commitment to provide duty concessions under the CETA would not be affected.

They reiterated the government's commitment to providing a stable and predictable environment for the industry. FE

ANALYSTS SEE OVERALL EARNINGS PERFORMANCE FOR Q2 AS POSITIVE SO FAR

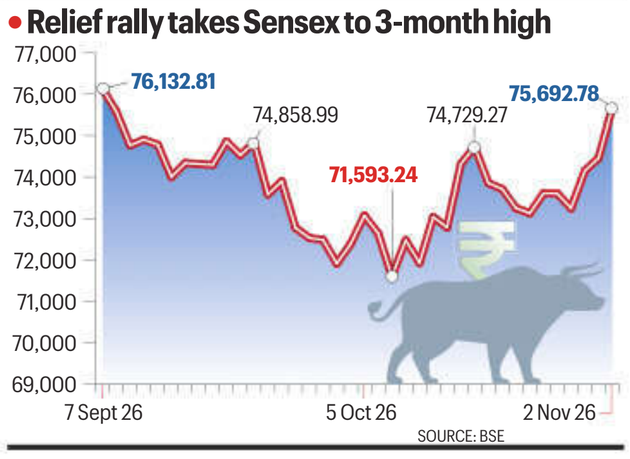
Stocks surge as RIL result, positive data lift sentiment

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, November 2

SENSEX GAINED 1.7% on Monday to its highest level in nearly three months as the index heavyweight Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL) posted better-than-expected earnings for the July-September quarter, geopolitical tensions eased a bit in West Asia, and positive macroeconomic data lifted sentiment.

In what analysts termed a "relief rally," Sensex closed the session at 75,692.78, its highest level since September 7, up 1,233.25 points or 1.7%. While Nifty 50 ended the session up 1.7% at 23,440.80 — its highest in five weeks. RIL shares skyrocketed nearly 12% after it reported record Q2 revenues and profits Friday. Incidentally, RIL has a nearly 8% weight in Nifty 50 — the third highest after HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank. It has a high weight on Sensex as well. Thus, a huge rally in the stock pushes benchmark indices notably higher. Apart from that, the mood was largely positive in the market, as around 65% of NSE-traded stocks ended the session in green.

Relief rally takes Sensex to 3-month high



SOURCE: BSE

Having been the worst-performing emerging market so far this year, the market gained around 2% in October, outperforming the likes of the US, South Korea, and Taiwan. While these foreign bourses were hit by earnings disappointments and AI concerns, India gained due to positive earnings.

Analysts see the overall earnings performance so far for Q2 as positive, which has helped lift near-term market sentiment. Big names like HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, L&T, and RIL have beaten the Street's consensus on earnings for the quarter.

Even IT, which is expected to get more vulnerable as AI adoption rises, posted strong gains.

Several mid- and small-cap companies delivered strong quarterly earnings, signalling that results have been good for many pockets of the market.

Strong GST collections, which surged 23% year-on-year in October, are also a positive sign that the economy continues to do well, analysts said. "Overall, it is a combination of these factors that lifted the markets higher. Also, an absolute lack of negative surprises, combined with robust earnings performances, has turned sentiment positive in the short term," said Kranthi Bathini, Equity Strategist at WealthMills Securities. Relatively lower valuations compared to historical averages are also aiding the market, analysts said.

A *Reuters* report claimed that the Securities and Exchange Board of India has recommended that the government remove the long-term capital gains tax on foreign investors — a key measure for sustained foreign inflows. Despite market gains in October, foreign investors sold Indian equities for second straight session, dumping stocks worth $3.6 billion during the month. "I do not think the market was influenced by this a lot. While such talks (like tax reforms) keep happening on informal channels, we have to wait and watch if anything has been proposed officially. For now, it's just speculation," the research head at a top domestic fund house said. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Khambata declines Tata Trusts reappointment

George Mathew
Mumbai, November 2

Senior Advocate Darius Khambata's decision comes at a critical juncture, with his term due to end on November 9 and the dispute over the proposed Tata Sons listing showing little sign of resolution

IN A significant development in the escalating Tata Trusts power struggle, Senior Advocate Darius Khambata has decided not to seek reappointment as a trustee of Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) and Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), raising fresh questions about the internal dynamics of the institutions controlling the Tata Group.

In a letter addressed to Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata and Tata Trusts, Khambata has conveyed that he does not wish to continue as a trustee. His decision comes at a critical juncture, with his term due to end on November 9 and the dispute over the proposed Tata Sons listing showing little sign of resolution.

Khambata has expressed dissatisfaction with the outcome of the Trusts' engagement with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), indicating that efforts to find an alternative to listing Tata Sons have failed to produce a convincing regulatory solution.

Referring to the "astounding events" in August and September, he said the discussions with the RBI had, unfortunately, failed to produce any meaningful progress or satisfactory outcome in demonstrating how Tata Sons could implement the transparency and disclosure standards of a listed company, either by giving up its Core Investment Company (CIC) status or by restructuring its operations to avoid the last-resort option of a stock market listing.

He termed the September 17 board meeting that okayed a five-year extension for N Chandrasekaran and listing of Tata Sons as "a day that will live in infamy".

One reason for his decision to leave Tata Trusts could be that he would be voted out when his reappointment proposal is taken up on November 9, sources said. Vijay Singh and Venu Srinivasan have been opposing Noel Tata's proposals in Tata Trusts. Earlier, four trustees including Noel Tata, Neville Tata, and Bhaskar Bhat had defended the restructuring proposal sent by Tata Trusts to avoid listing. Khambata also supported the September 11, 2025, decision that preserved the Trusts' veto rights for Noel Tata.

His exit is important because it exposes the central dilemma confronting Noel Tata and the trustees opposing a stock market listing of Tata Sons. While the Trusts have consistently argued that the company should remain unlisted, they have struggled to demonstrate how it could meet the regulator's requirements without going public.

RBI had rejected Tata Sons' application to surrender its registration as a CIC in September, putting the company back on the path towards listing. Tata Sons board had pursued deregistration as a means to retain its unlisted status. Tata Trusts, which collectively hold around 66% of Tata Sons, have opposed the listing and pushed for alternative arrangements.

The Trusts have argued that RBI's rejection of the deregistration application did not amount to an explicit direction to undertake an IPO and that the company should explore other legally permissible options.

One proposal involved restructuring Tata Sons through a merger with two group companies, Tata Electronics Systems Solutions and Tata Consulting Engineers.

The proposed restructuring was intended to transform Tata Sons from a holding company into a holding-cum-operating company, potentially taking it outside the regulatory framework applicable to upper-layer NBFCs and allowing it to remain unlisted. But the proposal has triggered another round of confrontation within the Trusts.

Vice-chairmen Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh have questioned the manner in which the restructuring proposal was pursued, alleging that they were excluded from important discussions and decision-making. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

FM: Govt to support growth through capex until pvt investment picks up

Press Trust of India
Mumbai, November 2



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and HSBC India CEO Hitendra Dave at the HSBC event in Mumbai, on Monday. X/@NSITHARAMANOFFC

THE GOVERNMENT will continue to support growth by undertaking capital expenditure until private sector investment increases, Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said on Monday.

Speaking at an event organised by HSBC, she said the government accords top priority to fiscal prudence and will continue to play the balancing act by being "creative" in continuing spending while pushing growth with capex. "Capex is a very important component of our growth strategy because till such a time when the private sector is also going to come in and expand capacities or establish newer capacities, it is important for the government to push through with the capital expenditure," she said.

MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▼
75,692.78	23,440.80	₹1,37,524	₹94.90
1,233.25	387.70	Silver ▼	Oil ▲
1.66%	1.68%	₹1,79,972	$118.74

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF OCTOBER 30, 2026

53 of top 100 companies fail to disclose whistleblower complaints, says report

George Mathew
Mumbai, November 2

AS MANY as 53 of India's top 100 listed companies failed to disclose information relating to whistleblower complaints in their FY26 annual reports. A total of 1,129 complaints were reported across the companies covered by the survey, of which 13.37% remained unresolved at the end of the financial year.

The findings of a report prepared by Excellence Enablers Pvt Ltd, a corporate governance advisory firm founded by former SEBI Chair M Damodaran, raise serious questions about transparency, accountability and effectiveness of corporate governance mechanisms in India Inc.

While India's corporate governance framework may look impressive in annual reports, board presentations and regulatory filings, a closer examination of disclosures by leading listed companies reveals major gaps between compliance on paper and accountability in practice.

The seventh edition of the Annual Corporate Governance Survey of Nifty 100 companies raises questions on board oversight, functioning of independent directors, whistleblower mechanisms and accountability of corporate managements. The most disturbing findings relate to whistleblower complaints, a critical mechanism through which employees and other stakeholders can flag financial irregularities, misconduct and governance failures without fear of retaliation. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Pvt electricity distributors: Centre wants more players, but Haryana doesn't

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, November 2



Mumbai is the only state with parallel electricity distribution licensing. REUTERS

ON OCTOBER 19, Haryana's power regulator approved the entry of a private electricity distributor in Gurugram and Nuh districts, in a move that was expected to give greater choice to consumers. On October 28, however, it decided "not to proceed further" with rolling out a parallel distribution licence to Eleven Power Pvt. Ltd.

The decision, taken on the directions of the Haryana government, came after opposition from both of Haryana's state-owned power distribution companies (or discoms), which raised concerns about the potential impact of parallel licensing on their finances.

What is notable is that the decision comes at a time when the Union government, also led by the BJP, is pushing for a framework that allows multiple electricity distribution licensees to operate in the same area. As per the Centre, this will expand consumer choice, improve service quality and enable more efficient use of distribution infrastructure. Both the Draft National Electricity Policy, 2026, and the Draft Electricity (Amendment) Bill, 2025, retain provisions for parallel licensing. The only such arrangement in India exists in Mumbai as of now.

The state government, invoking Section 108(1) of Electricity Act, explicitly told the Haryana Electricity Regulatory Commission (HERC) to not create or operationalise any parallel distribution licence in Haryana.

Under Section 108, a state electricity regulator must consider and follow written directions issued by the state government on policy matters that involve public interest.

Indeed, Haryana government's written direction cited concerns over consumer and public interest, financial implications for state revenues and existing state-owned distribution utilities, and public and employee agitations. The government said it was "gravely concerned" about the impact of licence on consumers and public interest, adding that the decision was a "complete deviation" from the state's existing policy. However, the government maintained that it was not examining the correctness of HERC's findings in its order granting the licence. Had the license granted to the private company, Eleven Power, taken effect, it would have marked the second instance of parallel electricity distribution licensing in India outside Mumbai, where Tata Power Company Ltd, Brihanmumbai Electric Supply and Transport Undertaking and Adani Electricity Mumbai Ltd (formerly Reliance Infrastructure) operate as distribution licensees in overlapping areas of the city.

While parallel distribution licensing remains rare in India, the Centre has been pushing for a framework to expand its adoption. In July, Consultative Committee of the Ministry of Power, chaired by Union Power Minister Manohar Lal, deliberated on a proposed framework aimed at promoting consumer choice, improving service quality and ensuring more efficient utilisation of electricity distribution infrastructure.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

RajCOMP Info Services Limited (RISL)
C-Block, 1st Floor, Yojana Bhawan, Tilak Marg, C-Scheme, Jaipur

RISL invites e-bids from the eligible bidders for the following:

NIB No./ Date/ Unique bid no.	Particulars	Estimated Cost/EMD	Start of sale / Last date
25240356/ 30-10-2026 (RIS2627SLOB 00066)	RFP for Selection of System Integrator (SI) for Establishment and Operation of Rajasthan Sampark – CM Helpline 181 Call Center, including Upgradation and Maintenance of 181 Call Center Licenses for the Government of Rajasthan.	Rs.190 Cr/ Rs. 3.80 Cr	30.10.2026 08.12.2026

Details can be seen on the websites **http://risl.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, http://doitc.rajasthan.gov.in.** Bids are to be submitted through **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in.**
Raj.Samwad/C/26/12752 ACP (Dy. Director)

उदयपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, राजस्थान
No. :- F-2(01)Acct/Contract/2026-27/217 - 219 Date :- 30/10/2026
ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या : 60/2026-27

उदयपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, उदयपुर द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्यो मय डिफेक्ट लाईबिलिटी अवधि के लिये जो कि निविदा प्रपत्र में अंकित है के लिये उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदको से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई–टेण्डरिंग के माध्यम से ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है :–

निविदा कार्यों की कुल लागत	: रूपये 160.00 लाख (01 कार्य)
ऑनलाईन निविदा प्रपत्र डाउनलोड / अपलोड करने की अवधि	: 31.10.2026 को प्रातः 10.00 बजे से 23.11.2026 को सायः 6.00 बजे तक
Online EMD, Tender Fee & Processing Fee जमा कराने की तिथी	: 31.10.2026 को प्रातः 10.00 बजे से 23.11.2026 को सायः 6.00 बजे तक
ऑनलाईन निविदा खोलने की तिथी	: 25.11.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे

विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाईट **urban.rajasthan.gov.in/uitudaipur, www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** व **www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in** पर देखा जा सकता है।
UBN No. : ITU2627SLOB00372
अधिशाषी अभियन्ता - द्वितीय
उदयपुर विकास प्राधिकरण
हज.संवाद/डी/26/12759

Gujarat Sports Infrastructure Development Company Limited (GSID)
Place : GSID, Administrative Building, Sector-13/B, KH-3 Circle, Near Vavol Railway Crossing, Near EVM Ware House Office, Gandhinagar - 382016.

Tenders are invited by Gujarat Sports Infrastructure Development Company Limited (GSID) for 2 tender documents namely **"The Appointment of Project Management Consultancy (PMC) for Development of Karai Sports Academy" and for "Appointment of Project Management Consultancy (PMC) for Development of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Sports Enclave (Package 1 – Aquatics Arena & Site Infrastructure)"**. Last date for submission of Pre-bid queries is **Date : 08.11.2026, up to 18:00 hrs**. via email on **office.gsid@gmail.com** & last date for submission of bids along with Tender Fees and EMD by **07.12.2026 up to 17:00 hrs.**
The tender documents will be available on **02.11.2026** on the nProcure Portal.
General Manager - Planning & Coordination, GSID
Date : 03.11.2026

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
PHULBANI (R&B) CIRCLE, PHULBANI
Email:sernbphulbani@gmail.com
34001/1086/2627
Letter No. 2250 Dated. 29/10/2026

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)
Bid Identification No. CCE R and B_PLB_07 of 2026_27

1	The Chief Construction Engineer, Phulbani (R& B) Circle, Phulbani on behalf of the Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bid in double cover system in ONLINE MODE for construction of the Building works as detailed in the table below from eligible contractors.		
2	Nature of work	:-	Building works
3	No. of tenders	:-	Two Nos.
4	Tender cost	:-	Rs. 10,000/- (through online) only.
5	Class of Contractor	:-	B and A Class
6	Date & Time of sale & receipt of bids	:-	10.00 AM of dtd.05.11.2026 to 5.00PM of dtd. 19.11.2026
7	Date of Opening of bid	:-	11.00 AM of 20.11.2026
8	The Bidders shall have to participate in online bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website **https://tendersodisha.gov.in**. Any addendum/Corrigendum / Cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website. The authority reserves the right to reject any or all bids without assigning any reason.		

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer,
Phulbani (R&B) Circle, Phulbani
OIPR-34001/34129/1/26-27/0008

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, SUNDARAGADA
25001/1431/2627 AT/PO-SANKARA, SUNDARGARH-770020, E-mail address-serw_sundargarh@yahoo.com
No. Tender Online - RWCCESNG – 36 of 2026-27, Letter No- 6066 Dtd. 29.10.2026

e-Procurement NOTICE

1. **Type of the Work** : Roads (MMSY)
2. **Class of Contractor** : As specified in the column-6 of the Annexure
3. **Time of Completion** : As specified in the column-5 of the Annexure
4. **Details Projects** : As per Annexure attached
5. **Estimated Cost** : As specified in the column-4 of the Annexure
6. **Other details:**

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender on-line for bidding From	To	Last Date & Time of seeking tender clarification	Date & Time of opening of tender Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Sundaragada	RWCCESNG36 of 2026-27	04.11.2026 11:00 AM	19.11.2026 5:00 PM	18.11.2026 5:00 PM	20.11.2026 11:00 AM	Will be intimated separately

Further details can be seen from the website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**
Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Rural Works Circle, Sundaragada
OIPR-25001/25133/1/26-27/0054

FORM NO. CAA. 2
[Pursuant to Section 230(3) and Rules 6 and 7]
Company Application No. CA(CAA) 67/CHE/2026
In the matter of:
Evoqua Water Technologies India Private Limited
...Applicant/ Transferor Company
Xylem Water Solutions India Private Limited
...Non-Applicant/ Transferee Company
NOTICE AND ADVERTISEMENT OF NOTICE OF MEETING OF UNSECURED CREDITORS OF APPLICANT/ TRANSFEROR COMPANY

Notice is hereby given that by an Order dated 16 October 2026 (hereafter referred as the "Order"), in the above Company Application No. CA(CAA) 67/CHE/2026, the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal, Chennai Bench (hereafter referred to as the "Hon'ble Tribunal") has directed that a meeting of the Unsecured Creditors of Evoqua Water Technologies India Private Limited ("Transferor Company") be convened and held through videoconferencing, on 04 December 2026 at 11:00 AM, for the purpose of considering and if thought fit, approving the Scheme of Amalgamation between the Applicant/ Transferor Company, Xylem Water Solutions India Private Limited ("Transferee Company") and their respective shareholders and creditors ("Scheme").
In pursuance of the said Order and as directed therein, notice is hereby given that the meeting of the Unsecured Creditors of the Transferor Company (as on 27 June 2026) will be held on 04 December 2026 at 11:00 AM, at which time the Unsecured Creditors are requested to attend the meeting through videoconferencing with the facility of remote e-voting.
The facility of remote e-voting will be available during the prescribed time period before the meeting, by logging on to https://www.evoting.nsdl.com/. Accordingly, Unsecured Creditors can vote through remote electronic means (without attending the meeting) instead of voting during the Unsecured Creditors' meeting. The schedule for remote e-voting will be as per the following details:

Commencement of remote e-voting	01 December 2026 at 09:00 AM
End of remote e-voting	03 December 2026 at 05:00 PM

** Voting will also be available to the Unsecured Creditors during the Meeting of Unsecured Creditors of the Transferor Company on 04 December 2026 from 11:00 AM till the conclusion of the Meeting.*
The Unsecured Creditors shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting and will be entitled to attend and vote in the meeting through videoconferencing. The instructions for attending the meeting through videoconferencing, and to vote through remote e-voting, are provided in the Notice of Meeting. The Notice of Meeting with accompanying documents is being sent to the Unsecured Creditors of the Transferor Company as directed by the Hon'ble Tribunal, through electronic mode, to those Unsecured Creditors whose email IDs are registered with the Transferor Company, and through registered post/ speed post/ courier to the other Unsecured Creditors at their registered or last known addresses available with the Transferee Company. Unsecured Creditors whose email IDs are not registered with the Transferor Company can have the same registered by sending a request to Ms Pinky Shah at pinky.shah@xylem.com. Copies of the Scheme, the Order, the Notice, the Explanatory Statement and the form of proxy can be obtained free of charge at the Registered Office of the Transferor Company, DLF IT SEZ Park, Block 2, 10th Floor, No 1/124, Mount Poonamallee Road, Nandambakkam Kudiyiruppu, Kanchipuram, Saidapet – 600089, Tamil Nadu, India between Monday to Friday between 10:00 AM to 05:00 PM, up to the date of the Meeting or by email to Ms Pinky Shah at pinky.shah@xylem.com, and in case of no response, can contact the Chairperson, Mr. Arvind Devnathan, at arvind@daa-india.com.
Persons entitled to attend and vote at the meeting may vote by remote e-voting or e-voting during the meeting or by proxy provided that all proxies in prescribed form are deposited at the registered office of the company not later than 48 hours before the meeting.
The Hon'ble Tribunal has appointed Mr. Arvind Devnathan, Former Technical Member, National Company Law Tribunal, to be the Chairperson and Mr. V. Sriram Ananth to be the Scrutinizer of the aforesaid Meeting. The abovementioned Scheme, if approved at the Meeting, will be subject to subsequent approval of the Hon'ble Tribunal.
Dated this 03rd day of November 2026.
Sd/-
Arvind Devnathan, Former Technical Member, NCLT
Chairperson Appointed for the Meeting
Registered Office:
Evoqua Water Technologies India Private Limited
CIN: U41000TN2018FTC126512
DLF IT SEZ Park, Block 2, 10th Floor, No 1/124, Mount Poonamallee Road, Nandambakkam Kudiyiruppu, Kanchipuram, Saidapet – 600089, Tamil Nadu, India

@ieExplained
#ExpressExplained
If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to
explained@indianexpress.com

• WILDLIFE

Why collared Kuno cheetahs cannot be live-tracked

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, November 2

SATELLITE COLLARS fitted on cheetahs are not a live telecast and cannot provide continuous live tracking, Kuno National Park Director Uttam Kumar Sharma has said. The explanation comes as the state government has suspended six forest department officials in connection with the death of KNG22, a male cheetah who was found seriously injured in the Sheopur territorial forest division on October 25 and died during treatment.

How collars work

In his note posted on social media, Sharma sought to explain the limitations of satellite-based wildlife monitoring, saying that a satellite location only provides the geographical position of an animal at a particular point in time. By the time the information reaches the monitoring team and personnel reach the reported location, the animal may have moved several kilometres away.

"Therefore, let us get rid of the misconception that a satellite-collared animal is available for continuous live tracking, like a live television broadcast," Sharma wrote.

At Kuno, monitoring teams track around 15 cheetahs through a combination of satellite collars and radio receivers. Satellite collars provide location information over large and often inaccessible areas, while very high frequency (VHF) equipment is used by field teams to locate animals more precisely on the ground.

• TRACKING TOUGH

- Following a cheetah on foot is extremely difficult. Vehicles cannot move through forests in straight lines, as animals do.
- The actual distance covered by a monitoring vehicle can thus be several times the straight-line distance between two locations.

The collars are generally programmed to transmit location information at six-hour intervals. Sharma said satellite collars are expensive, generally costing around Rs 4-5 lakh each, and the frequency of transmission had to be determined by balancing monitoring requirements, battery life, and the expected duration of collar use.

However, if a scheduled transmission is missed, the gap between two location updates increases. If one update is missed, the gap can increase to 12 hours. If the next one is also missed, it can extend to 18 hours.

A temporary loss of satellite signal, he said, was not an unusual occurrence and could happen for several reasons. Dense forest canopy can interfere with the collar's ability to obtain an accurate GPS location, while rocky terrain, caves and deep valleys may obstruct satellite visibility.

Kuno's difficult terrain

Sharma said the limitations of satellite tracking were particularly significant at Kuno because of the extensive movement of cheetahs across the landscape.

Cheetahs are highly mobile animals and move an average of 6-8 kilometres a day. On many occasions, they cover 12-15 kilometres or even more, with their movements often concentrated during the early morning and late evening hours.

This means that by the time a monitoring team reaches the last reported satellite location, the animal may have moved several kilometres away and could have gone outside the team's VHF radio range.



• GLOBAL

US midterms & the Trump economy

The US economy is growing fast and stock markets are booming. Why, then, is cost of living the major issue? Inflation remains the big worry



UDIT MISRA

ON NOVEMBER 3, US voters will deliver their verdict on the performance of the second Trump administration and the Republican lawmakers in the US Congress.

Most opinion polls suggest that the results could go against the Republican Party. If so, the result could fundamentally alter the nature and course of the remaining two years of the Donald Trump presidency. In fact, the ramifications will be widespread, given how the Trump Administration's decisions — from slapping punitive tariffs to starting a war with Iran — have affected household budgets across the global economy.

Why do polls suggest a 'blue wave'?

Trump staged a remarkable political comeback when he beat Vice-President Kamala Harris in the 2024 presidential elections. Notwithstanding his checkered past —he is the first president in the US history to be impeached twice, and also the first former president and sitting president to have a criminal conviction on his record — Trump won in a landslide primarily on two big issues. One, he promised to curb and regulate immigration in a way that secures US borders. Two, he promised to address the cost of living crisis.

On immigration, the results of his policies, although controversial, have been effective enough for it to not be the biggest issue in the midterms. The number of migrants and refugees entering the US and the visas provided have fallen sharply, even as detentions and deportations of immigrants have spiked. However, on the economy, the concerns have only flared up. According to most polls, the economy is the single-most important issue on which votes will likely be cast. Trump's approval ratings on this count are at historic lows, and falling.

But isn't the US economy booming?

Yes, in many ways it is.

The US is the world's largest economy and yet, notwithstanding its large base or the many policy disruptions introduced by Trump during his second term, its GDP growth has been reasonably high. (*Chart 1*). When Trump took charge in January 2025, the US GDP was around $29.9 trillion. Since then, barring two quarters, the US GDP has often surprised on the upside and has now reached $33 trillion.

The International Monetary Fund estimates that the US's per capita GDP — GDP divided by population — has grown from $86,400 in 2024 to $95,200 in 2026 — a jump of around $8,800 in the first two years of Trump's second term. In the same period, India's per capita GDP has grown from $2,590 to $2,750, China's from $13,440 to $15,370, and France's from $46,300 to $51,450.

Unsurprisingly, the US stock markets have been skyrocketing. The NASDAQ 100 index, which features the most innovative and biggest non-financial companies, has gone from just over 21,000 to just over 28,000 while the broader S&P 500 index has gone from around 6,000 to the 7,600-mark. Further, fast GDP growth has also ensured that the US continues to have fairly low, and stable, levels of unemployment rate (*Chart 2*).

Then what is the problem?

Even before Trump's second term, the US's economic growth was by itself not the problem.

The US was the only major economy that recovered to its pre-pandemic growth path in the space of one year. In other words, it registered a genuine V-shaped recovery; it grew back to where it would have been without the Covid pandemic. In most other countries, this recovery — to go back to the same trend of absolute GDP — took a much longer time.

The problem in the US was affordability for an average American. That in turn depended on two factors: the rate at which prices went up (read inflation) and the rate at which wages or earnings went up.

Chart 3 shows that since Trump took charge, inflation rate has reversed its trajectory; it was 2.4% when Trump took charge but has not come back to that level since. At last count, it was at 3.7% — almost double of the US central bank target of 2%.

What's most damaging is that the main reasons for this spike in inflation rate are Trump's policy choices; first it was tariffs (which are a tax on US consumers) and then the war in Iran, which further spiked fuel prices. Since the Iran war, retail fuel prices have gone by almost 50%.

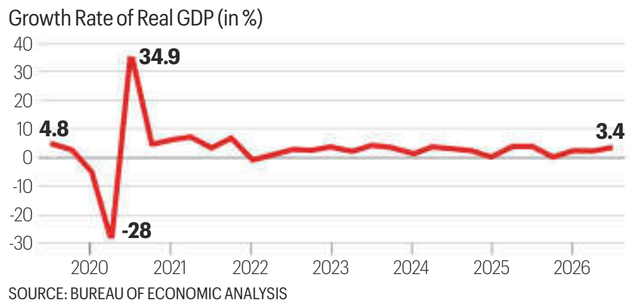
The spike in inflation has been such that it has robbed average US workers of any real earnings growth. *Chart 4* shows the growth rate of earnings of US workers when adjusted for inflation. As the data shows, since the start of March, the growth rate of real earnings has turned negative every month.

Further, the government's own debts have continued to grow to alarming levels, leading to investors demanding higher interest rates for lending money. That has made loans costlier for the average American. In other words, things are costlier to buy with cash in their pockets. In real terms, most Americans are worse off than a year ago.

This explains the anger that many opinion polls are capturing, notwithstanding a fast-growing economy and a booming stock market.

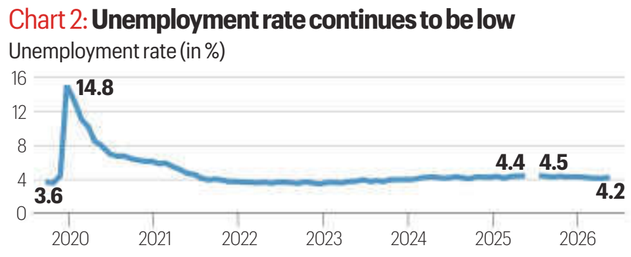
Worsening affordability

Chart 1: **Overall economy is growing rapidly**



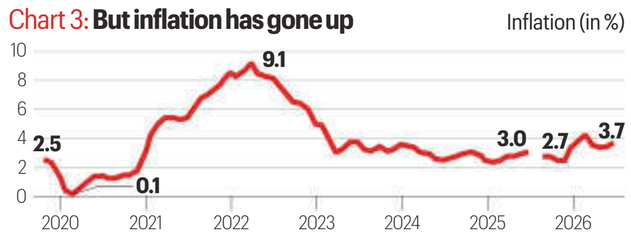
SOURCE: BUREAU OF ECONOMIC ANALYSIS

Chart 2: **Unemployment rate continues to be low**



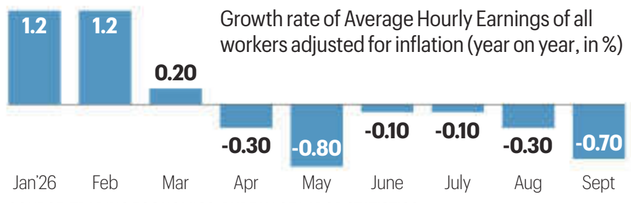
SOURCE: FEDERAL RESERVE BANK OF ST. LOUIS

Chart 3: **But inflation has gone up**



SOURCE: BUREAU OF LABOR STATISTICS

Chart 4: **This resulted in real earnings growth contracting**



SOURCE: TRADING ECONOMICS, BUREAU OF LABOR STATISTICS

Trump's claims

Trump has never accepted that his policy choices are hurting American citizens.

•

For months after taking charge, every time he was asked about the worsening economic state, he would blame his predecessor, Joe Biden.

•

In May last year, in an interview to *NBC News*, he even said that "the good parts are the Trump economy and the bad parts are the Biden economy".

Boost or barrier to the President: What midterms can deliver



ARAV SHAH & ANAGHA JAYAKUMAR

THE US is going to midterms, the polls that will determine the balance of power in the American national legislature, state governorships, and thousands of local offices for the remainder of the second Donald Trump presidency.

The midterms will see Americans elect all 435 members of the House of Representatives, 35 Senators, including two in special elections, and Governors in 36 states. The Senate and the House of Representatives together make up the US Congress.

Republicans currently control both Houses, although their majority in the House of Representatives is narrow. Both chambers must approve legislation before it can be sent to the President to be signed into law. The President has the power to veto legislation.

The midterms will also provide evidence of how voters are responding to the administration midway through its term, although state and local factors will shape individual races.

US Congress

The lower chamber, the House of Representatives, comprises 435 voting members who each serve two-year terms. The upper chamber, the Senate, comprises 100 members who each serve six-year terms, with roughly one-third of the Senate elected every two years.

Each state's representation in the House is proportional to the state's population, whereas every state gets two Senators irrespective of its population.

Bills concerning taxation and government revenue must originate in the House of Representatives, although the Senate can amend them. The Senate alone has the power to confirm presidential appointments, including Cabinet members and federal judges, and approve treaties by a two-thirds majority. The House of Representatives can impeach federal officials, including the President, while the Senate conducts impeachment trials and decides whether to remove them from office.

Why midterms matter for US

In the Senate, Republicans hold a 53-47 advantage. Democrats require a net gain of four seats to flip the chamber, navigating difficult toss-up races in states like Texas, Maine, Ohio, and Alaska. In the House of Representatives, the Republican majority is fragile, and generic ballot polling suggests Democrats possess a tangible path to reclaiming control.

Democrats are widely expected to win control of the House. A Democrat-majority House would give the party a greater say in government spending decisions, while empowering them to stall legislation championed by the Republican Party, launch investigations into the administration and subject senior officials to congressional scrutiny.

When the Democrats flipped the House during the 2018 midterms, House committees launched investigations into Donald Trump's businesses, his handling of the Russia investigations, and voted twice to impeach Trump.

• Anatomy of the US midterm elections

- The president is elected through the Electoral College. Most states award all their electoral votes to the statewide winner, making close states crucial.
- In the midterms, voters elect members of Congress and Governors. A state may elect a President from one party but choose a Governor or Senator from another party.

What's at stake on November 3?

435	35	36
House seats	Senate seats	Governorships

SENATE MAJORITY: Republicans hold 53 seats. Democrats and two allied independents hold 47. Democrats need a net gain of four seats for control.

How the US battleground map changes in the midterms

2024 presidential election:
Seven major swing states
● Arizona ● Georgia ● Michigan
● Nevada ● North Carolina
● Pennsylvania ● Wisconsin

2026 midterms: Seven Senate toss-ups
● Alaska ● Iowa ● Kansas ● Maine
● Michigan ● Ohio ● Texas

SOURCE: COOK POLITICAL REPORT, OCTOBER 2026 RACE RATINGS.

Trump has said if Democrats control Congress, he would "probably become Mr. Veto", though he could "make deals at some point". A Democratic majority in the Senate could block or delay many of Trump's major political appointments and force negotiations with the White House over legislation. However, wresting control of the Senate, despite the Republicans' wafer-thin majority, still appears to be an uphill climb.

Why they matter for India

For India, the midterms are significant on two fronts: tariff implementation and immigration rules.

TARIFFS: Over the past year, Trump has repeatedly changed tariffs on Indian goods. In September, Congress passed legislation authorising tariffs of up to 100% on major buyers of Russian oil, affecting India. Trump subsequently waived these provisions in October. It illustrates Congress's power to legislate on trade, but also the considerable discretion it grants the President to implement or suspend tariffs.

If Republicans retain control of Congress, Trump will face fewer obstacles in advancing his trade agenda, while a Democratic majority in either chamber could block new legislation and investigate existing measures, though reversing them would be difficult owing to his veto power.

IMMIGRATION: The Trump administration has tightened H-1B visa rules, including extending a $100,000 payment requirement for certain new petitions until September 2027. Congress is also considering legislation to raise wage thresholds for H-1B-dependent employers. These measures have implications for Indian professionals and IT companies.

If Republicans retain both chambers, they could advance such restrictions through legislation. A Democratic majority in either chamber could block these Bills or demand greater scrutiny. But it would not overturn Trump's executive orders.

• ECONOMY

Grey market and IPO booms: What retail investors need to watch out for

George Mathew
Mumbai, November 2

BOOMING PRIMARY markets at times attract unscrupulous elements seeking to take advantage of the euphoria. In India, an unofficial IPO market is gaining traction as public offers — big and small — line up to raise funds from investors. Such a grey market takes advantage of regulatory gaps and operates beyond the reach of established regulatory mechanisms, according to market stakeholders.

In the grey market, shares of companies that are yet to list are traded. These markets are operated by players in Ahmedabad, Jaipur and Rajkot, according to sources in the official stock exchanges. The premium at which these pre-IPO shares trade, that is, the grey market premium (GMP), becomes an unofficial indicator of the premium at which IPO shares are purportedly expected to trade. Market stakeholders, who did not wish to be named, said even fund managers of mutual funds take a cue from these GMPs.

Genuine investors worry about such practices and equate it with illegal "betting activity in cricket matches" and a "parallel black economy". With a vibrant primary market, the scale of such unofficial speculative activity has risen, with IPO applications being 'trafficked' and premiums getting inflated. This, at times, encourages retail investors to mistake market hype for genuine demand, market players said.

In an October 21 representation to the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi), the Small Investors Welfare Association (SIREN) has called for immediate regulatory intervention, arguing that the widespread publicity surrounding unofficial premiums and application transactions raises serious questions about market integrity and the effectiveness of existing safeguards.

"What was previously a covert activity is now conducted in broad daylight across WhatsApp, Telegram groups and public tracking portals and others. This open black market makes a mockery of Sebi's mandate to maintain a fair, transparent and orderly market," said Arun Goenka, founder president, SIREN.

Sebi did not respond to queries from *The Indian Express* on the thriving illegal grey market. Market players said the government and the regulator are aware of the grey market. "It is an illegal activity just like gambling or betting. Is it for Sebi to act or the state police or other law enforcement agencies? It is a question for all," said a stakeholder who did not wish to be named.

Parallel market in the shadow of regulation

The grey market operates outside recognised stock exchanges, with transactions typically taking place through informal arrangements between buyers and sellers. GMP figures are neither official exchange prices nor guaranteed indicators of the eventual listing price, but they do influence investor sentiment, said market players.

A high premium can create expectations of substantial listing gains, encouraging investors to subscribe to an IPO without adequately examining the company's valuation, financial performance, business risks or prospects.

Retail investors who rely on such illegal markets to make investment decisions do so at their own risk, said a market player. But the promise of high gains continues to be a pull and unsophisticated investors get lured. Some take loans and some commit their hard-earned savings to invest. "When unofficial numbers are widely circulated, investors may interpret them as evidence of strong demand even though they do not necessarily reflect verified orders or actual subscription figures," the association said.

How does the grey market operate?

It operates by word of mouth. There's no paperwork or online activity. An investor buys one share of XYZ with an issue price of Rs 1,000 at a premium of Rs 300. After listing, if the share is quoted at Rs 1,400, he gets a profit of Rs 100 from the seller. On the other hand, if the share lists at a discount of Rs 1,200, he will lose money and pay Rs 100 to the seller. "Only the difference is paid. There's no transfer of shares or possession of shares. It's like betting in cricket matches. This is unofficial and illegal... and there's no legal sanctity," said an investor.

Small investors could pay the price

SIREN has drawn parallels with the frenzy surrounding the Reliance Power IPO years ago, warning that expectations of spectacular listing gains can leave retail investors exposed when market reality fails to match the hype.

Reliance Power shares were trading at huge premium pre-listing, but the stock crashed upon listing, going almost Rs 100 below the offer price of Rs 450 per share (Rs 400 for retail investors after Rs 50 discount).

This showed that an IPO is not a guaranteed route to listing gains. Nor does a high grey market premium establish that a share is worth the price investors expect to receive after listing. For smaller investors, the consequences of confusing speculation with reliable information can be particularly severe.

Can SEBI leave the questions unanswered?

SIREN has urged Sebi to choose between two broad approaches: enforce the law decisively against unlawful activity or examine whether a transparent, regulated mechanism could accommodate legitimate pre-listing entitlement transactions.

Under its enforcement proposal, the association has called for action against operators involved in illegal transactions, scrutiny of platforms publishing unofficial rates and investigation of financial channels allegedly used for such activity. Market players are not sure if Sebi is the right agency to wield its stick on such an illegal market.

The other alternative is to examine if certain transactions could be formalised through recognised market infrastructure, subject to appropriate safeguards. Such a proposal would require careful legal and policy examination; it does not mean that all grey market activity can automatically be treated as illegal or that formalisation would eliminate manipulation.

The central issue is not whether every unofficial premium is fraudulent. It is whether unlawful trading, deceptive promotion or manipulation is taking place and whether the authorities have adequate tools to detect and deter it.

"Sebi's position on the legality of different forms of grey market activity, the scope of its surveillance and enforcement efforts, and the possibility of investor advisories is therefore important. A response would help distinguish permissible conduct from potentially actionable violations," said a market observer.

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,NIKHIL GERARD,S/O-PHILIP PUTHIYEDATHU CHALIL,R/O-FLAT NO-I=1103,10TH FLOOR EMPEROR-1,SUPERTECH EMERALD COURT SECTOR-93A,NOIDA GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR,UTTAR PRADESH-201301,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME,FROM NIKHIL GERARD TO.NIKHIL GERARD CHALIL,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES
0040886919-7

I,Sumanter Sharma S/O Jamna Sharma R/O A-111/6,Baba Colony,Burari, Delhi-110084,have changed my name to Sumant Sharma.
0040886928-1

I Pooja Bhirappa Unchaonkar W/o Vittal L Sambrekar R/o # 4691/54, Koli Galli, VTC-Belgaum, PO- Belgaum, Dist-Belgaum, Karnataka - 590001, have changed my name to Pooja Vittal Sambrekar
0071069347-1

I,PARDEEP KUMAR MUKHI S/O VASU DEV MUKHI RESIDENT MUKHI HOSPITAL AND NURSING HOME,AMBALA ROAD,SONIPAT,HARYANA HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PARDEEP MUKHI. 0040886911-9

I,Anoop Kumar,S/o-Gauri Shankar Dubey,R/o-Plot No.-33, Sector-15,Vasundhara, Ghaziabad,U.P.-201012,have changed my minor daughter's name from,Pihu Dwivedi to Varalika Dwivedi. 0040886913-4

I, Mohammed Aziz Khan S/o Abdul Kha R/o-10, Bichhawali Bangar, Kanpur Dehat have changed my name to Ajij Khan for all purposes. 0071069326-1

I,RETNA R NAIR,W/o Sh.RADHA KRISHNAN NAIR,R/o PG-25,POSSANGIPUR, JANAK PURI,NEW DELHI-110058,inform that RETNA R NAIR and RETNAMMA,both names are same person. 0040886911-2

I,hitherto known as,PRACHI,D/O-SHRI VINOD KUMAR,,R/O.K-1448/1449,JAHANGIR PURI,NORTH WEST DELHI,DELHI-110033,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as PRACHI KUMARI. 0040886919-9

I SHEETAL KUMARI D/o SI VIJAY KUMAR and R/o F-159,VILLAGE KONDLI,VASUNDHRA ENCLAVE S.O.,EAST DELHI,DELHI-110096, have changed my name to SHEETAL DTD 03.11.2026
0040886816-1

I, Rajni Bala W/O Lalit Mohan Sharma R/O G-9/30, 2nd Floor, Sector-16, Rohini, Delhi-110089, have Changed my name to Rajni Sharma. I hereby confirm that Rajni Bala and Rajni Sharma are one and same person for all purposes.
0040886926-1

I, Ankit Vishwa R/O of 4/p-112 Bihari Colony Shahdara, declare that my late father name is wrongly recorded as Gyainder Kumar in my MCD Birth Certificate. Correct name is Gyanender Kumar Vishwa, vide affidavit dated 31.10.26 Notary Karan Singh Kardam
0050300722-1

I, Brijesh Kumar S/o Alakhnandan Sharma R/o Flat No B-202, Thiruvizha CGHS Ltd,Plot No 37, Sector 10, Dwarka New Delhi-110075 have changed my name to Brijesh Kumar Sharma 0071069399-1

I,VEENA AGGARWAL W/o Gian Parkash Aggarwal R/o-E-873 Saraswati Vihar Pitampura Delhi-110034,have changed my name to VEENA DEVI
0040886919-2

I sakeena khatoon,W/o-Md Kayoom R/o House No-47,Gali No-14, Valmiki Mohalla,Tughlakabad Village,Badarpur,South Delhi-110044 Have changed my name to SAQEENA KHATOON.
0040886913-6

I, Mohammad Yosuf S/o Birsu Khan R/o-433, Nahal, Ghaziabad, UP have changed my name to Mohd Yusuf.
0071069332-1

I,Arvind S/o Karan Singh,R/O 304,Ward.No-2,Near Sheetla Mata Mandir,12 Biswa,Gurugram, Haryana-122001,inform that Arvind and Arvind Kumar,both names are same person. 0040886911-4

I Harish Sachdeva alias Harish Chander S/o Chuni Lal, Address E/12 First floor, G.K.3, Greater Kailash, South Delhi-110048, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Harish Sachdeva. 0040886806-2

I hitherto known as Kamini alias Kavya, D/O, Harish Kumar, R/O, H. No. 4153, Gali No. 12,Ajeet Nagar, Gandhi Nagar, East Delhi 110031 Have Changed My Name and shall hereafter be known as Kavya. 0040886926-3

I,Smt.Ganga Dei,W/o-Gangaram,R/o-K-120,Main Road Gali-No.36, Rajapuri, Uttam Nagar,New Delhi-110059,have changed my name from Ganga Dei to Gayadei,for all future purposes.Ganga Dei and Gayadei is one and the same person. 0040886919-4

I,MUKILA,Wife of MOHD ISLAM,R/o-H NO-E-2796,GALI NO-23,RAJIV GANDHI NAGAR,MUSTAFABAD,NORTH EAST, DELHI-110094,I have changed my name to MUKILA BEGAM for all purposes.
0040886913-2

I, Jasbir Kaur W/o Baljinder Singh R/o-1871/15, Govind Puri Extn., Kalkaji, Delhi-19 have changed my name to Jasbeer Kaur. 0071069343-1

I,RAJBIR SINGH YADAV,hereby inform that my wife's name has been wrongly recorded as"GITA DEVI YADAV"instead of "GEETA YADAV"in,my Army Record,of Service.Both names refer to one and the same person as declared vide Affidavit,dated-02.11.2026.
0040886913-8

I Sukhvinder Nagi S/o Surjeet Singh R/o 144 Chand Nagar, Tilak Nagar, West Delhi, Delhi - 110018, have changed my name to Sukhvinder Singh
0071069335-1

I,KM PRIYANKA AGARWAL,D/O-SHAIL AGGARWAL,R/O.B-503,ADITYA MEGA CITY,VAIBHAV KHAND,INDIRAPURAM,GHAZIABAD,U.P.201014,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO,PRIYANKA AGGARWAL FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES 0040886911-6

I,MOODI BEGUM,Wife of MOHD YUNUS,R/o-H.NO-574,GALI NO-6,OLD MUSTAFABAD,NORTH EAST,DELHI-110094, I have changed my name to MEHMUDDAN for all purposes.
0040886913-1

I, Shaina W/o Anmol Goswami R/o 1598/21, Adarsh Nagar, Rohtak, Haryana -124001, have changed my name to Shaina Sharma permanently.
0040886822-1

I NIZAMUDDIN GOURI S/O IMAMUDDIN R/O Q-155 MOHAN GARDEN UTTAM NAGAR,DELHI-110059 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO NIZAMUDDIN FOR FUTURE. 0040886931-2

I, Avinash Yadav, R/o E -1401 JM Aroma, Sector 75, Noida, UP - 20130. Have changed the name of my minor daughter from Aashi Avinash Yadav to Aashi Yadav for all purposes.
0130070943-1

I hitherto known as,PUSHPA DEVI,W/O-SATPAL,R/O.J-32,J Block, New Seelampur,Garhi Mendu,North East Delhi,Delhi-110053,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as NITA DEVI. 0040886919-6

I,SUNITA RAHEJA,W/O-LATE BASANT KUMAR RAHEJA,R/o-H.NO.1,ENGINEERS ENCLAVE,PITAMPURA,DELHI-110034,declare that SUNITA RAHEJA,and SONITA BASANT KUMAR RAHEJA is one and same person. 0040886913-10

I Khurshida Begam Shanoor Khan W/o Hasantaj Shaikbade R/o # 107, Gouthan, Dandeli (Rural), Uttara Kannada, Karnataka- 581325, have changed my name to Khurshida Begam Hasantaj Shaikbade 0071069344-1

I, Tina D/o Jile Singh R/o K-73, Jhangir Puri, North West Delhi, Delhi-110033,have changed my name to Tina Singh all-purposes.
0040886911-8

I, ANUBHAV S/o SUKHBIR RATHI, aged 22 years, residing at 33A STREET - 2, VINOBA ENCLAVE, JHARODA KALAN, NEW DELHI - 110072, have changed my name from ANUBHAV to ANUBHAV RATHI.
0071069273-1

I,Gurpreet Singh,S/o-Harbinder Singh,R/o-144,Arjun Nagar, Safdarjung Enclave,Vasant Vihar,South-West,Delhi-110029,have changed the name of my minor Son,Kabeer Singh alias Kabeer,aged 12 years to Kabir Singh.
0040886913-3

I, Firoj Khan S/o Ajij Khan R/o-S172, Uppals Southend, Sec-49, Gurgaon have changed my name to Abeer G Kumar for all future purposes. 0071069320-1

I,Satyam,S/O-Om Prakash R/o SF2, plot 258, gyan khand 1, indirapuram ghaziabad. have changed My Name To Satyam Sharma permanently.
0040886911-1

I,NEETU KUMARI,W/O-GHANSHYAM KUMAR JHA,R/O-HOUSE NO-1569,GROUND FLOOR SECTOR-5 VASUNDHRA, GHAZIABAD,UTTAR PRADESH-201012.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM NEETU KUMARI TO,NEETU JHA,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040886919-8

I, Priyanka Gogne Mudgal W/o Sreedhar Mudgal R/o Flat No.1765, Valencia Tower, Mahagun Mascot, Crossing Republik, Ghaziabad, UP-201016 have changed my name from PRIYANKA Alias PRIYANKA GOGNE Alias PRIYANKA GOGNE to PRIYANKA GOGNE MUDGAL for all future purposes. 0040886804-1

I, GULSHAMA BANO W/O MUJTABA HASAN, VILL-SOHANCHIDA MUST, PAHARPUR, SAHARANPUR, UP, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO GULSHAMA. 0071069348-1

I,SABA SUHEL,W/O-SUHEL ISLAM,R/O-18 PARK END COLONY VIKAS MARG DELHI-110092 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SABA ISLAM FOR ALL PURPOSES. 0040886919-1

I, FOZIYA H REHMAN ANSARI, R/o House No. D-34, Gali No.9, Village Wazirabad, Delhi-110084, declare that my name is wrongly mentioned as "FOZIYA H REHMAN" in my son's school records. My correct name is "FOZIYA H REHMAN ANSARI". Both names belong to one and the same person. 0040886805-2

I, Anmol S/o Yashpal R/o 1598/30, Adarsh Nagar, Rohtak, Haryana -124001, have changed my name to Anmol Goswami permanently.
0040886822-2

I, POOJA D/o Suresh Singh,R/o Karauli Bangar, Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP-203209,have changed my name to KM POOJA. 0040886911-7

I,MOHD KAYOOM,S/O-Md Haseeb,R/o-House No-47,Gali No-14,Valmiki Mohalla, Tughlakabad Village,Badarpur,South Delhi-110044,Have changed my name to Md Kayoom. 0040886913-5

I Anita Gujjar Alias Anita Goojar Alias Anita Bhati Alias Savita D/o Prem Singh and W/o Videsh Kumar Bhati R/o H No- 2, Street No- 1 Block - A, Nehur Vihar, Delhi- 110094, have changed my name to Savita Bhati
0071069329-1

I,HARSH,S/o-SHRI.PYARE LAL,R/O-205,T HUTS,KABIR-NAGAR,RANA PRATAP BAGH,DELHI-110007,inform that in my 10th and 12th marksheet documents my father name PYARAY LAL and mother name VIMALESH wrongly-written.My father correct name PYARE LAL and my mother name VIMLESH, amendment accordingly in my 10th and 12th documents.
0040886911-3

I, Sammeer Jaain S/o Vijay Kumar Jain R/o 3866, Gali Mandi Wali, Pahari Dhiraj, Delhi G.P.O., Delhi G.P.O., North Delhi, Delhi-110006 I have changed the name of my minor Son Aadijay Jaain to Adijay Jain aged 9 years 0071069383-1

I, Chander Prabha Tewai W/O Kanwal Tewari R/O H.No.168, First Floor Phase-1, Ashok Vihar Delhi-110052, have changed my name to Prabha Tewari. 0040886926-2

I,Km Neetu,W/o-Rakesh Kumar,R/o-Villa No-D-235, Paramount Golf Foreste,Sec Surajpur,Site-C,Plot No-BGH-A, UPSIDC Housing,Gautam Buddha Nagar,Uttar Pradesh-201306 have changed my name to Neetu. 0040886919-10

I Virin Miglani alias Virin Kumar S/o Tilak Raj, Address 156-B, Gali no. 2, Govind Puri, Kalkaji, Delhi-110019, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Virin Miglani.
0040886806-1

I, Pradeep Singh, Father of Hunny, R/o WZ-155/9, Madipur Village, New Delhi-110063, hereby declare that my minor child's name has been changed from Hunny to Honey Singh for all purposes and in all official records. 0050300720-1

I,Murslin Ali,S/o-Musharraf Ali,R/o.T-385,Street No.-13, Gautampuri,VTC Seelampur,Delhi-110053,have changed my name from Murslin Ali to Mursalin Ali for all future purposes.
0040886919-3

I,Shabana khan,W/o-Islam khan,H.no-1478,A block gali no-24, Shri Ram colony Rajiv nagar,Delhi-110094,have changed my name to Shabana.
0040886913-7

I Kalpana sood Lal W/o Pramindra Lal R/o B-90, Swasthya Vihar, Shakarpur, East Delhi, Delhi - 110092, have changed my name to Kalpana Sood
0071069334-1

I,SHAHJHA,w/o-FAEEM AHMED,R/o-Rc 720 koyle wali Gali deepak vihar khora colony,Ghaziabad,Uttar-Pradesh-201309,have changed my name to SHAHJAHAN for all future purposes.
0040886911-5

I,GOVIND RAM,S/O-MANGE RAM BANSAL,R/O.26-C 2nd-FLOOR WP-BLOCK,PITAMPURA, DELHI-110034.DECLARE THAT,GOVIND RAM AND GOVIND BANSAL,BOTH ARE SAME AND ONE PERSON. 0040886919-12

I, DIPAK KUMAR SINGH S/o BHUPNESHWAR SINGH R/o HOUSE NO- 19-D, VANDEMATARAM APARTMENTS, DDA FLATS POCKET-2, BEHIND SECTOR-6, DWARKA MARKET, VTC: DWARKA SEC-6, PO: DWARKA SEC-6, DISTRICT: SOUTH WEST DELHI, DELHI -110075 declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as DIPAK SINGH in my minor son DIVYANSH SINGH, aged 17 years in his 10th class educational documents. The actual name of mine is DIPAK KUMAR SINGH 0071069289-1

I,Heena Kauser,W/O-Mohammad Ismail,R/O-H.NO.104/1,kh.no.132, min back portion,4th-floor,west face Village,wazirabad,Delhi-110084,have changed my name to Hina kauser for all purposes
0040886931-1

I, RAGNI D/o KAMESHWAR PRASAD R/o A-78, Gali 7, Panchsheel Colony Pt-2, Faridabad, Haryana-121003 have changed my name to RAGNI GUPTA. 0130070945-1

I,ELEYAS,S/o-Mohd Naeem,R/o.D-1/209,New Kondli,Delhi-110096,have changed my name from ELEYAS to MOHD ELEYAS for all future purposes. 0040886919-5

I hitherto known as Nutan, wife of Shailesh Kumar Singh, residing at Plot Number 103 A, Block B, Babul Vihar, Phase-2, New Delhi, Najafgarh, South-West Delhi, Delhi-110043, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Nutan Singh. 0040886808-1

I SHUBHAM KUMAR GARG S/O-RAKESH KUMAR GARG R/O-H.NO-513-514 F-2 BLOCK SUNDER NAGRI DELHI-110093 have changed my name to SHUBHAM GARG.
0040886913-9

I,RAZIYZ BEGUM W/O NIZAMUDDIN R/O Q-155 MOHAN GARDEN UTTAM NAGAR DELHI-110059 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RAZIA GOURI FOR FUTURE.
0040886931-3

I Gagan S/o Jasvinder Singh R/o T 28/B Railway colony Naya Bazar Delhi 110006.Have changed my name from Gagan to Gagan Singh for all purposes. 0071069371-1

I, RAVIDA KHATUN W/O NOOR ISLAM R/O D1-554 WISHKARMA COLONY JAITPUR EXTN PART 2 BADARPUR DELHI-44 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME NUJHAT BANO TO RAVIDA KHATUN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040883551-2

LOST & FOUND

I, Shri Raman Kapoor s/o late Shri Raj Rishi Kapoor have loss my Original Approved Sanctioned Map Dated 23.02.2015 in respect of Built-up Freehold Residential Property No. 22, Block D, Ministry of Commerce & Industry Co-operative House Building Society Ltd., Pushpanjali Enclave, Pitampura, Delhi-110034. Finder May Contact At 9810166574 0040886805-1

Original DDA FDR RECEIPT-15631 , DATED- 30/03/1981, APPLICATION NO-172560 AND PRIORITY NO- 13054. belonging to Manju Chadha S/D/W/O Late Sh. Satish Kumar Chadha R/o K-14, Kailash Colony , Greater Kailash, Delhi-110048. have been lost. FIR has been Lodged in E- Police Station, Greater Kailash, Delhi vide NCR No.768251/2026 Dated 02/11/2026. Founder infrom at: 9818736466 0071069363-1

I, Shekhar Shankar Aiyar, resident of H-32, 1st Floor, Jangpura Extension, New Delhi, hereby inform that my original ICSE Class X Statement of Marks and Pass Certificate (1987), Index No. T 399/065, issued by CISCE, has been lost. Finder may contact: 9311400214. 0040886928-2

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that I am investigating title of the Property owned by **Shri. Vijay Kumar Sharma**, son of Late Shri P.N. Sharma, resident of Flat No. 403, Aashna Coop. Housing Society Limited. St. Martins Road, Bandra West, Mumbai-400050, Maharashtra, to their property more particularly described in the Schedule hereunder.

All persons having any claim or interest against or to the Property or any part thereof by way of sale, exchange, assignment, mortgage, gift, trust, charge, maintenance, inheritance, possession, lease, tenancy, easement, lien or otherwise are hereby requested to make the same known in writing along with documentary evidence to the undersigned within 14 days from date of publication of this notice, failing which the claim, if any shall be deemed to be waived.

SCHEDULE OF THE PROPERTY

Entire Second Floor with one Servant Quarter with W.C. on the same floor (having access from rear side through spiral staircase), and two Cars Parking space in the Stilt having separate Gate (next to corner gate on front side), as demarcated on site, of the freehold Property bearing No. D-170. Defence Colony, New Delhi-110024, measuring 325 sq. yards, along with 22.5% undivided, indivisible and impartible share of ownership rights in the plot of land underneath.

Shubham Chandra (Advocate)
A-391, Block A, Ground Floor, Defence Colony, New Delhi-110024
Email: shubham83chandra@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

General public is hereby informed that My clients **Satish Kumar** S/o Rajender Singh and **Nisha Choudhary** W/o Satish Kumar R/o A-4/107, DDA Janta Flats, SFS, Paschim Vihar, West Delhi, Delhi-110063, have debarred & disowned her son **Prashant Choudhary** S/o Satish Kumar, severed all relations with him for his misconduct from all their moveable & immovable properties. Anybody transacting any business with him in respect to my clients is doing that in his/her/their own risks.

Abhimanyu Sangwan (Advocate) Ch.No. 315, L.C. Building, Rohini Courts, Delhi.

PUBLIC NOTICE

This Public Notice has been issued by Praveen Rastogi (Advocate), under instructions from and on behalf of my client namely Mrs. Adarsh Sachdeva, wife of Late Mr. Subhash Chander Sachdeva R/o 7/17 South Patel Nagar, Delhi-110008. I hereby inform that Late Mr. Subhash Chander Sachdeva, who was the co-owner of property with Mrs. Adarsh Sachdeva bearing Unit No EFS-B-I-FF-170 situated at Emerald Hills, Ivory Block, Sector-65, Gurgaon, Haryana and measuring 2000 square feet on a 400 sqyd plot passed away on 24 February 2022.

He has not left any registered or un-registered will and is survived by legal heirs Adarsh Sachdeva (Wife), Puja Malhotra (Daughter) and Mukul Sachdeva (Son), who have relinquished their share in the said property through a registered deed in favour of Mrs.Adarsh Sachdeva.

That my client Mrs. Adarsh Sachdeva, wife of Late Mr. Subhash Chander Sachdeva intends to apply for the transfer of the aforementioned property in her own name becoming the sole owner. If any person having any claim or interest in the said property may file his/her claim to the undersigned within 21 days from the date of publication.

Praveen Rastogi (Advocate)
ENRL No. D-244/06
RZ-97, Khushi Ram Park, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059
Mob. No.9810986643

PUBLIC NOTICE

GENERAL PUBLIC IS HEREBY INFORMED THAT MY CLIENT **SH. NARESH KUMAR SHARMA** S/O LATE SH. RAGHUNATH AND **SMT. RAJKUMARI SHARMA** W/O NARESH KUMAR SHARMA BOTH R/O A-920, SHASTRI NAGAR DELHI-52 HAVE SEVERED ALL HIS RELATIONSHIP AND TIES WITH THEIR SON NAMELY **SH. ANUJ SHARMA** AND HIS WIFE **SHEETAL** DUE TO THEIR DUTIES OWING MISBEHAVIOUR AND NEGLECTING THEIR DUTIES OWING TOWARDS MY CLIENTS FROM ALL OF THEIR MOVABLE AND IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES AND EVEN OTHERWISE, THEY ARE RESIDING INDIVIDUALLY SINCE THE INITIAL DAY AFTER THEIR MARRIAGE, HENCE MY CLIENTS DOES NOT HAVE ANY RELATIONSHIP OR CONNECTION WITH THE ABOVE-MENTIONED PERSONS. ANYBODY DEALING WITH THESE TWO PERSONS WILL BE DOING THE SAME COMPLETELY AT HIS/HER/THEIR RISK. RESPONSIBILITIES AND CONSEQUENCES AND MY CLIENTS WILL NOT BE RESPONSIBLE FOR ANY DEED/ACT OF THE ABOVE-MENTIONED PERSONS IN ANY MANNER, WHATSOEVER

Sd/-
SHUBHAM VERMA
Advocate
Enerol. No. D/6527/2019
Off. B-4/47B, Keshav Puram, Delhi-110035

सार्वजनिक सूचना

सर्वसाधारण को इस नोटिस द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि मेरी क्लाइंट श्रीमती सुनीत कुमारी पत्नी श्री अमरजीत यादव निवासी आर जेड 127, वेस्ट कृष्णा विहार, आर्यमान पब्लिक स्कूल, खेरा रोड, नजफगढ़, दिल्ली-10043 की कुछ खेती की जमीन गांव मुंडेला खुर्द में है। उनमें से 4 बीघा 16 बिस्वा जमीन जोकि खसरा नंबर 1 वगैरा //253 मिन (जमीन 13 बीघा 10 बिस्वा में से) गांव मुंडेला खुर्द, दिल्ली की रेवेन्यू एस्टेट को बेचने का एग्रीमेंट राजेश यादव पुत्र श्री कंवर सिंह निवासी 561, नजदीक पंचायत घर, गांव रजोकरी, दिल्ली-110038 के साथ दिनांक 03.11.2023 को हुआ था।

उपरोक्त राजेश यादव ने जमीन की पूरी कीमत समय पर देकर जमीन की सेल डीड अपने नाम करवाने का वायदा किया था, इसी वायदे के आधार पर मेरी क्लाइंट सुनील कुमारी ने जीपीए सेट आदि उसके नाम पर बना कर उसे दे दी थी। परन्तु आज तक राजेश यादव ने पूरी कीमत अदा नहीं की है। अतः अब मेरी क्लाइंट सुनील कुमारी ने नोटिस भेजकर उपरोक्त जमीन का सौदा राजेश यादव से समाप्त कर दिया है व सभी कागजात कैंसिल कर दिए है। उपरोक्त नंबर की जमीन सुनील कुमारी की हैं व राजेश यादव का उस जमीन पर कोई हक नहीं है।

अगर अब से पहले किसी भी व्यक्ति ने उपरोक्त जमीन का कोई सौदा राजेश यादव के साथ किया है तो वह 15 दिन के भीतर सुनील कुमारी के पास अपना दावा लिखित में पेश करें, 15 दिनों के बाद किसी भी दावे पर कोई भी विचार नहीं किया जाएगा।

आज के बाद कोई भी व्यक्ति उपरोक्त नंबर की जमीन के संबंध में राजेश यादव से कोई सौदा नहीं करे अन्यथा वह अपनी हानि का जिम्मेदार होगा।

उमेश यादव, एडवोकेट
चेंबर नंबर 619, द्वारका कोर्ट,
नई दिल्ली 110075,
मोबाइल नंबर 9213124537.

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to notify publically that my client Mrs. Nimmy Massey, D/o Late John Samuel, R/o A-1, Siddharth Apartment Phase-1, Aya Nagar, South Delhi, Delhi 110047 has disowned & debarred her daughters Jennifer Massey Chauhan w/o Nikhil Chauhan r/o house no. 38 Khirki Village, Malviya Nagar and Jasslyn Massey D/o Late Harrision Massey r/o 126 3rd floor, Bagdola village, Sector 8 Dwarka from her all moveable and immoveable properties. They are not under the control of my client therefore my client has severed all legal/ social relations with them. My client will not be responsible for any act, done by them in future.

Salim Alvi (Advocate)
Ch. No. 529, Saket Court, New Delhi-17

सार्वजनिक सूचना

सर्व साधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि मेरी मुवक्किल श्रीमति गीता देवी पत्नी स्व० श्री धर्म दास, उम्र 65 वर्ष, निवासी 6/438, दक्षिण पुरी विस्तार, नई दिल्ली 62 ने अपनी पुत्री श्रीमति सुनीता को अपनी समस्त चल और अचल सम्पत्ति से बेदखल कर दिया है, क्योंकि मेरी मुवक्किल की उपरोक्त पुत्री ने मेरी मुवक्किल को पिछले कुछ वर्षों में लगातार आर्थिक नुकसान और मानसिक प्रताड़नाएं दी हैं जिससे मेरी मुवक्किल को कष्ट का सामना करना पड़ा है। अतः जो कोई भी उनसे किसी प्रकार का व्यवहार, लेन-देन करेगा, वह स्वयं उत्तरदायी होगा। उसके किसी भी अच्छे या बुरे व्यवहार के लिए मेरी मुवक्किल जिम्मेदार नहीं होंगी।

गिरीश करगेती (अधिवक्ता)
चैंबर नं 216 साकेत कोर्ट नई दिल्ली-17

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client Lalita Singh, W/o Lt. Mahendra Singh, R/o Murari Nagar-6, Khurja, Bulandshahr, Uttar Pradesh-203131, has severed all her relations and disowned her Son Aarush Singh from all her movable and immovable properties, due to his abusive behaviour towards my client. My client shall not be responsible for any acts, deeds, transactions or liabilities undertaken by him in the name of my client or on her behalf without her consent.

Mohammad Samad (Advocate)
Ch. No. 685 Saket Court New Delhi-17

सार्वजनिक सूचना

सर्वसाधारण को इस नोटिस द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि मेरी क्लाइंट श्रीमती सुनील कुमारी पत्नी श्री अमरजीत यादव निवासी आर जेड 127, वेस्ट कृष्णा विहार, आर्यमान पब्लिक स्कूल, खेरा रोड, नजफगढ़, दिल्ली-110043 ने खेती की 9 बीघा 3 बिस्वा जमीन जोकि खसरा नंबर 1 वगैरा //252 (5-5), 1 वगैरा //253 मिन वेस्ट (3-18) गांव मुंडेला खुर्द, दिल्ली की रेवेन्यू एस्टेट में स्थित है को खरीदने का एग्रीमेंट टू सेल श्री प्रदीप कुमार पुत्र श्री श्रीओम निवासी मकान नंबर 514, गांव बादली, जिला झज्जर, हरियाणा-124105 व श्री विशाल चाहर पुत्र श्री चांद सिंह चाहर निवासी गांव सिलानी, जिला झज्जर, हरियाणा-124105 से किया था।

अब मेरी क्लाइंट श्रीमती सुनील कुमारी इन्हीं दोनों व्यक्तियों से उपरोक्त जमीन की सेल डीड का रजिस्ट्रेशन संबंधित सब रजिस्ट्रार कार्यालय नजफगढ़ में अपने नाम करवाने जा रही है।

अगर अब से पहले उपरोक्त जमीन के संबंध में किसी भी व्यक्ति का कोई भी सौदा या दावा उपरोक्त व्यक्तियों के साथ या जमीन के बारे में है तो वह इस नोटिस के प्रकाशन के 10 दिन के भीतर, अपना दावा लिखित में मेरी क्लाइंट श्रीमती सुनील कुमारी के पास पेश करें अन्यथा 10 दिनों के बाद कोई भी दावा मान्य नहीं होगा।

उमेश यादव, एडवोकेट
चेंबर नंबर 619, द्वारका कोर्ट,
नई दिल्ली - 110075,
मोबाइल नंबर 9213124537.

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is for general information that I, Ritu Rani D/O Ramchander R/O Mohan Nagar Jhajjar Road, House No. 558/23, Bahadurgarh Po: Bahadurgarh Dist: Jhajjar, Haryana-124507, declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as **RITU** in my Pan Card No. BAYPR4514H. The actual name of mine is **RITU RANI** which may be amended accordingly.

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that my client Smt. Saraswati w/o Sh. Pramod Kumar Ravi R/o 12/60-61, 3rd Floor, Dakshin Puri Ext., Dr Ambedkar Nagar, New Delhi is the co-owner of the said property. Presently, my client is in possession there of alongwith her husband and son Arush Ravi. Said property was purchased jointly by my client and her husband, but the documents were executed in the name of Smt. Chaman Kaur & with mutual consent/understanding, original property documents are in my client's Custody. Whosoever deals with the said property without the consent of my client, does so at one's risk.

Sd/-
KARTAR SINGH
Advocate
Ch.No.: K-67, Near Gate No.2, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that my client **Sh. Jaswant Singh**, S/o Late Puran Singh, R/o H. No. A-403, Street No. 1, Ganesh Nagar-II, Shakarpur, Near Krishna Temple, East Delhi-110 092 has severed all his relations with his daughter in law **Ms. Rachna,** W/o Late Harjeet Singh and her minor son **Rajveer Singh (Duggu)** due to their bad habits. My said client has also disowned and debarred **Ms. Rachana** and **Rajveer Singh (Duggu)** from all of his movable and immovable properties. Anybody dealing with above named **Ms. Rachna** and **Rajveer Singh (Duggu)** will do so at his/her/their own risk and responsibility/ies and my client will not be responsible for any such acts, deed or dealing done by **Ms. Rachna** and **Rajveer Singh (Duggu)**.

Sd/-
LALIT KUMAR
Advocate
Ch.12, Old Lawyer Chambers, Supreme Court of India
Tilak Marg, New Delhi-110001

COURT NOTICE

NOTICE UNDER SECTION 11 OF ACT NO. VIII OF 1890 OF GUARDIAN & WARDS ACT
IN THE COURT OF MS. ANJU BAJAJ CHANDNA, PRINCIPAL DISTRICT & SESSIONS JUDGE (HQ.), DELHI
ROOM NO. 301, 3RD FLOOR, TIS HAZARI COURTS, DELHI 110054
GP-10/2026 (CNR No.DLCT01-010869-2026)

Vandana Bamba
W/o Lt. Sh. Gopal Bamba
R/o 8A/73, Ground floor, W.E.A.
Channa Market, Karol Bagh, Delhi-110005.
.....Petitioner

VERSUS

State of NCT of Delhi
.....Respondents

The petitioner above named having applied u/s 8(2) of the Hindu Minority and Guardianship Act, 1956, for permission to relinquish/transfer of respective shares of her minor children namely Gaurika Bamba (born on 16.06.2011) and Tanish Bamba (born on 05.08.2014) in immovable properties i.e. (i) House Built up bearing no. H/58, Tank Road, Gobindgarh, Gali no.4, New Delhi, (ii) Mpl. No. 11557 (8A/73), measuring 134 sq. yds situated at WEA Karol Bagh, Delhi, (iii) property bearing no. 53/28, Front side portion of 3rd Floor, measuring 271.5 sq. yds. at Ramjas Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi; (iv) Flat no. 190, GF, Prasad Nagar, New Delhi; (v) Mpl. No. XVII/2994/3, measuring 68.89 sq. yds. left side portion at Ranjit Nagar, New Delhi and (vi) Built up right side portion Ground Floor without roof rights, bearing Pvt. no. G-1, measuring 66-2/3 sq. yds. Mpl. no. XVII/2994/3, at Ranjit Nagar, New Delhi.

The **10th December 2026** has been fixed for hearing of the application and notice is hereby given to general public that if any other relatives/friends, Kinsman or well wisher of the aforesaid or desire be appointed, declare as guardian of the person and property of the said minors or desire to oppose the application of the petitioner aforesaid, he/she should enter appearance in persons in this court on the aforesaid date and be prepared to adduce on that day and documentary or oral evidence which he/she may desire to adduce in support of his/her claim to such appointment or declaration of in support his/her opposition to the application of the petitioner aforesaid.

GIVEN under my hand and seal of the Court on this the 30th day of October 2026.

Seal

Sd/-
PRINCIPAL DISTRICT & SESSIONS JUDGE (HQ.)

IN THE COURT OF DR. AJAY GUDATI DISTRICT JUDGE (COMM COURT)-04, COURT NO. 509, SOUTH-WEST DISTRICT, DWARKA COURTS, NEW DELHI
PUBLICATION NOTICE: DEFENDANT (Order 5, Rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure)
SUIT NO.: CS (COMM)/66/2026
AGGARWAL TRADING CO
V/S .....PLAINTIFF
SHREE BANKE BIHARI OIL MILLS
TO .....DEFENDANT

MR. VIPUL SINGLA S/O NIRANJAN DASS MOB: 9812428077EMAIL ID: VIPUL.PPS@GMAIL.COM RESIDING AT: BUILDING NO. 185/6, AJAD MARKET, MEHAM HARYANA 124112

Whereas **Plaintiff** has instituted the above Commercial Suit for Recovery against the defen-dant. You are hereby summoned to appear in this Court in person or by a pleader on 14.12.2026 at 10:00 AM. to answer the same, failing which the Suit will be disposed of 'Ex-Parte'. Given under my hand and the seal of the Court, this **27 Day of OCTOBER 2026**, to be put-lished in Newspaper **"INDIAN EXPRESS"**

NOTE:- Defendant is informed to file Written Statement alongwith Statement of Truth and Affidavit of Admission and Denial of Documents within a period of 30 days from the date of receipt of Summons with advance copy to the Plaintiff.

SEAL **JUDGE**

IN THE COURT OF DR. AJAY GUDATI DISTRICT JUDGE (COMM COURT)-04, COURT NO. 509, SOUTH-WEST DISTRICT, DWARKA COURTS, NEW DELHI
PUBLICATION NOTICE: DEFENDANT (Order 5, Rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure)
SUIT NO.: CS (COMM)/66/2026
AGGARWAL TRADING CO
V/S .....PLAINTIFF
SHREE BANKE BIHARI OIL MILLS
TO .....DEFENDANT
MIS SHREE BANKE BIHARI OIL MILLS GSTIN:- 06AEBFSS452F1Z5 OFFICE AT:- BHIWANI ROAD, MEHAM, ROHTAK, HARYANA-124112.
ALSO AT:- GODOWN NO. 1, NEELAM KUMARI GODOWN, KHEWAT NO. 94, VPO MADINA GINDHRAM, MEHAM, ROHTAK, HARYANA 124111
ALSO AT:- GODOWN NO. 1, SUSHIL KUMAR S/O RAM KANWAR, KHATONI NO. 3534, SAMAN ROAD, MEHAM, ROHTAK, HARYANA 124112

Whereas **Plaintiff** has instituted the above **Commercial Suit for Recovery** against the defen dant. You are hereby summoned to appear in this Court in person or by a pleader on **14.12.2026 at 10:00 AM.** to answer the same, failing which the Suit will be disposed of Ex-Parte'.

Given under my hand and the seal of the Court, this **27th Day of OCTOBER 2026.** to be pub lished in Newspaper **"INDIAN EXPRESS"**

NOTE:- Defendant is informed to file Written Statement alongwith Statement of Truth and Affidavit of Admission and Denial of Documents within a period of 30 days fromn the date of receipt of Summons with advance copy to the Plaintiff.

SEAL **JUDGE**

Call or WhatsApp 9717006820 to advertise on classified page

The Indian EXPRESS JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT

Office of Executive Engineer (Mech.)
Irrigation Mechanical Division, Birpur, 2nd Floor, Kaushiki Bhawan, Birpur, 854340
Email: - imdbirpur@gmail.com
Emergent NIQ No.- 16/2026-27

Letter No.- 2096

The undersigned hereby invites budgetary quotations from reputed original equipment manufacturers (OEMs), manufacturers, and their authorized suppliers of dredgers, tugboats, houseboats, barges and other associated marine equipment for the items specified in the table below, for the purpose of assessing the estimated cost of the proposed procurement.

-The quotationer shall submit the **Quotation before03.00 P.M of 09.11.2026**

- By post or in person: In a sealed envelope addressed to the Executive Engineer (M)Irrigation Mechanical Division, Birpur, Bihar

- By Email: **- imdbirpur@gmail.com**

Sl. no.	Name of Items	Quantity	Unit	Rate	Amount
1	Design and Drawing, Engineering, Fabrication, Supply, Testing and Commissioning of Multi-utility Amphibian Cutter Suction Dredgers (CSD) of proven design and standard model having satisfactory performance with one year builder warranty Dredging capacity - min. slurry discharge capacity of 1,150 m³/hour discharge of the dredged spoil through dredge pipelines or nozzles. The dredger also to be supplied with other attachments for excavation, complete with 1,500 m (Floating pipeline – 500m) discharge pipeline with all advanced and latest accessories, auxiliary machinery and equipment, conforming to applicable IRS standards and relevant codes, suitable for deployment in the upstream and downstream of the Koshi River for desilting, flood management and other departmental works.	1	No.		
2	Design and drawing , Engineering, Fabrication, Supply, Testing and Commissioning of Suitable Tug Boats, complete with latest marine engines, propulsion systems, steering arrangements, towing winches, towing hooks, navigation and safety equipment, and all necessary accessories and auxiliary machinery, conforming to applicable IRS standards and relevant codes, for towing and shifting cutter suction dredgers, floating pipelines and associated equipment from one operational location to another in the upstream and downstream of the Koshi River for desilting, flood management and other departmental works, as per the required by the Department.	1	Nos		
3	Design and drawing, Engineering, Preparation of Drawings, Fabrication, Supply, Testing and Commissioning of a Houseboat with Accommodation Facilities for 16–18 Crew Members and Departmental Inspection Personnel, including sleeping berths, toilets, bathrooms, kitchen, dining area, inspection room, electrical and lighting arrangements, ventilation, water supply, sanitation, safety equipment and all necessary accessories and auxiliary machinery, conforming to applicable IRS standards and relevant codes, suitable for deployment in the upstream and downstream of the Koshi River, Bihar, as required by the Department.	1	Nos		
4	Operation and Maintenance (O&M) of Cutter Suction Dredgers, Tugboats and Houseboat/accommodation per years, including deployment of qualified operators, crew members, technical personnel, fuel, lubricants, consumables, maintenance, repairs, spare parts and all other manpower, materials and resources required for safe and efficient operation of the equipment, as per departmental requirements. The quotationer shall quote separate rates per year, inclusive of all applicable costs and taxes, for deployment in the upstream and downstream of the Koshi River, Bihar, as directed by the Department. (approx. 8 hrs./ day)	5	Year		
5	Design and drawing, Engineering, Fabrication, Supply, Testing and Commissioning of Self-Propelled twin screw engine Barge for the shallow water (low draft like Koshi river) with a Minimum Payload Capacity of 500 MT, fitted with efficient self-loading and unloading of materials and equipment, complete with propulsion, steering, navigation, safety systems, auxiliary machinery and all necessary accessories. The barge shall conform to applicable IRS rules, Inland Vessels regulations, BIS/IS codes and other relevant marine engineering standards and shall be suitable for deployment in in the upstream and downstream of the Koshi River, Bihar, for dredging operations, transportation of equipment and materials, and other departmental purposes.	1	No		
6	Operation and Maintenance (O&M) of Self-Propelled Barge per years, including deployment of qualified operators, crew members, technical personnel, fuel, lubricants, consumables, maintenance, repairs, spare parts and all other manpower, materials and resources required for safe and efficient operation of the equipment, as per departmental requirements. The quotationer shall quote separate rates per year, inclusive of all applicable costs and taxes, for deploymentin the upstream and downstream of the Koshi River, Bihar, as directed by the Department. (approx. 8 hrs./ day).	5	Year		

Executive Engineer (M)
Irrigation Mechanical Division, Birpur,
PR. No. 014644 (WRD) 2026-27 Mob:- 8210141033

For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

रक्त की आवश्यकता पड़ने पर लाईसेंस प्राप्त ब्लड बैंकों से ही रक्त प्राप्त करें।

Govt. of Bihar

RURAL WORKS DEPARTMENT

Office of the Engineer-in–chief-cum-Additional Commissioner-cum-Special Secretary/Engineer-in-Chief, Rural Works Department, Bihar
5th floor, Visvesvaraya Bhawan, Nehru Path, Patna-800015

DETAILED NOTICE INVITING TENDER

(through e-procurement mode only http://pmgsytendersbih.gov.in)
for Construction of road/bridgeand 06 year Operation & Management (O&M) with surface renewalunder component of Sulabh Samparkta Yojana (SSY).

Notice Inviting Tender No.-RWD/SSY/HQ/ET/28/2026-27

1. Designation and Address of the Advertiser : Engineer-in–chief-cum-Additional Commissioner-cum-Special Secretary/Engineer-in–chief, Rural Works Department, Govt. of Bihar
2. Date of Notice Inviting Tender : 29.10.2026
3. Period for download of Tender Document : From 25.11.2026 (9:00 hrs) to up to 03.12.2026 15:00 hrs
4. Date, Time & Place of Pre-Bid meeting : Date 27.11.2026 at 15:00 hrs
5. Last Date & Time for uploading tender documents by bidder : Date 03.12.2026 till 15:00 hrs http://pmgsytendersbih.gov.in
6. Date and time of opening of Technical Bid : Date 03.12.2026 Time 15:30 hrs.
7. (i) Bid Security (EMD) **and cost of BOQ shall be submitted Online.** No other forms of Earnest Money (Bid Security) **and cost of BOQ** will be accepted. The Earnest Money deposited by the non -responsive bidder will be automatically refunded. In case the bid of non -responsive bidder is reconsidered whose EMD has been refunded automatically, will be collected and refunded manually in the shape of Fixed Deposit Receipt.
(ii)Bidders are required to upload an Affidavit regarding correctness of Information furnished with bid document. Original Affidavit regarding correctness of Information furnished with Bid document shall be submitted at the time of signing of agreement.
9. **Details of Works and Services:**

Sl. No.	District	Division	Block	Road/Bridge Name	Length (in km)	Total Construction Cost (in Lakhs)	6 years Operation & Management Cost (in lakh)	Total Estimated Cost (in Lakhs)	Amount of Earnest money in Online Mode(in Lakh)*	Cost of B.O.Q. in Online Mode (Non-Refundable) in Rs.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
1	Gopalganj	Gopalganj-1	Kataiya	Parsauni Nahar pul se sota dharhara tak path ka nirman	6.64	1014.605	93.427	1108.03	21.08	10000/-
2	Gopalganj	Gopalganj-1	Kataiya	Sota Dharhara se Dhanauti petrol pump tak path ka nirman karya	6.66	924.405	96.845	1021.25	20.21	10000/-
3	Gopalganj	Gopalganj-1	Kataiya	H.L Bridge across Sona river at chainage-2.950 km in Parsauni Nahar pul se sota dharhara path	0.05137	457.990	5.190	463.18	9.26	10000/-
4	Samastipur	Dalsingh sarai	Sarairanjan	Khajuri to chak Ahlad tak	2.500	385.53	19.299	404.83	8.09	10000/-
5	Saran	Sonpur	Sonpur	Gram Kachahari More to Baba Manokamna	0.600	87.5	2.51	90.01	1.8	10000/-
6	Nalanda	Biharsharif	Rahui	Amba Bajrangbali mandir se SH 78 via kadibigha	2.4	236.596	26.227	262.823	5.256	10000/-
7	Nalanda	Biharsharif	Rahui	Barandi bypass via Jagatnandpur se SH 78 se NH 82 tak	2.95	287.348	28.542	315.89	6.318	10000/-
8	Lakhisarai	Lakhisarai	surajgarha	Khawa Rajpur Path Khakra Chandi Asthan se hote hue Shivnagar Path Nirman	4.600	741.852	44.434	786.286	15.726	10000/-
9	Banka	Banka-1	Banka	Banka jamdaha road to madhaya nishedh Office	1.01	94.263	12.853	107.116	2.142	10000/-
10	Rohtas	Sasaram-1	Kargahar	Dharmpura Baraw Path Se NH-30	10.5	1528.9	108.179	1637.079	26.371	10000/-

10. Bid Validity:**180 days**.
11. Detailed NIT can be seen on website **http://pmgsytendersbih.gov.in**

Engineer -in–chief
Rural Works Department, Govt. of Bihar

For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**
PR. No.014628 (RWD) 2026-27

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

Govt. of Bihar

BIHAR SAMVAD SAMITI

(IPRD, Soochna Bhawan Nehru Path, Patna)

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

RFP No: 02/2026-27

The MD, Bihar Samvad Samiti, Information & Public Relations Department, Government of Bihar (BSS, IPRD), invites proposals from reputed agencies under the Two-Bid System (Technical Bid and Financial Bid) for Selection of a Public Relations Agency for media management, news tracking and monitoring, content development, crisis communications and communications outreach, for an initial period of two (2) years.

Issue of this RFP and selection under it shall not, by itself, bind the Department to award the work or enter into any agreement. The Department shall not be liable for any cost incurred by an Applicant in participating, and makes no commitment, express or implied, that this process will result in an award of work, an agreement or any commercial transaction.

Document Fee and Tender Processing Fee: Each Applicant must pay a non-refundable Document Fee of Rs. 5,000/- (Rupees Five Thousand only) and a Tender Processing Fee of Rs. 1,180/- (Rupees One Thousand One Hundred Eighty only) on the e-Procurement Portal by e-payment (NEFT/RTGS/Credit Card/Debit Card).

Earnest Money Deposit (EMD): An EMD of Rs. 5,00,000/- (Rupees Five Lakh only), non-interest bearing and refundable, shall be paid only by e-payment on the e-Procurement Portal before the last date/time for bid submission, failing which the bid shall be rejected. Bidders registered with MSME/NSIC for the relevant services are exempt from the EMD on submitting a valid registration certificate with the Technical Bid. The EMD is liable for forfeiture if the selected bidder fails to submit the requisite Performance Security or execute the Agreement within the stipulated period, withdraws/modifies its proposal during bid validity, or furnishes any information or document found to be misleading or untrue in any material respect.

The Proposal must be submitted online at https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in, where it can be found under the "Tender" tab on the home page, then Latest Tender, by searching Department Name as "Information & Public Relations Department, Govt. of Bihar".

The application procedure, eligibility criteria, evaluation methodology, terms and conditions and scope of work are detailed in this RFP, available for download from the e-Procurement Portal and the departmental website https://state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar from 02/11/2026. The pre-bid meeting will be held at 03:00 PM on 18/11/2026. The last date for submission of proposal/bid is 08/12/2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. The Technical Bid will be opened on or after 10/12/2026 post 16:00 Hrs. Proposals will be evaluated as per the criteria laid down in this RFP, which should be referred to for complete details.

This RFP is issued in accordance with the Bihar Financial Rules (BFR), the General Financial Rules, 2017 (to the extent applicable and consistent with BFR), the Manual for Procurement of Consultancy and Other Services of the Government of India (for QCBS-based selection), the Bihar State Purchase Preference Policy, the public procurement policy for Micro and Small Enterprises, the Information Technology Act, 2000 (for e-procurement validity) and other applicable guidelines, as amended from time to time.

The Department reserves the right to issue addenda/corrigenda, amend any condition of this RFP, accept or reject any or all proposals, or cancel this RFP at any stage without assigning any reason, and no applicant/bidder shall have any claim or cause of action against the Department for the same.

MD,
Bihar Samvad Samiti,
IPRD, Govt. of Bihar

PR- 014808 (I & P R D) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur

E-mail ID –bhag.gp@gmail.com, Website-https://www.gpbhagalpur.ac.in/

NIT NO. – GPB- 03/2026-27

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS
(Through e-procurement mode only – www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

1. Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur has been constituted under the Department of Science, Technology and Technical Education, Government of Bihar to cater to the needs of technical education. The Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur intendent to invite bids from eligible entities supply of Machines and Equipments for Garment Technology Lab.
2. The contract will be offered by Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur to the successful agency/bidder.
3. To participate in the e-tendering process, the bidder/agency are required to get themselves registered with eproc2.bihar.gov.in.
4. **Schedule of Events:**

Sn.	Event Description	Timeline
4.1	Bid Submission Start Date	**29 October 2026 at 10:00 AM** on the www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4.2	Last date & time of downloading the RFP	Till 19 **November 2026 up to 05:00 PM**, on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4.3	Pre-bid meeting	**4 November 2026 at 11:00 AM**
4.4	Submission (upload) of online bidding document.	**19 November 2026 till 05:00 PM**, on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4.5	Submission of EMD	Offline by **19 November 2026** to "Principal office Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur"
4.6	Opening of Technical Bid	**20 November 2026 at 11:00AM** on the www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4.7	Opening of Financial Bid	**After Evaluation of Technical Bid.**
4.8	Pre- bid meeting venue	Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur, Vill + Post Barari Bhagalpur Bihar – 812003
4.9	Contact person	Principal, Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur Mobil no : 8340244983 Email ID: bhag.gp@gmail.com
4.10	Method of Selection	Least Cost Selection (LCS)

Note: i.) Interested bidders may obtain further information about this Notice Inviting Tender (NIT) from the office of Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur
ii) No tender will be accepted after closing date and time in any circumstances.

5. Bidder may also download the tender document available from eproc2.bihar.gov.in.
6. The Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur will select the bidder based on Least Cost Selection (LCS) method for supply of Machines and Equipments for Garment Technology Lab.. The tender shall be accompanied by Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of Rs 10000/- (Ten thousand rupees only) in the shape of Demand Draft from any Schedule Bank in favour of Principal, Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur.
7. The technical and financial bids must be submitted through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in before the date and time specified in the tender document. The Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur doesn't take any responsibility for the delay / Non-Submission of Tender / Non-Reconciliation of online Payment caused due to Non-availability of Internet Connection, Network Traffic/ Holidays, or any other reason.
8. The bidders shall submit their eligibility and qualification details, Certificates as mentioned in the tender document, in the online standard formats given in eproc2.bihar.gov.in at the respective stage(s) only.
9. The bidders shall upload the scanned copies of all the relevant certificates, documents etc., in support of their eligibility criteria / technical bids and other certificate /documents in the eproc2.bihar.gov.in.
10. The bids must be uploaded (e-mode/online) at the eproc2.bihar.gov.in.
11. All prospective bidders may attend the Pre-Bid meeting. The venue, date and time are indicated in Schedule of Events as in above **section 4**.
12. The Earnest Money should be deposited on or before the closing date & time indicated above in the Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur, failing which the tenders will be treated as late tender and would be summarily rejected. Proof of the same shall be uploaded on the eproc2.bihar.gov.in during the bid submission.
13. In the event of any of the above-mentioned dates being declared as a holiday/ closed day for the Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur the tenders/EMD will be opened/received on the next working day at the scheduled time.
14. Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur reserves the right to accept or reject any or all tender or change the terms and condition of NIT or cancel the NIT without assigning any reasons at any stage and time.
15. For further enquiry and information, contact Er. Raj Kamal Prasad, HOD-Textile Engineering, Mobile No: +91-7702560334 during office hours 10:00 AM to 05:00PM.
16. All further notifications/Corrigendum/Addendum if any shall be posted on eproc2.bihar.gov.in.
17. When reading this document if you identify any errors or omissions, please advise Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur in writing, in 7 calendar days from the date of publication of the tender by giving a brief description of the problem, its location within document and your contact details.

Confidentiality

This document contains privileged and confidential information pertaining to the "Supply of Machines and Equipments for Garment Technology Lab" at Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur. The access level for the document is specified above. The addressee should honour access rights by preventing intentional or accidental access outside access scope.

Principal
Government Polytechnic, Bhagalpur

PR- 014668 (Science & Tec.) 2026-27

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

Government Engineering College Kaimur

Jaitpur Kalan, PO + PS Bhagwanpur Kaimur-821102
E-mail:- geckaimur@gmail.com

ADV No. GECK/e.Proc/01/2026-27

SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR SUPPLY INSTALLATION, TESTING, COMMISSIONING AND GO-LIVE OF AN IP BASED CCTV SURVEILLANCE SYSTEM COVERING THE ACADEMIC BUILDING, AUDITORIUM AND OTHER PLACES ON THE CAMPUS IN THE PREMISES OF GOVERNMENT ENGINEERING COLLEGE, KAIMUR
(E-Procurement Mode only)

Government Engineering College Kaimur has been established under the Department of Science, Technology and Technical Education, Government of Bihar to cater to the needs of technical education. The college/institute is providing technical education as per the norms set by the All-India Council for Technical Education (AICTE). **Government Engineering College Kaimur** invites bids in two bid systems from reputed, experienced and financially sound Firm for Supply of Installation, Testing, Commissioning and Go-Live of an IP Based CCTV Surveillance System covering the Academic building, Auditorium and other places of the campus in the premises of Government engineering college Kaimur.

Bidder may download the tender documents available on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in **from 07/11/2026** and submit the tender by using the downloaded document, on or before **18/11/2026.** Least Cost Selection (LCS) method will be adopted for selecting the firm for Supply Installation, Testing, Commissioning and Go-Live of an IP Based CCTV Surveillance System covering the Academic building, Auditorium and other places of the campus. The tender shall be accompanied by **Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of Rs. 1,20,000/- (One lakh Twenty Thousand rupees only)** in the shape of **Demand Draft** from any Schedule Bank in favor of **Principal, Government Engineering College, Kaimur , Hard copy of demand draft must be reached on or before 19/11/2026 by 5:00 pm.** The bidders shall submit their eligibility and qualification details, certificates as mentioned in the tender document, in the online standard formats given in eproc2.bihar.gov.in at the respective stage(s) only.

The technical and financial bids must be submitted through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in before the date and time specified in the tender document, the processing fee may be applicable as per www.eproc2.bih.gov.in**. The Government Engineering College, Kaimur doesn't take any responsibility for** the delay / Non-Submission of Tender / Non-Reconciliation of online Payment caused due to Non- availability of Internet Connection, Network Traffic/ Holidays or any other reason.

Note: Interested bidders may obtain further information about this Notice Inviting Tender (NIT) from the Office of Government Engineering College, Kaimur. No tender will be accepted after closing date and time in any circumstances.

Principal
Government Engineering College, Kaimur

PR- 014671 (Science & Tech.) 2026-27

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

बिहार सरकार

कार्यालय नगर निगम सासाराम
जी0टी0 रोड, सासाराम।

ई–मेल : **sasaramnagarnigam@gmail.com**

RE-NOTICE INVITING (NIT) No.- 33/2026-27

RFP for Selection of an Agency for the Implementation of Animal Birth Control (ABC) Program in Sasaram, Rohtas District of Bihar

Municipal Corporation, Sasaram
GT Road, Sasaram, Bihar-821115
Phone No.- 8210751663
Email: sasaramnagarnigam@gmail.com

01. **Sasaram Municipal Corporation** invites proposals from eligible firms for "Selection of an Agency for the Implementation of Animal Birth Control (ABC) Program in Sasaram, Rohtas District of Bihar".

02. Interested Consultancy Firms may download the complete Request for Proposals (RFP) Document, from website: https://state.bihar.gov.in/urban

SL	PARTICULARS	DESCRIPTION
1	Website for submission of bid/proposal	Not applicable Separate bids to be submitted to the respective ULBs HQ at each district. (A bidder may choose to bid for multiple districts. For each district separate bids, Tender fee, Bid Security has to be submitted)
2	Mode of Submission	Proposals/bids to be submitted in **hard copies only** to the **respective district ULBs HQ Sasaram Municipal Corporation Sasaram** (as per Annexure 3). A bidder is allowedto submit bidsin more than one district subject to submission of separate tender processing fee and EMD / Bid Security for each district applied. Submission of Tender fee, Bid Security, payment proof, original copy of affidavit, declaration regarding Blacklisting and Power of Attorney as per RFP document along with the bid hard copies
3	Last date and time for Submission of hard copies of Technical Bid/proposal along with financial bid/proposal in separate sealed envelopes inside one envelop.	14/11/2026 up to 05:00 PM
4	Date and time of Pre bid meeting	12/11/2026 by 12:00 PM At Office Sasaram Municipal Corporation
5	Submission of bids through eproc portal	**Not applicable**
6	Date and time of opening of Technical Bids	17/11/2026 at 03:30 PM at respective district ULB HQ
7	Date and time of opening of Financial Bids	Will be intimated later to successful bidders by the respective district ULB HQ
8	Method of Selection	Least cost (rate per unit) selection method

03. Modifications/Amendments/Corrigendum, if any shall not be advertised in the newspaper but shall be published on the departmental Website: https://state.bihar.gov.in/urban

For further details please visit website **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

Municipal Commissioner
Municipal Corporation Sasaram.

PR- 014663 (B & C) 2026-27

बिहार में शराब का व्यापार, बिक्री एवं सेवन अवैध है।
संबंधित शिकायत इस नंबर पर दर्ज करायें आपकी जानकारी गुप्त रखी जाएगी।
टॉल फ्री नं– 15545 या 1800 345 6268

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA,
HOME DEPARTMENT (PORTS & TRANSPORT)
MAHARASHTRA MARITIME BOARD

Indian Mercantile Chambers, 2nd Floor, Ramjibhai Kamani Marg, Ballard Estate, Mumbai - 400 001.
Tel.: 022-69041777 **Fax :** 022-69041740
Website : https://mahammb.maharashtra.gov.in
Email: ceo.mmb@maharashtra.gov.in / ceommb@gmail.com

Second E-Tender Notice - (Year 2026-27)/R3/61-62

Main Portal: https://mahatenders.gov.in

Digitally signed E-Tender for following work is invited by Chief Executive Officer, Maharashtra Maritime Board, Mumbai, from Registered with Government of Maharashtra and having experience in execution of Marine related civil works, for following work in B-1 Tender Form.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Approximately Tender Cost in Rs.	Blank Tender form amount in Rs.	Earnest Money Amount in Rs.	Time limit for Completion of Work
1	Strengthening and Modernizing of Existing Jetty for Ro-Ro Service at Tarkarli, Tal. Malvan, Dist Sindhudurg	4,97,19,840/-	2,360/-	2,49,000/-	12 Months (Including Monsoon)
2.	Strengthening and Modernizing of Existing Jetty for Ro-Ro Service at Korjai, Tal. Vengurla, Dist Sindhudurg	4,97,19,840/-	2,360/-	2,49,000/-	12 Months (Including Monsoon)

The details can be viewed online and downloaded directly from the Government of Maharashtra E-Tendering Portal https://mahatenders.gov.in **27.10.2026* at 15:00 to 05.11.2026* at 17:00 hours** (IST)*

The right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason is reserved.

Sd/-
Sudhir Deore
Executive Engineer,
Maharashtra Maritime Board, Mumbai.

DGIPR-2026-27/3526

उपायुक्त–सह–
जिला दण्डाधिकारी का कार्यालय चतरा
(E-mail : dpochatra@gmail.com)
(जिला योजना)

–:रद्द संबंधी सूचना:–

इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक 900 / जि0यो0 दिनांक 30.10.2026 द्वारा कोटेशन आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या (PR NO 392954) को अपरिहार्य कारणवश रद्द किया जाता है।

जिला योजना पदाधिकारी,
चतरा

PR 393072 (Planning and Development)26-27*D

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़
रामगढ़ थाना के सामने, थाना चौक/गांधी चौक, रामगढ़ कैन्ट, जिला-रामगढ़, झारखण्ड- 829122,
ई.मेल–eercdramgarh-jhr@nic.in

" सूचना "

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि पथ प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़ अन्तर्गत एस०बी०डी० आधारित अल्पकालीन ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना का प्रसंग संख्या–RCD/RAMGARH/1525/2026-27 दिनांक – 10.10.2026 का P.R. No.- 391742 द्वारा आमंत्रित अल्पकालीन ई–निविदा में निम्न प्रकार से संशोधित किया जाता है:–

क्रमांक	विवरणी	पूर्व में आमंत्रित अवधि	संशोधन की अवधि
1.	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	12(बारह) माह	24(चौबीस) माह

शेष यथावत रहेंगे।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
पथ निर्माण विभाग,
पथ प्रमण्डल,
रामगढ़

PR 393120 Road (26-27) D"

Government of Jharkhand
Urban Development and Housing Department
Jharkhand Mineral Area Development Authority, Dhanbad

e-Procurement short term Notice Inviting Tender No.
UDHD/JMADA/SBD/01/2026-27
NIT No.- UDHD/JMADA/SBD/01/2026-27 Date :- 02.11.2026

1.	Name of the work	**Construction of Market Complex in Nirsa** Circle Under JMADA,Dhamnad.
2.	Value of Work	Rs. 3,47,43,350.00
3.	Tender Fee and Bid Security	**Tender document fee: - INR 10000/-** (Ten Thousand Only) Non -Refundable. Bid Security: Rs **3,50,000.00** (Rupees Three Lakh Fifty thousand Only).
4.	**Time of Completion**	548 Days
5.	Date/Time of Publication of **Tender on Website**	12/11/2026 at 11:00 AM
6.	**StartDate of Submission of Bids**	**12/11/2026 at 11:00 AM**
7.	**Last Date / Time for receipt of bids Online**	**04/12/2026 till 05:00 PM**
8.	**Date and Time of Technical Bid** Opening Online.	05/12/2026from 05:00 PM
9.	**Name & address of office Inviting tender**	Manging Director, Jharkhand Mineral Area Development Authority, Dhanbad.
10.	Helpline number of e-Procurement cell	**7368005128**
11.	**e-mail id**	mdmada22@gmail.com

NOTE:- (i) Only e-Tenders will be accepted. Further details can be seen on website http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in.
(ii) Contractor should be registered in Class (I) First class as per NIT
(iii) Estimated Cost / Quantity May Vary
(iv) Any Change/Information can be seen on Website on http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in.
(v) EMD and Cost of BOQ/Tender Cost shall be Deposited in a form of Bank Draft only of any Scheduled Indian Bank Payable at JMADA, Dhanbad in Favor Secretry, Dhanbad.

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
झमाडा, धनबाद

PR 393143 District (26-27)_D

"IMPORTANT"

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

Govt. of Bihar

Department of Environment, Forest & Climate change.
Patna Zoo Management and Development Society
TENDER NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER
(Through e-Procurement mode only at https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Corrigendum For Tender No: 11/e-PROC/PZMDS/2026-27

Corrigendum to the Advertisement issued vide Tender No. 11/e-PROC/PZMDS/2026-27 for "Installation of Selfie Points at different locations in the Zoo"

An advertisement was published in various newspapers on 22.10.2026 vide PR No. 014053 (Forest) 2026-27 regarding the Short Notice e-Tender for "Installation of Selfie Points at different locations in the Zoo."

Due to technical reasons, the following corrigendum is hereby issued regarding the revision of the tender schedule. The complete revised details may be seen and downloaded from the e-Procurement Portal of Government of Bihar at https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in.

Revised Tender Schedule/Programme:

Sl. No.	Activity	Revised Date and Time
1.	Online Sale/Download date of Tender documents	From 22.10.2026 to 05.11.2026 (Upto 12:00 P.M.) **(https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)**
2.	Bid-clarification date and time	24.10.2026 - 4:00 P.M. (In the office of the Director, Patna Zoo -cum-Secretary, Patna Zoo Management and Development Society)
3.	Date/Time for Submission/ Uploading of offer/Bid	Till 05.11.2026 up to 05.00 P.M. **(https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)**
4.	Date & time for Opening of Technical Bid.	06.11.2026 at 2:00 P.M. **(https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)** (In the office of the Director, Patna Zoo -cum-Secretary, Patna Zoo Management and Development Society)
5.	Financial Bid Opening Date and Time	Date will be announced after evaluation of technical bid.

All other terms and conditions of the tender will remain unchanged.

PR. No. 014648 (Env. & Forest) 2026-27

Secretary,
Patna Zoo Management and Development Society

For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

रक्त की आवश्यकता पड़ने पर लाईसेंस प्राप्त ब्लड बैंकों से ही रक्त प्राप्त करें।

INDEL MONEY

Corporate office: **Indel Money Limited,**
IIIrd Floor Indel House, Changampuzha Nagar,
South Kalamassery, Ernakulum -682033 ,
Ph: 0484-2933999 E:customercare@indelmoney.com

GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

The pledges in specific and the public in general are hereby notified that public auction of the gold ornaments pledged in the below accounts is proposed to be conducted at the following branches on 03-12-2026 at 11:00 am We are auctioning the gold ornaments of the defaulted customers who have failed to make the payment of his/her loan amount despite being notified through various communication. Unauctioned items shall be auctioned on any other days without further notice of changes in venue or date and the same shall be displayed at concerned branches without any further notice.

ADHYAPAK NAGAR - 32905140006807, **BADARPUR -** 40105140003276, 0514/03320, 0514/03321, 0514/03336, 0514/03373, 0514/03387, 0514/03388, 0514/03397, 0514/03398, 0514/03399, 0514/03406, 0514/03451, 0514/03468, 0514/03470, 0514/03471, 0514/03473, 0514/03475, 0514/03480, 0514/03482, 0514/03487, 0514/03492, 0514/03493, 0514/03495, 0514/03503, **KARAWAL -** 33905140006834, 0514/06856, 0514/06950, 0514/06951, 0514/06960, 0514/06985, 0514/07045, 0514/07061, 0514/07064, **KIRARI -** 33405140003688, 0514/03689, 0514/03693, 0514/03806, **MAYUR VIHAR -** 35005140003194, 0514/03294, 0514/03295, 0514/03315, 0514/03327, 0514/03344, 0514/03366, 0514/03367, **PANKHA ROAD -** 33305140003144, 0514/03260, 0514/03284, **POOTHKALAN -** 34005140006699, 0514/06718, **RANIBAGH -** 46805140001028, 0514/01040, 0514/01070, 0514/01073, 0514/01075, 0514/01083, 0514/01084, 0514/01088, 0514/01091, 0514/01096, 0514/01097, **UTTAM NAGAR -** 34205140002757, **NAJAFGRAH -** 36105140002089, 0514/02109, 0514/02110, 0514/02118, 0514/02134, 0514/02173, **SHAKURPUR-** 44905140001196, 0514/01213, 0514/01215, 0514/01216, 0514/01221, 0514/01222, 0514/01223, 0514/01226, 0514/01227, 0514/01228, 0514/01229, 0514/01230, 0514/01232, 0514/01244, 0514/01245, 0514/01246, 0514/01250, 0514/01255, 0514/01258, 0514/01261, 0514/01262, 0514/01263, 0514/01265, 0514/01266, 0514/01269, 0514/01270, 0514/01271, 0514/01272, 0514/01273, 0514/01278, 0514/01280, 0514/01284, 0514/01287, 0514/01288, 0514/01289, 0514/01290, 0514/01291, 0514/01292, 0514/01294, 0514/01296, 0514/01300, 0514/01303, 0514/01307, 0514/01311, 0514/01312, 0514/01314, 0514/01316, 0514/01317, 0514/01319, 0514/01323, 0514/01324, 0514/01335, 0514/01337, 0514/01341, 0514/01342, 0514/01344, 0514/01348, 0514/01349, **BETUL -** 34905140003896, 0514/03899, 0514/03903, 0514/03999, 0514/04026, **BIAORA -** 42705140001681, 0514/01694, 0514/01729, 0514/01736, 0514/01801, 0514/01832, 0514/01847, **IMAMI GATE -** 32205140003040, 0514/03054, 0514/03115, 0514/03122, 0514/03127, **GUNA -** 36305140005663, 0514/05677, 0514/05691, 0514/05844, **ITARSI -** 32105140005974, **KAMLA NAGAR -** 34805140007403, **KAROND -** 40205140003090, 0514/03103, 0514/03132, 0514/03151, 0514/03155, 0514/03157, **MANDIDEEP -** 35205140004015, 0514/04041, 0514/04067, 0514/04073, 0514/04074, 0514/04075, 0514/04076, 0514/04077, 0514/04078, 0514/04080, 0514/04143, 0514/04152, 0514/04154, 0514/04157, 0514/04186, 0514/04197, 0514/04198, 0514/04203, **MARIMATA -** 32305140004055, 0514/04090, 0514/04096, 0514/04102, 0514/04103, 0514/04227, 0514/04246, **PIPARIYA -** 46105140001014, **RAISEN -** 35805140006104, 0514/06117, 0514/06122, 0514/06128, 0514/06131, 0514/06145, 0514/06149, 0514/06157, 0514/06162, 0514/06167, 0514/06172, 0514/06205, 0514/06216, 0514/06217, 0514/06221, 0514/06228, 0514/06233, 0514/06234, 0514/06255, 0514/06263, 0514/06265, 0514/06268, 0514/06269, 0514/06284, 0514/06286, 0514/06298, 0514/06302, 0514/06306, 0514/06307, 0514/06308, 0514/06315, 0514/06327, 0514/06330, 0514/06368, **MHOW -** 32405140003131, 0514/03160, 0514/03161, 0514/03196, 0514/03230, **SAGAR -** 35905140003473, 0514/03477, 0514/03479, 0514/03480, 0514/03481, 0514/03489, 0514/03493, 0514/03508, 0514/03509, 0514/03510, 0514/03511, 0514/03540, 0514/03545, 0514/03546, 0514/03549, 0514/03559, 0514/03579, **BHANGEL -** 33205140003543, **SHALIMAR GARDEN -** 36205140002606, **FARIDABAD NIT 2 -** 43805140001241, 0514/01244, 0514/01246, 0514/01252, 0514/01255, 0514/01256, 0514/01258, 0514/01268, 0514/01270, 0514/01275, 0514/01280, 0514/01284, 0514/01309, 0514/01310, **JAWAHAR COLONY -** 38905140002465, 0514/02494, 0514/02495, 0514/02496, 0514/02497, 0514/02511, 0514/02512, 0514/02513, 0514/02521, 0514/02523, 0514/02528, 0514/02529, 0514/02530, 0514/02531, 0514/02532, 0514/02538, 0514/02539, 0514/02540, 0514/02541, 0514/02546, 0514/02553, 0514/02556, 0514/02557, 0514/02558, 0514/02561, 0514/02562, 0514/02563, 0514/02564, 0514/02565,

In case we are unable to complete the auction at the branch on the notified date, the same will be conducted through Shriram Automall India Limited (SAMIL) on their online e- auction platform https://gold.samil.in or e-Procurement Technologies Limited (AuctionTiger) on their online e- auction platform https://egold.auctiontiger.net on 05-12-2026 between 12.30 PM to 3.30 PM. Please note if the e- auction does not completed on 05-12-2026 the same will be re-auctioned on subsequent working days on the same terms and conditions.

By Authorized Officer,
Indel Money Limited

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, NARWANA	SPECIAL REPAIR OF ROAD FROM UCHANA TO JALAB KHERI ROAD IN JIND DISTRICT (ROAD ID 6816) (ODR VT) UCHANA CONSTITUENCY + 1 WORKS	29.10.2026 10.11.2026	1055.30 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	7599999782 pwdnarwana@gmail.com
2	PWD B&R, KARNAL	WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING WITH WBM PLUS CCP AND 80MM IPB ON KALSAURA DRAIN TO YAMUNA GHAT TO NASEEB SINGH KA KHET (ROAD ID-11110) (ODR) IN KM 0.00 TO 1.750 IN INDRI CONSTITUENCY, IN KARNAL DISTRICT (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27)	24.10.2026 06.11.2026	240.90 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9876009311 pwd-eepd-karnal@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, KARNAL	WORK OF 2 NOS ROADS (1) WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING WITH WBM PLUS 50MM BM PLUS 20MM PC ON TAPRANA TO DARAR ROAD (ROAD ID-11111) LENGTH KM. 0.00 TO 1.360 (2) WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING WITH WBM PLUS 50MM BM PLUS 20MM PC ON GHORGARH TO SIKRI ROAD (ROAD ID-11113) IN KM 0.00 TO 2.000 IN INDRI CONSTITUENCY, IN KARNAL DISTRICT (UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27).	28.10.2026 10.11.2026	246.88 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9876009311 pwd-eepd-karnal@hry.nic.in
4	PWD B&R, SIRSA	SPECIAL REPAIR BY PROVIDING 30 MM THICK BC AND 50 MM THICK DBM OF ROAD FROM BY-PASS ON ROAD AT GHAGGAR BANDH (EASTERN SIDE) STARTING FROM DABWALI ROAD TO RANIA ROAD (VT) (ROAD ID 10561) BC IN KM 0.00 TO 16.80 IN SIRSA DISTRICT (SIRSA CONSTITUENCY WORK PROGRAM 2026-27)	CLOSING DATE 11.11.2026	926.74 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666-220530 pwd-eepd1-sirsa@hry.nic.in
5	SHKM GOVT. MEDICAL COLLEGE NALHAR,NUH	TENDER FOR PURCHASE OF QR CODE STICKERS WITH AUTOMATED WASTE COLLECTION SOFTWARE FOR BIO MEDICAL WASTE MANAGEMENT	02.11.2026 15.11.2026	EMD 7171/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01267-282007 tendergmcmewat@gmail.com
6	SHKM GOVT. MEDICAL COLLEGE NALHAR,NUH	TENDER FOR PROVIDING CANTEEN SERVICES FOR CAFETERIA AT SHAHEEDHASAN KHAN MEWATI GOVT. MEDICAL COLLEGE NALHAR, NUH	02.11.2026 15.11.2026	15.12 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01267-282007 tendergmcmewat@gmail.com
7	SHKM GOVT. MEDICAL COLLEGE NALHAR,NUH	TENDER FOR PURCHASE OF VARIOUS MEDICINE FOR DEPARTMENT OF ORTHOPEDICS, SURGERY AND OBS & GYNAE AT SHAHEED HASAN KHAN MEWATI GOVT. MEDICAL COLLEGE, NALHAR.	02.11.2026 15.11.2026	3.50 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01267-282007 tendergmcmewat@gmail.com
8	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, KARNAL	BALANCE WORK FROM REACH RD KM 45.450 TO 58.665 FOR THE WORK OF REMODELING OF AUGMENTATION CANAL FROM RD KM 0.000 TO 75.250	28.10.2026 06.11.2026	284.13 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0184-2258008 xeninddivn@yahoo.in
9	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, KARNAL	CONSTRUCTION OF V.R BRIDGE AT RD KM 33.983 AUGMENTATION CANAL.	30.10.2026 10.11.2026	179.57 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0184-2258008 xeninddivn@yahoo.in
10	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, KARNAL	BALANCE WORK OF INDRI ESCAPE AT RD 56.00 KM FOR THE WORK OF REMODELING OF AUGMENTATION CANAL FROM KM 0 TO 75.250 IE MERGING POINT WITH WJC MAIN BRANCH. + 2 WORKS	30.10.2026 19.11.2026	3475.08 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0184-2258008 xeninddivn@yahoo.in
11	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA,ROHTAK	RECONSTRUCTION OF VR BRIDGE AT RD 4200 OF KAHNI LINK DRAIN + 2 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 10.11.2026	680.41 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9034106126 xenconst21@gmail.com
12	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, MANDI DABWALI	ASA KHERA: DNIT FOR PROVIDING AND LAYING OF 400M I/D RCC PIPE CHANNEL AT VILLAGE ASA KHERA CH. TO.`JOTTANWALI:- ESTIMATE FOR AUGMENTATION AND RENOVATION OF WATER SUPPLY SCHEME AND PROVIDING WATER SUPPLY FACILITY IN VILLAGE AND MGGBY COLONY AT VILLAGE JOTTANWALI, DISTT. SIRSA. (DEMAND DURING JAN SAMVAD)` + 1 WORKS	30.10.2026 06.11.2026	9.95 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8730000001 ee.mandidabwali@gmail.com
13	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR REQUIREMENT OF KITS FOR MD BIOCHEMISTRY THESIS AT KCGMC, KARNAL.	05.11.2026 16.11.2026	EMD 10,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9992132471 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
14	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	RESEARCH STUDY KITS & CONSUMABLES REQUIRED FOR PROJECTS UNDER MRU, KCGMC, KARNAL.	05.11.2026 16.11.2026	EMD 10,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9992132471 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
15	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE AND CONSUMABLE (DISPOSABLE PATCH, TRYPAN BLUE DYE, BUDS, COTTON WOOL 500GM ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	03.11.2026 10.11.2026	EMD 10,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9992132471 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
16	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE AND CONSUMABLE (DISPOSABLE SYRINGES 5ML AND UROBAG 01 LTR.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	03.11.2026 10.11.2026	EMD 10,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896154463 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
17	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR MEDICAL EQUIPMENT/INSTRUMENT (MCFARLAND DENSITOMETER ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	05.11.2026 16.11.2026	EMD 10,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9992132471 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
18	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR MEDICAL INSTRUMENT (K FILES OF DIFFERENT SIZE, H FILES OF DIFFERENT SIZE, ROTARY FILE OF DIFFERENT SIZE, C PLUS FILES, DIAMOND BUR OF DIFFERENT SIZE AND OTHER VARIOUS INSTRUMENT OF DENTISTRY DEPARTMENT) AT KCGMC, KARNAL.	05.11.2026 16.11.2026	EMD 10,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9992132471 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
19	FOREST DEPARTMENT, SIRSA	REG. PROCUREMENTOF RCC FENCING POSTS AS PER SPECIFICATION AND DRAWING GIVEN SIRSA FOREST DIVISION, SIRSA	CLOSING DATE 04.11.2026	3.54 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416067122 forest_srisa@yahoo.com
20	FOREST DEPARTMENT, BHIWANI	TENDER FOR MAINTENANCE OF HERBAL PARK KAIRU AND TOSHAM	30.10.2026 05.11.2026	21 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01664-242430 dfo.bhiwani@yahoo.com
21	HORTICULTURE DEPARTMENT, IHDC HODAL,PALWAL	REGARDING PUBLIC NOTICE FOR E-TENDER (GOODS & SERVICES) RATE CONTRACT FOR MENIAL WORKS FOR VEGETABLES SEEDLING PRODUCTION AND OTHER CENTRE WORKS ON JOB ROLE BASIS" AT IHDC, HODAL (PALWAL) FOR THE YEAR 2026-27.	06.11.2026 16.11.2026	20000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	7015157607 ddhihdchodal@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50729/HRY

Govt. of Bihar

BIHAR STATE TEXT BOOK PUBLISHING CORPORATION LTD.
(A Govt. of Bihar Undertaking)
Pathya Pustak Bhawan, Budh Marg, Patna-800 001
CIN - U22110BR1965SGC000758, Phone: 2221975, Email: textbookmd@gmail.com

APPLICATION FOR WALK-IN INTERVIEW

ADVT. No. BSTBPC/1103/2026

Bihar State Text Book Publishing Corporation Ltd. (BSTBPCL), a Govt. of Bihar undertaking under Education Department, Bihar invites application from the eligible persons for appointment on following posts:

Sl. No.	Name of the Post	Number of Post UR	EBC	BC	Total	Remuneration per Month (In ₹)	Upper Age Limit as on 01/11/2026	Min. Qualification / Eligibility and Work Experience
1	Manager (Personnel & Administration)	1	-	-	1	50,000/-	37 Yrs.	• MBA in Human Resources or Personnel Management from a recognized university or institution.
2	Technical Officer	1	-	-	1	45,000/-	37 Yrs.	• Bachelor's or Master's degree or Equivalent Degree in Pulp and Paper Technology from a recognized university or institution.

General Instructions:-

1. The detailed procedure along with prescribed Performa can be downloaded from the BSTBPCL website i.e. **www.bstbpc.bihar.gov.in**.
2. Candidate having requisite qualification and fulfilling eligible criteria should send their application in prescribed Performa for the above mention post through speed post/registered post only.
3. The appointment shall be strictly on contract basis for one year which may be renewed annually depending upon the satisfactory performance.
4. In case of unsatisfactory performance, the appointment may be terminated at any time without giving any reason in this regard.
5. The candidates must enclose two latest passport size photos along with copy of self-attested certificates pertaining to age, caste, mark sheet / certificates of all years/semesters, graduation/diploma and experience certificate.
6. The application of the candidate who are claiming in writing and not producing the copy of qualification and other concerned certificates in their application form, will be out rightly rejected.
7. Depending on the number of Application received, Corporation will conduct walk in Interview of shortlisted eligible candidates. Based on the performance in the Interview selection will be made.
8. No TA/DA or any other cost shall be paid for interview.
9. Information for interview shall be given on email/mobile number provided by the candidate.
10. Interested candidate will have to send the complete application form mentioning the name of the post for which they applying on the top of envelop through **speed post / Registered Post** to the following address.

Managing Director,
Bihar State Text Book Publishing Corporation Ltd.,
Pathya Pustak Bhawan, Buddh Marg, Patna-800 001

11. The application form received after due date shall not be considered. BSTBPCL will not be responsible for postal delay.
12. The Corporation reserves the right to increase, decrease, or cancel the vacancy at any time without assigning any reason.

NOTE:-1. Last date of submission of application **30.11.2026.**
2. Date of Interview will be communicated by post / Telephone / Mail etc. separately.

PR. No. 014712 (B&C) 2026-27

Managing Director

This information is available on website **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** also

रक्त की आवश्यकता पड़ने पर लाईसेंस प्राप्त ब्लड बैंकों से ही रक्त प्राप्त करें।

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE SONIPAT CO-OPERATIVE SUGAR MILLS LTD.	RATE CONTRACT OF BOILERS CHEMICALS FOR MAINTAINING P.H. AND TDS + 08 OTHER WORK	OPENING CLOSING DATE 11.11.2026	RS. 1,00,00,000/	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9996259370 sonipatsugar@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50716/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HPGCL	OVERHAULING OF FLUE GAS DUCTING, REPLACEMENT OF METALLIC EXPANSION BELLOWS / JOINTS AND REPLACEMENT OF FABREC COMPENSATOR OF FLUE GAS DUCTS /RAH DUCTS OF BOILER DURING OVERHAULING OF 250 MW UNIT-7 PTPS PANIPAT	27.10.2026 12.11.2026	1,09,14,579/-	www.hpgcl.org.in https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01802566015 xenmtcplg1@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50698/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COUNCIL, TOHANA	CONSTRUCTION OF MAHARAJA AGGARSAIN GATE IN MC TOHANA. + 15 WORKS	30.10.2026 06.11.2026	1,86,90,135/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8930314172 mctohana1@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50718/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COUNCIL, BHIWANI	PAVEMENT OF KACHI BERM (FOOTPATH) BOTH SIDE (ROHTAK GATE TO HANUMAN PYAU) , MC BHIWANI + 6 WORKS	29.10.2026 20.11.2026	3,85,86,625/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9996629555 mc.mcbhiwani@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50719/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	ONLINE TENDER FOR THE RATE CONTRACT FOR THE SUPPLY OF AYURVEDIC MEDICINES FOR DH, CHC, PHC, GAD AND HOSPITALS IN THE STATE OF HARYANA FOR A PERIOD OF TWO YEARS.	30.10.2026 20.11.2026	31,48,00,000/-	www.hmsd.org.in	0172-478822 hmsctenders@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50696/HRY

Govt. of Jharkhand

Department of Labour, Employment, Training & Skill Development
Directorate of Employment and Training
3rd Floor, Nepal House, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002
E-mail Id: dir.et.jharkhand@gmail.com, directorate.et.jh@gmail.com

Letter No.:-1382 **Date:- 02.11.2026**

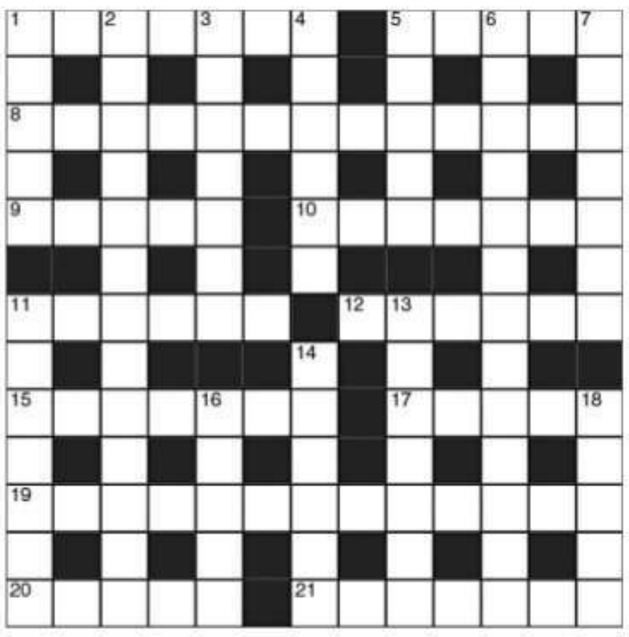
NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

S. No.	Particulars	Details
1	Tender Reference No.	5/TRG(PM_SETU)17/2026
2	Tender ID	2026_LABOR_120535_1
3	Name of the Work	**Selection of an Anchor Industry Partner (AIP) for upgradation of Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) under the Centrally Sponsored Scheme "Pradhan Mantri Skilling & Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU)" For :- 1. Chaibasa, 2. Ranchi, 3. Hazaribagh, 4. Dhanbad, 5. Dumka and 6. Palamu Clusters**
4	Issuing Authority	Directorate of Employment and Training (DoET)
5	Publish Date	02 November 2026
6	Pre-Bid Meeting	10 November 2026, 12:00 PM
7	Last Date for Submission of Bids	23 November 2026, 4:00 PM
8	Technical Qualification Bids opening Date/Time	25 November 2026, 5:00 PM
9	Address of Communication	Directorate of Employment and Training, Department of Labour, Employment, Training & Skill Development, (Govt. of Jharkhand), 3rd Floor, Nepal House, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002, Email: dir.et.jharkhand@gmail.com, directorate.et.jh@gmail.com
10	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Rs. 82,00,000 (Rupees Eighty-Two Lakhs Only)
11	Validity of Proposal	Proposals must remain valid 180 days after the submission date.
12	Currency	The currency in which the Bidders may quote the price and will receive payment is INR only.
13	Bid Submission	Online through e-Tender https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in

Sd/-
Employment Officer(HQ)
Directorate of Employment & Training
Jharkhand, Ranchi

PR 393088 Labour Employment and Traning (26-27)_D

• CROSSWORD 6136



ACROSS

1 Wrong time to be unconventional (7)
5 Laughter in company's causing disorder (5)
8 Made money illegally (13)
9 To and fro round and round it goes (5)
10 So Laura creates excitement (7)
11 Puts up a house for sale perhaps (6)
12 Took advantage of American in a plot (6)
15 Small company having oddly short Roman soldiers (7)
17 A major strike has influence (5)
19 Different view put in writing by a dramatist? (6,2,5)
20 Follow directions and prosecute (5)
21 Photographed out of doors? (7)

DOWN

1 Prize awarded for a zero mark? (5)
2 Jets start out from them (13)
3 Went in for tree chopping in the end (7)
4 Used in a sewing machine it goes round a screw (6)
5 An ingredient of sacred orthodoxy (5)
6 They adopt different attitudes when working (7,6)
7 Loaded but prepared to ride (7)
11 Self-propelled transport (7)
13 Is more cheerful when the dollar's risen? (5,2)
14 Received a hero's treatment when landed (6)
16 Knave withdrawn from the pack? (5)
18 Walk about a little outside (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6135 ACROSS: 1 Haste, 8 Stunt man, 9 Spree, 10 Villager, 11 Knock, 12 Beg, 16 Nicety, 17 Nether, 18 Emu, 23 Cents, 24 Nominate, 25 Cases, 26 Pathetic, 27 Least DOWN: 2 Appendix, 3 Trenches, 4 Strife, 5 Angle, 6 Image, 7 Snort, 12 Bye, 13 Gnu, 14 Steerage, 15 Restless, 19 Metric, 20 Snipe, 21 Smite, 22 Annex

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

__ __ __ - who said love is blind? - Mae West (4,4,4)

CFEOR

FOPLTU

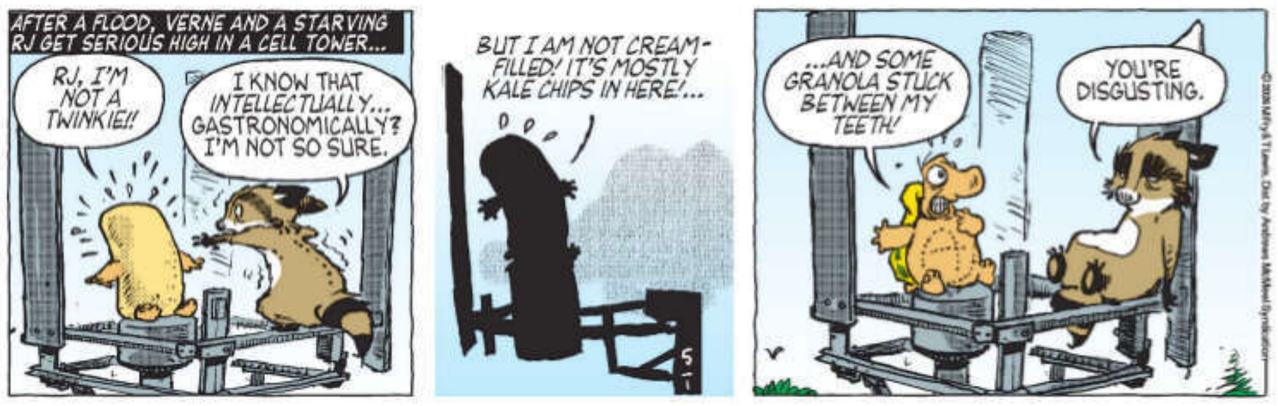
ENOOS

BNOBKY

SOLUTIONS: Force, Noose, Pitful, Knobby
ANSWER: **Look your best** - who said love is blind? - Mae West

• OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS



• CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON



• MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG



SUDOKU 6491

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

		3	7	6				
		6		1			9	
	4			3			8	7
					5	4	3	
	9	2	6					
5	8			9			1	
	6			5		8		
				8	1	2		

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6490

9	2	8	6	7	5	4	3	1
4	6	1	9	3	2	5	7	8
3	7	5	4	1	8	2	9	6
2	1	3	5	9	4	6	8	7
5	8	4	3	6	7	9	1	2
7	9	6	2	8	1	3	4	5
8	5	9	1	2	3	7	6	4
6	4	7	8	5	9	1	2	3
1	3	2	7	4	6	8	5	9

• ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Your work routine might be interrupted today, or something related to your health or even your pet might create an unexpected hiccup. Nevertheless, this is a productive day. Review your values and guard against impetuous actions. Tonight: Get organised.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Parents should know this is an accident-prone day for your kids, which means keep your eyes open and be aware of toddlers at all times. Meanwhile, social occasions might suddenly change. Despite this, it's a productive day. Tonight: Socialise.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Your home routine might be interrupted today. Stock the fridge so you have food and drink on hand to deal with whatever arises. Small appliances might break down or someone unexpected might appear at your door. Tonight: Relax at home.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Even though you might feel mentally restless, pay attention to what you say and do because this is a mildly accident-prone day. You might entertain at home. Tonight: You're eager to share ideas.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Your energy is strong today and you feel hopeful and enthusiastic. Relatives and old friends might be back on the scene. Check your belongings, assets and money to prevent loss, damage or theft. Keep an eye on what you own. Tonight: Money ideas.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Today the Moon is in your sign, which can make you more emotional than usual, but also luckier. Because the Moon is at odds with unpredictable Uranus, you might be obsessed about something unusual that's occurring. Stay chill. Tonight: You win.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): This is a restless day for you. Checks in the mail might be late, because money seems to be slow coming your way. Fortunately, you're still charming and diplomatic with everyone. Physical activities are good choices for you, especially as something going on behind the scenes might make you anxious. Tonight: Privacy.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): This is a strong day for you because the Sun and retrograde Mercury are in your sign. In addition to which, Mars and Jupiter are at the top of your chart making you look great. Tonight: You're popular.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): You're noticed today. Perhaps it's because your obsession with something unusual is calling attention to you. This might hinder your relations with others. Tonight: You're admired.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): You're popular with others, especially younger people. Meanwhile, unexpected travel might be on the menu. Or perhaps travel plans are cancelled. Tonight: Explore.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Keep an eye on your banking details and anything to do with inheritances and shared property. Something unexpected might impact your assets. Fortunately, you look good in the eyes of others; they admire you. Tonight: Check your finances.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Be diplomatic and cooperative when dealing with others, especially partners and close friends, because your obsession with something unusual and your feelings of independence might create a problem with someone. Tonight: Be cooperative.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Dharmender Kumar Yadav, S/o Latu Rai Yadav R/o B-319, New Friends Colony, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.0450/2022 dated 01.12.2022 u/s 279/427 IPC, P.S. New Friends Colony, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Dharmender Kumar Yadav** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Dharmender Kumar Yadav** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Dharmender Kumar Yadav** of **FIR No.0450/2022 dated 01.12.2022 u/s 279/427 IPC, P.S. New Friends Colony, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.12.2026.**

By Order,
Sh. Vinod Joshi
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, South-East District
Room No.515, Saket Courts, New Delhi
DP/15876/SE/2026

KARNATAKA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
(CIN : U40109KA1999SGC025521)
No. CEE/T&P/SEE-2/2026-27/7862-74 Date : 02.11.2026

BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION
(THROUGH KARNATAKA PUBLIC PROCUREMENT PORTAL ONLY)

KPTCL invites Bids on electronic mode for the following work against following enquiry number on **Partial Turnkey basis.**

Sl No.	Enquiry number and Name of the Work
1	**KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4360**
	Establishing **3X150MVA, 220/66kV and 1X12.5MVA, 66/11 kV Sub-station at Kotehal (Holalkere)** along with construction of associated 220kV DC line for a distance of 43.092kms, 66kV MC line for a distance of **27.009kms** and construction of **02 Nos.** of 220kV Terminal Bays at ongoing 220/66kV Bharamasagara Sub-station in Holalkere Taluk, Chitradurga District.

The Bids will be received through electronic tendering mode only. The details regarding participation in the e-tendering process can be obtained by logging on to KPTCL website https://kptcl.karnataka.gov.in with hyperlink "E Procurement KPTCL" or https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in on or after **20.11.2026 @ 15:00hrs.** Last date & time for receipt of Bids **and any extension of Due date for Bid submission will be intimated in the Karnataka Public Procurement portal.** Any details required in this regard can also be obtained from the office of the undersigned during office hours.
All Corrigendum/Addendums shall be noticed by the bidders before the last date of submission of the Bids.

Sd/- Chief Engineer (Electy.), Tendering & Procurement, KPTCL, 9th Floor, Indhana Bhavana, A.R Circle, Bengaluru-560 009.

PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LTD.
Regd. office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001.
Corporate Identity Number: U40109PB2010SGC033813
[Website: www.pspel.in | (Contact no. 96461-20640)

Tender Enquiry no. 1965/Th.Op/O&M/PC-2834 Dated: 02-11-2026

Chief Engineer / O&M (P&P Cell-I), GHTP, Lehra Mohabbat- 151111 Distt. Bathinda invites E-tender for the Procurement of 140 MT of Sulphuric Acid for GHTP Lehra Mohabbat. Quantity as per NIT. For detailed NIT & Tender Specifications please refer to https://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 02.11.2026 from 17:00 hrs. Onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and Addendum, if any will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in

No. 16731/PB GHTP-81/26

PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
REGD. OFFICE:- PSEB HEAD OFFICE, THE MALL, PATIALA 147001
CORPORATION IDENTITY NUMBER(CIN):- U4019PB2010SGC033813
WEB SITE:- www.pspel.in Contact number (96461-22942)

Tender Inquiry No: 14/MHC/2026-27, 15/MHC/2026-27, 16/MHC/2026-27 Dated: 02.11.2026

Sr.Xen/Civil, MHC O&M Division Talwara invites E-Tender for following as per technical specification:
1. Restoration of damaged CC Lining slabs in between RD 1846 M to RD 2975 M on both sides of MHC-II during the year 2026-27. (14/MHC/2026-27)
2. Filling of cavities behind CC lining slabs by coarse sand grouting in between RD 31722 M to RD 35500 M on both sides of MHC-I during the year 2026-27 (15/MHC/2026-27)
3. OUTSOURCING OF ACTIVITY/SERVICES FOR WATCH & WARD, CUTTING & CLEARANCE OF WILD GROWTH FROM THE JOINTS OF CEMENT CONCRETE LINING SLABS, INTERNAL SIDE SLOPES /EMBANKMENTS /DRAIN, STONE PITCHING ETC. OF MHC-I&II FOR THE PERIOD OF ONE YEAR. (16/MHC/2026-27)

For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to https//eproc.punjab.gov.in from 03.11.2026. from 05:00 PM onwards. Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at https//eproc.punjab.gov.in

No. 16713/PB C-1039/26

GMDC Gujarat Mineral Development Corporation Ltd.
GMDC
TENDER NOTICE
E-Tender is invited for Sale/Disposal of Old Server and Storage at the Corporate office of GMDC.
For e tenders notice, tender documents and for further details visit our website **www.gmdcltd.com**.Tender shall be downloaded from **https://gmdc.nprocure.com** and submitted online as per e-tender notice. Please visit **https://gmdc.nprocure.com** for time to time for any corrigendum/addendum.
GMDC E-Tender No. : GMDC/IT/Servers/04/2026-27
n-Procure Tender No : 360568
EXPLORING LIMITLESS POSSIBILITIES
Gujarat Mineral Development Corporation Ltd.
(A Government of Gujarat Enterprise)
Khanij Bhawan, 132 Feet Ring Road,
Near University Ground, Vastrapur, Ahmedabad-380052

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-31
कन्स्ट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय)
एस0बी0 - 90, शास्त्री नगर, गाजियाबाद - 201002
ई-मेलः cdspmunit31@gmail.com
प्रधान कार्यालय : टी0सी0-38बी0, विभूति खण्ड, इण्डियन ऑयल के पास, गोमती नगर, लखनऊ-226010
निविदा सूचना सं0: 1978/Vividh-12/343
दिनांक : 31.10.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम की ओर से अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा **जनपद बुलन्दशहर के राजकीय महिला पोलीटैक्निक अर्निया में एक्सीलैन्स सेन्टर का निर्माण कार्य, अनुमानित लागत रू0 547.34 लाख (जी0एस0टी0 रहित एवं लेबर सेस सहित)** हेतु सी0एण्ड डी0एस0 में यथोचित श्रेणी में भवन कार्य हेतु पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से **दिनांक 30.11.2026 के अपरान्ह 16:00 बजे तक** अल्पकालीन ई-निविदाएं आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र **दिनांक 02.11.2026 से दिनांक 30.11.2026 के मध्य** उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement वेबसाइट **https://etender.up.nic.in** से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते हैं तथा ई-निविदा **दिनांक 01.12.2026 को पूर्वान्ह 14:30 बजे** सी0एण्ड डी0एस0,, यूनिट-31, उ0प्र0 जल निगम, गाजियाबाद में निविदा खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य **रू0 10,000.00+GST(18%) अतिरिक्त** देय होगा। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट **www.cdsupjn.org** एवं प्रोक्योमेन्ट पोर्टल **https://etender.up.nic.in** पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धिपत्र (Corrigendum) **https://etender.up.nic.in** पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, **इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा।** निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाईट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-31
कन्स्ट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय)
एस0बी0 - 90, शास्त्री नगर, गाजियाबाद - 201002
ई-मेलः cdspmunit31@gmail.com
प्रधान कार्यालय : टी0सी0-38बी0, विभूति खण्ड, इण्डियन ऑयल के पास, गोमती नगर, लखनऊ-226010
निविदा सूचना सं0: 1977/Vividh-12/342
दिनांक : 31.10.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम की ओर से अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा **Construction of Community Centre at Nagar Panchayat Narora, Distt-Bulandshahr, अनुमानित लागत रू0 114.22 लाख (जी0एस0टी0 रहित एवं लेबर सेस सहित)** हेतु सी0एण्ड डी0एस0 में यथोचित श्रेणी में भवन कार्य हेतु पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से **दिनांक 30.11.2026 के अपरान्ह 16:00 बजे तक** अल्पकालीन ई-निविदाएं आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र **दिनांक 02.11.2026 से दिनांक 30.11.2026 के मध्य** उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement वेबसाइट **https://etender.up.nic.in** से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते हैं तथा ई-निविदा **दिनांक 01.12.2026 को पूर्वान्ह 14:30 बजे** सी0एण्ड डी0एस0,, यूनिट-31, उ0प्र0 जल निगम, गाजियाबाद में निविदा खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य **रू0 10,000.00+GST(18%) अतिरिक्त** देय होगा। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट **www.cdsupjn.org** एवं प्रोक्योमेन्ट पोर्टल **https://etender.up.nic.in** पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धिपत्र (Corrigendum) **https://etender.up.nic.in** पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, **इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा।** निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाईट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	CONSTRUCTION OF KITCHEN/STORE IN THE AREA OF ARYA NAGAR COMMUNITY CENTRE IN WARD NO. 42, BALLABGARH. + 12 WORKS	29.10.2026 05.11.2026	2,18,04,166/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292411649 xenmcf4@gmail.com
2	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	ESTIMATE FOR REPAIRING OF ROADS THROUGH CEMENT CONCRETE M-25 GRADE AT GALI NO 06,07 22' ROAD., MANJEET WALI GALI PCA 100 WARD NO. 18 FARIDABAD + 16 WORKS	30.10.2026 06.11.2026	4,67,04,105/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292411649 mcfameut1@gmail.com
3	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	ESTIMATE FOR CONSTRUCTION OF BOUNDARY WALL AND GRASSING IN FRONT OF HOUSE NO. 1939, SECTOR 28, WARD NO. 30 DIV-V + 3 WORKS	30.10.2026 06.11.2026	53,26,142/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292411649 xenmcf5@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50695/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MAHARAJA AGRASEN MEDICAL COLLEGE, AGROHA (HISAR)	COMPREHENSIVE HOUSE KEEPING AND COLLEGE MECHANISED SANITATION SERVICES WITH CLEANING MATERIALS FOR TWO YEARS EXTENDABLE BY ONE ADDITIONAL YEAR SUBJECT TO SATISFACTORY PERFORMANCE. COMPLETE IN ALL RESPECTS IN THE PREMISES OF MAMC, AGROHA (HISAR)	29.10.2026 16.11.2026	12,68,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8930200823 eb@mamc.edu.in
2	MAHARAJA AGRASEN MEDICAL COLLEGE, AGROHA (HISAR)	1.SITC OF EQUIPMENTS OPHTHALMOLOGY 2026_HRY_549326_2 2.INSTALLATION OF ESR ANALYZER FOR PATHOLOGY 2026_HRY_540864_4	30.10.2026 12.11.2026	130 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8930200824 purchase@mamc.edu.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50692/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF VARIOUS IPB AND CC STREETS (ULB_RTK_04551,04552,04624,04635,04416,04418,04415,04245,04530, 04531,02292,02213) IN WARD-13, MCR + 1 WORKS	30.10.2026 10.11.2026	1,56,84,608/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467283967 xenmcrohtak@gmail.com
2	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF GATE IN MAL GODAM ROAD , WARD NO. 18, M.C ROHTAK. + 1 WORKS	30.10.2026 06.11.2026	8,70,740/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467283967 xenmcrohtak@gmail.com
3	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	ESTIMATE FOR CLEANING AND MAINTENANCE WORK OF VARIOUS COMMUNITY CENTRES, PEHRAWAR STADIUM AND OTHER STADIUM WITHIN THE LIMIT OF M.C. ROHTAK.	31.10.2026 09.11.2026	40.28 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467283967 engg-rohtak@ulbharyana.gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50694/HRY

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Rajeev Kumar Mallick** S/o Sh. Virender Mallick R/o A-6, Raju Park Deoli Road, Khanpur, South Delhi-110062 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC NI ACT 7102/2019 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Moti Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Rajeev Kumar Mallick** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rajeev Kumar Mallick** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Rajeev Kumar Mallick** in **CC NI ACT 7102/2019 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Moti Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.12.2026**.

By order
Sh. Gaurav Singhal
Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI ACT)-04
West District, Room No. 04 (Annex-I)
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/15790/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sh. Ram Ratan Pal, S/o Late Pool Singh R/o H.No. 1449/112, Gali No. 3, Durgapuri, Shahdara, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in case **CT Case No. 12381/2018 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Jafrabad, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sh. Ram Ratan Pal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sh. Ram Ratan Pal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sh. Ram Ratan Pal** of **CT Case No. 12381/2018 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Jafrabad, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.01.2027.**

By Order
Ms. Manisha Bhau
Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI Act)
Shahdara District, Room No. G-05
New Court Building, Ground Floor
Karkardooma Court, Delhi
DP/15708/NE/2026

Sooryavanshi, Rinku in India A squad for Rising Stars Asia Cup

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 2

INDIAN SELECTORS have named a formidable India A side for the upcoming Asian Cricket Council (ACC) Men's Rising Stars Asia Cup to be held in Doha, Qatar, from November 19 to 29, 2026.

The side is packed with players like Abhishek Sharma, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Tilak Varma [who is the captain of the side], and Rinku Singh.

India A are placed in Group B alongside the United Arab Emirates (UAE), Nepal, and Pakistan A. Group A comprises Bangladesh A, Sri Lanka A, Afghanistan A and Hong Kong, China. The top two teams from each group will advance to the semi-finals, scheduled for November 26 and 27.

The final will take place on Sunday, November 29.

INDIA A SQUAD: Abhishek Sharma, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Prabhsimran Singh [WK], Tilak Varma [C], Rajat Patidar [VC], Rinku Singh, Kumar Kushagra [WK], Suryansh Shedge, Shahbaz Ahmed, Vipraj Nigam, Harsh Dubey, Tanush Kotian, Harshit Rana, Prince Yadav, Arshad Khan

Rachin, Chapman ruled out ODI series

New Zealand will be without batsmen Rachin Ravindra and Mark Chapman for their upcoming ODI series against India, the country's cricket board said on Monday.

New Zealand Cricket (NZC) further said that Tim Seifert, who had been selected for only the last two matches of the five-match ODI series, will be in the squad for the full rubber, while Henry Nicholls will be available for the first to third matches. Dean Foxcroft has been called up for the fourth and fifth matches.

"A recent MRI showed Chapman's left hamstring requires another two weeks of rehabilitation before he is fully fit to return to the field, whilst Ravindra's right shoulder requires more recovery time before he's able to field at full capacity," said the NZC.

"Everyone knows what an asset Mark and Rachin are to this side so it's a shame they have to miss this series," said head coach Rob Walter. "I caught up with Mark last week and although he's disappointed he's working hard to get back on the field. With Rachin, his shoulder hasn't quite recovered to a position where he could field comfortably in white-ball cricket, so with the Test series later this month we don't want to take any undue risks."

IMPACT PLAYER

Dhir's journey from schoolboy's TV dream to India colours

A father's faith, a coach's guidance and years of perseverance have shaped Faridkot all-rounder

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, November 2



Naman Dhir was named India's impact player of the five-match T20I series against New Zealand. CREIMAS

WHEN NAMAN Dhir was in eighth standard, his father asked him a question. Did he want to see his name on the school honours board or on TV?

"TV," Naman said.

"I told him we would support him," Naresh Kumar Dhir told *The Indian Express*.

The second conversation came in 2021. Naman had not been picked for the Punjab side, and the family was thinking of sending him to his elder sister Sheenam in Edmonton, Canada. "Papa, give me one more year," Naman said.

On Sunday, Dhir Sr thought of both conversations. Naman was named India's impact player of the five-match T20I series against hosts New Zealand, and collected the medal in the dressing room. "To see him now play for India is a special feeling, and the result of his hard work," he said.

Growing up in the Mohalla Pukran locality of Faridkot, Naman played with neighbourhood kids in the street. His father worked at a medical shop, and Naman did well in studies too. Dhir Sr, who later ran a surgical wholesale business, remembers that the boy had only one demand from his maternal grandmother, Satya Sethi. "Naman would always tell her to bring a new bat for him," he says.

Young prodigy

In 2008, Naman was spotted playing near his home by Arunvir Devgan, the Faridkot Cricket Association's former physical trainer and a former junior team-mate of Yuvraj Singh. Devgan asked the parents to send their son to train under coach Gagan Sidhu.

Within years he was in the Faridkot U-14, U-16 and U-19 teams, a minor district in the Punjab Cricket Association's lower division.

"I was impressed by his bat grip and follow-through as a young eight-year-old. I took him to Gagan Sidhu. Sidhu *paji* worked a lot on his footwork.



A young Dhir with his late coach, Gagan Sidhu. EXPRESS

Naman once scored a quadruple century in a two-day U-16 match against Barnala," Devgan says. "He would shift to Patiala to train in the off season, and he knew minor-district players had to score heavily to make the Punjab teams. Once, when Naman had an exam in 11th, the teachers told his parents he could not miss it. But his father had so much faith in him that he made Naman skip the exam and play the match," adds Devgan.

Naman made the Punjab Ranji Trophy team in 2022 and hit two hundreds that season. In 2023 he was the second-highest run-getter in the Sher-E-Punjab league, with 466 runs at a strike rate of 192.56, and took eight wickets with his off-spin. The same year, Sidhu died of a kidney ailment.

> **"I was impressed by his bat grip and follow-through as a young eight-year-old. I took him to Gagan Sidhu. Sidhu *paji* worked on his footwork. Naman once scored a quadruple century in a two-day U-16 match."**
>
> **ARUNVIR DEVGAN,** FARIDKOT CRICKET ASSOCIATION'S FORMER PHYSICAL TRAINER

Mumbai Indians picked him for Rs 20 lakh ahead of the 2024 IPL. He made a ten-ball 20 on debut against Gujarat Titans, hitting Afghanistan's Azmatullah Omarzai for three fours and a six. Later that year, they used the RTM card at the mega auction to retain him for Rs 5.25 crore.

"Naman was playing a match in Gujarat when he received the news of Gagan Sidhu's death. His bond with Gagan was like a godparent's, and he cried a lot that day. We wish Gagan was alive to see Naman play in the India jersey," says Dhir Sr.

Breaking the shackles

Naman made 252 runs at a strike rate of 182.61 in the 2025 IPL, and 318 at 147.22 in this year's. After the IPL he topped the Sher-E-Punjab T20 league, with 657 runs at a strike rate of 208.92 and seven wickets for winners Amritsar Soormas. Soormas batting coach Manish Sharma, a former U-19 World Cup winner, first saw Naman in 2017-18.

"Punjab had a triangular series of major district and minor district teams. That was the first time I saw Naman batting. He had good basics and was technically very sound. I remember recommending him to the selectors as a prospect. During the 2023 Sher-E-Punjab season, he showed his range of shots, including the pull, and his ability to counter short balls," says Sharma.

Days after Soormas won the title, Naman was called up for India's T20 and ODI sides for the home series against West Indies. He showed his hard hitting in a six-ball 24 in the rain-abandoned fifth T20I at Bengaluru.

In New Zealand he played an unbeaten, match-winning 15-ball 42 at number seven in the first T20I, then a 17-ball 31 in the second. He finished the series with 138 runs at a strike rate of 157.8.

Sharma sees Naman as a long-term middle-order option for India's white-ball team. "Naman decides early how to tackle pace, and he showed that in New Zealand too. He has worked on playing spin as well, and it was on display in Sher-E-Punjab, where he hit them with a straight bat."

Naresh Kumar Dhir had asked his son whether he wanted to see his name on TV. On Sunday, he watched it there.

• Number Plate

42

- Naman Dhir broke the record for the highest score by an Indian batter at No. 7 or lower in a successful T20I chase when he made 42 not out off 15 balls in the first T20I at Christchurch, which India won by four wickets.
- The previous best was by all-rounder Irfan Pathan who had made 33 not out off 16 balls at No. 8 against Sri Lanka in Colombo in 2009.

Siraj finds his rhythm ahead of ODIs, Tests

Express News Service
Mumbai, November 2



Mohd Siraj picked four wickets against New Zealand A. FILE

IN SEPTEMBER, while turning out for South Zone in the Duleep Trophy final against East Zone in Chennai, Mohammed Siraj candidly admitted that the two-month break from the end of the IPL to the two-Test series against Sri Lanka had affected his rhythm. "Every bowler's body is different, but mine doesn't handle long breaks well," the pacer said, admitting that he needed extended spells to get his body moving again.

Since then, Siraj has gone looking for that rhythm, first through first-class cricket, playing two Ranji Trophy games for Hyderabad before joining India A for the second unofficial Test against New Zealand A in Christchurch.

Though he is part of India's ODI squad for the five-match series against New Zealand, the management also wants him ready for the Tests later this month. This game, therefore, was a chance to get some overs and wickets under his belt.

He did just that on Monday. After finishing Day 2 with 1/49 in 16 overs, the 32-year-old needed one ball on the third morning to strike. Matthew Boyle, unbeaten on 107 overnight, pushed at a length delivery outside off and edged to Devdutt Padikkal at slip. The catch ended Boyle's 110-run innings and a 208-run fourth-wicket partnership with Dean Foxcroft. It was only the start.

He then removed Foxcroft for 93, getting one to jag back into the right-hander as he came down the track. Foxcroft missed his flick and was struck in front of the stumps.

At the other end, Mukesh Kumar was matching him. The Bengal seamer, who is not in the Test squad, had claimed two of the three wickets that fell on Day 2, leaving New Zealand A reeling at 13/3.

The contest between the two continued on Monday. Mukesh removed Mitchell Hay for 31, with Dhruv Jurel taking an edge behind the stumps, before Siraj bowled Brett Randell for five with a delivery that moved back in and hit the top of off. Both had three wickets at that stage, with the hosts placed at 291/7.

But Mukesh had the last word among the two Indian quicks. He dismissed Kristian Clarke for 41 and Fraser Sheat for 40, completing his 12th first-class five-wicket haul. He finished with 5/87 from 29 overs, while Siraj ended with 4/118 from 35 overs.

For Siraj, the significance of the outing lay as much in the workload as the wickets. His 35 overs gave him another long red-ball spell after his recent Ranji outings, and he was able to keep going even after New Zealand A's top order had made him work for breakthroughs.

Stubborn tail

New Zealand A had resumed at 218/3 and were eventually bowled out for 424, giving India A a 78-run first-innings deficit. After Boyle and Foxcroft were separated, Hay and Randell also fell in quick succession, but the lower order refused to fold.

Kristian Clarke and Fraser Sheat added 47 for the eighth wicket, and after Mukesh removed both, Lennox and Jarrod McKay added 55 for the last wicket before Washington Sundar removed McKay to end the innings. The final three wickets added 133 runs to frustrate the India A bowlers.

The visitors negotiated 11 overs without losing a wicket, reaching 32/0 at stumps. Yashasvi Jaiswal was unbeaten on 20 and Sai Sudharsan on 11. They still trail by 46, but on Monday, Siraj got the miles he wanted, and Mukesh won the battle of the pacers with his five-fer.

BRIEF SCORES: **India A** 346 and 32/0 in 11 overs trail **New Zealand A** 424 all out in 132.5 overs (Matthew Boyle 110, Dean Foxcroft 93; Mukesh Kumar 5/87, Mohammed Siraj 4/118) by 46 runs

• PANT UNLIKELY FOR THIRD INDIA A TEST

RISHABH PANT is unlikely to feature in India A's third unofficial Test in Lincoln scheduled from November 7 to 10 as he is yet to be declared fit from his side strain sustained during the Irani Cup game in Srinagar last month.

PANT IS doing rehabilitation routine at the BCCI Centre of Excellence in Bengaluru and is yet to clear the fitness test mandated to join the squad for the India A unofficial Tests against the Kiwis.

HIS NEXT fitness test is on November 9 and hence there is no chance that he will be playing India A's third Test.

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Sarfaraz on India omission: I ask myself, 'Why should I work harder'?

Devendra Pandey
Mumbai, November 2



Sarfaraz Khan's last Test appearance was in 2024. FILE

SARFARAZ KHAN couldn't control his frustration and emotion as he spoke about his non-inclusion in the India Test team. His last Test appearance came in 2024 against New Zealand before warming the bench in Australia during the Border-Gavaskar Trophy and thereafter being sidelined completely despite scoring consistently in domestic cricket. On the sideline of the Ranji Trophy game against Railways, the Mumbai batsman put his heart out. From 97 kilograms to 77 kilograms to improve his fitness, the Mumbai batter has done everything possible to put his case forward.

To restart every season is getting tougher and tougher but Sarfaraz is not giving up. "*Har subah utatha hoon,* (I wake up every morning) and ask myself the same question. Why should I work harder and undergo the same thing again and again. I have played for India. I wake up at 5am in the morning and go to practice. *Chahoon to Mumbai ke liye khel sakta hoon* and I am still playing. Sometimes I get that question in my mind. But when I see that my father is working hard for me, *mein unko liye ab score karna chahta hoon*. This is the only factor which is motivating me," he said after scoring fifty at the Brabourne Stadium.

The selection committee picked him for two Test match series against Sri Lanka after Sai Sudharsan didn't recover from his injury. Sarfaraz says he didn't know that he would get a call for the Sri Lanka tour. "I was batting in the NCA. They called me there and I didn't get an opportunity. I came back and played cricket in Mumbai. I am just playing. They (selector) will call me wherever I get a chance. I will go and play. If they don't call me, I will play here."

Battling perception

When asked whether the selectors had clearly communicated the areas they wanted him to improve, Sarfaraz appeared to have more questions than answers. A perception has taken hold that he cannot bat in overseas conditions.

"When I went to the Indian team, I heard that I will be given more chances in Indian conditions but still I have a question. When I went to Africa, I scored 100 runs against the Indian team in 60 balls. When I went to England, I scored 100 runs in 60 balls. So I think when you come back (in India), you will get such a big rank turner in India. You struggle so much and suddenly you won't be able to work with such a difficult wicket. It's not that I didn't score outside. I scored outside too. That's their look out, that's their point of view. But my job is to play cricket, and I will continue playing," the Mumbai middle-order added.

He was hoping to be picked for India A squad for the New Zealand tour, but the selectors didn't pick him.

Somewhere Sarfaraz feels that he didn't get the support from the people who mattered. "Everyone knows that I don't have support in my life. If I have support, it is only from my father. No one has supported me in my life. But it's okay. I have worked hard. I fulfilled my father's dream. It's not easy to play in India in this generation. And I didn't score once or twice and played in India. I scored 300's, 200's, 250's.If someone supports me, it's my father. I will keep working hard as much as I can," he points out.

Openers set the tone

Railways needed to make the most of the helpful conditions on a hazy morning if they had to be competitive against in-form Mumbai. But openers Angkrish Raghuvanshi and Divyaansh Saxena negotiated the tricky period expertly as their century opening partnership helped Mumbai reach 247 for six on Day 1 against Railways on Monday.

BRIEF SCORES: **Mumbai** 247 for 6 (Angkrish Raghuvanshi 78, Sarfaraz Khan 55; Himanshu Sangwan 3 for 32) vs **Railways**

Paliwal scores century without a glance at the scoreboard

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, November 2



Services' Rajat Paliwal scored his 21st ton on Monday. EXPRESS

RAJAT PALIWAL has his idiosyncrasies.

On Monday, the Services captain ended a two-year wait for a Ranji Trophy century with an unbeaten 111 against Delhi. Yet, save for the applause of the opposition, he had no means of knowing he had reached the milestone. His scores are never shown on the scoreboard; the scorers have been instructed accordingly. "I have been following this since COVID. The scoreboard draws attention, so I have taken it out of the picture entirely so that I concentrate only on the game. Today, I realised I had scored a century only through the reaction of the Delhi players," he said.

Tuesday marks the start of his 16th year with Services, a career that has yielded 7,028 runs and 20 centuries before this one. The 21st, though, carried a significance of its own.

"This hundred is very special, especially because the team had lost four wickets for 40-odd runs and we needed this knock. This has come after a long time and at a critical juncture before a break, to set the tone for the next phase."

Paliwal had walked in at 27/3, on a pitch he described as one that "may not look dangerous at first, but sudden balls can behave unpredictably."

With no steady partner at the other end, Services' second-highest score being 33, he built vital stands with the tail and took his side to 266.

The innings followed an unbeaten 48 against Bengal and 44 against Maharashtra, the start of a comeback after a 2025/26 season in which he made 264 runs. "The previous season was not good, I'll admit. But I prepared well for this season. I started my preparation in May itself, and then performed in a competitive Inter-Services tournament. When you have runs under your belt, that confidence transitions into your Ranji Trophy performance as well. That is what happened with me."

At 34, Paliwal is reworking his game to prolong his career. "Until my thirties, my focus was only on my skills. But as I grew older, I realised that I need to work on both my fitness and my body to stay on top of my game. Paras Dogra has been an inspiration in this regard. He became a Ranji champion in his forties. When you look at him consistently performing at that age, you feel confident about yourself as well."

For Delhi, Aman Chaudhary was the most effective bowler, taking four wickets in only his second senior fixture. The left-arm spinner, 21, who models his game on Sri Lanka's Rangana Herath and is pursuing English honours, said: "I can only thank the selectors for picking me after watching me only in the nets. Before this season, I had played only one Cooch Behar Trophy match."

The day, however, belonged to Paliwal, who at 34 carries burdens beyond the boundary rope. As he posed for photographs, he asked that his team's front-of-shirt sponsor be kept in the frame. The reason was simple: "We overcame numerous challenges to finally get a sponsor on board. *Warna Services ko kaun hi poochta hai?* [Else, who cares about Services?]"

Paliwal's fight is to ensure people do.

BRIEF SCORES: **Services** 266 all out in 88 overs (Rajat Paliwal 111 not out; Aman Chaudhary 4/79) vs **Delhi**

• RANJI ROUND-UP

TWIN TONS RESCUE PUNJAB

Salil Arora continued his prolific start to the Ranji Trophy season with an unbeaten 111 as Punjab recovered from 71/5 to reach 276/5 in their Group B match against Andhra in New Chandigarh. **Brief scores:** Punjab 276/5 in 80 overs (Salil Arora 111 not out, Sanvir Singh 100 not out; Kavuri Saiteja 3/65) vs Andhra.

20 WICKETS FALLS IN HP

20 wickets fell on the opening day of the Group D clash between Himachal Pradesh and Rajasthan in Dharamsala. **Brief scores:** Rajasthan 78 in 30.3 overs (Abhishek Kumar 5/14, Jitender Rana 3/22) and 8/0 in one over trail Himachal Pradesh 153 in 40 overs (Ankush Bains 56, Pukhraj Mann 42; Sahil Dhiwan 5/50) by 67 runs.

PRADOSH STARS FOR TN

Pradosh Ranjan Paul's unbeaten 138 headlined a dominant opening day for Tamil Nadu in their Group D clash against Chandigarh at the Sector 16 stadium. **Brief scores:** Tamil Nadu 320/4 in 86 overs (Pradosh Ranjan Paul 138 not out, N Jagadeesan 52, Baba Indrajith 51) vs Chandigarh.

DESAI, URVIL STAR FOR GUJ

Aarya Desai's 95 helped Gujarat reach 300/5 against Kerala in their Group C clash in Ahmedabad. **Brief scores:** Gujarat 300/5 in 83 overs (Aarya Desai 95; Urvil Patel 63 not out) vs Kerala

India blank Korea 8-0 in ACT, to face them again in semi-finals



Dilpreet Singh (C) scored a brace in India's resounding win. HI

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 2

THERE WAS a time when South Korea ran India close on the hockey turf and caused them grief on a regular basis. That now seems like ancient history. India are the strongest team in the continent, while the East Asians are no longer the force they used to be, having failed to qualify for the most recent World Cup and Olympics.

The gulf in class was evident at Jalandhar's Olympian Surjit Singh Hockey Stadium on Monday, as India, bronze medallists at the last two Olympics, thrashed the Koreans 8-0 to finish their round-robin engagements at the Asian Champions Trophy.

Dilpreet Singh (8th, 40th minutes) struck a brace, while Jugraj Singh (11th), Harmanpreet Singh (15th), Shilanand Lakra (33rd), Sukhjeet Singh (34th), Sanjay (36th) and Angad Bir Singh (60th) were also on target.

After the 13-0 romp against Bangladesh, Craig Fulton's men did not have things all their way against China, Japan and Malaysia, but pulled away decisively in the second half of those games to maintain their winning streak. Against Korea, they hardly faced any resistance.

The tournament now shifts to Mohali, where India will play the Koreans again, this time in the semi-finals on Wednesday. Malaysia will face Japan to decide the other team in the title clash.

Fulton was delighted with his team's performance on Monday.

"We played really well. I enjoyed it. We played our style of hockey. We were good on the ball. When we start to move the ball, transfer the ball, it's difficult for them. That's a lot of goals," the South African was quoted as saying.

However, he said the big margin of victory would count for nothing when the two teams meet again in the last four.

"The pressure is different. We need a good start. That's the key."

Captain Harmanpreet believed the team is in a good space. "If you are getting opportunities and scoring, it's definitely an advantage. We are creating opportunities in every match, but sometimes we score and sometimes we don't. Next match is a new day, but we will come with the same attitude," he said.

Forward Abhishek was injured during the warm-up before Sunday's match against Malaysia, and there is no certainty of him being available for the semi-final.

ISSF WORLDS

From Nagoya to Doha: Shooters begin LA Games quota hunt

Little rest and new faces mark India's Doha World Championship campaign

Shashank Nair
New Delhi, November 2

THE INDIAN shooting team, like several other Asian squads, will be at a disadvantage at the ISSF World Championship in Doha, with the competition beginning this week.

As was the case with the Wrestling Worlds, India too has sent a squad with members of the Asian Games team that went to Nagoya. With little time to rest, the team is a mix of the Asian Games group usually expected to be the first names on any squad list, followed by an inexperienced group of shooters who performed well enough at the multiple domestic trials but have had limited exposure to competitions outside the country.

The timing of the Asian Games has meant that European countries will come to Doha fresher. The World Championships will also officially be the start of the qualification cycle for the Los Angeles Olympics. Three quota spots will be on offer in each of the 12 individual Olympic events. "There is no turnaround time," admitted Indian shooting's high-performance director Pierre Beauchamp. "If you look at the Olympics and Asian Games, it takes several months for people to psychologically and emotionally recover. And there's no recovery time. So for European teams, this is a huge advantage, because there will be over 100 countries there that will go up."

The short turnaround affected some of the Indian wrestlers – particularly Sujeet Kalkal, who couldn't train after his gold medal at the Asian Games and was undercooked for the Worlds. With some of India's best shooters, the challenge is similar.

Take the case of Manu Bhaker. India's double Olympic bronze medallist failed to win a medal in either the 10m or 25m pistol events at Nagoya, but is now one of the established names along with Suruchi Phogat in a pistol team that is largely untested barring the duo. Beauchamp said that the coaches have tried to deal with the constraints. "When you're not completely recovered, there's a cognitive deficit and you need to find a way to re-energise yourself. So we've had several workshops with the athletes about what their focus points are. Coaches are doing debriefs on a regular basis, helping them to set meaningful goals, so that they can reset quickly," he says. "There's only so much you can do."

Fresh names

Other than the duo, the 10m pistol teams on both the men's and women's sides are largely untested. Kamaljeet Sohlot, whose first big-ticket event was the Nagoya Asiad, where he won mixed-team gold with Suruchi, leads the men's team along with first-timers Ravin Kumar and Jaypal Malviya.

The third shooter in the women's 10m team, Sainyam Vij, exemplifies the churn within the team. Bhaker, Suruchi and Esha Singh are all within the top 15 in the world, and that lends itself to fewer chances in the bigger events, especially in the 10m pistol. But the proximity of the events means that, in the end, a good average in the trials can open the door to an opportunity — one that Vij has put herself in a position to take.

Winning an Olympic quota in her event also comes with perks domestically. Under the rejigged Olympic Selection Trials for selecting the squad for the LA Olympics, winning a quota comes with a bonus point that gets added along with the average score at the trials. In a hotly-contested discipline, it could add up. Vij might be new to the locales of a Worlds, but she knows how this plays out.

"The competition in this game is with yourself, so you need to be better than yourself from before. I don't focus on anybody, what they are doing, what they are shooting, what's their score. I focus on my mind that I have to improve my score. I know what scores will help me get into the team, or what scores are enough to get into the finals," says Vij.

India had stitched together 22 quotas ahead of the Paris Olympics. It was a marked improvement from the 12 they had earned ahead of the 2016 Rio Olympics, and the 15 they had at Tokyo. Beauchamp said the aim is to pick up as many quotas as possible and get to that magical number of 24.

"You need to demonstrate patience, belief in your team and belief in the country that we will come through by the time we get there," said India's HPD. "If you remember the last cycle, we were missing a quota for the women's pistol. We sent a group to Rio and they achieved the quota at that. So we have all of this on the calendar. It's all there and we're planning for it."



Manu Bhaker will lead an inexperienced pistol team at the Worlds. ANI

• India's new faces

When Samrat Rana made his World Championships debut at the previous edition, few would have expected him to go on to win gold. Yet two years later, Rana is not part of India's team, nor is Paris Olympics bronze medallist Sarabjot Singh. It is another example of the churn that has become commonplace in Indian shooting, particularly in the pistol events.

10M MEN'S TEAM Perhaps nothing exemplifies the frequency of change better than the 10m pistol team. 24-year-old Ravin Kumar will make his international debut in Doha - and it will also be his first time travelling abroad, having taken his first-ever flight to reach the World Championships.

Then there is 31-year-old Jaypal Malviya, who will be competing at only his second international event. Both Malviya and Kumar earned their places in the team through their performances in the domestic trials, with their averages enough to secure a place on the flight to Doha.

25M RAPID FIRE PISTOL
Gurmeet Singh, who finished seventh at the Rio Olympics, returns to the national team after almost a decade. Suraj Sharma, who made his senior international debut only this year, is also part of the squad, with Bhavesh Shekhawat completing the team.

Dhinidhi wins India's first global swimming medal at Youth Oly

Pritish Raj
New Delhi, November 2

DHINIDHI DESINGHU was once afraid of going into a swimming pool but on Monday, the 16-year-old made history by becoming the first-ever Indian to win a global medal in the sport after clinching a 100m freestyle bronze at the Youth Olympics in Dakar, Senegal.

Dhinidhi clocked 56.27s in the final to set a new national record, lowering her own previous mark of 56.57, set at the Indian Championships in Ahmedabad on June 18. The teenager from Bengaluru had earlier topped her heat in 56.80 seconds to qualify for the final as the third-fastest swimmer. Croatia's Ana Bobanovic (56.22s) and Alyssa Lawson of New Zealand (56.53s) were the only swimmers quicker than her in the heats.

Dhinidhi's medal also opened India's account at the ongoing Youth Olympics.

The prodigy, who made her senior Olympics debut in Paris at 14, was more happy with her timing.

"I wanted the gold and my plan was to go sub-56s. When I saw the result on the board, I was not exactly thrilled. But when I stood on the podium, the feeling of winning a medal finally sank in," Dhinidhi told *The Indian Express* from Dakar.

Before traveling to the Youth Olympics, Dhinidhi had set a target of lowering the national record.

"I didn't think much about the medal when I landed here. My whole focus was on improving my personal best. But as I topped the heats, the confidence of a podium finish came naturally," she said.

Dhinidhi swam a strong second half after clocking 27.31s over the first 50m, being placed fifth at the turn, before making up time and places to finish third behind Bobanovic and Lawson.

"I didn't swim here for three days after landing due to the pool's closure. The weather was also hot and sticky but I think now that I have settled in, I will perform well in my next events," she said.

Dhinidhi is set to compete in the women's 200m individual medley on Wednesday and the 200m freestyle on Friday.

"I am proud of her. She has achieved what no other Indian swimmer has done," Dhinidhi's mother Jesitha said. "She has always been a hardworking athlete and today's result was just the culmination of her efforts over the years."

> **"I wanted the gold and my plan was to go sub-56s. When I saw the result on the board, I was not exactly thrilled. But when I stood on the podium, the feeling of winning a medal finally sank in"**
> **DHINIDHI DESINGHU,** ON HER AIM FOR THE 100M FREESTYLE

Generational talent

Dronacharya awardee coach Nihar Ameen, under whom Dhinidhi trains at Dolphin Aquatics in Bengaluru, calls her a generational talent.

"When she came here, she had no idea what swimming was. She was a nine-year-old training with kids four or five years older than her," Amin told this newspaper.

The coach said that Dhinidhi targeted a personal best, but the medal is a historic one.

"I always told her to work hard and the medals will come. Her target was to get the personal best and in the process, the medal arrived. I believe she will do better in the 200m freestyle."

Dhinidhi trains under Amin and Madhu Kumar at the academy.

"When we first saw her and how crazy she was about working hard, we realised that we have got a special talent. Sometimes, we have to call her out from the pool, she is that kind of an athlete," Amin added.

At the age of 16, Dhinidhi has experience of competing at the Olympics, Asian Games and World Championships. Amin believes she is a potential flagbearer of the sport in the country.

"She is going to raise the standard of the sport in the country. She is already dominating at the national level, has defeated Chinese swimmers in age-group competitions, and has now won a global medal. All these are signs of what she can do when her body reaches its full potential," the coach felt.

With a couple of events left, Dhinidhi has the opportunity to further burnish her credentials and make a name for herself in a sport where Indian has hardly had any success.



Dhinidhi won a bronze medal in 100m freestyle. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Father in coach's seat is not ideal, says Kharb Sr

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, November 2

ONE OF Indian badminton's (sport's at large) biggest problems in the past many years has been excessive interference of parents in coaching matters. Devender Kharb who sits for daughter Anmol's matches and was again courtside when she made her first Super 500 semifinals at Hylo Open, has decided to step back and hand over the guiding reins to a professional coach, saying, there are drawbacks to controlling that aspect of an athlete's game.

"I realised if she trained under a proper coach instead of being coached by me, it was far better for her game," Devender said, while informing that Anmol had shifted base to National Centre of Excellence, Guwahati, and was now being coached by 54-year-old Malaysian coach Sankar Annamalai.

"Coaches like Park, Sankar Sir can help players go from 0 to 100. Main toh kuchh nahi hoo unke experience and tactical understanding ke saamne (I'm not as adept at formal coaching as them)," he would say.



Anmol Kharb was beaten by PV Sindhu in the Hylo Open semis. FILE

Elaborating on the issue where he gave it a a go for couple of years, but found himself out of depth in seniors, he admitted, "At best I can motivate her if she's slumping in a match. If she makes too many mistakes, I would get angry like a father would. But that doesn't work for the athlete. It's a bad idea and she needed a professional coach," Devender added. Anmol defeated Wotld No 12 Line Christophersen and No 21 Unnati Hooda in back-to-back matches at Saarbrucken, but lost to PV Sindhu who went on to win the title.

The Faridabad parent also realised that as the level of play on the Tour increases, he found himself at a loss of the exact coaching tips needed in crucial moments. "Pro coaches can instruct when to move from defense to offense. I realised I was only reacting to her points and not anticipating them or what opponent was trying to do. All the badminton I know is because of Anmol, otherwise I'm just a national kabaddi player," he would add, having mulled over the decision and packing her off to Guwahati a month and half back.

Earlier, she had trained at the Gopichand academy, but headed back home for her Class 12 boards interrupting the stint. "Gopi sir training was excellent, she really picked up a lot there. Kamaal hi khelne lagi thi. But we insisted she focus on studies for 6 months so that couldn't be helped. We were training on our own at that point but she was struggling without a coach," he added. BAI secretary Sanjay Mishra would suggest she move to Guwahati and OGQ and Yonex lined up to fill in the funding gaps for 6-8 tournaments out of 20-22.

It's been a tough two bridge-years to seniors for the 19-year-old. "Meeting top names like Chen Yufei, An Se-young and Putri Kusuma Wardani in first round can be tough," he says of 4 such occasions, though the remainder of the tournaments offered the reality checks needed.

"She kept fighting, she's always been good at that. But I realised it would be better if a coach like Sankar Sir went with her instead of me," he recalls. "After coming back from Hyderabad her game went down. Now her attack is better, stamina work is better that shows in court speed. Technically, she's using her wrist more than her shoulder, and that helped her beat World No 12," he says, speaking from the Korea Super 500 where she plays this week.

While she rushed and made some wide errors against Sindhu, Devender reckons Unnati's was a match she could have wrapped up in two, even as the latter showed grit to fight back in semifinals. "*Sindhu ke saath mahaan coach the* (Irwansyah). And her cheering squad definitely succeeded in distracting Anmol over 3 crucial points at least. These are things that are bound to happen and she needs to learn to play through it," he recalls. It was yet another occasion when he realised a proper coach like Sankar, Park or Gopichand or Gurusaidutt could've guided her to deal with it better. "I hope Sankar Sir can travel with her and help her game," he added, looking ahead to next season.

• HISTORY-MAKER

Mercedes driver Antonelli becomes youngest champion in F1 history at age 20

Associated Press
Mexico City, November 2

AFTER CROSSING the finish line of the Mexico City Grand Prix behind race winner Max Verstappen and Lewis Hamilton, F1 history-maker Kimi Antonelli placed his hands on the steering wheel and his voice cracked as he said, "We did it, we did it." Although the 20-year-old Mercedes driver finished third in the Mexican capital on Sunday, he became the youngest champion in the history of Formula 1.

"I'm still trying to realize and understand what just happened, when you work so hard and then you finally achieve it is truly special," said Antonelli, who was joined by his parents and younger sister. "All the emotions come, to be able to witness this moment with my family is a moment I will always remember." Antonelli, who secured the title with four races remaining, said the final lap was complicated by the excitement of what he had achieved - he began to savor it even before crossing the finish line.

"I think I lost two seconds because I could not see ahead, I think I saw two Ferraris," he said with a smile. "It was very special, a lot of memories went through my mind at that moment, and I let it all out after achieving one of my biggest dreams.

Antonelli, the first Italian to win the title since Alberto Ascari in 1953, took an unassailable lead in the standings over teammate George Russell and Ferrari's Hamilton.

Sebastian Vettel was the previous youngest champion at age 23 in 2010.

Although the Italian driver knew, after winning the United States Grand Prix, that the title was firmly within his grasp, his first few days in Mexico were not easy; he fell ill, even though he claimed on Sunday to be in his best physical shape.

But the greatest challenge was the mental battle that came with having the achievement so close within reach.

"The weekend has not been easy; I kept hearing the same thing over and over again. It is not easy to hear congratulations on a win when the job is not yet done. But hearing it repeatedly made me realize that I could actually achieve it." Verstappen, meanwhile, claimed his sixth victory at the Mexico City Grand Prix, further cementing his affinity with the circuit.



Kimi Antonelli (C) won his maiden world championship. REUTERS

"The Max-ico' Grand Prix will be a great name to call it," Verstappen said with a laugh. "To be honest I love the city and the fans, but I have no idea why I have won it six years, it just happened. It always comes together for me here."

> ***Although the Italian driver knew, after winning the US GP, that the title was within his grasp, his first few days in Mexico were not easy***

"For 73 years, our country has waited for this moment, and today an entire nation will celebrate one of its own reaching the very pinnacle of our sport," said Formula 1 CEO Stefano Domenicali.

"Today, his name joins the legends of our sport. A new chapter in Formula 1 history has been written, and I firmly believe this is only the beginning of an extraordinary legacy."

Infighting in Ferrari

Hamilton, who had secured pole position on Saturday, lost it on the fourth lap while battling for the lead with Leclerc. Hamilton briefly went off track, dropping back to third place.

The maneuver between the two Ferrari drivers was investigated, resulting in a five-second penalty for Leclerc - a decision that left seven-time world champion Hamilton fuming.

"The stewards are basically handing Charles this win. We agreed in the drivers' briefing," Hamilton said. "The problem with a 5-second penalty is that he's got clean air and doesn't have to manage (the car) like the rest of us. He should have just given the position back." Shortly before the red flag caused by Bottas' crash, Hamilton radioed, "We've got problems ... big, big problems." On pulling into the garage, he appeared visibly frustrated with his team.

Leclerc said after the race that he wanted to give the position back to Hamilton, but Verstappen got between them.

"At that point it did not matter because Max passed us and the race was done," Hamilton said. "I am happy, but we lost valuable points we could have easily been 1-2 today, but your teammate works against you, we just have to figure it out and something needs to change for sure."

Vol XCIV, Issue No. 307. Regd.No. DL-21046/03-05 RNI Regn. No. DELENG/2018/76281. Printed and Published by Ramesh Chander Malhotra on behalf of The Indian Express (P) Limited and Printed at The Indian Express (P) Limited Press, A-8, Sector-7, Noida -201301 and Published at The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9 &10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110002. Editorial office: The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9&10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002. Phone: 0120-6651500. Advertising office: The Indian Express (P) Ltd.,Express Building, B1/B, Ramnath Goenka Marg, Sector 10, Noida-201301. Phone:01206651291. Chairman of the Board: Viveck Goenka, Chief Editor: Raj Kamal Jha, Editor: Unni Rajen Shanker, Editor (Delhi):Monojit Majumdar** ** Responsible for selection of News under the PRP Act. Copyright: The Indian Express (P) Limited. All rights reserved. Reproduction in any manner, electronic or otherwise, in whole or in part, without prior written permission is prohibited. The Indian Express®